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01 International Relations 2025-26: War, Summits and Memberships

At a Glance

1. US-Israel vs Iran war from 28 February 2026 · Hormuz crisis · "Islamabad MoU" on 17-18 June (suspended by Iran on 18 July)
2. India chaired BRICS for the **fourth time** · 18th summit on 12-13 September, Bharat Mandapam · 140-point New Delhi Declaration
3. UAE out of both OPEC (Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries) and OPEC+ from **1 May 2026**
4. President of the 81st UNGA (United Nations General Assembly) session: **Khalilur Rahman** of Bangladesh · race for UN Secretary-General on, Guterres till 31 December
5. New faces: first woman PM in Japan and Morocco · youngest PM in Nepal · new PM in Britain

One Rule: Three Questions for Every News Item

- **A** **Where?** Place on the map — Makkah or Jeddah, Galle or Colombo
- **B** **Which forum?** Which group — G7 or G20, OPEC or OPEC+
- **C** **India's membership status?** Member, observer or outside — only an observer in the Board of Peace

Examiners create wrong options by changing one of these three — so every card in this chapter answers all three.

Board

India's Membership Status: Where India Stands in the Forums of 2026

Member

- **BRICS** — founder; 2026 chair
- **SCO** (Shanghai Cooperation Organisation) — full member since 2017
- **G20** — founder, 1999
- **Pax Silica** — 20 February 2026
- **US 6G initiative** — 7 September 2026
- **ICAO** (International Civil Aviation Organization) **Council** (Part II) 2025-28

Invitee/Observer

- **G7** — invitee (Evian 2026)
- **Board of Peace** — observer only
- **ASEAN** (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) — comprehensive strategic partner, not a member
- **P4M** (Partners for Multilateralism) **summit** — co-chair Jaishankar, co-sponsor

Outside

- **OPEC and OPEC+** — never a member
- **NATO**
- **Makkah Joint Defence Pact**
- **UNSC** (United Nations Security Council) — not permanent; last non-permanent term 2021-22

India Left/Changed

- **Ayni airbase** (Tajikistan) — Indian troops withdrawn
- **Kabul mission** — from technical mission to full embassy
- **UNGA "Correct the Map"** — voted in favour

1.1 War and Crisis: West Asia

Timeline **War 2026: Four Phases**

1 · War
28 Feb – 7 April

28 February
Epic Fury and Roaring Lion; Khamenei killed

4 March
IRIS Dena sunk near Galle

18 March
US: 60-day Jones Act waiver

27 March
India: excise duty cut by ₹10/litre

5 April
LPG tanker "Green Asha" crosses Hormuz

2 · Ceasefire
8 April – June

8 April
Two-week ceasefire; mediator Pakistan

11-12 April
Islamabad talks fail

At the UN
Russia-China veto on Hormuz resolution (Bahrain)

3 · Agreement
17-18 June

17-18 June
"Islamabad MoU" — electronic signatures of Trump and Pezeshkian

Terms
14 provisions; 60 days for a final deal

4 · Tension Again
July – August

18 July
Iran suspends MoU commitments

7 August
Makkah Joint Defence Pact

13 August
CENTCOM (US Central Command)'s "Falcon Strike"

24 August
"Operation Economic Outcast"

Map **Map of the War Zone — numbers = cards below**



Iran · Israel-Palestine · Three countries of the Makkah pact · India

Energy line · Chokepoint (red circle)

Golden letters: **A** Kharg Island (hub of Iran's oil exports) · **B** Bab-el-Mandeb · grey dotted line: route of IRIS Dena returning from Visakhapatnam

1 Tehran: Start of the War

28 February 2026 | India: not a party

- US-Israel strikes on Iran's capital

1. US **"Operation Epic Fury"** · Israel's **"Operation Roaring Lion"**
2. Supreme Leader **Ayatollah Ali Khamenei** killed · successor his son **Mojtaba Khamenei**
3. Iran's response **"True Promise 4"** · decentralised war doctrine **"Operation Mosaic"**

> Identify the country by the name: Lion = Israel (Lion of Judah), Epic = US, Promise = Iran's "True Promise".

! **Trap** Roaring Lion is Israel's, not the US's — the reversed pair will appear in options.

2 Hormuz: Crisis and India

March-April | India: direct impact

- Strait between Iran and Oman (Musandam)

1. On **5 April** the Indian LPG tanker **"Green Asha"** crossed Hormuz
2. **27 March** excise duty on petrol-diesel cut by **₹10/litre** · Navy's **"Operation Urja Suraksha"** · **RAHAT Scheme 2026**
3. **Russia-China veto** on the Hormuz resolution (**Bahrain**) in the UNSC · 11 in favour · 2 abstentions including Pakistan
4. Iranian parliament approved the principles of the "foreign infiltration" bill by **183 votes** (not final)

! **Trap** The resolution was Bahrain's; Pakistan abstained, it did not oppose.

3 Galle: War at Sea

4 March 2026 | Indian Ocean

- Near Galle, Sri Lanka, outside its territorial waters

1. Iranian warship **IRIS Dena** torpedoed and sunk by a **US submarine**
2. The ship was returning from the Indian Navy's **International Fleet Review (IFR) and MILAN** exercise (Visakhapatnam)
3. US claim: **first enemy warship** sunk by torpedo since World War II · Sri Lanka Navy rescued 32 people

! **Trap** The place is Galle (southern Sri Lanka), not Colombo or Hormuz; the submarine was American.

4 Islamabad: Ceasefire and MoU

Mediator: Pakistan | 17-18 June

- Pakistan's capital — the talks were held here, and the agreement is named after it

1. **8 April** two-week ceasefire, mediator **Pakistan**
2. **11-12 April** Islamabad talks fail: **J.D. Vance** from the US; **Ghalibaf and Araghchi** from Iran; hosts Shehbaz Sharif and Asim Munir
3. **17-18 June "Islamabad MoU"**: electronic signatures of Trump-Pezeshkian · **14 provisions** · **60 days** for a final agreement (extendable by mutual consent)
4. **18 July** Iran suspended its MoU commitments, accusing the US of violations (Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi)

! **Trap** The mediator was Pakistan, not Qatar or Oman. The MoU was not a "final agreement".

5 Gaza: "Board of Peace"

India: observer | 22 January 2026

Gaza Strip; charter signed at Davos, first meeting in Washington

1. Basis: **UNSC Resolution 2803** (17 November 2025)
2. Charter **22 January 2026, Davos** · chair **Trump** · High Representative **Nickolay Mladenov** · 20+ countries
3. First meeting **19 February, Washington** · India an **observer** (along with Germany, Italy, Norway, Switzerland, Britain)
4. Draft condition: 3-year term, permanent membership for **$1 billion**

! **Trap** India is not a member of the Board of Peace, only an observer.

6 Makkah: Joint Defence Pact

7 August 2026 | India: outside

Makkah, Saudi Arabia (Al-Safa Palace)

1. **Saudi Arabia, Türkiye, Pakistan** · "an attack on one = an attack on all"
2. Signed by Crown Prince **Mohammed bin Salman**, **Erdoğan**, **Shehbaz Sharif**
3. Basis: Pakistan-Saudi **"Strategic Mutual Defence Agreement"** (September 2025, Riyadh) · expansion possible per Türkiye (Egypt likely)

> Three countries, three strengths: Saudi (money), Türkiye (arms industry), Pakistan (nuclear army) — a promise like NATO's Article 5.

! **Trap** Türkiye is already a NATO member — so one country is in both collective-defence blocs.

7 Lebanon

1. **Qasmiyeh bridge** on the Litani river destroyed

8 Yemen

1. **Mokha port** under Houthi control (near Bab-el-Mandeb)

9 Durand Line

1. Pakistan's **"Operation Ghazab lil-Haq"** (Afghan border) · Russia-Ukraine war still unresolved

US Moves (off the map)

Washington and CENTCOM

1. **18 March** 60-day waiver from the **Jones Act (1920)** · **PrSM** (Precision Strike Missile) used in the war
2. **13 August** CENTCOM's (Admiral **Brad Cooper**) drone task force **"Falcon Strike"** — successor to "Scorpion Strike"
3. **24 August** Treasury Secretary **Scott Bessent**'s **"Operation Economic Outcast"** — targeting digital assets, technology, gold, aviation, shipping

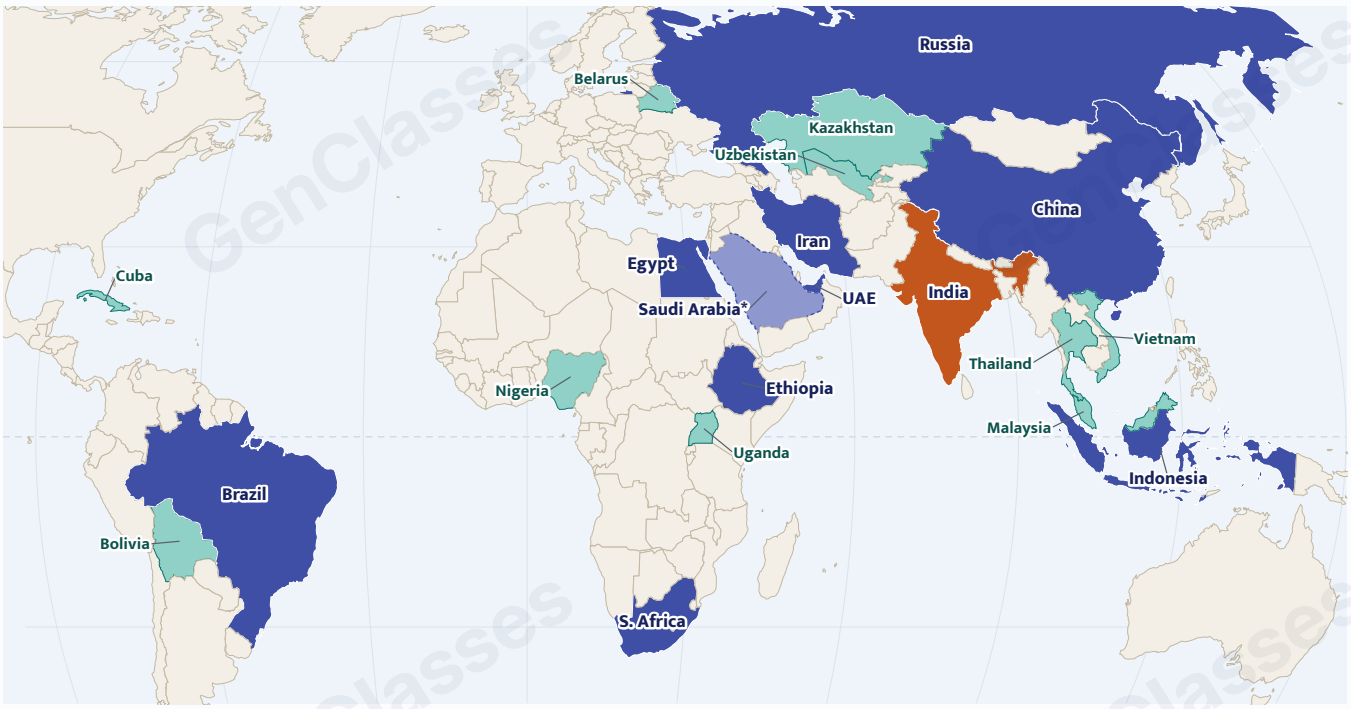
> Jones Act = only US ships can carry cargo between US ports; the waiver let foreign tankers carry fuel too.

Static

1. **Strait of Hormuz**: between Iran and Oman (Musandam Peninsula) · connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman-Arabian Sea · over 20 million barrels of oil a day
2. **(A) Kharg Island**: in the Persian Gulf · 90-96% of Iran's oil exports pass through it
3. **(B) Bab-el-Mandeb** ("Gate of Tears"): connects the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden · separates the Arabian Peninsula (Yemen) from the Horn of Africa (Djibouti-Eritrea)

1.2 BRICS 2026: India the Host

Map **BRICS Family: 11 Members + 10 Partners**



Members: Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa + Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia, Indonesia · **Partners:** Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Vietnam

A 18th Summit: Bharat Mandapam

12-13 September 2026 | India chair for the fourth time

1. **20 years** of BRICS (first BRIC foreign ministers' meeting in 2006)
2. Theme: **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"**
3. Image of the **Ramanathaswamy Temple (Rameswaram)** behind the stage

> Join the first letters of the theme: **B**uilding · **R**esilience · **I**nnovation · **C**ooperation · **S**ustainability = BRICS.

B New Delhi Declaration

140 points | 12 September, by consensus

1. Criticism of **unilateral tariffs** · support for global governance and **UNSC reform**
2. Condemnation of the **Pahalgam terror attack** · the most detailed section on **AI** so far
3. **UAE-Iran joint statement** through India's mediation

C Who Came, Who Did Not

1. Special guest **Bangladesh** · Xi Jinping and Putin announced to attend
2. Brazil's **Lula did not** come (elections), the foreign minister came · from Saudi Arabia Foreign Minister **Faisal bin Farhan** (as an invitee)
3. Next chair **China (2027)**

! **Trap** Saudi Arabia has not formally confirmed membership — that is the catch in any "11th member" statement.

D BRICS Summits in India

1. **2012** New Delhi — 4th summit, **idea of the NDB** (New Development Bank)
2. **2016** Goa — 8th
3. **2021** Virtual — 13th
4. **2026** New Delhi — 18th

India's turn every 5 years: 2016 → 2021 → 2026 (order B-R-I-C-S).

Map BRICS 2026: Which Meeting in Which City



1. **New Delhi** — Foreign ministers (14-15 May) · **Summit** (12-13 September)
2. **Lucknow** — Statistics chiefs (3-4 August) · 18th Academic Forum (24 August)
3. **Hyderabad** — Labour (15 July) · Anti-corruption (4-5 August)
4. **Gandhinagar** — Justice (from 21 May) · Youth (19-20 August)
5. **Indore** — 16th Agriculture Ministers' meeting (12-13 June)
6. **Gurugram** — 11th Energy (25 June)
7. **Kochi** — Women (from 6 July)
8. **Guwahati** — Anti-drug agency chiefs (6-7 July)
9. **Chandigarh** — 16th Health (22-24 July)
10. **Goa** — 8th Ocean-Polar Science, NCPOR (12-14 August)
11. **Pune** — 12th Communications (21 August)
12. **Visakhapatnam** — Youth and Sports (22-23 August)
13. **Bhopal** — 11th Culture (8 August) → **"Bhopal Declaration"**
14. **Jaipur** — 2nd Tourism (19 August) → **"Jaipur Declaration"**

Two declaration cities, both heritage cities: **Bhopal** (culture — land of Bhimbetka-Sanchi) and **Jaipur** (tourism — the Pink City). 8th narcotics control meeting held virtually (17 June).

Static

1. The term "BRIC" was coined by **Jim O'Neill** (Goldman Sachs, 2001) · first summit **2009 Yekaterinburg** · South Africa joined in **2010**
2. **New Development Bank**: agreement 15 July 2014, Fortaleza · operational from 21 July 2015 · headquarters **Shanghai** · first president K.V. Kamath (India)
3. Uzbekistan is the NDB's first partner and 10th member · any UN member can join the NDB

1.3 Other Summits: Calendar of 2026

Calendar **Summit Calendar: When, Where, Which Forum**

Oct.-Nov. 2025	January	February	March	April-May	June
22nd ASEAN-India 26 Oct., Kuala Lumpur	**WEF** (World Economic Forum) **56th** 19-23, Davos	**India in Pax Silica** 20, AI Impact Summit	**Raisina Dialogue 11th** 5-7, New Delhi	**Islamabad talks** 11-12 April	**52nd G7** 15-17, Evian
20th G20 Nov., Johannesburg	**Board of Peace** 22, Davos		**WTO** (World Trade Organization) **MC14** 26-30, Yaoundé	**48th ASEAN** 8 May, Cebu	**Pax Silica-2** 25-26, Washington

July	August	September	October	November (upcoming)	December
NATO 7-8, Ankara	**Makkah pact** 7, Makkah	**18th BRICS** 12-13, New Delhi	**World Food Forum** 12-16, FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization) Rome	**COP31** Antalya, Türkiye	**21st G20** 14-15, Miami
EAS Foreign Ministers 22-23, Manila	**26th SCO** 31 Aug.-1 Sep., Bishkek	**UNGA-81 and P4M** 8 and 21, New York		**APEC** Shenzhen, China	

52nd G7: Evian-les-Bains (France)

15-17 June 2026 · India: invitee

1. 8 invitees: **India, Brazil, South Korea, Kenya, Ukraine, Egypt, Qatar, UAE** · PM Modi attended
2. Meeting with Trump: West Asia, India-US interim trade agreement

> Evian = the "Evian" mineral-water town on Lake Geneva; the G8 was held here in 2003 too, when India (Vajpayee) was invited to the outreach for the first time.

G20: From Africa to America

20th · 21st

1. **20th Johannesburg** (November 2025): first in Africa · theme "Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability" · **122-point** declaration · boycotted by the US
2. **21st 14-15 December 2026, Miami** (Trump National Doral) · South Africa not invited

26th SCO: Bishkek (Kyrgyzstan)

India: member | 31 Aug.-1 Sep.

1. **25 years** of the SCO · **"Bishkek Declaration"** signed
2. India's initiative: **English as an official language** in the SCO Charter · Civilisational Dialogue Forum, Young Scientists Forum
3. Next chair **Pakistan**, 27th summit in 2027 · **Lahore** SCO tourism-cultural capital 2026-27

Trap Until now the SCO's official languages were only Russian and Chinese.

NATO: Ankara Summit

India: outside | 7-8 July 2026

1. 36th summit, **Beştepe complex** · 32 members · **"Ankara Declaration"**: Article 5 reaffirmed, Russia a long-term threat
2. **€70 billion** military aid to Ukraine for 2026
3. **5%** of GDP on defence by 2035 (Hague pledge, 2025)

ASEAN 2026: Chair the Philippines

India: partner

1. 48th summit **8 May, Cebu** (chair passed from Malaysia's Anwar Ibrahim to Marcos)
2. **Timor-Leste** 11th member (October 2025)
3. 22nd ASEAN-India summit 26 October 2025, Kuala Lumpur — Modi joined virtually (12th time)
4. EAS Foreign Ministers 22-23 July, Manila (Jaishankar) · Economic Ministers 21-22 September, Manila

Forums and Dialogues

1. **WEF 56th** Davos, 19-23 January · theme **"A Spirit of Dialogue"**
2. **Raisina Dialogue 11th** 5-7 March · theme "Samskara: Assertion, Accommodation, Advancement" · chief guest Finland's President **Alexander Stubb**
3. **WTO MC14** 26-30 March, **Yaoundé (Cameroon)** · Hamburg Sustainability Conference "We co-create sustainable development together" · 27th World Knowledge Forum, Seoul "The Promethean Moment"

Static

1. **G-7**: began in 1975 (France) as the G-6 · **G20**: 1999 · African Union a full member in 2023
2. **SCO**: 2001, Shanghai · secretariat Beijing · RATS Tashkent · India-Pakistan full members in 2017
3. **NATO**: 1949 Washington Treaty · headquarters Brussels · 32 members · **ASEAN**: 1967 Bangkok Declaration · secretariat Jakarta
4. **WTO**: 1995, Geneva · MC13 Abu Dhabi (2024) · **WEF**: 1971 Klaus Schwab · earlier "European Management Forum", WEF since 1987 · headquarters Cologny (Switzerland)

1.4 Changes in Membership

Board Who Joined, Who Left, Who Was Elected

Joined

- **Timor-Leste** → ASEAN (11th)
- **Bangladesh** (27th) and **Saudi** (26th) → IBCA (International Big Cat Alliance)
- **Cambodia** → UPI (9th country)
- **Bulgaria** → Eurozone (21st)
- **India** → Pax Silica and US 6G initiative
- **EU** → Pax Silica (June 2026)
- **Türkiye** → Artemis Accords (71st)

Left

- **UAE** → OPEC and OPEC+ (1 May 2026)
- **US** → 66 organisations (7 January 2026; incl. UNFCCC (United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change), ISA) and WHO (World Health Organization)
- **Venezuela** → Rome Statute / ICC
- **India** → Tajikistan's Ayni base

Elected

- **UNSC non-permanent 2027-28** (3 June): Austria, Kyrgyzstan (first time), Portugal, Trinidad and Tobago, Zimbabwe
- **India** → re-elected to ICAO Council (Part II) 2025-28

Suspension

- **Cricket Canada** — suspended by the ICC
- **Belarus** — IOC (International Olympic Committee) suspension lifted conditionally
- **Russia** — IOC suspension continues

Diagram The 15 Members of the Security Council: 2026 and Beyond

Permanent 5 (veto)

USA	Britain	France	Russia	China

Non-permanent 2025-26 — leave on 31 December 2026

Denmark	Greece	Pakistan	Panama	Somalia

Non-permanent 2026-27 — will continue

Bahrain	Colombia	DR Congo	Latvia	Liberia

New 2027-28 — elected on 3 June 2026 (from 1 January 2027)

Austria	Kyrgyzstan ★	Portugal	Trinidad and Tobago	Zimbabwe

Every year 5 non-permanent members are elected for two years · two-thirds of those present and voting in the General Assembly needed · ★ Kyrgyzstan for the first time · Asian seat replacing Pakistan: Kyrgyzstan

1.5 The United Nations and Its Agencies

President of the General Assembly (UNGA)

- Term **1 year**, by regional rotation
- 81st session: **Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh)
- Only one from India so far: **Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit** (1953, 8th session)

VS

Secretary-General (SG)

- Term **5 years**
- Appointed by the General Assembly on the Security Council's recommendation (Art. 97) — P5 veto applies
- Guterres's term till **31 December 2026** · no woman SG so far

81st Session of the UNGA

8 September 2026 | Asia-Pacific's turn

1. President **Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh's foreign minister) · defeated Cyprus's Andreas Kakouris **99-91** on 2 June
2. Bangladesh **after 40 years** (1986, 41st session: Humayun Rasheed Choudhury)
3. Theme: "Restoring trust, managing transformation: a United Nations that delivers for all"
4. Previous president **Annalena Baerbock** (Germany) visited India on 28 April, then China

Race for Secretary-General: Straw Polls

No recommendation yet

1. **30 July**: Rebeca Grynspan (Costa Rica) 10 · Carolyn Rodrigues-Birkett (Guyana) 9
2. **21 August**: Rodrigues-Birkett 8 · Grynspan and Rafael Grossi (Argentina) 7 each
3. **18 September**: Grynspan 9 in favour / 5 against · Grossi 5 / 8

> All three contenders are from Latin America-Caribbean — the informal regional turn is considered to be this region's.

First P4M Summit

India: co-chair | 21 September 2026

1. Full name: Partners for Multilateralism, International Law, Peace and Prosperity
2. Co-chair **Jaishankar** · co-sponsors Australia, Brazil, Barbados, EU, Canada, India, Kenya

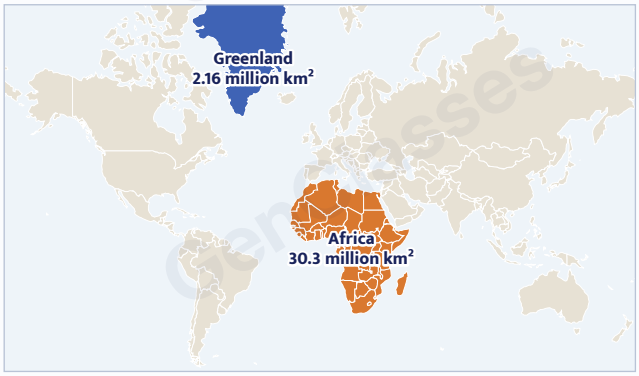
New Heads, a New Day, New Meetings

1. **UNESCO** (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization): Khaled El-Enany (Egypt; 12th; first Arab; 172 of 174 votes) · **WFP** (World Food Programme): Luke Lindberg (after Cindy McCain) · UN Resident Coordinator in India Stefan Priesner (Austria)
2. New UN Day **27 November**: elimination of child and forced marriage (UNGA 4 September 2026; Sierra Leone's initiative; India a co-sponsor)
3. UN's first AI governance dialogue 6-7 July, Geneva (Kirti Vardhan Singh) · UNCTAD consumer protection meeting 6-8 July (chaired by India) · World Food Forum 12-16 October, FAO Rome · APO's 68th Governing Body meeting 20-22 May, New Delhi

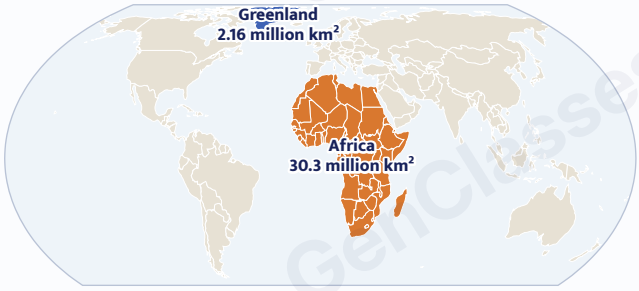
Diagram

"Correct the Map": Why the Map Shows Africa Small

Mercator (1569): Greenland looks almost as big as Africa!



Equal Earth (2018): true proportions



1. **4 September 2026**, UNGA resolution A/RES/80/297 · moved by **Togo** on behalf of the African Group (54 countries)
2. **164 in favour** (India too) · 6 abstentions · only the **US** against
3. Suggestion: adopt the **"Equal Earth"** projection — the resolution is **not binding**
4. Africa is actually about **14 times** larger than Greenland

One rule: area inflation in Mercator ≈ 1 ÷ cos²(latitude)

0° (Equator)	1×
30°	1.33×
45°	2×
60° (Oslo)	4×
72° (central Greenland)	10.5×

Land swells towards the poles; Africa, sitting on the Equator, keeps its true size, while Greenland swells 10 times.

1.6 Groups of Oil, Finance and Technology

Timeline

Order of Countries Leaving OPEC

2016	1 Jan. 2019	1 Jan. 2020	1 Jan. 2024	1 May 2026
Indonesia (membership suspended)	Qatar	Ecuador	Angola	UAE (from OPEC+ too)

11 remaining: Algeria, Congo, Equatorial Guinea, Gabon, Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Libya, Nigeria, Saudi Arabia, Venezuela

UAE's Exit from OPEC

Effective 1 May 2026 | India: never a member

1. Announced on **28 April** · out of **OPEC+** too
2. The UAE held about **14%** of OPEC's production capacity · reasons: differences with Saudi Arabia over output caps, Gulf equations disturbed by the war

! **Trap** The UAE left OPEC+ too — an option saying "only OPEC" is wrong.

Pax Silica

India: 20 February 2026

1. US **AI-semiconductor supply-chain** initiative (December 2025)
2. India joined during the **AI Impact Summit** · second summit 25-26 June, Washington, 35 countries' **AI workers' pledge**

Silica = silicon chips made from sand; "Pax" = peace alliance → a chip alliance.

US 6G Initiative

India: 7 September 2026

1. July 2026 · **26 countries**
2. India on **7 September** — at the G20 innovation ministers' meeting, **Chapel Hill** (US)

New Money, New Rules

1. Trump's **"Gold Card"** visa — permanent residence for $1 million
2. Japan's first yen stablecoin **JPYC**
3. China's **15th Five-Year Plan** (June 2026): half of electricity non-fossil by 2030

Static

1. **OPEC**: 14 September 1960, **Baghdad** · founders Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia, Venezuela · headquarters **Vienna** (moved from Geneva in 1965)
2. 12 members before the UAE left · **OPEC+** formed in 2016 by adding Russia and others · India is a member of neither

1.7 Changes of Government Around the World

Asia

First woman PM: Japan | Youngest PM: Nepal

1. **Japan**: Sanae Takaichi — first woman PM (21 October 2025), again after the February 2026 election
2. **Bangladesh**: Tarique Rahman (BNP) 11th PM, 17 February 2026 (209 of 297) · President Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir (23rd, 20 August)
3. **Nepal**: Balen Shah (RSP) 47th and youngest PM (35 years), 27 March 2026, after the Gen-Z movement · Bhumika Shrestha first openly transgender MP
4. **Myanmar** Min Aung Hlaing President (10 April) · **Vietnam** To Lam President (2026-31) · **Mongolia** Nyam-Osor Uchral PM · **South Korea** Han Seong-suk nominated PM

Europe

New PM in Britain

1. **Britain**: Andy Burnham PM (20 July, replacing Starmer) · Kanishka Narayan first AI minister
2. **Netherlands**: Rob Jetten (38) — youngest and first openly gay PM
3. **Norway**: King Harald V died (28 August), **Haakon VIII** king
4. **Italy**: Meloni 1,413 days in a row — longest government since World War II (beyond Berlusconi's 1,412) · **Bulgaria** 21st in the Eurozone

The Americas

1. **Venezuela**: Maduro in US custody · Delcy Rodríguez interim
2. **Peru** Keiko Fujimori (sworn in 28 July) · **Colombia** Abelardo de la Espriella (7 August) · **Chile** José Antonio Kast (11 March) · **Barbados** Mia Mottley (third time)
3. **New York** Mayor Zohran Mamdani (1 January 2026; first Muslim and South Asian) · **Virginia** Lieutenant Governor Ghazala Hashmi · **Fed Chair** Kevin Warsh (22 May)

Africa and West Asia

First woman PM: Morocco

1. **Morocco**: Fatima Zahra El Mansouri — first woman PM (29 September)
2. **Uganda** Museveni for the seventh time (12 May) · **Djibouti** Guelleh for the sixth time · **Senegal** Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo PM
3. **Iraq** Nizar Amidi (Kurd) · **Yemen** Shaya al-Zindani PM · Roman Gofman 14th chief of Israel's **Mossad** (2 June)

Courts and Justice

1. **Assad** sentenced to death in absentia by a Damascus court (11 August; in Moscow since 8 December 2024)
2. Former CJI (Chief Justice of India) **D.Y. Chandrachud** an arbitrator on Russia's side (in Ukraine's Oschadbank dispute)

Trap

1. Two "first woman PMs": **Japan** (Takaichi) and **Morocco** (Mansouri)
2. Nepal's Balen Shah is the **47th** PM, aged 35 · the Netherlands' Jetten is 38 — both "youngest" in their own country

1.8 The World's "First-Ever" Policies

Scale Children and Social Media: Age Limits

Australia — first country (10 Dec. 2025)	**16 and below**
Spain — first in Europe	**16 and below**
Indonesia (March 2026)	**16 and below**
France (Parliament)	**15 and below**
UAE (minimum age)	**15 and below**
Türkiye (parental controls too)	**15 and below**

Fines up to A$49.5 million in Australia · in India, Karnataka proposed it in its budget (6 March)

Generational Ban on Tobacco

1. **Maldives**: born after 1 January 2007 — first in the world
2. **Britain** Tobacco and Vapes Act: born after 1 January 2009

Trap The first country is the Maldives, not Britain.

Other Initiatives

1. **Uruguay**: first Catholic Latin American country to legalise euthanasia
2. **Indonesia** blocked Grok over deepfakes
3. **Scotland** legalised "water cremation" (alkaline hydrolysis) — up to 90% less carbon
4. **Switzerland** rejected a population cap of 10 million (14 June; now about 9.1 million)
5. **Nauru** renamed "Republic of Naoero" (May 2026)

New Names and News from the US

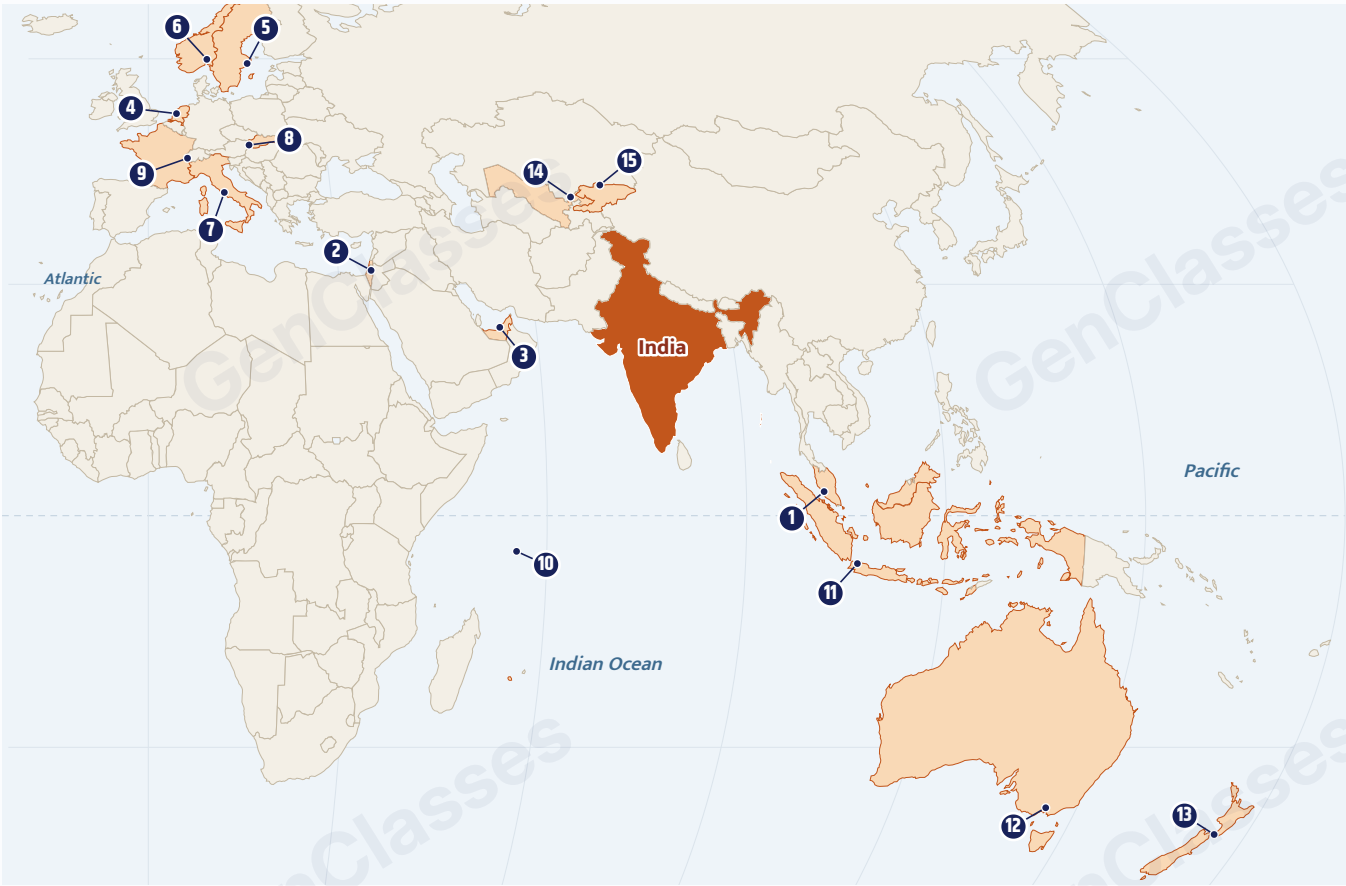
1. **Lake Ontario** to "Lake America" — Executive Order 14420 (27 August; federal use only)
2. **Indo-Pacific Command** back to "Pacific Command" (founded 1 January 1947, Truman; HQ Camp H.M. Smith, Hawaii; renamed in 2018)
3. **250 years** of independence (4-8 July; **INS Sudarshini** in the New York naval review)
4. US-Greenland-Denmark security agreement (22 September; sovereignty remains Denmark's) · "Project Meridian" (30 September, 120 days; Musk, Palmer Luckey, Newt Gingrich) · Britain's RAF gets its first dedicated space squadron (23 September)

Mass Movements and Disasters

1. **Albania**: "Flamingo Revolution" against a $1.6 billion resort
2. Russian refining about 3.6 million barrels/day in July (30%+ lower; Ukrainian drones)
3. Submarine volcano in the **Bismarck Sea** · North Korea: nuclear programme "absolutely non-negotiable"

1.9 India's Foreign Policy: PM's Visits and Leaders Who Came to India

Map **PM Modi's Visits in 2026 — in Date Order**



Numbers = cards below · light saffron: countries visited

1 Malaysia

7-8 February

1. 11 agreements
2. Settlement in **rupee-ringgit**

2 Israel

25-26 February

1. First Indian PM to address the **Knesset** (120 members)
2. First foreigner to receive the "Speaker of the Knesset Medal"
3. Special Strategic Partnership · 27 agreements · UPI

3 UAE

15 May

1. Oil storage of up to 30 million barrels in India · Vadinar maritime infrastructure
2. C-DAC-G42 **8-exaflop** AI cluster · about $5 billion

4 Netherlands

15-20 May

1. Visited the **Afsluitdijk dam** (about 32 km) — for Gujarat's **Kalpasar project** (Gulf of Khambhat)

5 Sweden

15-20 May

1. "Royal Order of the **Polar Star**" — Modi's 31st foreign honour

6 Norway

15-20 May

1. "Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian **Order of Merit**" — 32nd

7 Italy

20 May

1. Target of **€20 billion** by 2029
2. FAO (Rome) **"Agricola Medal"**

8 Slovakia

14-16 June

1. First visit by an Indian PM since **1993** (independent Slovakia)

9 France

14-18 June

1. **G-7** (Evian) · "India Nouvelles 2026" in Nice · **VivaTech** in Paris

10 Seychelles

27-29 June

1. Guest at the **50th National Day** · first Indian PM to address the National Assembly
2. ₹1,250 crore credit · patrol vessel "Lespwar" · honour "Guardian of the Blue Horizon"

11 Indonesia

6-8 July

1. First address to Parliament · honour **"Bintang Adipurna"**
2. Prambanan temple · 100 tonnes of DWR-162 wheat seed · "Tagore-Dewantara" year

12 Australia

8-10 July

1. Third annual summit in Melbourne · provisions of the 2014 nuclear agreement finalised

13 New Zealand

10-11 July

1. **First visit in 40 years** · "Roadmap-2030"
2. NZ in the Global Biofuels Alliance · 2 kiwi centres (Nagaland, Uttarakhand)

14 Uzbekistan

30 August

1. Highest honour **"Oliy Darajali Do'stlik"** in Tashkent
2. Ties: "Comprehensive Strategic Partnership" · $5 billion trade by 2030 · uranium framework

15 Kyrgyzstan

31 Aug.-1 Sep.

1. 26th **SCO summit**, Bishkek · Bishkek Declaration

"First Indian PM address" in three parliaments: the **Knesset** (Israel), the **National Assembly** (Seychelles), the **Indonesian Parliament** — i.e., February, June, July. Honour count: Sweden 31st, Norway 32nd.

Timeline **Foreign Leaders Who Came to India (2025-26)**

4-5 Dec. 2025	**Putin** — 23rd annual summit; first visit since 2022
12-13 Jan. 2026	**Merz** (Germany) — 19 agreements in Gandhinagar
19 Jan.	**Mohamed bin Zayed** (UAE) — $200 billion by 2032
26-27 Jan.	**EU leadership** — Republic Day chief guests; 16th summit on 27 January
5-10 Feb.	**Patrick Herminie** (Seychelles) — vision "SESEL", $175 million
17-19 Feb.	**Macron** — Year of Innovation; MFN clause removed from the 1992 treaty
18-22 Feb.	**Lula** (Brazil) — $20 billion target
2 March	**Mark Carney** (Canada) — uranium; $50 billion by 2030
4-7 March	**Alexander Stubb** (Finland) — strategic partnership
19-21 April	**Lee Jae-myung** (South Korea) — $50 billion
30 May-3 June	**Min Aung Hlaing** (Myanmar)
3-7 June	**Delcy Rodríguez** (Venezuela)
1-3 July	**Sanae Takaichi** (Japan) — 129 MoUs, ¥10 trillion
2026	**Christodoulides** (Cyprus) — defence roadmap 2026-31

Also: 2nd India-Arab Foreign Ministers' meeting on 31 January (co-chair UAE; first in 2016, Bahrain) · 7th NSA (National Security Adviser) meeting of the Colombo Security Conclave on 20 November 2025 (Doval) · 10 agreements with Mongolia (free e-visa) · 2 with Angola

President Murmu: Eastern Europe

19-25 July 2026

1. **Moldova** and **North Macedonia** — first state visit by any Indian President
2. Gandhi statue in Skopje — **birthplace of Mother Teresa**
3. **Romania** — after three decades

Small but Frequently Asked Country-wise Facts

Russia	RELOS (Reciprocal Exchange of Logistics Support) in force · Russian "Tirukkural" gifted to Putin (133 chapters, 1,330 couplets) · trade target $100 billion by 2030 · Russia imported petrol from India for the first time (5 August)
USA	Massachusetts, Boston, New York-New Jersey declared 15 August "India Day" · NY parade 16 August
Saudi · UAE	Water management agreement in Jeddah (29 June) · cultural agreement in Riyadh · "India House" in Abu Dhabi · yoga a competitive sport · 14th meeting of the investment task force, Mumbai (28 September)
Ethiopia	Agreement supporting WTO membership (22 May, Geneva) · highest honour "Great Honour Nishan" to Modi
Bangladesh	New High Commissioner Asad Alam Siam · India now second in trade (China first)
Neighbours	First India-made high-speed boat to the Maldives · 1,000 tonnes of rice to Malawi · first trilingual school in Polonnaruwa, Sri Lanka · Kabul mission a full embassy
EU and others	12th Human Rights Dialogue (24 June) · EV battery recycling ₹169 crore · audit cooperation with Israel (23 June) · MSME (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) dialogue with Denmark (Copenhagen) · forest working group with Japan (Bengaluru, 8 September)
Geneva	5 peacocks gifted to UNOG — "the newest, most colourful diplomats"

Points to Note

1. India is not a member of the "Board of Peace" — only an **observer**
2. The ceasefire mediator was **Pakistan**, not Qatar · Iran **suspended** the MoU on 18 July
3. "Roaring Lion" is Israel's, "Epic Fury" the US's, "True Promise 4" Iran's
4. IRIS Dena sank near Galle (Sri Lanka) while returning from MILAN (Visakhapatnam)
5. Makkah pact: Saudi + Türkiye + Pakistan — not the UAE or Egypt
6. The UAE is out of both OPEC **and** OPEC+ · India was never an OPEC member
7. The UNGA President changes every year, the Secretary-General serves 5 years · India's only UNGA President: Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit
8. Khalilur Rahman is not the first Bangladeshi President — Humayun Rasheed Choudhury in 1986
9. Kyrgyzstan in the UNSC **for the first time** · Pakistan among those leaving
10. "Correct the Map" is not binding · only the US opposed · moved by Togo
11. Bhopal Declaration = culture · Jaipur Declaration = tourism
12. The SCO Charter now has English too — earlier only Russian-Chinese

02 Polity 2025-26: Parliament, Judiciary and Elections

At a Glance

1. **131st Constitutional Amendment** (850 Lok Sabha seats) failed on 17 April 2026: 298 in favour, 352 needed
2. Kerala is now **"Keralam"** (25 August 2026) · Supreme Court judges **34 to 38**
3. **Census 2027**: first digital census with self-enumeration · first caste count since 1931
4. 2026 elections: BJP for the first time in Bengal · TVK (Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam) in Tamil Nadu · UDF (United Democratic Front) returns in Kerala
5. CJI (Chief Justice of India) **Surya Kant** (53rd) · Vice-President **C.P. Radhakrishnan** (15th) · new CIC (Chief Information Commissioner) **Raj Kumar Goyal**

One Rule: For Every Parliamentary News Item Ask "Which Majority?"

- **A** **Simple** — new state, name or boundary (Art. 3-4): Keralam · number of SC judges
- **B** **Effective** — removing the Lok Sabha Speaker-Deputy Speaker, Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman (14 days' notice)
- **C** **Special** — amendment under Art. 368 · removing an SC judge and the CEC (Chief Election Commissioner)
- **D** **Special + half the states** — amendments affecting the federal structure

The 131st bill failed on "C", Keralam passed on "A" — both news items of the same year.

2.1 The Constitutional Amendment Bill That Could Not Pass

Diagram **131st Constitutional Amendment Bill: The Arithmetic of the Vote (17 April 2026, Lok Sabha)**



1. Present and voting: 298 + 230 = **528** → two-thirds of this = **352**
2. First condition (majority of total membership, 272) met — 298 > 272
3. Second condition (⅔) not met — 298 < 352 → **bill defeated**
4. The **first bill** defeated in the Lok Sabha in 12 years of the Modi government

1 What It Sought

Introduced 16 April 2026

1. Amend Art. 81-82 to raise the Lok Sabha's maximum strength **from 550 to 850** (states 815 + UTs 35)
2. Women's reservation under Art. 334A from **2029 instead of 2034**

! **Trap** 850 is the cap for the whole House, not for the states alone (states 815).

2 Controversy and Outcome

Defeated

1. Seats were to be allocated on the **2011 Census** · southern states feared political loss · last delimitation 2002 (2001 Census)
2. **Delimitation Bill 2026** and **Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill 2026** withdrawn (Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju)

3 But the 106th Is Alive

Nari Shakti Vandan

1. **Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam** (106th Amendment) in force from 16 April 2026
2. The real benefit of reservation comes from the delimitation after the next census

> The 131st failed — not the 106th on women's reservation.

Static

1. Constitutional amendment (Art. 368): in each House a **majority of total membership** and **two-thirds of those present and voting** · amendments affecting the federal structure also need ratification by half the states
2. Art. 4: laws made under Art. 2-3 (new state, changing name or boundary) are not "amendments" — a simple majority is enough

2.2 Parliament 2026: An Account of Proceedings

Kerala to "Keralam" (Art. 3)

In force 25 August 2026 | Simple majority

- Name changed in the First Schedule of the Constitution

1. Lok Sabha **11 August**, Rajya Sabha **12 August** · after the President's assent, the Home Ministry brought it into force from 25 August
2. Procedure: President's prior recommendation → views of the state legislature (not binding) → simple majority in Parliament

> **Trap** It is not an amendment under Art. 368 — Art. 4 says so clearly.

Monsoon Session 2026

20 July – 13 August

1. **19 sittings** · **12 bills** passed by both Houses
2. In this session: Keralam, number of SC judges, Public Examinations amendment, Prevention of Insults to National Honour amendment, tribunal reform

Motion to Remove the Lok Sabha Speaker

11 March 2026 | Defeated by voice vote

1. Against **Om Birla** · debate chaired by **Jagdambika Pal**
2. Earlier: **Mavalankar 1954, Hukam Singh 1966, Balram Jakhar 1987** — all failed

> **Trap** No Lok Sabha Speaker has ever been removed this way.

Art. 94-96: Rules for the Speaker

1. Loses office on losing membership · resignation addressed to the **Deputy Speaker**
2. Removal by **effective majority**, with **14 days'** notice
3. Stays in office after dissolution until the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha
4. While a removal resolution is pending cannot preside, but can vote in the first instance — no casting vote

Notice to Remove the CEC

March 2026 | Rejected on 6 April

1. Against Chief Election Commissioner **Gyanesh Kumar** · about 193 MPs (Rajya Sabha 63 + Lok Sabha 130)
2. Rejected by: Om Birla and C.P. Radhakrishnan
3. The CEC can be removed only on the same grounds as an SC judge, by special majority under **Art. 324(5) and 124(4)**

> **Trap** Speaker = effective majority; CEC/judge = special majority.

"One Nation One Election"

Pending

1. Term of the JPC (chair **P.P. Chaudhary**) extended
2. No bill passed

Timeline — Attempts to Remove the Lok Sabha Speaker — All Failed

- **1954** — G.V. Mavalankar
- **1966** — Hukam Singh
- **1987** — Balram Jakhar
- **11 March 2026** — Om Birla (defeated by voice vote)

Board

New Laws: What Changed

1 Four Labour Codes

21 November 2025

1. **29 central labour laws** merged

2 DPDP Rules 2025

13 November 2025

1. Phased over 18 months: Board immediately · consent managers 13 November 2026 · rest 13 May 2027
2. Penalty up to **₹250 crore**

3 SHANTI 2025

Assent 20 December 2025

1. Atomic Energy Act 1962 and Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act 2010 **repealed**
2. Indian private companies can enter, foreign ones cannot · **AERB** (Atomic Energy Regulatory Board) **statutory** · graded liability · 100 GW by 2047
3. Lok Sabha 17, Rajya Sabha 18 December · draft rules August 2026

4 Income-tax Act 2025

From 1 April 2026

1. Replaces the 1961 Act · **"tax year"** · Form 130

5 Insurance Amendment

2025

1. FDI (Foreign Direct Investment) **74 to 100%** · goal: insurance for all by 2047

6 Public Examinations Amendment 2026

Lok Sabha 29, Rajya Sabha 30 July

1. Paper leak: **5-10 years, up to ₹50 lakh** (earlier 3-5 years, ₹10 lakh)
2. Organised crime: 7 years to life, ₹1-10 crore · investigation 2 months, trial 6 months

7 Prevention of Insults to National Honour Amendment

Rajya Sabha 29, Lok Sabha 30 July

1. Original Act 1971 · now insulting **"Vande Mataram"** is also punishable

8 Tribunal Reforms 2026

Lok Sabha 10, Rajya Sabha 11 August

1. 2021 Act repealed · **National Tribunals Commission**: chair + 2 judicial + 2 technical members, HQ New Delhi, 16 tribunals

9 SC (Number of Judges) Amendment

Lok Sabha 3, Rajya Sabha 5 August

1. Replaces the ordinance (May 2026) · 34 to **38** (including CJI) · effective 16 May 2026

10 Others of 2025

2025

1. Finance · **Online Gaming** (regulator OGAI, MeitY, from 1 May 2026) · Electricity Amendment · National Sports Governance · Waqf Amendment · VB-G RAM G (Chapter 04)

11 Rest of the Monsoon Session

2026

1. Registration of Births and Deaths · MSME (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) Development · Bankers' Books Evidence · Taxation · NCDC · Mines and Minerals · Appropriation (3)

12 Pending

In JPC

1. **FCRA** (Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act) **Amendment** · **Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan** (replacing UGC (University Grants Commission), AICTE (All India Council for Technical Education), NCTE (National Council for Teacher Education); JPC chair D. Purandeswari)

2.3 FCRA Bill: Why in the News

Process: From the Lok Sabha to the JPC

25 March 2026 | JPC 12 August

1. Introduced in the Lok Sabha on **25 March 2026** (MoS Home Nityanand Rai)
2. JPC on **12 August** · 31 members (Lok Sabha 21 + Rajya Sabha 10) · chair **Dr. Sanjay Jaiswal**
3. Report: by the end of the first week of the Winter Session

Key Points and Criticism

1. Foreign-funded assets of cancelled, surrendered or non-renewed organisations to be managed by a **"designated authority"**
2. Religious character of places of worship protected · "key functionaries" personally liable
3. Maximum imprisonment reduced **from 5 to 1 year**
4. Criticism: no appeal route when renewal is refused

Static

1. FCRA first in **1976** · current Act **2010** · since the 2020 amendment the FCRA account only at SBI's New Delhi main branch, administrative expense cap 20%

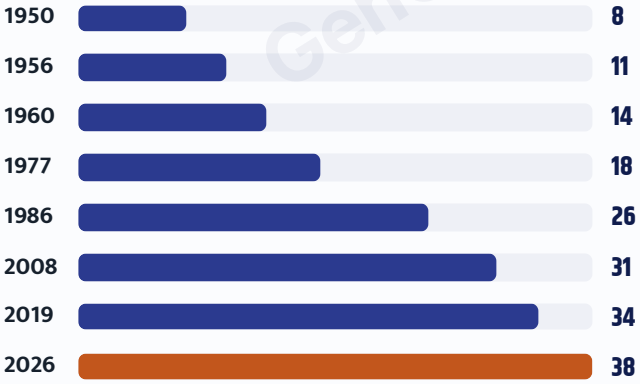
2.4 Judiciary: From the Supreme Court to District Courts

Timeline Order of Chief Justices (estimated by seniority)

- **52nd** — Bhushan R. Gavai
- **53rd · 24 Nov. 2025** — **Surya Kant** — till 9 Feb. 2027
- **→ 23 Sep. 2027** — Vikram Nath
- **→ 30 Oct. 2027** — B.V. Nagarathna, first woman CJI (~36 days)

Next: P.S. Narasimha → J.B. Pardiwala

Chart Number of Judges in the Supreme Court (including CJI)



Basis Art. 124(1): Parliament fixes the number by law · in 2026, 35 working, 3 vacant

CJI Surya Kant

53rd

1. Tenure **24 November 2025 to 9 February 2027** · predecessor Bhushan R. Gavai
2. Practised at the Punjab-Haryana HC from 1985 · Haryana's **youngest Advocate General** in 2000 · HC judge in 2004

Trap 38 = including the CJI, 37 = without the CJI.

High Courts

September 2026: regular CJs in all 25 HCs

1. Three HC Chief Justices elevated to the SC on 5 October
2. Bombay's 50th CJ **Mahesh Chandra Tripathi** (from Allahabad) · Patna Vallury Kameswar Rao · Calcutta Ravindra Ghuge · Punjab-Haryana Ashwani Kumar Mishra · Rajasthan Sanjay Kumar Agrawal · Chhattisgarh Krishna Ram Mahapatra · MP Alpesh Kogje · J&K-Ladakh Pushpendra Bhati
3. Meghalaya **Revati Mohite Dere** — second woman CJ (first T. Meena Kumari, 2013)

Digital Courts

First time

1. First **paperless district court**: Kalpetta, Wayanad (6 January 2026)
2. First **paperless state judiciary**: Sikkim (1 May 2026)
3. "One Case One Data" + AI chatbot **"Su-Sahayak"** · "Jan Suchna Seva" from Hindi Day

! **Trap** Paperless district court in Kerala, paperless state judiciary in Sikkim.

New Institutions and Faces

1. First **Victim Rights Centre**: Patna (26 September 2026)
2. AI committee (Justice P.S. Narasimha) · judicial infra-structure committee, 6 members (Justice Arvind Kumar)
3. **Nathan C.C.** (Kerala) first fully visually impaired woman civil judge
4. 86th Presiding Officers' Conference 19-21 January 2026, Lucknow (Om Birla)

Board **Major Judgments — Article-wise**

Art. 21 — Life and Liberty

1. **Menstrual health** a right under Art. 21 · sanitary pads in every school
2. **Highway travel**: safe and unobstructed travel also under Art. 21
3. **Harish Rana (2026)**: first direct permission for **passive euthanasia** (Pardiwala and Viswanathan) · earlier Aruna Shanbaug (2011), Common Cause (2018, living will)

Art. 142 — Complete Justice

1. **Amit Kumar (January)**: student mental health — 24×7 counselling, strictness on ragging

Art. 143 — Presidential Reference

1. Courts **cannot impose time limits** on bills, no "deemed assent"
2. But Governors cannot sit on bills indefinitely either

Art. 300A — Property

20 May

1. Long withholding is a **"continuing wrong"** · the repealed 1894 land acquisition law does not apply

Art. 324 — Elections

1. **Bihar SIR (27 May)**: Art. 324 + RP Act 1950 Section 21(3) — revision valid
2. **CEC Appointment Act 2023**: two judges split (Dipankar Datta, Satish Chandra Sharma) · CJI to decide the Constitution Bench (23 September)

Other Important Orders

1. **UAPA 43D(5)** (22 May): bail-condition questions referred to a larger bench
2. **Prajwala** (29 May): rescue-rehabilitation framework for trafficking victims; reform of the 1956 law suggested
3. **Manjula vs Srinivas**: no fabricated claim to protect benami property
4. **Stray dogs** (19 May): November 2025 order upheld · ABC Rules

Education, Waqf, Examinations

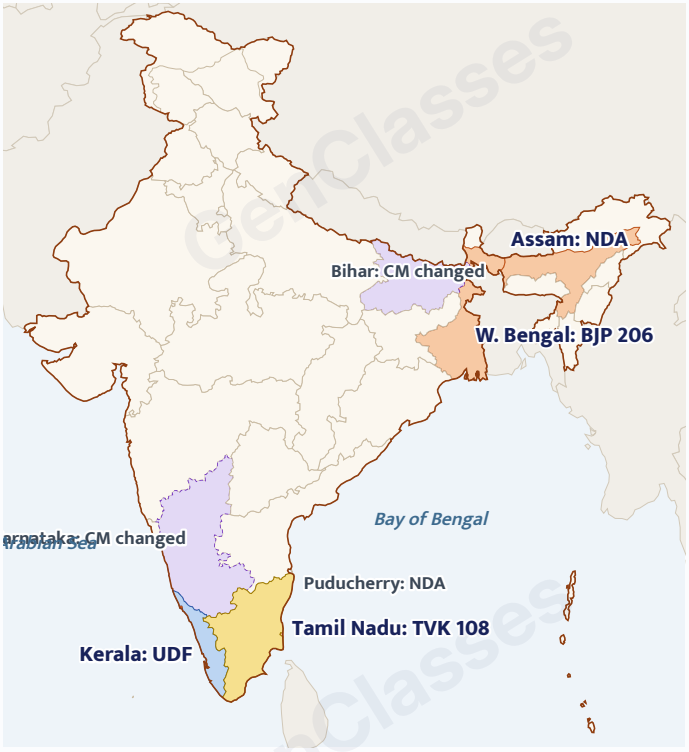
1. **Waqf (15 September 2025)**: the whole Act not stayed, some provisions stayed (the 5-years-of-practising-Islam condition)
2. **UGC Regulations 2026**: gazette 13 January → stayed 29 January → 2012 rules apply → under Centre's review on 20 August
3. **NEET** (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test) **protest** (28 July): independent probe into excesses; ban on action against those without records

High Court Judgments

1. **Thamirabarani** (Madras HC, 30 July): river a "legal person" · confluence named "Porunai" · all immersion except ashes banned · about 90 tonnes of clothes removed
2. **Uttarakhand HC moving to Haldwani**: about 40 hectares of reserved forest, elephant corridor — petition dismissed as premature (September)

2.5 Elections and Census

Map The Political Map of 2026: Who Won Where



BJP / NDA (National Democratic Alliance)

TVK **UDF**

Chief Minister changed

W. Bengal (294)	**BJP for the first time**, 206 (some say 207) · TMC 80 · CM **Suvendu Adhikari** (9 May; defeated Mamata in Bhabanipur by 15,000+)
Tamil Nadu (234)	**TVK 108** (majority 118) · DMK 59 · AIADMK 47 · CM **Vijay**
Kerala (140)	**UDF after ten years**, 97-103 · CM **V.D. Satheesan** (13th, 18 May)
Assam (126)	NDA · BJP 82 · CM Himanta (12 May)
Puducherry (30)	NDA · **N. Rangasamy for the fifth time**
Bihar	**Samrat Choudhary** 24th and first BJP CM (15 April; Nitish resigned 14 April, having taken oath for the 10th time in November 2025)
Karnataka	**D.K. Shivakumar** (3 June; Siddaramaiah resigned 28 May)

Polling: Assam, Kerala, Puducherry on 9 April · counting 4 May

SIR of Electoral Rolls

Special Intensive Revision

1. Second phase announced on 27 October 2025 — voters in 12 states/UTs fell by about **10.2%**
2. Third phase May 2026: 16 states + 3 UTs (Himachal, J&K, Ladakh excluded)
3. Aadhaar the **12th valid document**, but not proof of citizenship

! **Trap** Aadhaar is a document of identity, not of citizenship.

Voting Records and Institutions

1. Bihar election 2025: **66.91%** turnout — highest since 1951 (women 71.6%, men 62.8%)
2. **IIIDEM**: set up by the ECI (Election Commission of India) in 2011, 15 years in 2026
3. CEC Gyanesh Kumar chair of the **International IDEA** Council for 2026 (Stockholm)

Timeline **Census 2027 (16th): Phase by Phase**

Preparation
2025

30 April 2025
CCPA approval · **caste enumeration** for the first time since 1931

16 June 2025
Mapping begins · 30 lakh+ enumerators-supervisors

5 March 2026
Mascots **"Pragati"** (female) and **"Vikas"** (male) — Amit Shah

Phase 1: Houselisting
April – September 2026

Each state
30 days, preceded by 15 days of **self-enumeration**

14 August 2026
Population questionnaire: **40 questions**

1 October 2026
Reference date for snow-bound areas (Ladakh, J&K, high areas of Himachal-Uttarakhand)

Phase 2: Population Enumeration
February 2027

9-28 February 2027
Population enumeration, **including caste**

1 March 2027
Reference date for the rest of India (00:00 hrs)

New: fully digital · portal in 16 languages · four tools HLBC, HLO app, self-enumeration portal, CMMIS · caste as open entry · new questions: Covid vaccine, bank accounts, parents, digital literacy, migration, mother tongue · NPR postponed indefinitely · separate code for the Bodo "Bathou" religion · 8th Economic Census later · brand ambassador Sudarsan Pattnaik

2.6 States: New Units and "Firsts"

Map **"Firsts" of the States — on the Map**



1. Kalpetta (Wayanad) — **first paperless district court**
2. Sikkim — **first paperless state judiciary**
3. Patna — **first Victim Rights Centre**
4. Mitiyaj (Gujarat) — **first night gram panchayat**
5. Saundala (Maharashtra) — **first caste-free village**
6. Alwar — **first "Namo Biodiversity Park"**
7. Hazaribagh — **first pearl production centre**
8. Tripura — **first with a State Innovation Mission**
9. Assam — **first in matcha tea production**
10. Srinagar — **Asia's largest tulip garden**
11. Kolkata — **"Shabdalok", first immersive language museum**
12. Varkala — **in the UN "20 Cities Towards Zero Waste"**
13. Yana caves (Uttara Kannada) — **geo-heritage**
14. Kalinjar (Banda, UP) — **geo-heritage**
15. Chumur (Ladakh) — **first model border village**
16. Andhra — **first state with AI face-recognition attendance for MLAs**

Geo-heritage sites are declared by the **GSI** (Geological Survey of India), not the ASI (Archaeological Survey of India) · Yana: black limestone karst of the Western Ghats, Bhairaveshwara peak 120 m, Mohini about 90 m

New Districts and Autonomy

1. Haryana: **Hansi** (from Hisar) 23rd district (announced 16, notified 22 December 2025)
2. Andhra: Markapuram and Polavaram — 26 to 28 (31 December 2025)
3. Ladakh: **5 new, total 7** (27 April 2026) — Nubra, Sham, Changthang, Zanskar, Drass · UP still 75
4. **Amaravati** the sole permanent capital of Andhra ($340 million from the World Bank)
5. **FNTA** in Nagaland: agreement of the Centre, state and ENPO on 5 February 2026 · 6 eastern districts, 46 subjects · bill passed 3 September

South

1. Tamil Nadu Assembly (10 August): **"Tamil Thai Vazhthu"** first at every government-educational event (from Sundaranar's 1891 "Manonmaniyam"; state song 12 December 2021)
2. Karnataka: **Tulu** second additional official language of Dakshina Kannada-Udupi · "Tr" before teachers' names · Mekedatu dispute in the SC · Legislative Council Chairman Horatti resigned (7 August; 75 members)
3. Kerala: "extreme-poverty free" on 1 November 2025 (64,006 families) · first state with a Senior Citizens Department · "SAMPATH" portal · free bus travel for women-transgender persons
4. Telangana's Unified Welfare Card

North-West

1. Punjab's **"Pehchaan"** portal (unidentified bodies, facial recognition)
2. Goa Police 100% action on 1930 · "Majhe Ghar" scheme
3. Maharashtra's **"Saksham"** — first AI skill census (18-40 years) · "Wari Saksharatechi" (ULLAS; Pune-Pandharpur wari)

East and Central

1. Chhattisgarh: draft "Freedom of Religion Bill 2026" · Adarsh Shahar Samriddhi Yojana · INDI scheme (stray cattle)
2. MP: "School Chalen Hum" · MoU with IIM Indore · GI (Geographical Indication) for 4 tribal crops · zoonotic disease mock drill PYA 2026 in Khari (Vidisha)
3. Jharkhand: integrated fish farming in Tilaiya reservoir
4. Bihar: Bajjika and Surjapuri academies (there will be 8; now 6 — Sanskrit, Maithili, Bangla, Bhojpuri, Magahi, Angika) · Bihar-Jharkhand Sone water agreement (Chapter 07)

North-East

1. **Khasi-Garo** compulsory from Class 1 in Meghalaya
2. Manipur's "Chavang Kut" on 1 November
3. Israel's **"Operation Wings of Dawn"** — airlift of the Bnei Menashe (Shinlung) Jewish community of Mizoram-Manipur (April)
4. Partner country of Nagaland's Hornbill Festival 2025: **Ireland**

Foundation Days and Bihar

1. Uttarakhand 9 November (silver jubilee in 2025) · Jharkhand 15 November (2000; Birsa Munda's birth anniversary) · Bihar 22 March (theme "Unnat Bihar, Ujjwal Bihar")
2. Bihar: first gender budget 2008 · child welfare budget 2013-14 · green budget 2020-21 · NIFTEM Hajipur · 5,266 playgrounds in 4,700 of 8,053 panchayats · international skating stadium in Dumri
3. Hyderabad's Mir Alam Tank (on the Musi)

2.7 Constitutional-Statutory Posts and Governance

Top Posts

1. Vice-President **C.P. Radhakrishnan** (15th, September 2025)
2. Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla · Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman **Harivansh** (third consecutive time; first nominated member in this post)
3. Attorney General **R. Venkataramani** (two-year extension) · CIC **Raj Kumar Goyal** (oath 15 December 2025)

NITI Aayog

Neither constitutional nor statutory

1. Chair PM · Vice-Chair **Ashok Kumar Lahiri** (April 2026; after Suman Bery)
2. CEO **Anurag Jain** (22 July; interim Nidhi Chhibber in between)
3. Members: Rajiv Gauba, K.V. Raju, Gobardhan Das, M. Srinivas, Abhay Karandikar, Dr. Joram Aniya (2 May)

! **Trap** NITI Aayog was set up by an executive resolution of 1 January 2015 — neither constitutional nor statutory.

Governors-Lieutenant Governors

1. Bihar **Syed Ata Hasnain** (14 March) · Bengal R.N. Ravi · Maharashtra Jishnu Dev Varma (22nd) · Telangana Shiv Pratap Shukla
2. Himachal Kavinder Gupta · Nagaland Nand Kishore Yadav · Kerala (+ Tamil Nadu) Rajendra Arlekar
3. Delhi **Taranjit Singh Sandhu** (21st LG) · Ladakh Vinai Kumar Saxena · Andaman-Nicobar Dinesh Sharma

New Names of Offices

13 February 2026

1. Raj Bhavan → **"Lok Bhavan"**, Raj Niwas → **"Lok Niwas"** (25 November 2025; Punjab notified around 4 December)
2. PMO → **"Seva Teerth"** (inaugurated 13 February 2026, moving from South Block; Kartavya Bhavan 1-2) · till 1977 the PMO was the "Prime Minister's Secretariat"

! **Trap** 13 February twice: New Delhi became the capital in 1931, Seva Teerth in 2026.

Rules, Guidelines and Monitoring

1. When the national song and anthem are played together, first **6 stanzas of Vande Mataram** (3 min 10 sec; Jana-Gana-Mana 52 sec)
2. Cancer a notifiable disease · CIC: **BCCI** (Board of Control for Cricket in India) **not a public authority** (Section 2(h))
3. **PRAGATI** (25 March 2015) — top Uttarakhand 93.46 · **ICJS 2.0** ("One Data One Entry")

Parliamentary Committees 2026-27

1. Estimates: **Sanjay Jaiswal** (30 members)
2. Public Accounts: **K.C. Venugopal** (22)
3. Public Undertakings: Baijayant Panda (22)
4. SC/ST Welfare: Faggan Singh Kulaste (30) · Empowerment of Women: Daggubati Purandeswari (28)

! **Trap** The Estimates Committee has no Rajya Sabha member — all 30 from the Lok Sabha.

Board **National Panchayat Awards 2025 (presented 3 June 2026)**

Best District Panchayat

- **Sepahijala, Tripura** (₹5 crore)
- Ganjam, Odisha (₹3 crore)

Block · Gram Panchayat

- Best block: **Harippad** (Kerala)
- Gram Panchayat: **New-Napam**, Sonitpur, Assam (₹1.5 crore)

Nanaji Deshmukh

- **Telkap** (Rohtas, Bihar)
- **Girharu** (Agra, UP)

Deendayal (theme-wise)

- Poverty-free: Muddi (Udupi) · Healthy: Kanchanbari (Tripura)
- Child-friendly: Itgaon · Water-sufficient: Khashiwali (both Maharashtra)
- Clean-green: Kawrthah North (Mizoram) · Self-sufficient infrastructure: Melukavu (Kerala)
- Socially secured: Shansha (Himachal) · Good governance: Srungavaram · Women-friendly: Bommalam Gadem (both Andhra)

Total 42 panchayats, 17 states/UTs · Deendayal 34 + Nanaji 8 · most Karnataka (6), then Andhra and Odisha (5 each) · "Say No to Proxy Sarpanch" campaign against "sarpanch-pati"

Points to Note

1. The **131st** amendment bill failed — the 106th Act on women's reservation is in force
2. 850 = proposed cap of the whole Lok Sabha (states 815 + UTs 35)
3. Keralam: Art. 3, simple majority — not a "constitutional amendment"
4. Removing the Speaker = **effective** majority · CEC/judge = **special** majority
5. 38 in the SC = including the CJI · 37 = without · first an ordinance, then a law in August
6. B.V. Nagarathna will be the first woman CJI — only ~36 days
7. Paperless district court: Kalpetta (Kerala) · paperless state judiciary: Sikkim
8. Aadhaar is the 12th document in the SIR, but not proof of citizenship
9. Census reference date: snow-bound areas 1 October 2026 · rest of India 1 March 2027
10. Bihar's first BJP CM Samrat Choudhary (24th) · Bengal's Suvendu Adhikari
11. Geo-heritage sites are declared by the GSI, not the ASI
12. UP's panchayat in the Nanaji Deshmukh award: Girharu (Agra)

03 Economy 2025-26: Growth, Budget, Banking, Agriculture and Infrastructure

At a Glance

1. New GDP series (base **2022-23**): **7.6%** in 2025-26 · first quarter of 2026-27 **7.8%**
2. RBI (Reserve Bank of India) raised the repo by 25 bps to **5.50%** on **7 October 2026** — first hike since February 2023
3. Budget 2026-27 **for the first time on a Sunday** · ₹53.47 lakh crore · 16th Finance Commission added "contribution to GDP"
4. India the world's **sixth** largest economy in 2026, **fourth** in 2027 (IMF)
5. Non-fossil power capacity crosses **300 GW** · record foodgrains of **376.56 million tonnes**

One Rule: Three Things with Every Number

A **Whose number?** RBI, World Bank, IMF (International Monetary Fund), ADB (Asian Development Bank) — each institution's figure differs

B **What base year?** GDP-WPI-IIP 2022-23, new CPI (Consumer Price Index) 2024

C **State or country?** "India first" and "first among states" are different questions

In economy questions, options often swap the figures of two institutions.

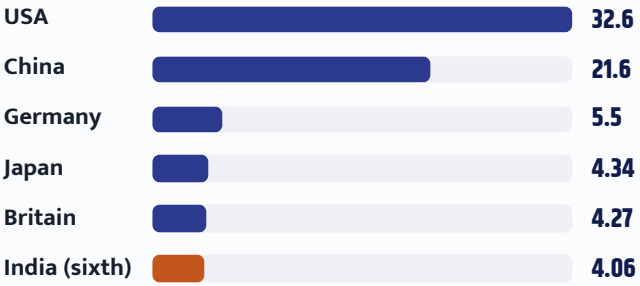
3.1 Growth Rate: Estimates of Various Institutions

Chart Growth Estimates for 2026-27 (%)



IMF: 7.4% in calendar year 2026 · fastest-growing major economy

Chart Size of the Economy, $ trillion (IMF, October 2026)



In 2027 India at $4.52 trillion ahead of Britain and Japan — fourth (weak yen)

New GDP Series

February 2026

1. Base year **2011-12 to 2022-23**
2. 7.1% in 2024-25 (6.5% in the old series) · **7.6%** in 2025-26 (provisional 7.7%) · **7.8%** in April-June 2026

Economic Survey 2025-26

29 January · 16 chapters

1. Remittances **$135.4 billion** — highest in the world
2. Services **56.4%** of GVA (Gross Value Added) · labour force participation 56.1%
3. Multidimensional poverty **55.34% to 11.28%**

Ratings

1. **S&P: BBB** (August 2025, upgrade after 18 years; insolvency system from C to B because of the IBC)
2. Fitch: BBB- · Moody's: Baa3

! **Trap** S&P upgraded; Fitch-Moody's are still at the lowest level of investment grade.

Risks: "WORR"

1. **W**ar, **O**il, **R**upee, **R**ains
2. R&D spending about **0.64%** of GDP (suggested 2%)

! **Trap** RBI and World Bank at 7.1, ADB and IMF at 7.0 · India sixth in 2026, fourth in 2027.

3.2 Government Finance: Budget, Finance Commission, Pay Commission

Budget 2026-27

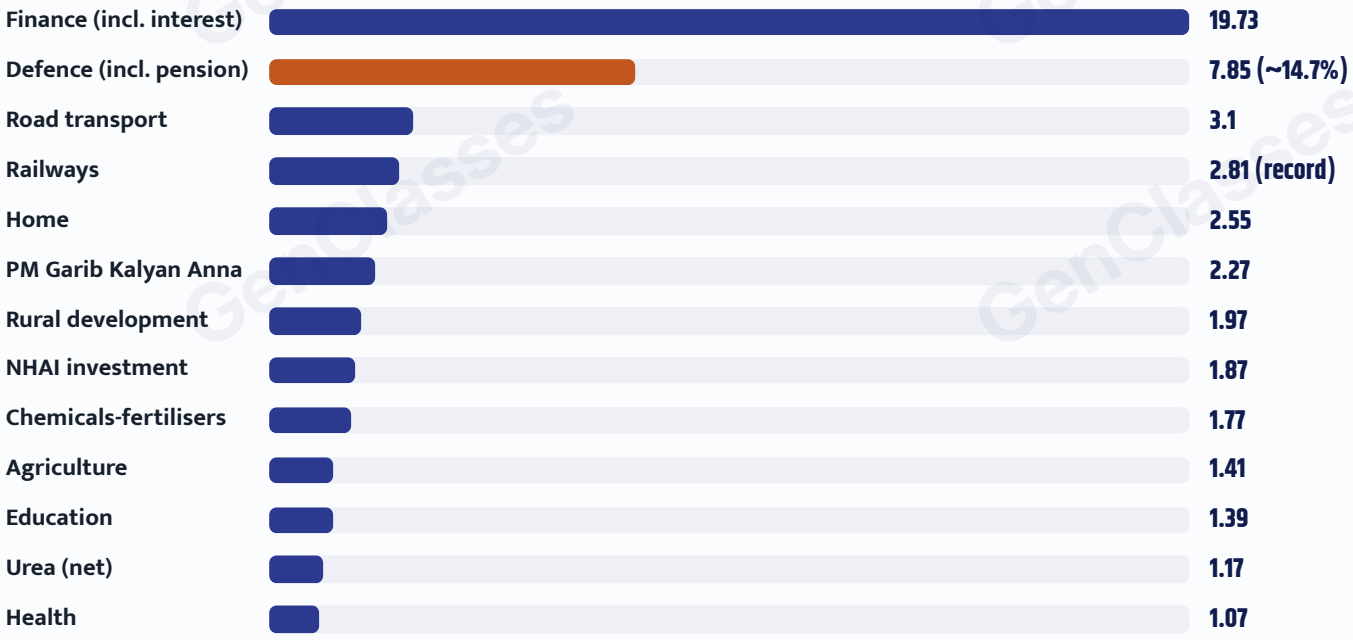
Sunday 1 February 2026 | First time on a Sunday

1. Sitharaman's **9th in a row** (overall record Morarji, 10)
2. Total **₹53.47 lakh crore** · capital ₹12.22 lakh crore · borrowing ₹17.2 lakh crore
3. Fiscal deficit target **4.3%** (4.4% achieved in 2025-26) · debt-GDP 55.6% · income tax rates unchanged

New Items in the Budget

1. Biopharma Shakti (₹10,000 crore/5 years) · Semiconductor Mission 2.0 · electronic components ₹40,000 crore
2. **Rare earth corridors** in four states · CCUS (Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage) ₹20,000 crore · **7 high-speed rail corridors** · 20 national waterways
3. ₹5,000 crore for each City Economic Region · 5 university townships · East Coast Industrial Corridor at Durgapur
4. NIMHANS-2 (National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro-Sciences) · 15 archaeological sites · North-East Buddhist circuit · Bharat-VISTAAR (₹150 crore) · She Marts · coconut scheme · SME Growth Fund ₹10,000 crore · 3 new AIIAs

Chart Major Allocations (BE 2026-27, ₹ lakh crore)



Schemes (₹ crore): VB-G RAM G 95,692 · Housing-Urban 85,522 · Jal Jeevan 67,670 · PM-KISAN 63,500 · PMAY-G 54,917 · rolling stock 52,109 · Samagra Shiksha 42,100 · labour 32,666 · MNRE 32,914.67 · power 29,997 · MSME (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) 24,566 · Krishonnati 11,200 · space 10,397 · PM-JAY 9,500 · PM SHRI 7,500 · smallest: Parliamentary Affairs ₹68.45 crore, Department of Public Enterprises ₹29.60 crore · urea ₹6,218 net of recoveries out of a gross ₹1,23,023

Diagram 16th Finance Commission: Formula for Sharing among States (weight %)



1. Chair **Arvind Panagariya** · period **2026-27 to 2030-31** · report 1 February
2. States' share (vertical) **41%** — unchanged
3. **Tax effort** criterion removed · **revenue deficit grants** ended

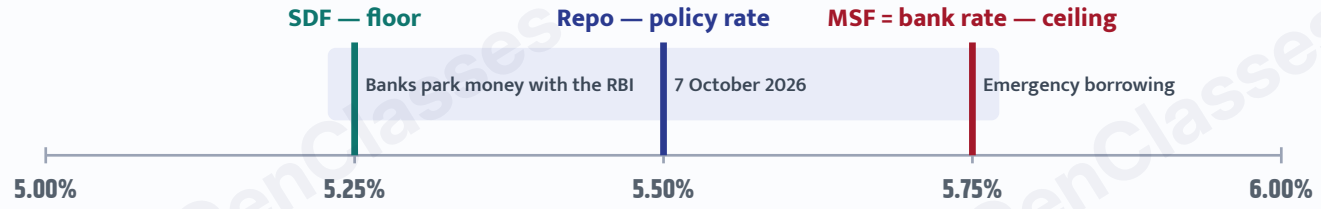
1. Grants ₹9.47 lakh crore (local bodies ₹7.91, disaster ₹1.56)
2. **8th Pay Commission**: resolution 3 November 2025 · chair Justice **Ranjana Prakash Desai** · report around May 2027 (18 months)

Static

1. Finance Commission every five years under **Art. 280** · chair of the first commission **K.C. Neogy** (1951) · the 15th (N.K. Singh) also gave 41%
2. **Vertical** sharing = between the Centre and states · **horizontal** = among the states

3.3 RBI and Banking

Diagram **Interest Rate Corridor — LAF (after 7 October 2026)**



Corridor width 50 bps · stance from "neutral" to **"calibrated tightening"** · reasons: weak monsoon, oil about $100, bond yields · CPI projection 5.2% · GDP projection 7.1% · next meeting 2-4 December

Timeline **Repo Rate: Timeline**

- **December 2025** — Cut to 5.25%
- **February – August 2026** — Unchanged in 4 meetings in a row
- **7 October 2026** — Unanimously **5.50%**; first hike since February 2023

Leadership

1. Governor **Sanjay Malhotra**
2. Deputies: Swaminathan J., Poonam Gupta, S.C. Murmu, **Rohit Jain** (from 4 May 2026, after T. Rabi Sankar)
3. Convention: two from the RBI, one economist, one banker

Regulatory Decisions

1. Licence of **Paytm Payments Bank** cancelled (24 April 2026)
2. In-principle approval for **Fino Payments Bank** as a small finance bank (December 2025)
3. **Loans against silver** (1 April 2026): LTV 85% up to ₹2.5 lakh, 80% for 2.5-5 lakh, 75% above · jewellery up to 10 kg, coins up to 500 g · ₹5,000/day for delay in return

! **Trap** No loans on silver bars and ETFs.

Benchmarks and Platforms

1. **Financial Inclusion Index 70.0** (March 2026; earlier 67)
2. "Banking Connect" (NBBL) net-banking payment platform · Common Lending Portal
3. **"Utkarsh 2029"** (April 2026-March 2029, 6 pillars, internationalisation of the rupee)
4. **"3A" campaign**: returning ₹1.84 lakh crore of unclaimed money

Other Financial Steps

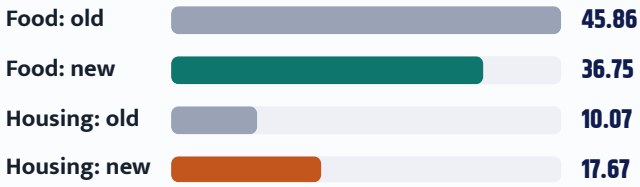
1. SEBI's **GARUDA** (AIF registration, 11 May) · NCDEX's **RAINMUMBAI** (29 May; first weather derivative, IIT Bombay)
2. India Marine Insurance Pool $1.5 billion (sovereign guarantee about ₹12,980 crore) · World Bank $1.5 billion for jobs
3. Small savings rates unchanged: Sukanya and Senior Citizens 8.2 · NSC 7.7 · KVP 7.5 · MIS 7.4 · PPF 7.1

Static

1. RBI: recommendation of the **Hilton Young Commission** (1926) · RBI Act 1934 · set up **1 April 1935** in Kolkata · Mumbai from 1937 · nationalised 1 January 1949
2. Monetary Policy Committee: **6 members** (3 RBI + 3 government nominees) · Governor's casting vote in a tie

3.4 Inflation, Output and Employment

Chart **New CPI (base 2024): How Weights in the Basket Changed (%)**



In force from 12 February 2026 · 2.75% in January 2026, 4.82% in August · 0.25% in October 2025 (record low of the old series)

Base Year and Output

1. WPI (Wholesale Price Index), IIP (Index of Industrial Production), GDP — all now on base **2022-23** · CPI on **2024**
2. IIP basket **839 to 1,042** items · first release 1 June 2026 · April growth 4.9%

Employment (PLFS)

1. Unemployment **3.1%** in 2025 (from 3.2) · educated 6.5% (from 7.1) · youth 9.9%
2. Monthly August 2026: 5.0% (rural 4.1, urban 6.8)
3. **First National Household Income Survey**: MoSPI-NSO, April 2026-March 2027

3.5 GST and Digital Payments

GST 2.0

From 22 September 2025

1. Two main rates **5% and 18%** · harmful goods **40%**
2. September 2026: gross **₹2,03,521 crore** (+14.7%) · refunds 27,001 · net ₹1,76,520 crore · domestic 1,37,996, imports 65,525
3. Above ₹2 lakh crore for the third month in a row · April-September ₹12.46 lakh crore

10 Years of UPI

11 April 2016

1. Launched by **Raghuram Rajan**, 21 banks (app for the public 25 August 2016) · 703 banks by March 2026
2. About **49%** of the world's real-time payments
3. 24,161.69 crore transactions in 2025-26 (~₹314 lakh crore) · 2,407 crore in September 2026 (₹29.37 lakh crore), ~80.2 crore a day
4. States (June 2026): **Maharashtra 9.78%** · UP 5.38% · Karnataka 5.17%
5. MDR: maximum 0.4% on merchant payments above ₹2,000 (cap ₹300)

UPI Abroad

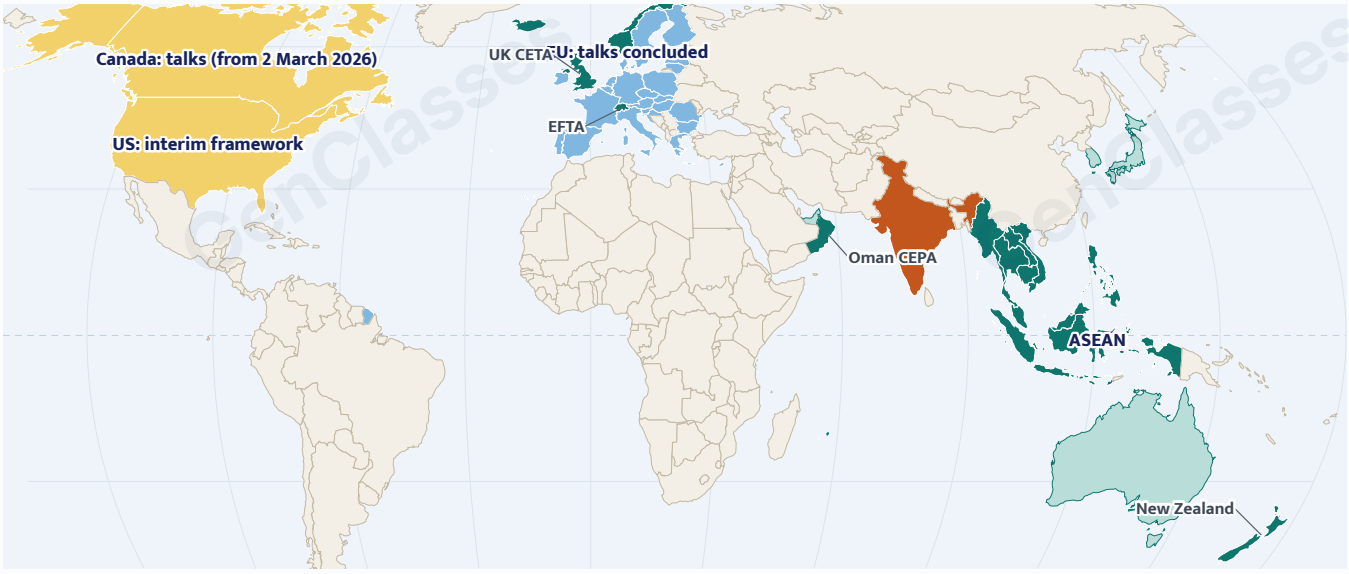
1. **Cambodia the 9th country** · Israel
2. **Favara-UPI corridor** in the Maldives (30 July 2026; MVR to INR — earlier only P2P)

Cooperative Banking

1. "Bank in a Box" and SOC (9 August, Amit Shah, Mumbai) — from NUCFDC
2. 650 of about 1,400 urban cooperative banks are members · 7th Global Fintech Fest (8 September, Mumbai)

3.6 Foreign Trade and the Tariff War

Map **Free Trade Agreements: Status (October 2026)**



In force (new in 2025-26 + ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations)**)** **Talks concluded (EU)**

Talks ongoing **Already in force (UAE, Australia, Mauritius, Japan, S. Korea)**

In force: ASEAN (goods 2010, services 2015) · EFTA (European Free Trade Association) TEPA (October 2025) · Oman CEPA (1 June 2026) · UK CETA (15 July 2026; $100 billion by 2030) · New Zealand (signed 27 April, in force 20 October 2026) · **Talks concluded:** EU (27 January 2026; "mother of all deals"; signing December 2026, in force 2027)

US Tariffs 2026

1. **2 February**: reciprocal tariff from 25% to 18% · **7 February**: interim framework
2. **20 February**: US Supreme Court held the sweeping tariffs illegal (6-3) → 10% global tariff under **Section 122** (cap 15%, 150 days)
3. **24 July**: 10% on India under **Section 301** · full deal not yet

Reserves and Exports

1. Record forex reserves **$740.803 billion** (28 August 2026) · $734.61 billion on 2 October · India **fourth** (after China, Japan, Switzerland)
2. **19th** in merchandise exports (~1.7%, $445 billion; world $26.3 trillion, top 10 hold 49.6%) · 8th in goods + services (NITI Aayog's Trade Watch Quarterly)
3. Ahead of China in cotton textile exports to the US · Bangladesh's second-largest partner · **first in ship recycling** (35.4%)

Russian Oil Imports

1. Nayara's **Vadinar** refinery under EU sanctions since 18 July 2025
2. 18 June 2026: 42,000 tonnes of petrol on "Cyclone" → at Damietta (Egypt) from "Garnet", "Photon" to "Talisman" → first cargo reached Russia on **5 August**

> **Trap** Russia imported petrol from India for the first time — trade in the reverse direction.

Other Policies

1. Ban on sugar exports till 30 September · **RAHAT Scheme 2026**

3.7 Corporates, Billionaires and Start-ups

Hurun: Families and Individuals

1. Family businesses (12 August): **Ambani ₹25.83 lakh crore** · Birla ₹8.14 · Jindal ₹8.02 · first generation Adani ₹19.6 · top 300 worth ₹138 lakh crore ($1.46 tn)
2. M3M Hurun (23 September): **Adani** (₹9.23 lakh crore), Ambani (8.63), L.N. Mittal
3. Hurun Global: 4,020 billionaires — China 1,110, US 1,000, **India 308 (third)** · Mukesh Ambani first in Asia · only woman in the top 10 **Roshni Nadar**

! **Trap** Adani first in Hurun India, but Ambani first among family businesses.

Forbes and the World

1. Forbes: record **3,428** billionaires (US 989, China 539, India 229)
2. Cities: New York 146, Shanghai 120, Shenzhen 112, Beijing 107, London 102, **Mumbai 95 (sixth)**
3. **Musk** the first trillionaire ($1 trillion, June 2026) · Nvidia about $5.8 trillion · Zhang Yiming richest in Asia on Bloomberg · **Surya Midha** (22, Mercor) sixth among Forbes' young billionaires

Start-ups

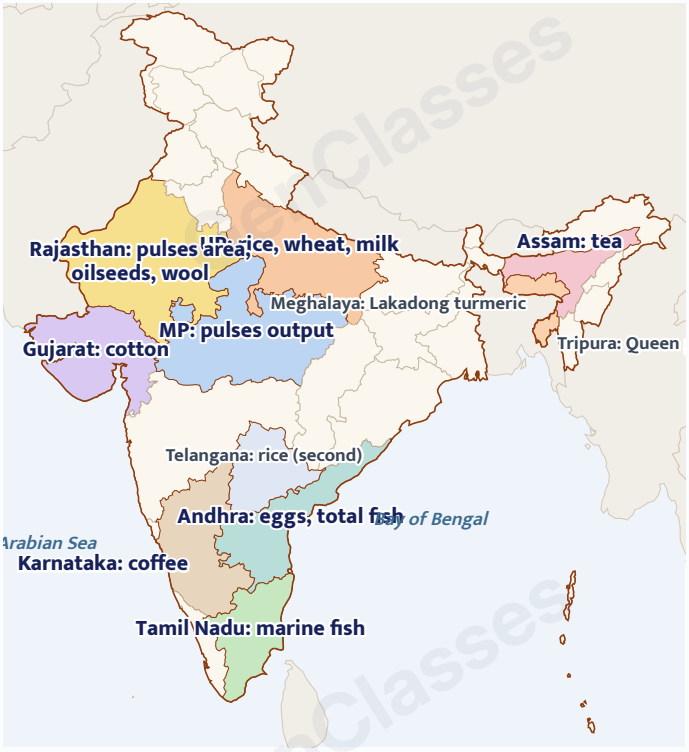
1. 2.12 lakh+ DPIIT (Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade)-recognised · women directors in 1 lakh+
2. Fund of Funds 2.0 ₹10,000 crore
3. Unicorns: US 806, China 381, UK 70, **India 61** (capital Bengaluru, 25)

Cooperatives

1. **Amul and IFFCO** top the ICA Monitor 2025
2. **"Bharat Taxi"** — first cooperative ride-hailing (start 5 February, formal 27 June; zero commission, "drivers are owners")

3.8 Agriculture: Crop-wise

Map **Which State Leads in What**



Total foodgrains	2024-25: 357.73 → 2025-26: **376.56 mn tonnes** (record)
Rice	**154.02 mn tonnes** (from 150.18) · India overtook China — **first in the world** · states: UP, Telangana, W. Bengal
Wheat	120.66 mn tonnes · second in the world · states: UP, MP, Punjab
Paddy MSP 2026-27	**₹2,441** (+₹72; 14 kharif crops, 13 May)
Pulses	India the largest producer and consumer · mission (11 October 2025): ₹11,440 crore, 310 lakh hectares and 350 lakh tonnes by 2030-31 · 1,000 dal mills (₹25 lakh subsidy; from Amlaha, Sehore on 7 February)
Cotton-Oilseeds	Cotton Productivity Mission ₹5,659.22 crore (5 May 2026)
Livestock-Fisheries	India first in milk · second in sheep population · ninth in wool · 70%+ of the world's jaggery · marine fish Tamil Nadu 6.85 lakh tonnes
Horticulture	30.37% of the world's coconut (9,871/hectare) · "Mission Golden Spice" for Lakadong turmeric (₹175.45 crore) · ₹236 crore for Queen pineapple · KU-Volkeni green chilli (Kerala Univ.) · Mushkbudji rice (Anantnag, GI (Geographical Indication) 2023)

Agricultural Science

1. First **digital soil formation map** (NBSS&LUP Nagpur, 16 July)
2. T2T (Telomere-to-Telomere) genome of pigeon pea **"Asha"** · AI-designed plant genome-editing tool **"Plant OpenCRISPR-1"** (CRRI Cuttack)
3. MatsyaMetri app (CMFRI) · "Khet Bachao Abhiyan" (22 October-30 November; ₹1,200 crore+)

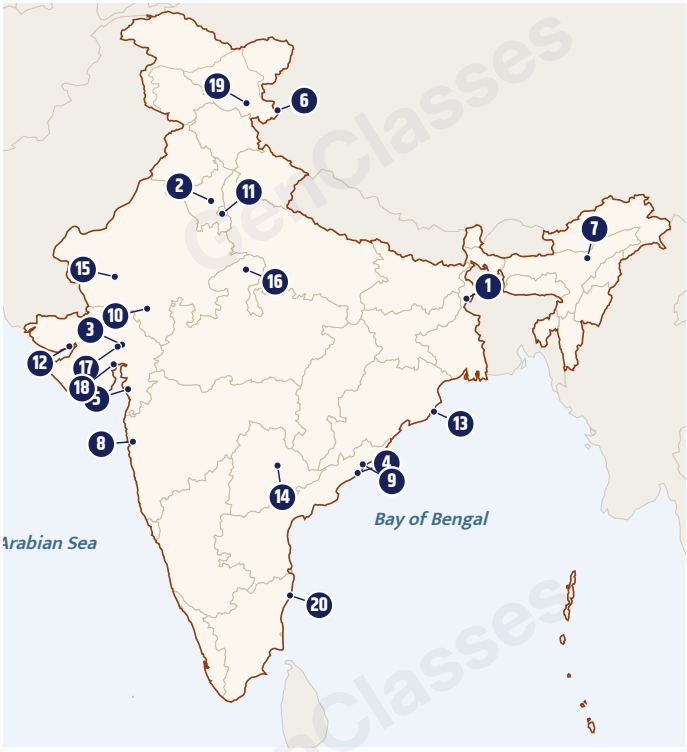
Agri Forums

1. UN **International Year of the Woman Farmer 2026**
2. 16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers (Indore) · Global Drylands Congress (10 September, NASC; ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) + ICRISAT (International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics))
3. SAPLING 2026 (Ahmedabad) · Unnat Krishi Mahotsav (Raisen) · IFAD (International Fund for Agricultural Development)'s COSOP 2026-2033 · Food Planet Prize to APCNF
4. 54.6% of Africa's land suitable for cassava (cassava mosaic virus, whitefly)

! **Trap** Total fish Andhra, marine Tamil Nadu · pulses output MP, area Rajasthan · India second in wheat, now first in rice.

3.9 Transport: Rail, Road, Aviation, Waterways

Map Infrastructure "Firsts" — on the Map



1. Malda — first sleeper Vande Bharat (17 January; Howrah-Kamakhya)
2. Jind-Sonipat — first hydrogen "Namo Green Rail" (17 July, 89 km)
3. Sabarmati — first LNG train (27 September)
4. Visakhapatnam — 18th zone South Coast Railway (1 June)
5. Choryasi (NH-48) — first barrier-free MLFF (Multi-Lane Free Flow) toll (May 2026)
6. Mig La (19,400 ft) — world's highest motorable road
7. Brahmaputra — first road-rail tunnel under a river (15.79 km)
8. Navi Mumbai airport (8 October 2025)
9. Bhogapuram — Alluri Sitarama Raju airport (1 August 2026)
10. Udaipur — first satellite landing using GAGAN (27 June)
11. IGI Delhi — first water-positive airport
12. Kandla — first electric tug and green methanol
13. Paradip — the only eastern mega port
14. Warangal — first PM MITRA park (10 May)
15. Pachpadra — first greenfield refinery-petrochemical (4 July)
16. Gwalior — Asia's first telecom manufacturing zone
17. Sanand — Micron ATMP (28 February)
18. Dholera — Tata's first commercial fab
19. Puga (Ladakh) — first geothermal project
20. Kalpakkam — first criticality of the PFBR (April 2026)

Rail: High-Speed and Metro

1. Mumbai-Ahmedabad **508 km** (NHSRCL) · next indigenous bullet train B-35
2. **7 new corridors**: Mumbai-Pune, Pune-Hyderabad, Hyderabad-Bengaluru, Hyderabad-Chennai, Chennai-Bengaluru, Delhi-Varanasi, Varanasi-Siliguri
3. Sarkhej-Dholera semi-high-speed (₹20,667 crore)
4. Metro: **third** largest network in the world · 29 cities, 1,143+ km · Delhi's 12.3 km ring metro

Roads

1. **"One Tag"** (FASTag portability) · geocell plastic road · bio-bitumen
2. Mig La (BRO "Himank") overtook **Umling La (19,024 ft)**
3. Brahmaputra tunnel ₹18,662 crore, corridor 33.7 km · Fotu La tunnel ₹1,196.22 crore

Aviation

1. Kempegowda second in domestic passengers · Kore (Palghar) offshore airport proposed
2. **UDAN 2.0** (₹28,840 crore; 100 airports, 200 helipads) · India third in business jets
3. Undavalli (Andhra) first DGCA (Directorate General of Civil Aviation) "Point in Space" heliport · hub-and-spoke flight Varanasi-Delhi

Ports

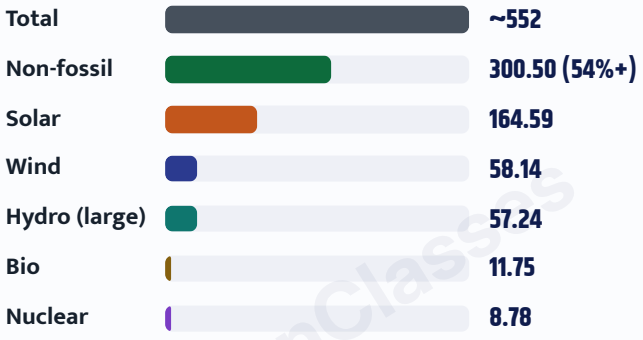
1. Four mega ports: **Paradip** (only eastern), Deendayal, Mundra, JNPA (Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority) · JNPA 22nd in the world CPPI
2. e-Samudra (60+ services) · Adani's first "Port of Refuge" (Dighi, Gopalpur) · VINIMAY land port system
3. First container goods train from Kolkata to Biratnagar · first direct cargo from Mopa (Goa) to Antarctica

Other "Firsts"

1. Kankaria (Ahmedabad) first water-neutral rail depot · first e-truck battery swap centre in Sonipat (5 minutes)
2. IRCTC's India-Bhutan "Mystic Mountain Tour"
3. Japan's first high-speed cargo Shinkansen (275 km/h) · Europe's first integrated lithium project at Kokkola, Finland
4. India Steel 2026 postponed · National Foundation Summit (23-24 March, Ministry of Mines)

3.10 Energy: Source by Source

Chart **Installed Capacity, GW (31 July 2026)**



Record **55.29 GW** added in 2025-26 · NDC (Nationally Determined Contribution) target of 50% non-fossil met ahead of time · coal still 79% of primary energy

Diagram **Homi Bhabha's Three-Stage Nuclear Programme**

Stage 1 PHWR	Stage 2 Fast breeder	Stage 3 Thorium
Fuel Natural uranium **Yields** Pu-239	**PFBR Kalpakkam** First criticality **April 2026** **Fuel** **MOX** (Mixed Oxide fuel) · coolant **liquid sodium**	**Th-232 → U-233** Monazite sands of Kerala-Odisha

Proposed 1954, approved 1958 · second stage begins with the PFBR

Solar and Wind

1. Solar **164.59 GW** (2.82 in 2014) · **third** in the world · module capacity 200 GW+ · floating solar ~700 MW (potential 102.18 GWp)
2. Kondareddypalli second fully solar village · Suryaghar award to Odisha
3. Wind **58.14 GW** · **fourth** in the world · target 100 GW (2030), 155 GW (2035) · WT-MARUT tracker · FLBS trial off the Muttam coast

Trap India third in solar, fourth in wind.

Hydro and Nuclear

1. Kamala 1,720 MW (NHPC 74%) · Kalai-II 1,200 MW · Punatsangchhu-II (Bhutan) 1,020 MW · Kishau 422 MW (6 states, ₹15,624 crore; 97,000 hectares irrigated) · Lakhwar 300 MW
2. Pumped storage target 100 GW (2035-36) · small hydro scheme ₹2,584.60 crore (~1,500 MW)
3. Nuclear: **Banka (Bihar) 1,400 MW** proposed

Other Sources and Minerals

1. Ethanol: **E-20 nationwide** (1 April) · E-85 (5 June) · E22-E30 standards
2. JSW Vijayanagar largest green hydrogen · coal gasification ₹8,500 crore
3. Coking coal a "critical mineral" · rare earth corridors (Kerala, Odisha, Andhra, Tamil Nadu) · **Jonnagiri (Kurnool)** first private gold mine · Argentina lithium to KABIL · gas at Dandewala (Jaisalmer) · India-Oman undersea gas pipeline proposed

Differences in the Numbers

1. **Energy Statistics India 2026** (MoSPI, 33rd): 520.51 GW, non-fossil 50%+
2. January 2026: coal-thermal 221.21 · solar 140.6 (March 150.26) · wind 54.65 · large hydro 51.16 · oil-gas 20.71 · bio 11.61 · small hydro 5.16 GW
3. Generation April 2025-January 2026: 1,529 billion units, coal's share 43.77% · T&D losses ~15% · 4,16,823 GWh from RE (2024-25)
4. RE potential **47 lakh MW+** (Rajasthan 23.70%) · ~70% of RE in the top 6 states (Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Andhra, Karnataka, MP)
5. IRENA (International Renewable Energy Agency): China 2,258.02 · US 467.92 · **India 250.52 (third; overtook Brazil's 228.20)** · Belgium's first artificial energy island · Brookfield's Lumara Energy ($600 million)

3.11 Industry, Telecom and New Hubs

Chips

1. **Micron Sanand ATMP** (28 February; ~₹22,516 crore) · **Tata Dholera** first commercial fab
2. Semicon India 2.0 ₹1,27,500 crore · Semicon India 2026 (17-19 September, Yashobhoomi)

Telecom

1. Asia's first telecom manufacturing zone in Gwalior
2. **Digital Communications Commission dissolved** (19 September; the 1989 Telecom Commission)
3. I-2SEA cable (~3,600 km, Singapore-Machilipatnam) · BSNL satellite phone (Inmarsat; ~₹1.34 lakh)

Industrial Parks and Corridors

1. **BHAVYA** (100 industrial parks)
2. First PM MITRA park at **Warangal** (10 May; 7 states; ~₹1,700 crore)
3. HPCL Rajasthan Refinery at Pachpadra (4 July) · Amul's largest curd plant (Howrah) · GIFT City corridor

Data **Savings and Digital: Key Figures**

Jan Dhan	Women 32.92 crore (55.7%) · rural 45.95 crore (77.8%)
Atal Pension	About 8.96 crore
e-Shram	Women 54.28%, men 45.72% · age 18-40 55.21%, 40-50 24.18%, 50+ 20.53%
DigiLocker · UMANG	72.43 crore users, 5,437 services · UMANG 11.66 crore, 2,575 services
UPI (Unified Payments Interface) **July 2026**	2,366 crore transactions (₹29.9 lakh crore) · June: Maharashtra 222.1 crore, UP 122.2, Karnataka 117.5

Static

1. Three-stage programme: first stage PHWR (natural uranium) · second fast breeder (Pu-239 from U-238) · third U-233 from thorium-232
2. India has some of the world's large thorium reserves (monazite sands of Kerala-Odisha) — hence the third stage matters

! Points to Note

1. Base of GDP, WPI, IIP **2022-23** · new CPI **2024**
2. RBI and World Bank at 7.1% · ADB and IMF at 7.0%
3. SDF = floor (5.25) · MSF = bank rate = ceiling (5.75) · repo 5.50
4. New criterion of the 16th Finance Commission "contribution to GDP" (10%) · tax effort removed · share still 41%
5. Budget on a **Sunday** for the first time · Sitharaman's 9th in a row, the record is Morarji's (10)
6. Loans on silver: jewellery-coins yes, bars-ETFs no
7. UPI 11 April 2016 (Raghuram Rajan) · Cambodia the 9th country
8. US tariffs: Section 122 (global 10%, 150 days) vs Section 301 (10% on India, 24 July)
9. India now **first** in the world in rice · second in wheat
10. India third in solar · fourth in wind · third in IRENA's total RE
11. PFBR: fuel MOX, coolant liquid sodium — not water
12. First MLFF toll at Choryasi (NH-48, Gujarat)

04 Schemes 2025-26: Campaigns, Missions and Portals

At a Glance

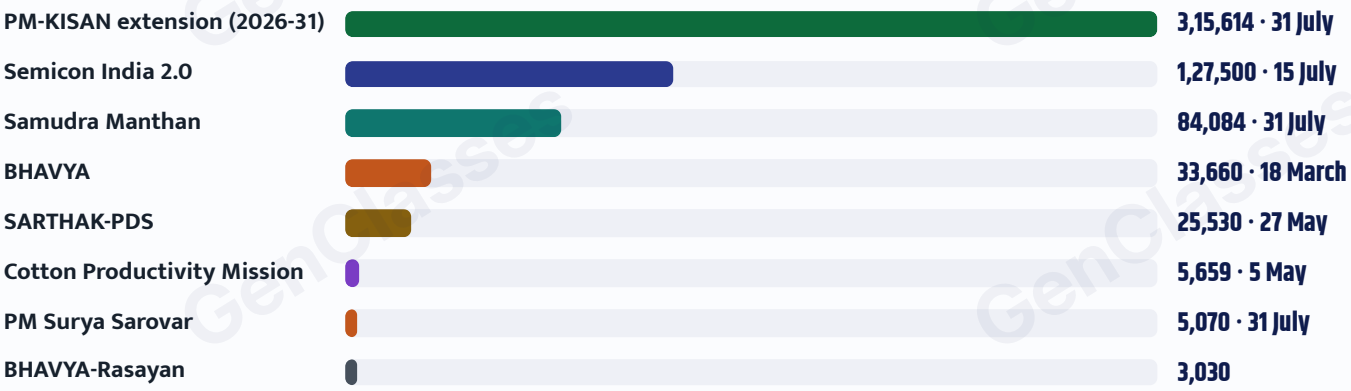
1. **VB-G RAM G** replaces MGNREGA (1 July 2026): **125 days** of work instead of 100
2. Three major approvals on a single day, **31 July 2026**: PM-KISAN extension, Samudra Manthan, PM Surya Sarovar
3. Jal Jeevan Mission extended to December 2028 ("JJM 2.0") · tap water in **82.24%** of homes
4. 12 years of Jan Dhan: **59.09 crore** accounts, 55.7% held by women
5. EPFO (Employees' Provident Fund Organisation) wage ceiling raised after 12 years **from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000**

One Rule: Four Pegs for Every Scheme

- **A** **Ministry** — whose scheme (Samudra Manthan = Petroleum)
- **B** **Money** — outlay and Centre:state share
- **C** **Date** — approval, entry into force and launch are different
- **D** **Number** — days, targets, beneficiaries

Examiners often swap the "in force" and "launch" dates or the ministry.

Chart **Major Cabinet Approvals 2026 (outlay, ₹ crore)**



Semicon 1.0: December 2021, ₹76,000 crore · GREAT scheme: research-startup grants in technical textiles (National Technical Textiles Mission, since 2023)

1 Samudra Manthan

31 July 2026

Ministry of Petroleum

1. **Offshore oil-gas exploration** · target of 600 MMTOE (Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent)+ reserves
2. Till 2030-31 · ₹84,084 crore

> Name from mythology: the ocean was churned for nectar — here, oil-gas from the seabed.

2 BHAVYA

18 March · 2026-32

1. **100 "plug and play"** industrial parks · support up to ₹1 crore/acre · 15 lakh jobs
2. BHAVYA-Rasayan: 3 chemical parks, each 8 sq km+ (2026-31)

3 PM Surya Sarovar

31 July 2026

1. **5,000 MW floating solar** + 10,000 MWh battery
2. Support of ₹1 crore/MW

> Sarovar = solar panels floating on reservoirs.

4 SARTHAK-PDS

CCEA 27 May

1. **Transport and handling of grain** in the Public Distribution System

4.1 Ministry of Rural Development: MGNREGA to VB-G RAM G

MGNREGA (2005)

- **100 days** per household
- 100% of wages by the Centre, material 75:25
- Now **repealed**

→

VB-G RAM G Act 2025

- Passed December 2025 · in force from **1 July 2026**
- **125 days** per household per year · wages within 15 days
- States can pause work for up to **60 days** a year in the peak farm season · 6 months to merge their own schemes

Diagram **VB-G RAM G: Funding Ratio (Centre : State)**



₹95,692.31 crore in 2026-27 · launched **2 July 2026, Tirupati** (Shivraj Singh Chouhan, CM Chandrababu Naidu) · proposed name was "Pujya Bapu Gramin Rozgar Yojana"

DDU-GKY

1. Since 2014-15 · **2.0 May 2025**
2. **"Roshni"** — insurgency-affected districts · **"Himayat"** — J&K, Ladakh

First National Rural Development Conference

28-29 June 2026

1. Theme **"Viksit Gram, Viksit Bharat"** · Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Trap In force 1 July, ceremony 2 July · North-East 90:10, general 60:40.

4.2 Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare · 4.3 Jal Shakti

PM-KISAN

100% Centre

1. **₹6,000/year**, in three instalments of ₹2,000
2. ₹4.47 lakh crore+ in 23 instalments (23rd: 9.49 crore+ farmers)
3. About a quarter of beneficiaries are women (₹1.06 lakh crore) · 92%+ used it in agriculture
4. Extension 2026-31: ₹3,15,614 crore (31 July)

PM Dhan-Dhaanya and Pulses

11 October 2025

1. **PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana**: ₹24,000 crore · **100 districts** with low productivity (e.g. Kishtwar)
2. **Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses**: ₹11,440 crore · together ₹35,440 crore

Women Farmers and Private Initiatives

1. AIC's **"Krishi Sakhi"** · most trained SHGs under Namo Drone Didi in **Karnataka** · SHG (Self-Help Group) link-age award to Karnataka Gramin Bank
2. **PRAGATI** (PepsiCo Foundation etc.; 20,000 young agri-entrepreneurs, 20 lakh farmers; July 2026) · APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) centre in Pilibhit

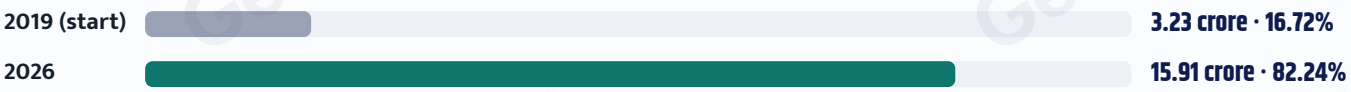
Jal Jeevan Mission

15 August 2019

1. Tap water **3.23 crore (16.72%) → 15.91 crore (82.24%)** homes
2. Standard **55 litres/person/day**
3. 188 districts, 1,090 blocks, 1.01 lakh panchayats "Har Ghar Jal" · taps in 9.34 lakh schools, 9.73 lakh anganwadis
4. **JJM 2.0**: extended in March 2026 to December 2028 · service continuity, water quality, people's participation · "Sujal Gram ID", "Sujalam Bharat Portal" · All-India Water Secretaries' Conference 2026

Trap 55 litres per person per day — not 40 or 70.

Chart **Jal Jeevan Mission: Rural Homes with Tap Water**



4.4 Finance and Labour: Savings, Insurance, Pension

Timeline **EPFO Wage Ceiling**



EPFO 15 November 1951 · EPF 1952, EDLI 1976, EPS 1995 · 51 lakh+ new workers

12 Years of Jan Dhan

28 August 2014

1. **59.09 crore** accounts · deposits ₹3,16,514 crore (12.8 times) · average ₹5,356
2. RuPay 41.29 crore · women 32.92 crore (**55.7%**) · rural-semi-urban 77.8%

Atal Pension

9 May 2015 PFRDA

1. Age **18-40** · ₹1,000-5,000 monthly after 60
2. **Crossed 9 crore** (April 2026) · till 2030-31

e-Shram

26 August 2021

1. First national database of unorganised workers · **31.89 crore+**
2. **54.28% women** · gig workers about 11.5 lakh · age 18-40 55.21%
3. 15 schemes in one place (since 21 October 2024) · top: UP, Bihar, Bengal, MP, Maharashtra

! **Trap** Women are more than half on e-Shram.

Tax Awareness

1. **"PRARAMBH"** campaign (new Income-tax Act)
2. New website and AI assistant **"Kar Saathi"**

4.5 Education and Skills

NCERT Now a Deemed University

30 March 2026

1. "Deemed to be University (Distinct Category)" — **Section 3 of the UGC** (University Grants Commission) **Act**
2. Set up in 1961 · 6 constituent institutes too

Digital Platforms for Children

1. **e-Jadui Pitara** (3-8 years): AI bots "Katha Sakhi", "Abhibhavak Tara", "Shikshak Tara"
2. **PRASHAST 2.0** (screening for 21 disabilities) · "Prompt of the Day"
3. **SATHEE** (IIT Kanpur): free preparation for JEE, NEET (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test), UPSC (Union Public Service Commission)

Skills and Foreign Campuses

1. **PM-SETU** (4 October 2025): ₹60,000 crore, 1,000 government ITIs · Skill India 15 July 2015
2. **University of Liverpool**'s first Indian campus — Bengaluru · LoI to Birkbeck (London) for Bengaluru

Examination Reform Task Force

26 July 2026

1. Chair **Nandan Nilekani**
2. Members: Amrit Lal Meena, S. Somanath, Anita Karwal, Tapan Deka, Prof. V. Kamakoti
3. Shiksha Adhishthan Bill (replacing UGC, AICTE (All India Council for Technical Education), NCTE (National Council for Teacher Education)) — still with the JPC (Joint Parliamentary Committee)

4.6 Digital India: Apps and Portals

Board **New Apps/Portals — Ministry and Purpose**

Identity	Public Service Portals	Railways	Big Ideas
• **New Aadhaar app** (January 2026; QR offline, face)	• **PM-AJAY** portal and AJAY app (25 May)	• **CHIRAG** — AI-based HR (Hyderabad, 29 May)	• NITI Aayog's **DPI** (Digital Public Infrastructure)**@2047**: $30 trillion by 2047, $18,000 per capita
• "Aadhaar Vision 2032" committee (Neelkanth Mishra) · bug bounty · mascot **"Uday"**	• **PRISM-PRI** — road over bridges (Gadkari and Vaishnaw)	• **SHINE** — complaints of women employees (encrypted)	• **Bharat-VISTAAR** (agri AI)
• DigiLocker 72.43 crore · UMANG 11.66 crore	• **e-Upahaar** — auction of Rashtrapati Bhavan gifts		• **Samriddh Gram** (DoT) — WSIS 2026 global winner
	• **JEEVAN** app and **SHATAYU** dashboard — senior citizens		
	• Common Landing Portal — unclaimed money		

Board **e-Governance Awards 2026 — 29th Conference, Jaipur (1-2 July)**

Centre (Gold)

- Agri Stack
- AI diagnosis in e-Sanjeevani
- ICMR-MINDS (Indian Council of Medical Research)
- Panchayat Advancement Index
- e-Jagriti
- ISRO-SAC (Indian Space Research Organisation) cyber threat intelligence

States-Institutions (Gold)

- **Mahakumbh 2025 (Prayagraj)**
- Kerala HC's DCMS
- K-DISC blood bag tracing (Kerala)
- MP e-Nagar Palika cyber security
- Bank of Baroda

Grassroots (Gold)

- Kadepur panchayat (Sangli)
- e-Arogya Dhamani (Nandurbar)

Silver · Jury

- Silver: Bijay Nagar panchayat (Tripura), Pune 360, Ujjain's "Trinetra"
- Jury: Survey of India's CORS

Total 17 (13 Gold, 3 Silver, 1 Jury) · inaugurated by CM Bhajanlal Sharma · awards by Dr. Jitendra Singh · "Jaipur Declaration" (e-governance) — different from the BRICS tourism "Jaipur Declaration"

4.7 Campaigns and Administrative Initiatives

NITI Aayog

1. **Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0** (26 January-14 April): 5 indicators for aspirational districts and 6 for blocks
2. Aspirational Blocks Programme (7 January 2023, 500 blocks) · nutrition-health agreement with UNICEF (United Nations Children's Fund)

Civil Services

1. **Sadhana Saptah** (2-8 April; iGOT Karmayogi)
2. **Seva Sankalp Abhiyan** (17 September-17 October) — PM's 76th birthday, 25 years in public life

Panchayati Raj and Social Justice

1. **Daanveer** (29 July): donating equipment through the "Meri Panchayat App" · "Say No to Proxy Sarpanch"
2. Nasha Mukt Bharat week (17-26 June) · PM-AJAY

Roads, Women and Conferences

1. **Project Saksham** (NHAI + Vertis; women along highways) · Sustainable Road Safety Finance Project (UN fund, 24 February, Jean Todt)
2. 10th Innovation-Inclusivity Summit (Chandigarh) · e-mobility (ASSOCHAM, 2 July) · One Health (from 2 July) · Responsible Business Conduct (4th) · BIMSTEC NSA (5th) · Bharat Buildcon ("One Nation One Expo")

Points to Note

1. VB-G RAM G: in force **1 July**, launched **2 July (Tirupati)**
2. Centre:State — general 60:40 · North-East-Himalayan 90:10 · UTs (without legislature) 100%
3. The new law gives 125 days; MGNREGA gave 100 days
4. Three approvals of 31 July: PM-KISAN extension, Samudra Manthan, Surya Sarovar
5. Samudra Manthan = Ministry of Petroleum (offshore oil-gas), not marine biology
6. JJM standard 55 litres/person/day · tap water 82.24%
7. EPFO ceiling ₹25,000 — changed after 12 years
8. Women 54.28% on e-Shram · 55.7% in Jan Dhan
9. NCERT (National Council of Educational Research and Training) a deemed university under Section 3 of the UGC Act
10. CHIRAG and SHINE — of the Railways · e-Upahaar — of Rashtrapati Bhavan

05 Defence 2025-26: Command, Weapons, Exercises and Security

At a Glance

1. All three top posts changed: CDS (Chief of Defence Staff) **N.S. Raja Subramani**, Navy Chief **Krishna Swaminathan** (both 31 May), Army Chief **Dhiraj Seth** (30 June)
2. First national counter-terrorism policy **"PRAHAAR"** (23 February 2026)
3. DAC (Defence Acquisition Council) approval for **114 Rafales** (MRFA) · Agni-4 test on 6 August
4. AK-203 **"Sher"** 100% indigenous (Korwa, Amethi)
5. Third indigenous SSBN (Ship Submersible Ballistic Nuclear) **INS Aridhaman** · "Shachi"-class patrol vessels

One Rule: Three Tags for Every Defence News Item

A **Which service?** Army, Navy, Air Force or Coast Guard

B **Indigenous or joint?** The shipyard/company that built it

C **First or which number?** Number in its class (4th of P-17A, third SSBN)

In exercises, both the partner country and the venue are changed to make options.

5.1 Leadership of the Forces

Board **Top Command 2026**

CDS (third)	Navy (27th)	Army (31st)	Air Force
General **N.S. Raja Subramani**	Admiral **Krishna Swaminathan**	General **Dhiraj Seth**	Air Chief Marshal **Amar Preet Singh**
31 May 2026 · after Anil Chauhan	**31 May** · after Dinesh Kumar Tripathi	**30 June 2026** to August 2028 · after Upendra Dwivedi	No change

Trap: the CDS and Navy Chief on the same day (31 May), Army Chief on 30 June

Women Ahead

First time

1. Captain **Shivani Sehrawat** — first woman ADC to the Army Chief
2. **Bhawana Kanth** — IAF (Indian Air Force)'s first woman fighter combat leader (TACDE Gwalior)
3. **Shakti Sharma** — first woman Air Vice Marshal in a non-medical branch (1 September)
4. Major **Navya Shekhawat** — first Army woman to become ADC to the President · Major Abhilasha Barak — UN Gender Advocate

Farewell: General V.N. Sharma

31 July 2026 · 96 years

1. 15th Army Chief (1988-90)
2. Younger brother of the first Param Vir Chakra **Major Somnath Sharma**
3. Later ran a free TB clinic in Himachal for four decades

Static

1. The CDS post was created on **24 December 2019** · first CDS General **Bipin Rawat** (1 January 2020)
2. The CDS is also Secretary of the Department of Military Affairs (DMA) · "first among equals" of the three chiefs

5.2 Army: Weapons and Exercises

AK-203 "Sher"

100% indigenous (2026) | Replaces INSAS

IRRPL (Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited), Korwa (Amethi, UP)

1. Contract December 2021 · **6,01,427** rifles
2. **7.62×39 mm** · ~3.6 kg · barrel 415 mm · ~700 rounds/minute · range 800 m
3. Indigenous content from 25% (2024) to **100% (2026)** · test 23 August

Trap Korwa (Amethi) is not among the 6 nodes of the UP Defence Corridor (Agra, Aligarh, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, Kanpur, Lucknow) — it is a separate ordnance factory.

Diagram Shareholding in IRRPL (%) — set up 3 March 2019



The largest share is AWEIL's (India) — 0.5% more than Kalashnikov's

New Systems

1. **Suryastra** — first indigenous multi-calibre rocket launcher, 300 km (at Republic Day 2026)
2. **Akashteer** — air defence control (BEL)
3. **"Saksham"** — counter-drone grid

Within the Army

1. **"Jai se Vijay"** — helicopter runway on NH-911 (29 September) · **"Agnivarsha"** (Southern Command, Jaisalmer) · Operation Netra 1.0 (Leh)
2. First military medicine department at Command Hospital Lucknow · Neeraj Chopra honorary Lieutenant Colonel · "Samudra Sahas" (200 years of the Artillery)

5.3 Navy: New Ships

Board **New Ships — Class-wise**

Major ships

- **INS Taragiri** — fourth stealth frigate of P-17A (MDL, 3 April)
- **INS Aridhaman** — third indigenous SSBN (after Arihant, Arighaat)
- **INS Dhruv** — first nuclear/missile tracking ship

Shallow-water hunters

- **INS Malvan** (Mahe-class, Cochin Shipyard, 22 July; crest the "Urumi" sword)
- **INS Androth** and **Agray** (GRSE)

Diving and support

- **INS Nipun** — second of the Nistar class (HSL; commissioned 31 August; 300 m dive; "Far Beneath, Few Beyond")
- **DSC A20** — first indigenous catamaran (Titagarh; 390 tonnes)
- **"Samarthak"** — first indigenous MPV (L&T, 27 August; 107 m, 3,750 tonnes; two MPVs ~₹887 crore; second "Utkarsh")

Patrol: "Shachi" class

- **11 ships** (7 Goa Shipyard, 4 GRSE (Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers)), ₹9,781 crore · 3,000 tonnes, 23 knots
- "Shachi" (31 March; yard 1280) · "Sanghamitra" (20 May) · "Shruti" (11 August; GRSE yard 3037)
- Coast Guard: **ICGS Achal and Akshar** (Adamya-class, Goa Shipyard)

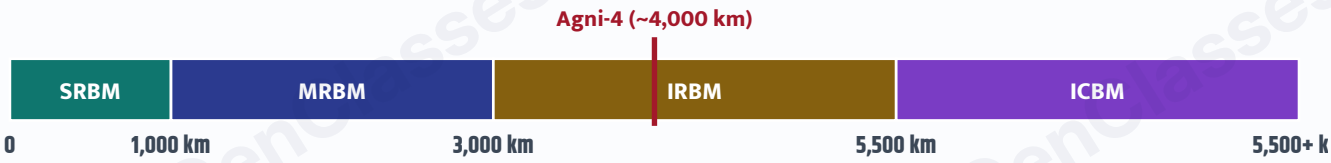
Naval Operations and Initiatives

1. **"Urja Suraksha"** (tankers from Hormuz) · **"Sankalp"** (since 2019, active again)
2. INS Sudarshini **"Lokayan-26"** — first Indian naval ship to visit the Canary Islands · INS Udaygiri and Kavaratti at Da Nang (Vietnam)
3. INMSS-2026 strategy · **India IONS** (Indian Ocean Naval Symposium) **chair 2026-28**

! **Trap** Aridhaman is the third SSBN — Arihant first, Arighaat second.

5.4 Air Force and Missiles

Diagram **Classification of Missiles by Range**



Agni-4 (6 August, Chandipur; nuclear-capable) is therefore called an IRBM (Intermediate-Range Ballistic Missile) in many sources · **MIRV** (Multiple Independently targetable Re-entry Vehicle) = warheads with several separate targets on one missile

114 Rafales (MRFA)

DAC 12 February 2026 | Contract pending

1. **18** directly from France, the rest in India
2. Request for proposal around June (about ₹3.25 lakh crore)

Engines and Aircraft

1. HAL-GE: **113 F404** engines for 97 LCA Mk1A (212 in all; 2027-32)
2. **HTT-40 "Ankur"** trainer to the IAF
3. President Murmu flew in the **LCH "Prachand"** (27 February, Jaisalmer)
4. Airbus-Tata H125 helicopter assembly line at Vemagal (Karnataka)

Missiles-Bombs-Drones

1. **Agni-4** (6 August, Chandipur) · **MIRV Agni** (May, Kalam Island)
2. **Kusha** LR-SAM (first flight 23 July) · **TARA** first glide weapon (7 May) · **Rudram-II** (2 June)
3. Khagantak-243 glide bomb · Astra Mk-2 · Sheshnaag-150 swarm drone

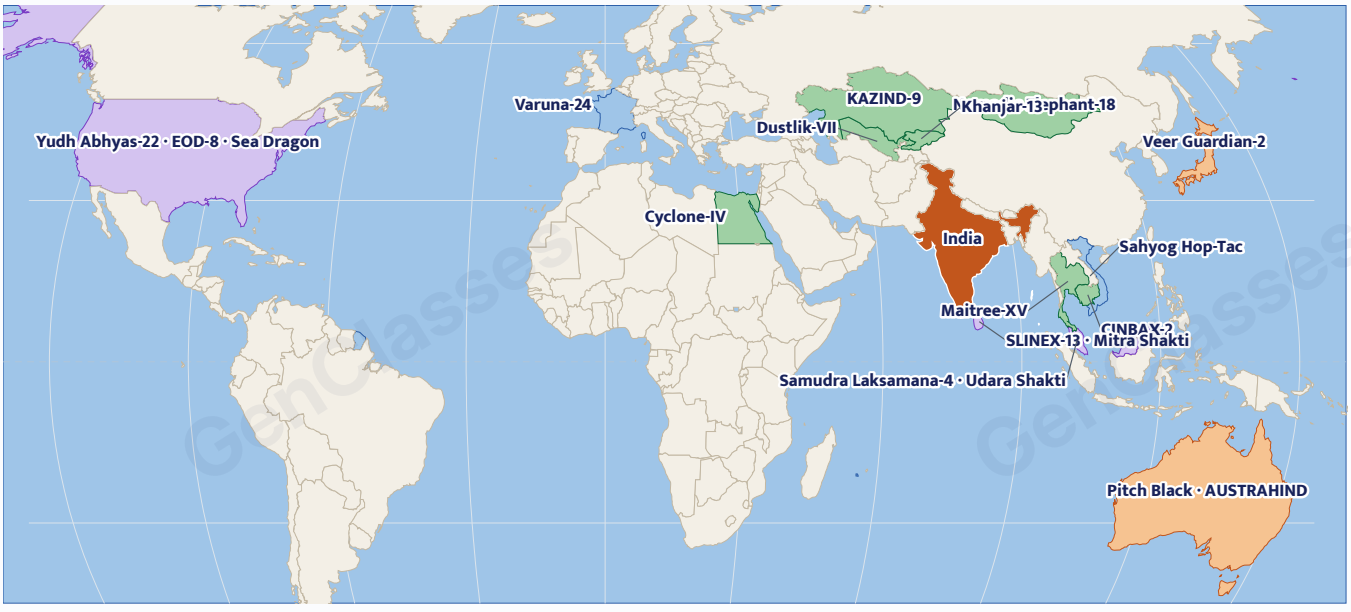
! **Trap** India's first glide weapon is TARA, not Rudram.

Soft Power

1. **Operation Amistad** — 2 C-17s to earthquake-hit Venezuela
2. "Sarang" team at the El Alamein Air Show (Egypt)
3. **Aero India 2027**: 8-12 February, Yelahanka

5.5 Military Exercises 2025-26: On the Map

Map **Partner Countries and Exercises — colour = service**



Board **Exercises: Partner · Venue**

Army

- **Dustlik-VII** Uzbekistan (Namangan)
- **Maitree-XV** Thailand (Surat Thani; 9 Gorkha)
- **Yudh Abhyas-22** USA (Mahajan and Auli)
- **KAZIND-9** Kazakhstan
- **Nomadic Elephant-18** Mongolia (Pithoragarh)
- **Khanjar-13** Kyrgyzstan (Sonitpur)
- **CINBAX-2** Cambodia
- **Cyclone-IV** Egypt (special forces, Anshas)

Navy

- **MILAN-13** (Visakhapatnam, 70+ countries)
- **RIMPAC-30** (Hawaii, INS Shivalik)
- **Varuna-24** France · **SLINEX-13** Sri Lanka
- **Samudra Laksamana-4** Malaysia (Lumut)
- **Sea Dragon** (Guam, P-8I) · **EOD-8** USA (Kochi)
- **Sahyog Hop-Tac** Vietnam Coast Guard (Chennai) · **IMEX-TTX** (IONS, Kochi)

Air Force

- **Tarang Shakti-2** (Jodhpur; "Power in Partnership"; 32 observers)
- **Veer Guardian-2** Japan (Jodhpur; Japanese air force in India for the first time)
- **Pitch Black** (Australia)
- **Udara Shakti** Malaysia (Subang; 4 Rafales)

Of 2025 (for recall)

- Mitra Shakti (Sri Lanka) · Ajeya Warrior (UK) · Harimau Shakti (Malaysia) · Garuda Shakti (Indonesia)
- Ekuverin (Maldives) · Desert Cyclone (UAE) · Konkan (UK Navy)
- JIMEX · Malabar (Guam) · AUSTRAHIND (Perth) · Trishul
- Table-top: Colombo Security Conclave (Visakhapatnam)

Freedom Shield is a US-South Korea exercise, not India's

5.6 Defence Diplomacy and Industry

India-Japan

19-20 August

1. Defence Minister **Koizumi** visited India · memorandum on maritime security arrangements (MDA, SAR, HADR)
2. **UNICORN mast** — first defence equipment transfer · joint shipbuilding · fourth 2+2 in Tokyo

Other Partners

1. India-Russia **RELOS** (Reciprocal Exchange of Logistics Support) in force · first India-Morocco Joint Defence Committee (8 September)
2. India-Thailand 10th defence dialogue (Bangkok) · India-US 25th Army staff talks (Hawaii)
3. **BrahMos** to Vietnam, Indonesia in the final stage (first customer the Philippines, 2022)

! **Trap** The first export customer of BrahMos is the Philippines.

Seminars and Training

1. **Ran-Samvad** (Bengaluru, "Multi Domain Operations") · **NETRA-2026** (DRDO, electronic warfare) · tri-service future warfare course (4th)
2. NCC **"Aparajita: Parang La"** — first girls' trek (28 cadets, ~5,578 m, ~250 km in 30 days)

Defence Industry

1. Adani's missile facility at **Shivpuri** (₹2,500 crore)
2. Lumira E40I50 germanium-free thermal payload · SWADES (DRDO Jodhpur desalination)

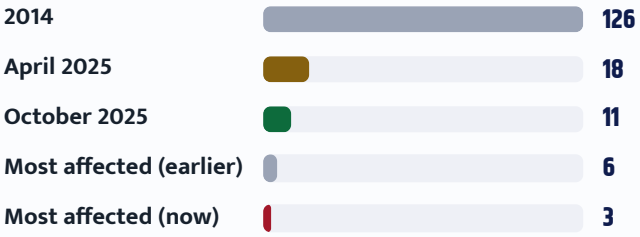
5.7 Internal Security

Diagram **"PRAHAAR" — First National Counter-Terrorism Policy, 23 February 2026**

P	R	A	H	A	A	R
Prevention	Response	Aggregating capacities	Human rights	Attenuating conditions	Aligning interna-tional efforts	Recovery & resilience

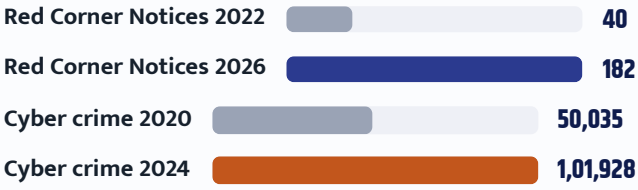
First national conference on 28 September (Amit Shah)

Chart **Naxal-Affected Districts**



All three most affected — **Bijapur, Sukma, Narayanpur** (Chhattisgarh) · target 31 March 2026 · **Telangana "Naxal-free"** (surrender of 42 cadres)

Chart **Fugitives and Cyber Crime**



401 Red Corner Notices in three years · NCRB (National Crime Records Bureau) 2024: **Telangana** tops cyber crimes

Fugitives and Asset Recovery

1. **274 fugitives** brought back from 36 countries since 2019 (33 extraditions, e.g. **Tahawwur Rana**)
2. PMLA: ₹17,874 crore recovered, ₹18,762 crore returned
3. **BHARATPOL** (CBI, 1,400+ agencies) · Operation Trishul

Cyber

1. **"Boss scam"** warning (I4C, 22 June)
2. CBI (Central Bureau of Investigation)'s **"Abhay"** chatbot and **Operation Chakra-II** (digital arrest)
3. Cyber Kushti 2026 — winner "Cyber Kesari"

Narcotics

1. **Operation RAGEPILL** — first big seizure of Captagon (~₹182 crore)
2. **"Team-Kalki"** network (NCB) · NARIT-AI (Gujarat Police)

Other Operations

1. National **IED** (Improvised Explosive Device) **Data System** (NSG Manesar, 9 January) · new NSG (Nuclear Suppliers Group) hub at **Ayodhya**
2. **Operation Mukta** (Bengaluru, illegal migrants, ~1,909 detained)
3. **Nanhe Farishte** (RPF): 84,119 children in 2018-May 2024 (highest 17,756 in 2022)
4. **Himsetu** (Lachen): 1,321 tourists + 84 locals = 1,405 rescued · Project Hawk Eye (Amarnath) · **Project Chetak** (BRO, 47th foundation day)

Global Air Power Ranking 2026 (WDMMA, July)

India ahead of China

1. **Country-wise** (aircraft of all services — army, navy, air): India **third** — after the US and Russia
2. **Service-wise**: Indian Air Force **sixth**, China's PLAAF seventh · TruVal Rating 69.4 vs 63.8
3. China leads in number of aircraft (3,733 vs 1,716) — the ranking is not just a count but capability-based (TruVal Rating)
4. Publisher: World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA)

! **Trap** India is third country-wise, but sixth in the air-force-only list — two different rankings.

! Points to Note

1. CDS third, Navy Chief 27th, Army Chief 31st
2. AK-203 factory at Korwa (Amethi) · largest share in IRRPL AWEIL 42.5%
3. INS Aridhaman the third SSBN · INS Dhruv the first missile tracking ship
4. INS Taragiri the **fourth** frigate of P-17A · INS Nipun the **second** of the Nistar class
5. "Shachi" class: 11 ships — 7 Goa Shipyard, 4 GRSE
6. TARA the first glide weapon · Kusha LR-SAM
7. The 4,000 km Agni-4 = IRBM class (3,000-5,500)
8. Veer Guardian-2: Japanese air force in India (Jodhpur) for the first time
9. Freedom Shield is not India's exercise
10. All three most Naxal-affected districts are in Chhattisgarh · Naxal-free state Telangana

06 Science 2025-26: Space, AI, Supercomputers and Biology

At a Glance

1. **Vikram-1** (Skyroot): India's first private rocket to reach orbit (18 July 2026)
2. **Artemis-II**: first crewed lunar flyby since 1972 (April 2026)
3. **China (LineShine)** tops the TOP500 for the first time since 2017
4. Complete **T2T** (Telomere-to-Telomere) **genome** of pigeon pea · first indigenous vaccine for African swine fever
5. **India AI Impact Summit** (February) · "New Delhi AI Impact Declaration"

One Rule: "First" in Which Sense?

A **First of whom?** India's, private, the world's — all three differ

B **To which orbit/point?** Sub-orbital, orbital, L1, L2

C **Maker** — ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation), C-DAC, an IIT or a private company

Vikram-S was the "first private" rocket, but sub-orbital; Vikram-1 is the "first private orbital" one.

6.1 Space: ISRO and India's Missions

Timeline **ISRO 2025-26: Successes and Failures**

Success
2 November 2025

LVM3-M5 (Launch Vehicle Mark-3)
GSAT-7R / CMS-03 — ~4,400 kg, heaviest naval communication satellite launched from India

Failure
12 January 2026

PSLV-C62 (Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle)
EOS-N1 **"Anvesha"** + 15 satellites · fault in the third stage

Second in 8 months
PSLV-C61 / EOS-09 in May 2025

Test
April 2026

Gaganyaan
Crew module **air-drop** successful

Next
First uncrewed G1: Q4 2026 (may slip to 2027) · crewed 2027-28 or later

Success
4 September 2026

GSLV-F17 (Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle)
EOS-05 — 2,367 kg · ISRO's 19th GSLV · 107th launch from Sriharikota

Chandrayaan-4

Around 2028

1. **Sample-return** mission · approved 18 September 2024
2. Landing zone near Mons Mouton

With NASA

1. Invitation to a lunar south pole **"Moon Base"** at the 9th CSJWG meeting (5-6 August, ISRO HQ)
2. India the **27th** signatory of the Artemis Accords (21 June 2023) · Türkiye **71st** (31 August 2026)

Honours-Conferences

1. **AIAA Goddard Astronautics Award** to the Chandrayaan-3 team (21 May)
2. SMOPS 2026 (Bengaluru, 8-10 April)
3. Third **National Space Day** 23 August

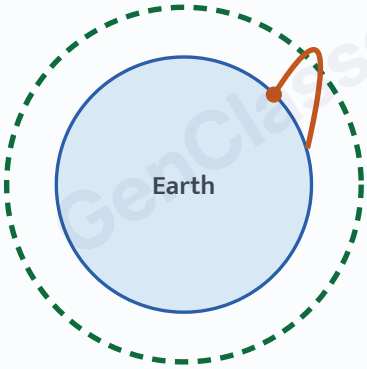
Private-Sector Satellites

1. **GalaxEye "Drishti"** (3 May, Falcon-9) — world's first **OptoSAR** (optical + radar together)
2. **Pathfinder** (Pixxel + Sarvam AI) — first orbital data centre satellite (in making)
3. Students: VikkoSAT-1 (Sivaganga, Class 11) · Mission ShaktiSat (~12,000 girls from 108 countries) · Kunchala Kaivalya Reddy (17) for astronaut training in Florida

! **Trap** OptoSAR is a world first — not just first in India.

6.2 Space: India's Private Sector

Diagram **Sub-orbital vs Orbital Flight**



— Vikram-S (November 2022): sub-orbital — went

- - - Vikram-1 (18 July 2026): in orbit — keeps circling

Orbit needs a horizontal speed of about 7.8 km/second

A sub-orbital vehicle touches space and falls back; an orbital vehicle gains so much horizontal speed that it keeps circling the Earth even while falling

Skyroot Vikram-1

18 July 2026 · Mission "Aagaman"

1. India's **first private orbital rocket**

! **Trap** Vikram-S (2022) was the first private rocket, but sub-orbital.

Astrobase "Everest" Engine

7 August

1. First private **full-flow staged combustion** engine · 800 kN
2. Liquid oxygen + **methane** · ~340 seconds specific impulse · for reusable rockets

Static

1. **IN-SPACe** (2020) — nodal body authorising private space companies · **NSIL** (2019) — ISRO's commercial arm

Diagram **Sun-Earth Lagrange Points: Which Mission Where**



L1 towards the Sun (continuous view of the Sun — Aditya-L1) · L2 away from the Sun (deep space, cold and dark — James Webb and the Nancy Grace Roman Telescope)

Artemis-II (NASA)

1-10 April 2026 | SLS + Orion

1. First **crewed lunar flyby** since 1972 — around the Moon, no landing
2. Crew: Reid Wiseman, Victor Glover, Christina Koch, **Jeremy Hansen (Canada)**

! **Trap** Artemis-II did not land — only orbited.

Nancy Grace Roman Telescope

30 August

1. On Falcon Heavy · **Sun-Earth L2** · first images 2027

Other US Missions

1. **SOLAR-1** (NASA) — first space weather monitoring satellite
2. **BOHR** (City Labs) — first commercial nuclear battery satellite (July)
3. **Project Suncatcher** (Google, 1 October) — AI on TPUs in space; solar AI data centres by 2027

China and Pakistan

1. **Shenzhou-23** (24 May) — three astronauts to Tiangong; two Pakistanis selected for training
2. **Jinnah-1** — Pakistan's first lunar rover, ~35 kg, with China ~2029

6.3 Discoveries in Astronomy and Earth Science

Discovery by IUCAA Pune

⌖ Magellanic Bridge (between the two satellite galaxies near our galaxy)

1. First **pulsating symbiotic supersoft X-ray system** eRASSU J043115.8–711730
2. With Germany's **eROSITA** telescope · a white dwarf pulls gas from a red giant
3. Dr. Tathagata Saha, Prof. Chandreyee Maitra

Moon and Observatory

1. Rare **cerium-magnesium** mineral in a lunar meteorite · possible water-ice in shadowed craters of the south pole
2. **NIT Srinagar** — first NIT with an observatory on campus (guided by IIA (Indian Institute of Astrophysics); IIA's high-altitude centre at Hanle)

6.4 AI, Supercomputers and Quantum

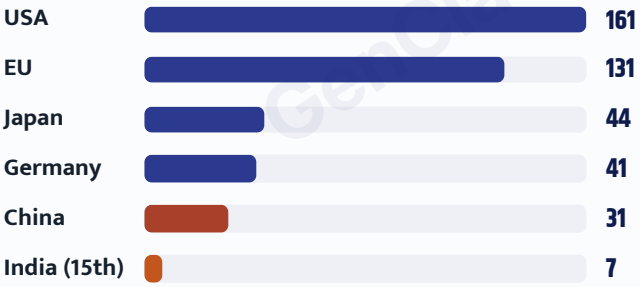
Chart **TOP500 (67th, 22 June 2026) — Top 5, exaflops**



3. Frontier (USA)
4. Aurora (USA)
5. **JUPITER** (Germany) — Europe's first exascale

China on top for the first time since 2017

Chart **Number of Supercomputers in the TOP500**



India's fastest AIRAWAT (75th in 2023)

India AI Impact Summit

16-20 February 2026 | Bharat Mandapam

1. Inaugurated 19 February · Macron and Guterres spoke
2. 21 February **"New Delhi AI Impact Declaration"** (logo by Ajith P. Suresh)
3. India joined **Pax Silica** during this time (20 February)

Indigenous Supercomputers and Chips

1. **"Param Pragya"** — IIT Delhi (Sonipat), 8 August 2026 (57th convocation)
2. **Param Shavak DL** — IET Lucknow · C-DAC's "supercomputer in a box"
3. **"Dhruv64"** (C-DAC, December 2025) — first indigenous 1 GHz 64-bit dual-core RISC-V processor · IIT Delhi micro GPU

! **Trap** Param Shavak DL is not India's first AI supercomputer.

Indian-Language AI

1. **Sarvam AI** — first indigenous LLM · **SraVaani** (IISc; 65 languages-dialects; open-source)
2. Gnani.ai's "Gnani Arth" (Evon 3.3, Plexus) · **"Samadhan"** (DARPG + Bhashini)
3. **BODH** (IIT Kanpur + NHA, health-AI benchmark) · DRDO (Defence Research and Development Organisation)'s **"Pragya"** (satellite image AI, Home Ministry)

AI World and Quantum

1. UN's **40-member AI scientific panel** (co-chairs Maria Ressa, Yoshua Bengio) · US-China AI hotline · UAE's first AI sovereign financial cloud · DeepMind's AlphaGenome Atlas
2. ₹100 crore to IIM Ahmedabad's "School of AI" · Chandigarh Univ. + Intel data lab · Telangana AI hub · RPF (Railway Protection Force)'s first humanoid **"ASC Arjun"** · first virtual zoo in Indore (14-D, ~₹4.5 crore) · Deloitte's ConnectSafe (4,500 sq ft)
3. Quantum: **Amaravati Quantum Valley** (first dedicated test facility) · IIT Bombay's first indigenous quantum diamond microscope

6.5 Biology, Medical Research and Devices

T2T Genome of Pigeon Pea "Asha"

ICAR-NIPB

1. T2T = telomere to telomere, a complete genome without any gaps
2. **752.65 Mb** · 11 chromosomes · 36,557 genes
3. The world's first draft genome of a pulse (2011) was also NIPB's

Plant OpenCRISPR-1

CRRI Cuttack

1. World's first **AI-designed** plant genome-editing system
2. Model crop: rice

Drugs and Vaccines

1. First indigenous vaccine for **ASF** (ICAR-NIHSAD Bhopal; live attenuated, genotype-II, MA-104 cells)
2. **Qdenga** — first dengue vaccine (CDSCO, July; 4-60 years)
3. **RK-251** "smart" anti-cancer prodrug (IASST + IIT Guwahati; activated by high ROS; effective on TNBC; preclinical)

Animal Breeding

1. World's first IVF calf of Assam's **Lakhimi** breed (Khanapara, 22 August)
2. First pig liver-kidney transplant in China

New Devices

1. **E-Eye** (IIT Guwahati): arsenic, lead, iron, chromium, fluoride, E. coli in water — ~₹3,500, ~₹2 per test, 2,700+ samples
2. CURAJ (Ajmer) lead monitoring · **Akasha 300** 3D printer (Fabheads, 350°C, to ISRO) · NESCOD (KAUST, cooling without power) · MatsyaMetri (CMFRI)

Brain and Policy

1. **ANCHOR** (IIT Madras) — most detailed 3D atlas of the human brainstem · BCI conference (5 May; inaugurated by CDS (Chief of Defence Staff) Anil Chauhan)
2. Bioeconomy **$165.7 billion** (2024), target $1 trillion (2047); start-ups from 100 to 11,000+
3. Mega Science Vision 2035 (nodal IISc, PSA) · Mahajal project · BioNEST at CFTRI Mysuru (1950)

Points to Note

1. Vikram-S (2022) first private sub-orbital · Vikram-1 (2026) first private orbital
2. PSLV-C62 failed (12 January 2026) — second PSLV failure in 8 months
3. CMS-03: heaviest **naval communication** satellite launched from India (LVM3-M5)
4. GalaxEye "Drishti" = world's first OptoSAR
5. Artemis-II did not land on the Moon · Canadian astronaut Jeremy Hansen
6. Roman Telescope at L2 · Aditya-L1 at L1
7. India the 27th in the Artemis Accords · Türkiye 71st
8. TOP500: China first, the US leads in numbers · India 7 (15th)
9. "Dhruv64" is C-DAC's RISC-V processor
10. Pigeon pea T2T genome — ICAR-NIPB (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) · ASF vaccine — ICAR-NIHSAD Bhopal

07 Environment 2025-26: Climate Talks, Wetlands, Wildlife and Pollution

At a Glance

1. India's Ramsar sites **103** (26 in 2014) · first in Asia
2. Third NDC (2035): emission intensity **47%** lower, **60%** non-fossil capacity
3. Third home for cheetahs **Nauradehi** · Asiatic lions **891**
4. **High Seas Treaty** (BBNJ) in force from 17 January 2026
5. India **176/177** in EPI (Environmental Performance Index) 2026 · India the **sixth** most polluted in IQAir

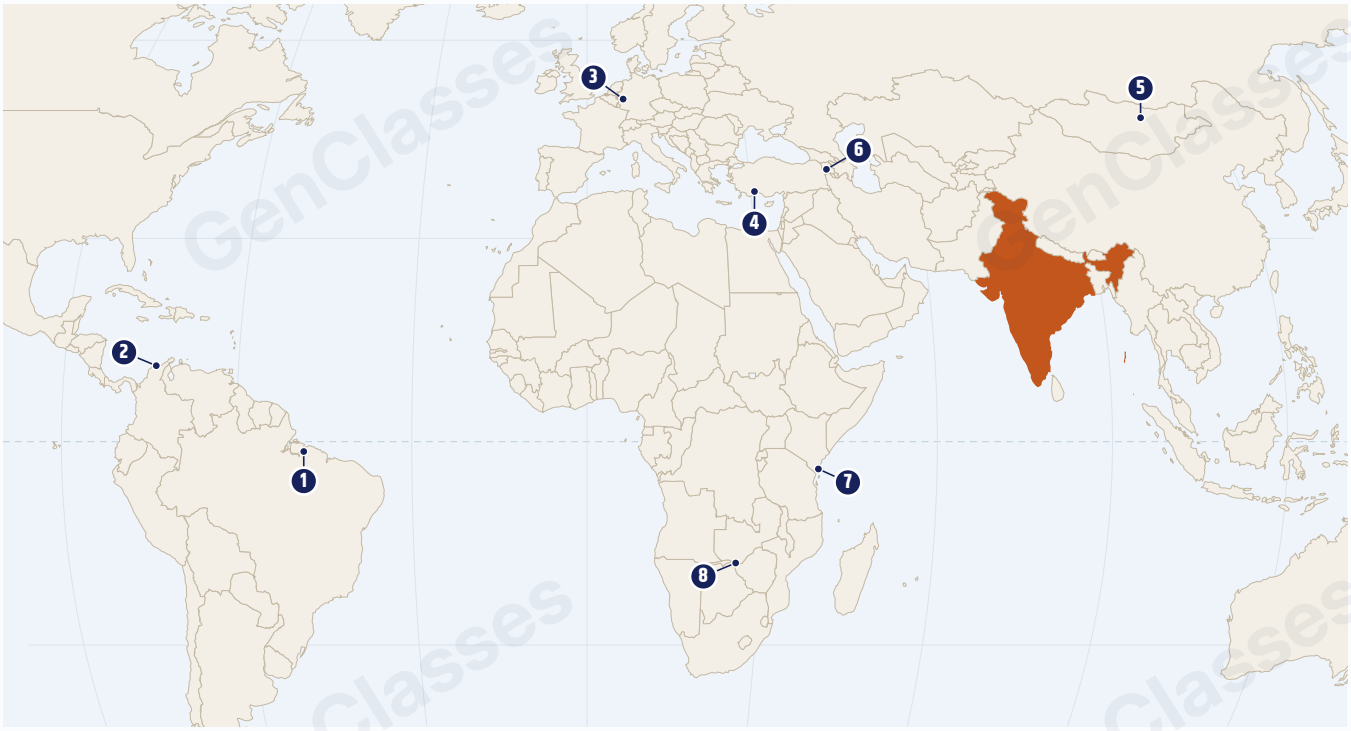
One Rule: In Every Environment Story, "Which COP?"

- **A** **Climate** (UNFCCC) — COP-30 Belém (key idea "Global Mutirão" — collective effort) · COP-31 Antalya, 9-20 November 2026 ("implementation COP"; no formal theme announced)
- **B** **Desertification** (UNCCD) — COP-17 Ulaanbaatar, theme **"Restoring Land. Restoring Hope."**
- **C** **Biodiversity** (CBD) — COP-17 Yerevan, theme **"Taking Action for Nature"**
- **D** **Wetlands** (Ramsar) — COP-15 Victoria Falls, theme **"Protecting Wetlands for Our Common Future"**

Two "COP-17s" in 2026 — the examiner swaps exactly these.

7.1 Climate Talks: What Was Decided Where

Map **Map of Environment Negotiations 2025-26**



1. Belém (Brazil) — COP-30, 10-21 November 2025: first COP in the Amazon
2. Santa Marta (Colombia) — first conference on transition away from fossil fuels, 24-29 April
3. Bonn — SB64, 8-18 June: recommendation of $120 billion adaptation finance
4. Antalya (Türkiye) — COP-31, 9-20 November 2026 (presidency Türkiye, negotiations Australia)
5. Ulaanbaatar (Mongolia) — UNCCD (United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification) COP-17, 17-28 August
6. Yerevan (Armenia) — CBD (Convention on Biological Diversity) COP-17, 19-30 October
7. Mombasa (Kenya) — 11th "Our Ocean": "Mombasa Declaration"
8. Victoria Falls — Ramsar COP-15 (July 2025)

COP-30 Belém

First COP in the Amazon

1. **"Global Mutirão"**: tripling adaptation finance by 2035
2. Roadmap away from fossil fuels (80+ countries in support) **left out of the final text**
3. Brazil's **"Tropical Forests Forever"** fund

> Mutirão = "collective community work" in a Brazilian indigenous language.

2026 Links

1. **India, China and the US did not attend** the Santa Marta conference
2. India withdrew its bid for **COP-33 (2028)**
3. UNCCD COP-17 theme "Restoring Land. Restoring Hope." · India's first **"Guide to Grasslands and Open Natural Ecosystems"** (MoEFCC + ATREE, 24 types)
4. CBD COP-17: **first review** of the Kunming-Montreal framework

Oceans

17 January 2026

1. **High Seas Treaty (BBNJ)** in force — first binding one under UNCLOS (United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea)
2. "Mombasa Declaration": 12 points against illegal fishing

Climate Finance

1. Germany's **IKI** — €20 million for India's climate-resilient cities
2. World Bank **"Water Forward"** — 1 billion people by 2030

! **Trap** Desertification COP-17 Ulaanbaatar, biodiversity COP-17 Yerevan, climate COP-31 Antalya.

Chart — India's Pledges: 2030 vs Third NDC (2035)

Emission intensity cut 2030	45% (36% achieved by 2020)
Emission intensity cut 2035	47%
Non-fossil capacity 2030	50% (52.57% in February 2026)
Non-fossil capacity 2035	60%

Base year 2005 · additional carbon sink: 2.5-3 billion tonnes by 2030 → **3.5-4 billion tonnes** by 2035

Timeline — From Ozone to Kigali

- **1985** — Vienna
- **16 Sept. 1987** — Montreal (India 1992)
- **2016** — Kigali (in force 2019)

India's HFC cuts (from baseline)

2032	10%
2037	20%
2042	30%
2047	85%

HFCs have zero ODP but very high GWP · HPMP Stage III 2023-30 · Ozone Day theme 2026 "Global Action for a Cooler Planet"

7.2 Wetlands: Ramsar 103

Timeline — Number of Ramsar Sites

- **2014** — 26
- **November 2025** — 94
- 96
- **30 January 2026** — 98
- **22 April** — 99
- **5 June** — 100
- **3 August** — 101
- **15 October** — 103

Table: UK 176 · Mexico 144 · India 103 (first in Asia) · among states **Tamil Nadu 20, UP 14** · largest Sundarbans · first two (1981) Chilika and Keoladeo · Bhopal's "Bhoj Wetland" (Upper + Lower Lake)

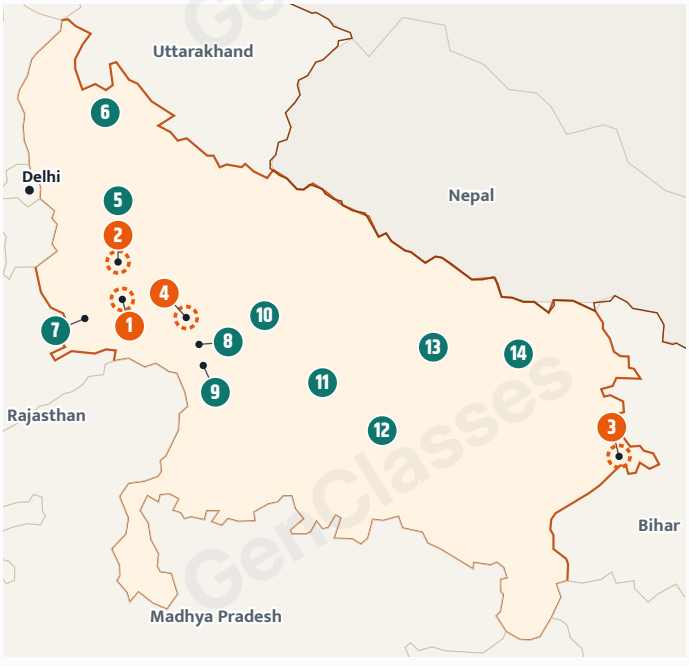
Map New Ramsar Sites — on the Map



1. Gogabil (Katihar, Bihar) — Bihar's first community reserve
2. Siliserh (Alwar) — Sariska buffer
3. Kopra (Bilaspur) — Chhattisgarh's first
4. Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah, UP)
5. Chhari-Dhand (Kutch, Gujarat)
6. Sheikha (Aligarh, UP)
7. Surha Tal (Ballia, UP) — 100th
8. Glow Lake (Lohit) — Arunachal's first, Kamlang Tiger Reserve
9. Sukhna — Chandigarh's first
10. Sauj (Mainpuri, UP)

Two states in green — **Tamil Nadu (20)** leads, **UP (14)** second.

Map Uttar Pradesh's 14 Ramsar Sites — the New Four Highlighted



New four (2025-26)

1. **Patna Bird Sanctuary** (Etah) — 2025 · UP's 11th
2. **Sheikha Lake** (Aligarh) — 22 April 2026 · India's 99th, UP's 12th
3. **Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary)** (Ballia) — 5 June 2026 · India's 100th, UP's 13th
4. **Sauj Lake** (Mainpuri) — 15 October 2026 · India's 103rd, UP's 14th

Earlier 10

5. **Upper Ganga River (Brijghat-Narora)** (Bulandshahr-Amroha)
6. **Haiderpur** (Muzaffarnagar-Bijnor)
7. **Sur Sarovar (Keetham)** (Agra)
8. **Saman Bird Sanctuary** (Mainpuri)
9. **Sarsai Nawar Lake** (Etawah)
10. **Sandi Bird Sanctuary** (Hardoi)
11. **Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary** (Unnao)
12. **Samaspur Bird Sanctuary** (Raebareli)
13. **Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary** (Gonda)
14. **Bakhira Bird Sanctuary** (Sant Kabir Nagar)

UP's first Ramsar: Upper Ganga River (2005) · six bird sanctuaries together in 2019 (Nawabganj, Parvati Arga, Saman, Samaspur, Sandi, Sarsai Nawar) · India's 100th Ramsar is in UP — Surha Tal

Static

1. Ramsar Convention **2 February 1971** (Ramsar, Iran) · in force 1975 · India a party from **1 February 1982**
2. 2 February World Wetlands Day (2026 theme: traditional knowledge and cultural heritage) · **"Montreux Record"** = sites whose ecological character is under threat

7.3 Wildlife: Species-wise

Tiger

3,682 (2022)

1. About **75%** of the world · **58** reserves · sixth assessment under way (report 2027)
2. Relocation approved in Satkosia · reintroduction in Buxa

Cheetah

Since 17 September 2022

1. 9 from Botswana (28 February 2026) · about 57 (Kuno 54, Gandhi Sagar 3)
2. Third home **Nauradehi** (8 October)

! **Trap** Order of homes: Kuno → Gandhi Sagar → Nauradehi.

Asiatic Lion

891 (May 2025)

1. 16th census; 674 in 2020, 523 in 2015 · 384 inside forest, 507 outside
2. **Barda** the second home · Project Lion (15 August 2020) · Spotlight programme from Gir

Elephant

DNA count 22,446

1. About 60% of the world
2. Human-elephant conflict research centre at Palamu · Andhra's HANUMAN project (kumki) · Project Elephant 1992 (MIKE)

Dolphin

First survey 6,327

1. = Ganges 6,324 + Indus 3 · Indus dolphin only in the **Beas (Punjab)**
2. Ganges dolphin the National Aquatic Animal (2009; Vikramshila) · Irrawaddy in Chilika · second survey 19 January 2026, from Bijnor

Snow and Clouded Leopard

1. Snow leopard **718** (Ladakh 477) · SHAN organisation (16 June)
2. **Mission Clouded Leopard** (Meghalaya, 4 August) — Meghalaya's state animal, IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature) Vulnerable

Gaur · Barasingha · Birds

1. Second Gaur Festival at **Debrigarh** (Odisha) · expansion of the barasingha sanctuary at Hastinapur (ESZ 408.7 sq km)
2. First AI bird monitoring at Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (₹45 crore) · 90% of the Indian skimmer is in India

Microbes-Insects

1. **Microbacterium pollutisoli** (tolerates the HCH pesticide)
2. Water hyacinth control with the Neochetina weevil · Kerala's state microbe **Bacillus subtilis**

7.4 Forests, Land and Conservation Policy

Land Restoration

1. **Bonn Challenge** (2011): 350 million hectares by 2030 · India's target **26 million hectares** (FLR about 21.8 million)
2. 3.2 lakh hectares from CAMPA · Green India Mission 1.7 lakh · 61.3 million assets geo-tagged

Western Ghats ESA (7th draft)

1. **6 states** · 56,825.7 sq km · most in **Karnataka 20,668**
2. **Myristica swamps** (~50 million-year-old "living fossils") under threat

Disputed Projects

1. **Great Nicobar** (~₹92,000 crore): NGT did not reopen the clearance · Calcutta HC hearing 25-26 November · Centre moved the SC
2. **Definition of the Aravallis**: SC suo motu; report 30 November

Biodiversity Bodies

1. About 54 heritage sites (**Nagamalai Hill**, 32.22 hectares — Tamil Nadu's fourth) · Mizoram Univ. museum the 21st notified repository
2. ₹29.40 lakh to Odisha for red sanders (ABS) · National Red List of 11,000 species by 2030 · PaleoIndia portal (ZSI) · Vantara University (Jamnagar)

Green Belts

1. **Arogya Van** (NHAI, medicinal trees) · first bee corridor **"Bee Corridor"** (~40 lakh trees) · Vaman Van (Delhi)
2. Mangrove workshop in Bhuj, MGIS portal · **18 Blue Flag beaches** (Kovalam for the fifth year)

Global

1. UN declared 2026 the **Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists** (along with the Year of the Woman Farmer)
2. Interpol-WCO "Operation Thunder 2025" (134 countries) · UAE sank 3 ships to make an artificial coral reef

7.5 Air and Water

Chart **IQAir 2025: Most Polluted Countries (PM2.5, µg/m³)**



Cities: **Loni first**, then Hotan, Byrnihat, New Delhi · 66 Indian cities in the top 100 · Delhi the most polluted capital for the 8th year · cleanest Tirunelveli · only 13 countries meet the WHO (World Health Organization) standard

Board **Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026**

10 lakh+	3-10 lakh	Below 3 lakh
Lucknow (198)	**Rourkela** (198.5)	**Kalinganagar** (198.5)
Indore	Firozabad-Guntur	Angul (196.5)
Jabalpur	Amravati	Talcher (193.5)

NCAP

January 2019

1. 130+ cities · target **40%** cut by 2026 (base 2017)
2. Only **26 cities** succeeded · 14 meet NAAQS · PRANA portal (2021)
3. Transboundary haze: API 519 in Sarawak (Malaysia) — from peat fires in Indonesian Borneo

! **Trap** Most polluted city Loni, most polluted capital Delhi · most polluted country Pakistan, India sixth.

Water

1. **Bihar-Jharkhand Son River Agreement** (31 August 2026): Bihar **5.75 MAF** (Million Acre-Feet), Jharkhand 2.0 MAF · 25-year-old dispute · Bansagar 1973
2. Chenab-Beas link approved · MP's "Jal Ganga Samvardhan" · Meghalaya's "soil lake" · Hyderabad's Himayat Sagar-Osman Sagar · Global Water Award to Digha-Kankarbagh
3. Methane: UNEP (United Nations Environment Programme) **MARS** (satellite monitoring) · largest oil-gas emitter Turkmenistan · Ghazipur landfill in India

7.6 Disasters and Weather

Timeline **North Indian Ocean Cyclones — Order of Names**

2025	2025	2025	2025	Next
Shakti	Montha (Thai: "fragrant flower")	Senyar	Ditwah	Arnab (Bangladesh)

Names taken in turn from a list of 13 countries · Atlantic: Hurricane Melissa — first Category-5 to hit Jamaica · Hurricane Polo (Mexico)

Monsoon and Warnings

1. IMD (India Meteorological Department)'s first forecast **92%** of LPA (13 April; El Niño) · second **90%** (29 May)
2. **Seventh satellite weather centre** in Jammu (5 June) · **SKYCAST** at IGI (Mission Mausam; 19th country) · C-DOT's **SACHET**
3. Kerala declared **tidal flooding** a state-specific disaster

Disasters of 2026

1. **Nepal glacial flood** (26 August; Bhotekoshi-Trishuli) — 1,252+ dead, 4,216+ missing, ~$5 billion
2. **Colombia earthquake 7.4** (10 August; Chocó) — 265 dead, 3,494 injured, ~500 missing; economic emergency
3. **Indonesia 7.8** (15 August; Flores) — tsunami, ~70 dead · **Assam-Arunachal floods** (Brahmaputra) — 103 dead, 1.4 lakh+ displaced
4. Storm "Lala" (15 August; Hawaii's Big Island) · Kronotsky volcano (Kamchatka) · Anak Krakatau on high alert · Yellowstone's **Echinus** — largest acidic geyser

Points to Note

1. Two COP-17s: desertification Ulaanbaatar, biodiversity Yerevan · climate COP-31 Antalya
2. COP-31: presidency Türkiye, negotiations Australia
3. Third NDC: intensity 47% (2035) · non-fossil 60%
4. India's HFC cut under Kigali 85% by 2047
5. Ramsar: India 103 · Tamil Nadu 20 · UP 14 · 100th Surha Tal
6. Glow Lake Arunachal's first, Kopra Chhattisgarh's first, Sukhna Chandigarh's first Ramsar
7. Third home of cheetahs Nauradehi · second home of lions Barda
8. Indus dolphin only in the Beas (Punjab)
9. Son agreement: Bihar 5.75 MAF, Jharkhand 2.0 MAF
10. Most polluted city Loni (UP) · country Pakistan · India sixth

08 Society 2025-26: Health, Education, Women and Children

At a Glance

1. **NFHS-6** (National Family Health Survey) released (29 May 2026): TFR (Total Fertility Rate) 2.0, stunting from 35.5% to 29.3% · highest TFR Bihar
2. **SRS** (Sample Registration System) **2023**: TFR 1.9, infant mortality rate 24
3. Organ transplants **crossed 20,000** for the first time in 2025 · India first in the world in living-donor transplants
4. Literacy **80.9%** · Mizoram first, Kerala now fourth
5. **Balod** (Chhattisgarh) the country's first child-marriage-free district

One Rule: Which Survey Is the Figure From?

- **A** **NFHS** — IIPS Mumbai, household survey (TFR 2.0, nutrition, insurance)
- **B** **SRS** — Registrar General, Sample Registration (TFR 1.9, IMR (Infant Mortality Rate) 24, birth-death rates)
- **C** **NHA** — National Health Accounts (government spending, out-of-pocket spending)

The same indicator (TFR) differs in two surveys — options are built on exactly this.

8.1 NFHS-6 (2023-24): 10 Key Points

National Family Health Survey-6

Released 29 May 2026 · Health Ministry · IIPS Mumbai

1. **Survey**: 2023-24 · **6.79 lakh** households, 7.16 lakh women, 1.01 lakh men · **715 districts** (all states/UTs except Manipur) · entire survey on CAPI (tablet)
2. Indicators in the **fact sheet** cut from 131 to **101** · **anaemia** blood test dropped (now in ICMR-NIN (Indian Council of Medical Research)'s Diet and Biomarkers Survey) · sex ratio also not in the fact sheet
3. **TFR 2.0** (2.0 in NFHS-5 too) · urban **1.6**, rural **2.1** (rural India at replacement level for the first time) · **28** states/UTs below 2.1
4. **Highest TFR**: **Bihar (~2.7)**, then Meghalaya (2.5) — only these two above 2.1 · **UP 2.1** (2.74 in NFHS-4) · **lowest**: Andaman-Nicobar **0.9**; among states **Sikkim 1.1**
5. **Stunting** 35.5% → **29.3%** · highest (large states) **Meghalaya 36.8%**, then Bihar 35.6% · lowest **Kerala 20.1%** (among UTs Puducherry 16.6%)
6. **Wasting** 19.3% → 19.0% · **severe wasting** 7.7% → 5.2% · **underweight** 32.1% → 31.8% (almost the same)
7. **Obesity/overweight**: women 24.0% → **30.7%** (urban 42.8%), men 22.9% → 27.3% · highest among women **Puducherry 46.3%**, among men **Tamil Nadu 38.8%** · Andhra Pradesh ahead among large states · high blood sugar (women) 13.5% → 17.8%
8. **Institutional deliveries** 88.6% → **90.6%** · **caesarean** 21.5% → **27.2%** (private hospitals 54.1%, government 16.9%; WHO (World Health Organization)'s reasonable range 10-15%)
9. **Full immunisation** (12-23 months) 83.8% → **87.1%** · **rotavirus** 36.4% → 85.4% · 95.6% of vaccines from government centres · households with **health insurance** 41.0% → **60.2%**
10. **Women**: own bank account 78.6% → **89.0%** · internet 33.3% → 64.3% · own mobile 53.9% → 63.6% · married before 18 (age 20-24) 23.3% → 20.1% · contraception (total) 66.7% → 69.1%, but modern methods fell 56.4% → 52.7%

! **Trap** TFR 2.0 in NFHS-6, 1.9 in SRS 2023 — two different surveys · NFHS-6 has no anaemia figure

Board The Other Two Surveys: SRS and National Health Accounts

SRS 2023

- TFR **1.9** · highest Bihar **2.8**, then UP 2.6 · lowest Delhi **1.2**, then West Bengal and Tamil Nadu 1.3
- Infant mortality **24** · under-5 28 (per 1,000) · birth rate 18.3 (21.0 in 2014) · death rate 6.4
- 60+ population 9.7% (Kerala 15.1%, Tamil Nadu 14.2%) · age: 0-14 24%, 15-59 66.4%
- Female age at marriage 23.1 (rural 22.6, urban 24.4)

NHA 2022-23

- Government health spending **1.43%** of GDP (from 1.15%; 1.48% on the new base; 1.84% in the Covid year) · per capita ₹1,042 → **₹2,786**
- **Out-of-pocket spending** 64.2% (2013-14) → 43.4% · government share of total 28.6% → 43.7%
- Health in total government spending 3.78% → 4.89%

Static

1. NFHS first round **1992-93** · nodal body IIPS Mumbai · SRS is run by the Registrar General of India
2. Replacement-level fertility **2.1** · NOTTO (National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation) in Delhi — under the Transplantation of Human Organs Act 1994

8.2 Health Programmes and Decisions

HPV Vaccination Campaign

28 February 2026 · From Ajmer

1. PM launched it from **Ajmer** · girls aged **14**
2. Protection against cervical cancer

Maternity

1. **SUMAN Roadmap 2030** (29 June; J.P. Nadda): MMR (Maternal Mortality Ratio) below 70 · 130 districts in 13 states · "SUMAN Panchayats", "Mother Friendly"
2. **JANANI** digital platform (7 May) · **SSBSK** (home-based check-ups from birth to 36 months)

Nutrition

1. **Poshan Maah 2026** (9 September, Varanasi; "Our Anganwadi, Our Responsibility")
2. **Poshan Pakhwada** (9-23 April; brain development in the first 6 years) · 13.99 lakh anganwadi centres · Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0

Policy Decisions

1. **Cancer a notifiable disease**
2. DCGI (Drugs Controller General of India) maximum age from 56 to 58 (DCGI Rajeev Raghuvanshi; Drugs and Cosmetics Act 1940)
3. First dengue vaccine **Qdenga** · zero-dose children from 9.09 lakh to 6.79 lakh (WUENIC 2025)

New Platforms

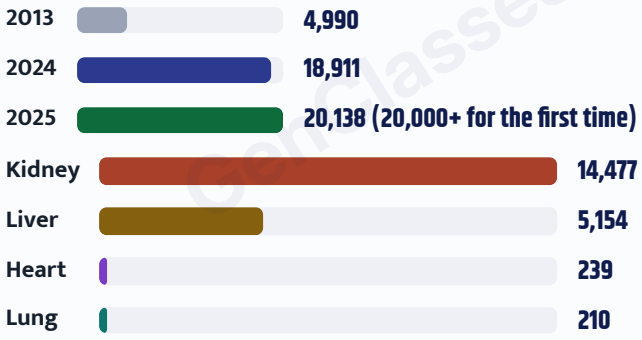
1. **"Mission SEHAT"** (ICAR-ICMR, 11 May) · I2I Connect (ICMR) · **SAHI** (health AI strategy)
2. AIIMS Delhi's first **face transplant** programme

AYUSH

1. **Prakriti Parikshan Abhiyan** (vata-pitta-kapha) · AYUSH Chintan Shivir (16-17 April) · AYUSH grant portal
2. AIIA (All India Institute of Ayurveda)'s "Ayurvarta" · 11th Ayurveda Day in Nagpur

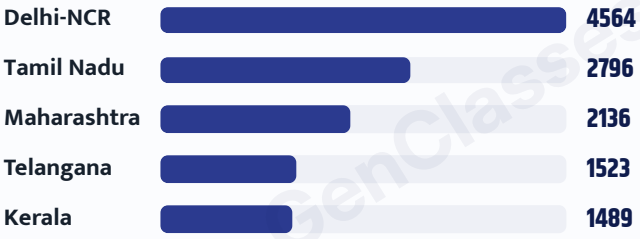
8.3 Organ Donation: NOTTO Report

Chart Organ Transplants: Year-wise and Organ-wise



Deceased-donor transplants from 837 (2013) to 3,526 · pledges 2.58 lakh+

Chart States: Total Transplants



A different order in deceased-donor donation: **Tamil Nadu (266)**, Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka, Kerala · India **third** in the world in total transplants (after the US, China), **first** in living donors

Trap

Delhi-NCR leads in total transplants, **Tamil Nadu** in deceased-donor donation — two separate lists.

8.4 World Health News

Ebola (Bundibugyo), DRC

From May 2026, Ituri

1. **4,665** cases, **2,184** deaths by 12 August — DRC's largest outbreak
2. 70,000 doses of Ervebo — but Ervebo is licensed for the **Zaire** species

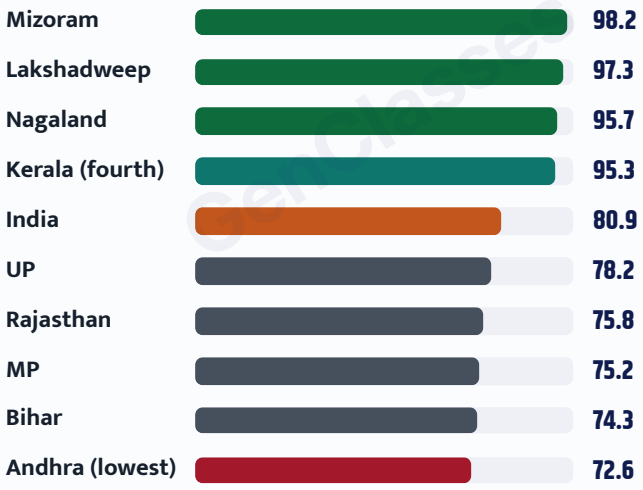
Trap The outbreak is of the Bundibugyo species, the vaccine is for the Zaire species.

HIV and Other Diseases

1. UNAIDS report (27 July): "Global HIV response falters as reemergence looms" · AIDS 2026 conference in **Rio**
2. Largest Cyclospora outbreak in the US ended (11 September; Michigan 14,000+)
3. Emergency measles-mumps vaccination in Bangladesh · One Health Summit Lyon (5-7 April) · US out of the WHO

8.5 Education: In Numbers

Chart Literacy % (PLFS 2023-24)



India 74.04% in 2011 · male 87.2, female 74.6 · urban ~89, rural ~77 · UP male 86.0, female 70.4 · world ~88% (female 79%)

Higher Education (AISHE 2023-24)

1. Enrolment **4.5 crore** · GER (Gross Enrolment Ratio) about 30%
2. Women 2.24 crore (GPI 1.08) · STEM crossed 1 crore for the first time

Schools

1. Pupil-teacher ratio **24:1** (UDISE+ 2025-26; NEP (National Education Policy) norm 30:1)
2. **Morung** (Naga youth dormitory) mentioned in "Mann Ki Baat" (132nd)

Trap Lowest in literacy is not Bihar but Andhra Pradesh (72.6%).

8.6 Women, Children and Social Reform

Child Marriage

Balod: First Free District

1. **Balod** (Chhattisgarh) — 1 October 2025, 436 panchayats · **Ganjam** Odisha's first (2022)
2. 100-day phase (Annapurna Devi) of "Bal Vivah Mukt Bharat" (from 27 November 2024) · new UN Day 27 November
3. 64 crore+ girls in the world married before 18

UN Women Report

1. Women have only **64%** of the legal rights men have
2. In 54% of countries the definition of rape is not based on "consent" · in ~72% child marriage possible in some situations · 44% lack "equal pay for equal work"

Initiatives

1. CARA's campaign against illegal adoption · **Purple Fest** (13 March, Rashtrapati Bhavan; persons with disabilities) · GCWAS-2026 (women in agri-food, 12 March)
2. Saundala (Maharashtra) the first caste-free village · **paid menstrual leave** in Karnataka · free bus travel for women in Kerala
3. Karnataka budget proposes a social media ban for under-16s · SC stays UGC (University Grants Commission)'s anti-discrimination regulations

Two NITI Reports

1. **"Reimagining Care"**: 60+ population 34.7 crore by 2050 · 2.68 crore persons with disabilities · care work 41% women vs 21.4% men · recommends a National Care Council
2. **NEET** (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test) **youth**: 8.7 crore youth aged 15-29 not in education, employment or training

Static

1. **Karl Landsteiner** (1868): ABO blood groups, Nobel 1930 · Rh factor Landsteiner + Wiener (1940) — hence 14 June World Blood Donor Day
2. Kerala's extreme-poverty project: 64,006 families (1,03,099 people)

Points to Note

1. TFR: 2.0 in NFHS-6, 1.9 in SRS 2023 · replacement level 2.1 · no anaemia test in NFHS-6
2. SRS 2023: highest TFR Bihar 2.8, lowest Delhi 1.2 · NFHS-6: highest Bihar (~2.7), lowest Andaman 0.9, among states Sikkim 1.1
3. NFHS-6's nodal body IIPS Mumbai
4. Out-of-pocket spending 64.2% → 43.4%
5. HPV (Human Papillomavirus) campaign from Ajmer · girls aged 14
6. Total transplants Delhi-NCR · deceased-donor donation Tamil Nadu
7. India first in living-donor transplants, third in total
8. Literacy: Mizoram first, Kerala fourth, Andhra lowest
9. First child-marriage-free district Balod (Chhattisgarh) · Odisha's Ganjam
10. Ebola outbreak Bundibugyo species, Ervebo vaccine for the Zaire species

09 Heritage 2025-26: UNESCO, History, Symbols and Crafts

At a Glance

1. **Sarnath** India's 45th World Heritage Site (2026)
2. **Deepavali** the 16th intangible heritage · Committee's 20th session at the Red Fort
3. 150 years of **Vande Mataram** (from 7 November 2025)
4. **Somnath Swabhiman Parv**: 1000 years of the 1026 invasion
5. 80th Independence Day: "Yuva Shakti for Viksit Bharat@2047"

One Rule: UNESCO's Four Separate Counts

- **A** **World Heritage Sites** — 45 (places)
- **B** **Intangible Cultural Heritage** — 16 (traditions, like Deepavali)
- **C** **Memory of the World** — 14 (documents, like the Bhagavad Gita)
- **D** **Tentative List** — 78 (nominees)

An option calling Deepavali a "site" is wrong — it is on the intangible list.

9.1 UNESCO Lists and New Nominees

Board India in the UNESCO Lists

World Heritage: 45

- **Sarnath** — 45th (2026)
- **Maratha Military Landscapes** (12 forts) — 44th (2025)

Intangible Heritage: 16

- **Deepavali** (10 December 2025)
- 20th session 8-13 December 2025, **Red Fort**
- Italy — first country to get intangible status for its entire national cuisine

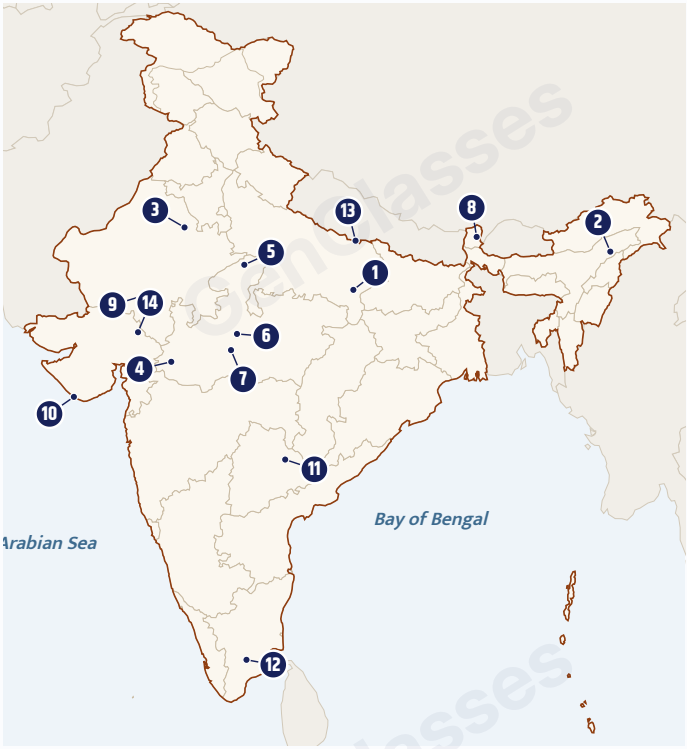
Memory of the World: 14

- **Bhagavad Gita**
- **Natyashastra**

Tentative List: 73 → 78

- 5 newly added (on the map below)

Map Heritage News — on the Map



1. **Sarnath** — 45th World Heritage Site (2026)
2. **Rangpur-Sivasagar** (Assam) — Ahom capital (tentative)
3. **Shekhawati havelis** — Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Churu; 14 towns, an "open-air art gallery"
4. **Bagh Caves** murals (Dhar) — Gupta-era Buddhist
5. **Chambal valley temples** (Bateshwar-Padavali-Kakanmath, Morena)
6. **Udayagiri Caves** (Vidisha) — Gupta-era Hindu-Jain rock-cut
7. **Ginnorgarh Fort** (Sehore) — Gond
8. **Ru-Som bridge** (Sikkim) — Lepcha bamboo-cane bridge
9. **Kumbhalgarh** — ~36 km wall; Rana Kumbha
10. **Somnath** — 1000 years of the 1026 invasion
11. **Gollala Gudi Temple** (Palampet, Mulugu) — national importance (2 September 2026)
12. **Keezhadi** (Sivaganga) — Sangam age, 11th phase
13. **Piprahwa** (Kapilavastu) — Buddha relics
14. **Devnimori** (Gujarat) — relics in an exhibition in Sri Lanka

Foreign/joint on the Tentative List: **Satyagraha sites** (India-South Africa joint nomination) · Prambanan (Indonesia; 9th century, the largest Hindu temple complex there; India helping with conservation)

9.2 History: Episodes in the News

Timeline — Ancient to Modern

1026	Invasion of Somnath · **Swabhiman Parv** on 1000 years (8-11 January 2026)
1443-58	**Rana Kumbha** · Kumbhalgarh (architect Mandan)
1826	**Shikshapatri**, Vadtal · Sahajanand Swami · 200 years
1831	Savitribai Phule born (3 January) · 1848 girls' school in Pune
1863	Vivekananda born (12 January) · 1893 Chicago
1873	Jyotiba Phule's **Satyashodhak Samaj**
1875	**Vande Mataram** composed (7 November)
1905	7 August: Swadeshi from Calcutta Town Hall — basis of Handloom Day
1908	Muzaffarpur bomb case (30 April) · Khudiram hanged (11 August) · Bir Bikram Manikya born (19 August)
1943	30 December: Netaji hoisted the tricolour in **Port Blair**
1951	11 May: rebuilt Somnath inaugurated — **Dr. Rajendra Prasad**
2018	30 December: new names for three Andaman islands

Phule, Braille, Vivekananda

1. Jyotiba Phule's works **"Gulamgiri"**, "Sarvajanik Satyadharma"
2. **Louis Braille**: 4 January 1809, France · 6-dot script · World Braille Day (UN declaration 2018, observed from 2019)
3. **Vivekananda**: 1897 Ramakrishna Mission · 4 July 1902 mahasamadhi at Belur Math · Youth Day from 1985, Youth Festival from 1995 · 2026 theme "Youth Empowerment for Nation Building"

Khudiram Bose

1889-1908

1. Target was Magistrate **Kingsford**, but two English women died
2. Companion **Prafulla Chaki** shot himself at Mokama
3. Hanged at 18 · the jail is now "Khudiram Bose Memorial Central Jail"

Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya

118th birth anniversary

1. Holiday in Tripura · **maker of modern Tripura**
2. Tribal land reservation · Agartala town planning · land for MBB College and Agartala airport

Hansa Mehta and the Andaman Names

1. **Hansa Mehta** — contribution to drafting the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) ("all human beings" instead of "all men")
2. Ross = **Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Island** · Havelock = **Swaraj Dweep** · Neil = **Shaheed Dweep**

> In 1943 Netaji named the Andamans "Shaheed" and the Nicobars "Swaraj" islands — in 2018 these two names went to Havelock and Neil.

Timeline **Vande Mataram: a 150-Year Journey (7 November 2025 to 7 November 2026)**

1875	1882	1896	1905	1937	24 January 1950
Composed by Bankim Chandra	Published in "Anandamath"	Rabindranath Tagore first sang it at the Calcutta Congress	Anti-partition slogan · Benares Congress	Congress Working Committee adopted the first two stanzas	Constituent Assembly: equal to the National Anthem

VM Frames: Culture Ministry's short film contest · in 2026 sung for the first time on the PM's arrival at the Red Fort · when sung together, Vande Mataram's 6 stanzas first (3 minutes 10 seconds)

9.3 80th Independence Day and Symbols

15 August: Flag Hoisting

- The flag is pulled up from below by a rope
- **Prime Minister** · **Red Fort**
- Symbol of the 1947 independence (no Constitution or President then)

VS

26 January: Flag Unfurling

- A flag tied at the top is unfurled
- **President** (Governor/LG in states) · **Kartavya Path**
- Symbol of the Republic · the State Emblem was also adopted on this day in 1950

15 August 2026

80th

1. Modi's **13th consecutive** address (~75 minutes)
2. Vande Mataram lyrics on Defence Ministry invitation cards
3. **Suryapath Tiranga** (MEA): flag hoisting in 54 missions in sunrise order — from Fiji (Suva) to San Francisco
4. **Har Ghar Tiranga** 5th edition, 9-17 August (Culture Ministry; since the Amrit Mahotsav in 2022)

"Sapt Dhara" — the Blueprint of Viksit Bharat

1. Manufacturing
2. Agri-food processing
3. Technology-innovation (AI, quantum, space, robotics)
4. Gati Shakti
5. Defence
6. Green-blue economy
7. Soft power (yoga, Ayurveda, crafts, cinema)

9.4 Temples, Forts and Excavations

Diagram **Four Ages of Somnath (Bhadrakali inscription)**

Gold	Silver	Wood	Stone
Soma (Moon)	Ravana	Shri Krishna	Bhimdev Solanki
First temple	**Second**	**Third**	**Fourth**
By Chandradev	By Ravana	By Shri Krishna	By Bhimdev

Style: **Kailash Mahameru Prasad** (a sub-style of Nagara) · the temple rebuilt in 1951 was inaugurated by Dr. Rajendra Prasad

Kumbhalgarh (Rajsamand)

1. About **36 km** wall — the second-longest continuous wall after the Great Wall of China
2. World Heritage 2013 (Hill Forts of Rajasthan) · birthplace of **Maharana Pratap**

Keezhadi (Sivaganga)

11th Phase

1. Sangam age · ASI (Archaeological Survey of India) permission March 2026; excavation by the state archaeology department
2. June: first **Red Slipped Ware with a handle**
3. 24 July: terracotta pot with a **fish motif** — fish = **Pandya** emblem

> Pandya = fish, Chola = tiger, Chera = bow.

Buddha Relics

1. Exhibition of **Piprahwa** (Kapilavastu) relics in Delhi — theme "Light and the Lotus: Relics of the Awakened One"
2. **Devnimori** (Gujarat) relics in an exhibition in Sri Lanka

Heritage Returned to India

1. Ashmolean (Oxford) returned a 16th-century bronze of **Thirumangai Alvar** (Sri Soundararaja Perumal Temple; one of the 12 Alvars)
2. The US returned ~657 objects (~$14 million) — like a dancing Ganesha, Avalokiteshvara

> ! **Trap** The stone Somnath is Bhimdev Solanki's · the 1951 inauguration was by Rajendra Prasad, not Nehru.

9.5 Handloom, Textiles and GI Tags

12th Handloom Day

7 August 2026

1. Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre · Droupadi Murmu · **22 artisans** (Sant Kabir 3 + National 19)
2. 4 postage stamps · "Handloom Awards Book 2025" · Day since 2015 (announced in Chennai)

Sant Kabir Award 2025

1. **Ram Meher** (Odisha) — Bichitrapuri khadi
2. **Runima Chetia Choudhury** (Assam) — Muga silk
3. **Shah Muhammad Ansari** (UP) — Zarbaft Shwetambari Awadh Jamdani

Other Events

1. **IIHT Sutra** (12 August; first national conference of IIHTs; "Educate, Innovate, Transform")
2. "Srijan: Voices from the Loom" (13 August; 100+ women weavers) · Vishwa Sutra (30×30×30 model; at the 61st Femina Miss India, Bhubaneswar)
3. **Bharat Tex 2026** (third; 14-17 July; Bharat Mandapam; Giriraj Singh)

New GI Tags

1. **Tamil Nadu (5; total 74)**: Woraiyur cotton saree · Kavindapadi Nattu Sakkarai · Namakkal Makkal Pathirangal (soapstone utensils) · Thooyamalli rice · Ambasamudram Choppu toys
2. Gujarat: **Ambaji marble** · Sikkim: Lepcha instruments "Tungbuk", "Pumtong Pulit"
3. Andhra: **Ponduru khadi** (Srikakulam) · West Bengal: **Darjeeling mandarin orange**

9.6 Festivals, Fairs and Tribal Culture

Timeline **Onam 2026: Ten Days (Chingam month, Thiruvonam star)**

~17 August	Chithira	Chodhi	Vishakam	Anizham	Thriketa	Moolam	Pooradam	Uthradam	26 August
Atham									Thiruvonam

Return of Mahabali · Vamana = Vishnu's 5th avatar

Tribal

1. **Bharat Janjati Mahotsav** (18 March-5 April, Sunder Nursery; TRIFED) · premium brand **RISA** (Timeless Tribal)
2. ITDC (1966) tribal homestay training · tribal language-museum conference (24-26 August, Mysuru; CIIL; Durgadas Uikey)
3. IGNCA (Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts)'s "Janjati Gaurav" section · tribal freedom fighter museums in 10 states
4. **Dhimsa dance** Guinness record (Bhogapuram, Vizianagaram; 13,000+ women)

Books, Languages, Festivals

1. **53rd World Book Fair** (10-18 January; guest country **Spain**; theme "Indian Military History: Valour and Wisdom @75") · third International Indian Languages Conference (10 January)
2. First **Jain Chadar Mahotsav** (Jaisalmer, 6-8 March) · 17th Kathakali Festival (Kalakshetra, Chennai; "Katha Rasa Sangam")
3. 65th National Art Exhibition (Lalit Kala Akademi) · second Suru Summer Festival (Damsna, Kargil)

Cinema and Museums

1. FICCI (Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry) Frames (26th, Mumbai) · Sikkim's "Numahangma" at the Nepal Indigenous Film Festival in London · Rajinikanth's 50 years
2. Sudarsan Pattnaik: first Indian to win Russia's Grandsand Masters
3. **Samprati Museum**, Gandhinagar (31 March, Mahavir Jayanti) · exhibition of the original Shikshapatri manuscript held by the Bodleian Library (Oxford)

Static

1. Sangeet Natak Akademi **1953** · Sahitya Akademi **1954** (24 languages: 22 of the 8th Schedule + English + Rajasthani) · Lalit Kala Akademi **1954**
2. NSD 1959 (autonomous in 1975) · CCRT 1979 · IGNCA 1987 · National Mission for Manuscripts 2003

Points to Note

1. Deepavali is not a site, it is **intangible heritage** · 45 sites and 16 intangible — separate counts
2. 44th Maratha Military Landscapes (2025) · 45th Sarnath (2026)
3. Shekhawati: Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Churu (Rajasthan)
4. Bagh Caves in Dhar · Udayagiri Caves in Vidisha · Ginnorgarh in Sehore
5. The stone Somnath is Bhimdev Solanki's · 1951 inauguration Rajendra Prasad
6. Hoisting 15 August (PM, Red Fort) · unfurling 26 January (President, Kartavya Path)
7. Vande Mataram: composed 1875, "Anandamath" 1882, Constituent Assembly 24 January 1950
8. Fish on the Keezhadi pot = Pandya
9. Havelock = Swaraj Dweep · Neil = Shaheed Dweep · Ross = Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Island
10. From UP in the Sant Kabir Award: Shah Muhammad Ansari (Awadh Jamdani)

10 Sports 2025-26: Big Events, Cricket, Grand Slams and Chess

At a Glance

1. India the first team to defend the **T20 World Cup** title (third title)
2. **Women's ODI** (One Day International) **World Cup 2025** India for the first time
3. Asian Games Nagoya: **85 medals**, fourth · Commonwealth Glasgow: **39 medals**, fourth
4. FIFA (Fédération Internationale de Football Association) World Cup 2026 **Spain** (second) · Hockey World Cup men Germany, women Argentina
5. **Gukesh vs Sindarov**: World Chess Championship, Geneva

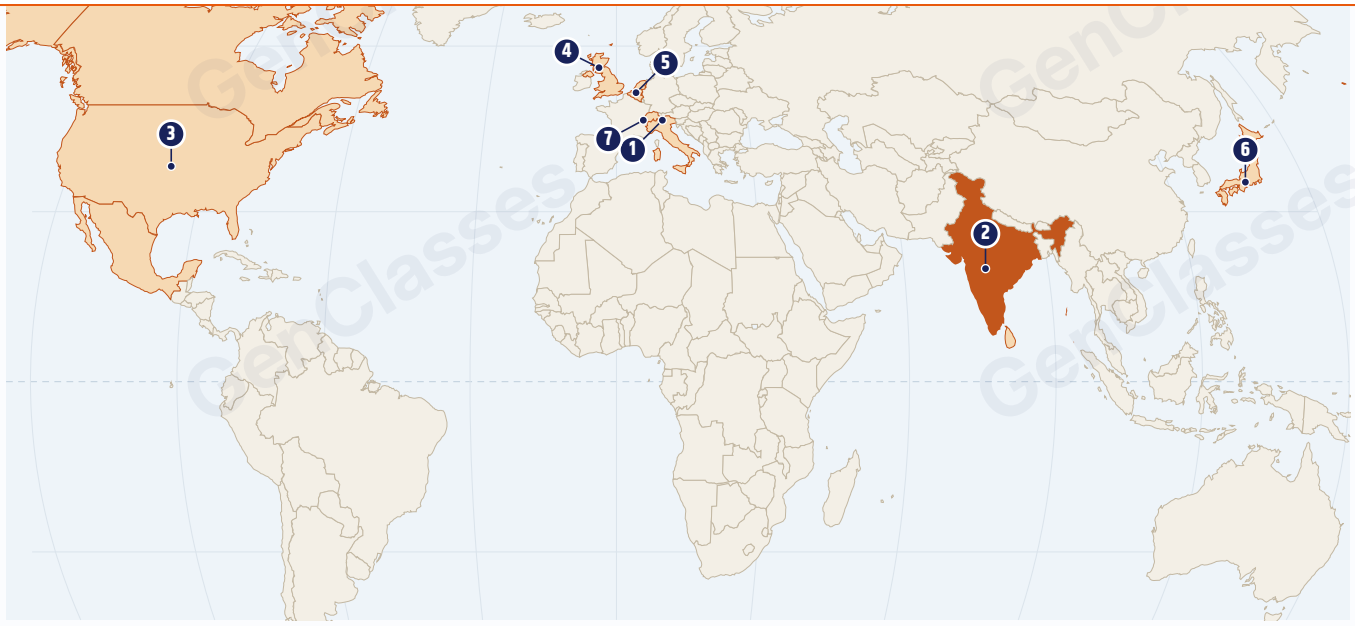
One Rule: Four Boxes in Every Sports Story

- **A** **Edition number** — 20th Asiad, 23rd Commonwealth
- **B** **Host city** — Aichi-Nagoya, Glasgow
- **C** **Winner and runner-up** — whom they beat in the final
- **D** **"First" in which sense** — India's, women's, of a sport

India fourth in both big Games — both times ahead on silver with equal golds.

10.1 Scoreboard of the Big Events 2026

Map **Where the Big Events Were Held**



1. Winter Olympics (25th) — **Milan-Cortina, 6-22 February:** Norway 18 golds · 2 athletes from India
2. Men's T20 World Cup — **India-Sri Lanka, 7 February-8 March:** India winner
3. FIFA World Cup (23rd) — **USA-Canada-Mexico, 11 June-19 July:** Spain
4. Commonwealth Games (23rd) — **Glasgow, 23 July-2 August:** Australia · India fourth
5. FIH Hockey World Cup — **Belgium (Wavre) and Netherlands (Amstelveen), 14-30 August:** Germany / Argentina · India 8th / 5th
6. Asian Games (20th) — **Aichi-Nagoya, 19 September-4 October:** China · India fourth
7. World Chess Championship — **Geneva, 24 November-12 December:** Gukesh vs Sindarov

10.2 Asian Games: Aichi-Nagoya (20th)

Chart **Medal Table (total medals; golds in brackets)**

China	341 (169)
Japan	269 (83)
South Korea	150 (39)
India	85 (21)
Uzbekistan	— (21; silver 25)

Both India and Uzbekistan have 21 golds — India has more silvers (27), so India is fourth

Timeline **India at the Asian Games**

- **1951 Delhi** — First Games · 51 medals, second
- **1982 Delhi** — 57 medals, 5th
- **2023 Hangzhou** — 107 — best ever
- **2026 Nagoya** — 85 (21-27-37), fourth

First Games 4-11 March 1951, 11 countries · 1982: 19 November-4 December, 33 countries, JLN Stadium built for it

Scale and Mascot

Japan's Third Time as Host

1. Tokyo 1958, Hiroshima 1994, now Aichi-Nagoya · 45 OCA countries · 43 sports · 469 events · medals to 40 countries · next **2030 Doha**
2. Mascot **"Honohon"** — based on "Shachihoko" (tiger head, fish body), guardian of Nagoya Castle; name from "honoho" (flame), also hints at a rice ear · slogan "Imagine One Asia"
3. **Six new disciplines**: Freestyle BMX · MMA · Padel · Surfing · Teqball · Virtual Taekwondo

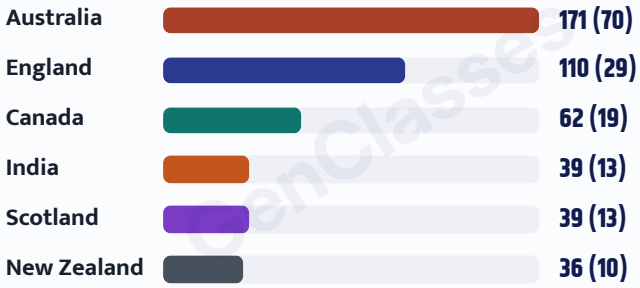
India

85 medals · fourth

1. **Second best** after Hangzhou 2023 (107) · 9 medals (5 golds) on the last day · most in athletics, 24
2. Golds: cricket (men-women), men's hockey (5-1 over Malaysia), kabaddi (men-women)
3. Flag-bearers **Manu Bhaker and Pawan Sehrawat** (Tajinderpal Singh Toor, chosen first, was replaced for lack of kit) · Neeraj Chopra out with an ankle injury

10.3 Commonwealth Games: Glasgow's "New Model" (23rd)

Chart **Medal Table (total; golds in brackets)**



India 13-17-9 · Scotland only 9 silvers — so India fourth · then Nigeria, Jamaica, Wales, Malaysia

Board **Sports: Included vs Dropped**

10 Retained

- Athletics/Para · Swimming/Para
- Artistic gymnastics · Track cycling/Para
- Netball · Weightlifting/Para powerlifting
- Boxing · Judo
- Bowls/Para · 3x3 basketball/Wheelchair

9 Dropped (from 2022)

- Badminton · **Hockey** · Squash
- **Cricket** · **Wrestling** · **Shooting**
- Table tennis · Diving · Rugby sevens

Board

Glasgow's 13 Gold Winners

Boxing (7)

- Sakshi Chaudhary 51 · **Preeti Pawar 54 (first gold)**
- Jaismine Lamboria 57 (5-0 over defending champion Michaela Walsh)
- Priya Ghanghas 60 · Arundhati Choudhary 70
- Sachin Siwach 60 M · Ankush Panghal 80 M
- Silver: Lovlina 75, Jadumani 55, Narender Berwal 90+ · top of the table

Para Athletics (3)

- **Sharmila Dhankhar** (F57 shot put 9.81 m) — first Indian woman para gold
- **Dilip Mahadu Gavit** (100 m T47, 10.71 s record) — first men's para gold
- **Soman Rana** (F57 shot put 13.40 m; former Gorkha havildar)

Judo (2 — firsts)

- **Asmita Dey** (48; over Heidi Quach in golden score)
- **Harsh Singh** (60; over Joshua Katz by waza-ari, 10-0)

Weightlifting (1)

- **Mirabai Chanu** · 48 kg · 85+105 = 190, all three records
- 2018, 2022, 2026 — first Indian weightlifter with three consecutive Commonwealth golds

Format and Opening

1. India's 19th participation · 10 sports, 215 events, ~3,000 athletes, 74 countries · all four venues in an 8-mile corridor · no public money
2. **OVO Hydro** — first indoor opening · King Charles III
3. Mascot **"Finnie"** — a unicorn (Scotland's national animal); name from the Finnieston Crane; horn a traffic cone (tradition of the Wellington statue)

India's Contingent

1. Contingent 126, 13 disciplines (athletics 32, boxing 14, judo 14, weightlifting 12, para athletics 11…) · fourth place earlier too in 2002, 2006, 2022 (61 medals)
2. Flag: opening **Mirabai Chanu** · closing **Jaismine Lamboria** · baton Lovlina Borgohain
3. **First medal: Jhandu Kumar** (Harnaut, Nalanda) — para powerlifting heavyweight bronze (190 kg, 130.9 points); polio in childhood, was a vegetable seller and e-rickshaw driver

! **Trap** Jhandu Kumar's medal is not India's first in this sport — Sudhir won gold in 2022.

Static

1. First Games **1930 Hamilton** (Canada), 11 countries · names: British Empire (1930-50) → Empire and Commonwealth (1954-66) → British Commonwealth (1970-74) → Commonwealth Games (since 1978)
2. India first in **1934 London** · first medal Rashid Anwar (wrestling bronze) · first gold **Milkha Singh** (1958 Cardiff, 440 yards) · best Delhi 2010: 101 medals (38 golds), second
3. Most successful Indians: Jaspal Rana 15 (9 golds), Samresh Jung 14 ("Goldfinger"), Sharath Kamal 13 · world: Chad le Clos 21 · **2030 Ahmedabad** (centenary edition; confirmed 26 November 2025) · Youth Games 2027 Malta

10.4 Cricket: Trophies and Winners

Board Trophies 2025-26

International (Men)

- **T20 World Cup**: India — beat NZ by 96 runs (255/5 vs 159), Ahmedabad, 8 March · titles 2007, 2024, 2026
- **Asia Cup 2025**: India — beat Pakistan by 5 wickets, Dubai
- **Under-19 World Cup**: India (record sixth) — beat England by 100 runs; captain Ayush Mhatre; POM (Player of the Match) Vaibhav

International (Women)

- **ODI World Cup 2025**: India (first) — beat South Africa by 52 runs, Navi Mumbai, 2 November · POM Shafali, POT Deepti · ₹37.3 crore
- **T20 World Cup**: Australia (record 7th) — beat England by 7 wickets, Lord's, 5 July
- **T20 Asia Cup**: India (record 8th) — over Sri Lanka, Dubai, 13 September

Leagues

- **IPL (19th)**: RCB for the second straight time — beat GT by 5 wickets, 31 May; captain Rajat Patidar
- **WPL**: RCB (second time)

Domestic

- **Ranji 2025-26**: Jammu & Kashmir (first time; over Karnataka; 10th different winner)
- **Vijay Hazare**: Vidarbha (first time; over Saurashtra)
- **Duleep**: East Zone (first-innings lead; POM Ishan Kishan)

T20 World Cup and IPL Numbers

1. 20 teams · Scotland in place of Bangladesh · POT **Sanju Samson** (321) · final POM **Bumrah** · most runs Sahibzada Farhan (Pak, 383) · most wickets Bumrah and Varun Chakravarthy (14)
2. IPL: final POM Kohli · Orange Cap **Vaibhav Suryavanshi** (776; 5 awards in all) · Purple Cap Rabada (29) · third team with back-to-back titles (after CSK, MI) · Bhuvneshwar the first Indian fast bowler with 200 IPL wickets

Records

1. **Vaibhav Suryavanshi** T20I debut at 15 years 99 days (Old Trafford) — broke Sachin's record (16 years 205 days)
2. **Rohit** the first Indian with an ODI hundred at Lord's (19 July; ~39 years) · Harmanpreet 356 women's internationals · Indian women's first Test win at Lord's
3. Brendan Taylor the longest ODI career (22 years 148 days+) · fastest T20I hundred Sahil Chauhan (Estonia, 27 balls)

Administration and Honours

1. Women's Champions Trophy 2027 moved from Sri Lanka to **India** (6 teams; Brabourne and Vadodara; 14-28 February 2027)
2. Cricket Canada suspended · India 5th in WTC 2025-27 · **Sourav Ganguly** the 12th Indian in the ICC Hall of Fame
3. Knighthood for James Anderson (704 wickets) · Williamson's T20I retirement · **T20 cricket at the LA 2028 Olympics** (earlier only Paris 1900) · Ritika Shree (Tamil Nadu) the first transgender cricket umpire

> ! **Trap** Men's T20 World Cup India, women's T20 World Cup Australia · Ranji for the first time J&K, Vijay Hazare for the first time Vidarbha.

10.5 Football and Hockey

FIFA World Cup 2026

Spain — second (first in 2010)

1. First **three-nation** hosting · first time **48 teams**, 104 matches, 12 groups
2. Final at MetLife Stadium: Spain beat **Argentina** 1-0 in extra time (Ferran Torres, 106th minute)
3. Golden Ball **Rodri** · Golden Boot **Mbappé** (10) · Golden Glove Unai Simón · Fair Play Netherlands
4. Theme "WE ARE 26" · mascots Maple (moose), Zayu (jaguar), Clutch (bald eagle) · smallest qualifier Curaçao · FIFA's first Peace Prize Trump · 2030 in 6 countries, 3 continents

Messi and Football in India

1. **Messi**: international retirement 31 August 2026 · 207 matches, 125 goals · last match the World Cup final · MLS Golden Boot 2025
2. **SAFF** (South Asian Football Federation) **Women**: India (3-1 over Bangladesh, Margao; after 7 years; record sixth) · SAFF U-17 2025 India (shootout 4-1)
3. **Santosh Trophy (79th)**: Services (8th time, 1-0 over Kerala) · **ISL 2025-26**: East Bengal for the first time (top of the league; 2-1 over Inter Kashi; 22-year drought)
4. U-17 team beat Iran 2-1 to qualify for the AFC U-17 Asian Cup

Hockey World Cup (Wavre and Amstelveen)

Men and women together for the first time

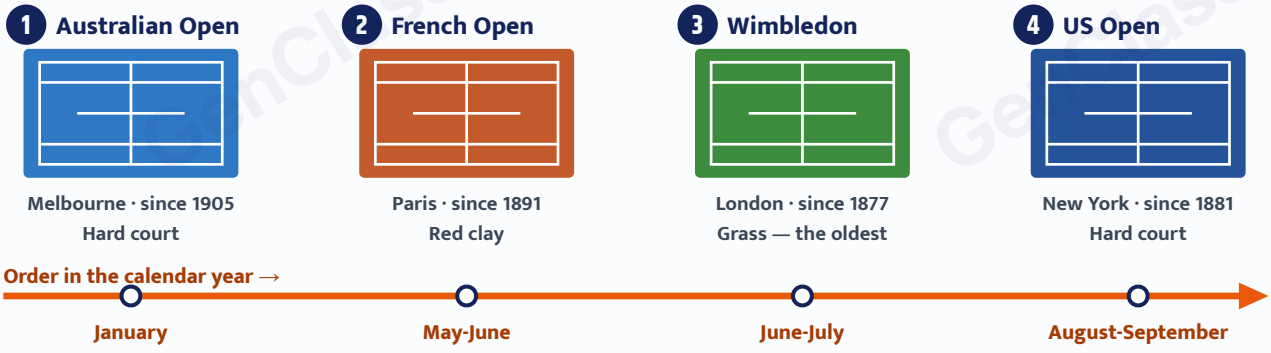
1. Men: **Germany** (1-0 over Spain; second in a row, fourth in all — equal with Pakistan) · bronze Argentina
2. Women: **Argentina** (3-1 shootout over the Netherlands; third) · bronze Belgium (first podium since 1978)
3. India: men 8th · women **5th** (3-1 over Germany, Navneet Kaur 2 goals; best since 1974)

Other Hockey News

1. Under-18 Asia Cup India (Kakamigahara, over Japan) · Junior Asia Cup (Moqi, China): men sixth, women third in a row
2. Asia Cup 2025 (Rajgir) India · Azlan Shah 2025 runner-up (0-1 to Belgium) · 42nd Surjit Hockey Indian Oil (third in a row)
3. Ball Hockey World Championship (Austria) Group B gold · 100 years of India-New Zealand sports ties (1926 army hockey tour)

10.6 Racket Sports: Tennis, Badminton, Table Tennis, Squash

Figure The Four Grand Slams: Which Comes First, Which Later



Know them by surface: **clay** only at the French Open, **grass** only at Wimbledon · oldest Wimbledon (1877), the newest to start the Australian Open (1905)

Table **Grand Slams 2026: Winners and Losing Finalists**

Category	1. Australian Open	2. French Open	3. Wimbledon	4. US Open
Men's Singles	**Carlos Alcaraz** beat Novak Djokovic **completed the career Grand Slam**	**Alexander Zverev** beat Flavio Cobolli **Zverev's first Slam**	**Jannik Sinner** beat Alexander Zverev **defended the title**	**Alexander Zverev** beat Ben Shelton **second Slam of the year**
Women's Singles	**Elena Rybakina** beat Aryna Sabalenka	**Mirra Andreeva** beat Maja Chwalińska **first Slam**	**Linda Nosková** beat Karolína Muchová **first Slam**	**Elena Rybakina** beat Aryna Sabalenka **second Slam of the year**
Men's Doubles	**Christian Harrison–Neal Skupski** beat Jason Kubler–Marc Polmans	**Marcel Granollers–Horacio Zeballos** beat Harri Heliövaara–Henry Patten	**Harri Heliövaara–Henry Patten** beat Marcelo Arévalo–Mate Pavić	**Christian Harrison–Neal Skupski** beat Kevin Krawietz–Tim Pütz
Women's Doubles	**Elise Mertens–Zhang Shuai** beat Anna Danilina–Aleksandra Krunić	**Kateřina Siniaková–Taylor Townsend** beat Anna Danilina–Aleksandra Krunić	**Guo Hanyu–Kristina Mladenovic** beat Gabriela Dabrowski–Luisa Stefani	**Kateřina Siniaková–Taylor Townsend** beat Ashlyn Krueger–Robin Montgomery
Mixed Doubles	**Olivia Gadecki–John Peers**	**Sara Errani–Andrea Vavassori** beat Gabriela Dabrowski–Evan King	**Marcelo Arévalo–Jeļena Ostapenko**	**Karolína Muchová–Jakub Menšík**

Zverev and Rybakina won two Slams each in 2026 · Harrison-Skupski won both hard-court Slams (AO, US) · US Open total prize money $108 million (singles $5.5 million) · ATP Finals 2025: Sinner

Badminton

1. **Thomas Cup** (Horsens, Denmark): China 12th; runner-up France; bronze India and Denmark · **Uber Cup**: South Korea (third), runner-up China
2. Lakshya Sen runner-up at the All England (to Lin Chun-yi) · **Singapore Open** (Super 750) Satwik-Chirag — first by an Indian pair
3. Taipei Open **Tanvi Sharma** (17 years 222 days; youngest; fourth Indian woman to win a Super 300+) · Japan Open P.V. Sindhu (over Yamaguchi)
4. **30th BWF World Championships** New Delhi (17-23 August; after Hyderabad 2009) · retirement of Saina Nehwal and Rohan Bopanna

Table Tennis and Squash

1. 22nd **Commonwealth Table Tennis**: Thyagaraj Stadium, Delhi (27 July-2 August; mascot "Mayur") — India both team golds (women 3-0 over Malaysia; men 3-2, decider Manush Shah) · singles Ankur Bhattacharjee and Yashaswini Ghorpade · all golds except men's doubles
2. India **Squash World Cup** winner for the first time (Chennai, 3-0 over Hong Kong)
3. **Anahat Singh** the first Indian to win the World Juniors (Canada) · Suraj Kumar Chand the first Indian title at FISU university squash (Mumbai)

10.7 Chess

World Championship

Geneva · 24 November-12 December

1. **Gukesh** vs **Javokhir Sindarov** (Uzbekistan) · 14 classical games
2. Sindarov won the **FIDE** (International Chess Federation) **World Cup 2025** (Goa, "Viswanathan Anand Cup"; over Wei Yi in tie-breaks) and the **Candidates 2026** (10 of 14)

Praggnanandhaa and Others

1. **Praggnanandhaa**: Norway Chess 2026 · Saint Louis Rapid-Blitz (23.5/36) · first Indian to win the **Grand Chess Tour** (15-13 over Caruana; $2 lakh)
2. Olympiad (Samarkand): open India silver, women bronze · Women's World Cup 2025 **Divya Deshmukh** the first Indian
3. Carlsen Esports World Cup (second in a row) and Freestyle champion · Jerusalem Masters 2025 Arjun Erigaisi (over Anand) · 62nd National P. Iniyan

Timeline **India's Grandmasters: Number 99**

87th	91st	94th	98th	99th
Aryan Varshney	Rahul V.S.	Mayank Chakraborty (first from the North-East)	Ashwath S.	V.S. Rathanvel

Youngest GM in history **Abhimanyu Mishra** (Indian origin, USA; 12 years 4 months 25 days) · India's youngest GM **D. Gukesh** · **Bodhana Sivanandan** (Indian origin, England) youngest WGM at 11 · "Messi of chess" Faustino Oro (IM at 12) · Anav Saxena (Karnataka) IM

10.8 Shooting, Wrestling-Boxing and Fencing

Shooting

1. ISSF Junior World Cup (Cairo) India top, 16 medals (5 golds)
2. **Neeru Dhanda** trap gold (Lonato) — first Indian woman · Esha Singh 25 m pistol gold (Hangzhou)
3. Samrat Rana World Championship (Cairo) 10 m air pistol gold · Avani Lekhara Al Ain Para World Cup gold (10 m SH1)

Archery

1. **Dhiraj Bommadevara** World Cup Final (Saltillo) recurve gold — first Indian man
2. Jyothi Surekha Vennam (Nanjing) bronze — first Indian woman medal at the Final · Asian Championship (Dhaka) 10 medals
3. World Archery Para Series (Sabarmati Riverfront, first in India): **Sheetal Devi** gold, Sarita bronze · Sheetal world para champion (no arms, shoots with her feet)

Wrestling, Boxing, Weightlifting

1. Asian Wrestling (Bishkek) India second, 17 medals (golds Sujeet Kalkal, Abhimanyu Mandwal)
2. **Minakshi Hooda** World Boxing Cup Final (Greater Noida) 48 kg gold · Sangram Singh beat a Pakistani in MMA
3. N. Tomchou Meetei Asian Junior (Tashkent) 60 kg gold (266; silver Guru Naidu 265)

Commonwealth Fencing (Lagos)

First African host

1. India top, **35 medals (13 golds)** · first time **"Wilkinson Sword Trophy"** (since 1982)
2. All three medals in women's épée (**Taniksha Khatri** gold 15-7, Khushi Dabhade, Prachi Lohan) — Taniksha's the first Indian senior gold in épée · 5 team golds

10.9 Athletics, Para and New Events

First Khelo India Tribal Games

25 March-3 April

Chhattisgarh (Raipur, Jagdalpur, Surguja)

1. ~3,800 athletes · mascot **"Mor Veer"**
2. **Karnataka 23 golds (38)** first · Odisha 21 (57) · Jharkhand 16 (35) · then Maharashtra, Arunachal
3. Best swimmers Manikant L. (8 golds) and Manjpati Munda (5)

> **Trap** Odisha has more total medals (57), but Karnataka is first on golds.

First World Yogasana Championship

4-8 June

EKA Arena, Ahmedabad

1. Opened by the PM · 79 countries, 522 athletes
2. India **114 (102 golds)** · Nepal 52 · Japan 11 · Singapore 7

New National Records

1. **Sawan Barwal** (Himachal) Rotterdam Marathon 2:11:58 — Shivnath Singh's (1978) 48-year-old record
2. **Anju Sojan** long jump 6.88 m (Anju Bobby George 6.83, 2004) · **Sarvesh Kushare** high jump 2.31 m (Tejaswin 2.29)
3. Asian Relays women's 4×100 gold · first National Indoor Athletics (Kalinga) · Sabita Mahato (Saran) the first Indian woman to do the 265 km Leh-Mig La ultra run

Para

1. World Para Athletics Grand Prix (JLN Delhi): India **208 medals (75 golds)**, Russia 35, Bosnia-Herzegovina
2. **Payal Nag** (Odisha, 18) Bangkok gold — first quadruple amputee · Hokato Hotozhe Sema (Nagaland) world no. 1 in F-57 shot put · Deaflympics 2025 (Tokyo) 111-member contingent

"Firsts" in Other Sports

1. Vrish and Ujjwal Kumar India's first gold at World Rowing Cup III (Lucerne) · Ariha Pangambam (Manipur) Asian Aerobic Gymnastics senior gold
2. Asian Youth Games 2025 (Manama) record 48 medals · **Omegaball** (a three-team game) started by IIT Madras
3. Swati Manchiyana (100 years) · 5-year doping ban on Manju Bala (hammer) · Neeraj Chopra: Tokyo 2021 gold 87.58 m, Paris 2024 silver 89.45 m (Arshad Nadeem 92.97 m)

Upcoming Hosting and World Sport

1. World Indoor Athletics 2028 **Bhubaneswar** (2026 Toruń, Poland) · UCI Road World Championships 2032 **Pune** · National Games: 38th Uttarakhand (2025), 39th Meghalaya (2027)
2. Winter Olympics: theme "Armonia", mascots Tina and Milo · table Norway 18 (41), USA 12 (33), Netherlands 10, Italy 10 (30, its best) · IOC (International Olympic Committee) conditionally lifted Belarus's suspension, continues on Russia
3. Tour de France (113th, Barcelona to Paris) **Pogačar** — fifth and third in a row · **Kami Rita Sherpa** Everest for the 32nd time · Lhakpa Sherpa 11th (most among women) · "The Don Award" to Oscar Piastri

Points to Note

1. At the Asiad India ahead of Uzbekistan, at the Commonwealth ahead of Scotland, on the strength of silvers
2. Glasgow had no hockey, cricket, wrestling, shooting or badminton
3. Glasgow's first Indian medal Jhandu Kumar (para powerlifting bronze)
4. Mirabai: 2018, 2022, 2026 — three consecutive Commonwealth golds (first Indian weightlifter; in wrestling Vinesh Phogat had already won in 2014, 2018, 2022)
5. T20 World Cup titles: 2007, 2024, 2026 · women's T20 World Cup is Australia's
6. Ranji for the first time J&K · Vijay Hazare for the first time Vidarbha
7. FIFA 2026: Spain beat Argentina · Golden Ball Rodri, Boot Mbappé
8. Hockey World Cup: men Germany, women Argentina · India women 5th
9. Sindarov won the FIDE World Cup 2025 in Goa
10. In the Tribal Games Karnataka first on golds, Odisha ahead on total medals
11. Commonwealth 2030 Ahmedabad · Asiad 2030 Doha

11 Honours 2025-26: Awards, Appointments and People in the News

At a Glance

1. Peace Nobel 2026 **Navi Pillay** (South Africa; Indian-Tamil origin) — first South African woman
2. Padma 2026: **131** · Khel Ratna 2025 to no one (third time) · no Bharat Ratna after 2024
3. Jnanpith (60th) **R. Vairamuthu** · Phalke (2024) **Anant Nag** · Vigyan Ratna **Jayant Narlikar** (posthumous)
4. Ashoka Chakra to **Shubhanshu Shukla** · **Smriti Mandhana** BBC Indian Sportswoman 2025
5. **Annapurni Subramaniam**: first Indian woman to get the COSPAR (Committee on Space Research) Vikram Sarabhai Medal

One Rule: Four Boxes for Every Award

- **A** **Who gives it?** Body and country (Magsaysay — Philippines, Sakharov — European Parliament)
- **B** **In which field?** Literature, science, peace, sports
- **C** **For which year?** "Award year" and "announcement year" differ (Phalke 2024 announced in 2026)
- **D** **Which edition?** 60th Jnanpith, 35th Saraswati, 98th Oscars

The examiner mostly builds a wrong option by changing the year or the awarding body.

Awards Chart 2025-26: At a Glance

Award	Given by / Field	Winner	Key Point
National Honours			
Bharat Ratna	Government of India (since 1954)	No new announcement	Last 2024: Karpoori Thakur, Advani, Narasimha Rao, Charan Singh, Swaminathan
Padma Awards 2026	Home Ministry	Total **131**: 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, 113 Shri	Vibhushan: Dharmendra (p.), K.T. Thomas, N. Rajam, P. Narayanan, V.S. Achuthanandan (p.)
Ashoka Chakra 2026	Highest peacetime gallantry award	**Shubhanshu Shukla**	Independence Day 2026 · 78 gallantry awards in all

Award	Given by / Field	Winner	Key Point
Gandhi Peace Prize	Culture Ministry (since 1995)	No new announcement	Last announced (2021): Gita Press, Gorakhpur · ₹1 crore
Indira Gandhi Peace Prize 2025	Indira Gandhi Memorial Trust (since 1986)	**Graça Machel** (Mozambique)	Announced 21 January 2026
Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025	Government of India	Vigyan Ratna: **Jayant Narlikar** (p.)	8 Vigyan Shri, 14 Vigyan Yuva · Team: CSIR (Council of Scientific and Industrial Research) Aroma Mission
National Sports Awards 2025	Sports Ministry	Khel Ratna **to no one** · 17 Arjuna	Third time without a Khel Ratna, after 2008 and 2014
Dadasaheb Phalke (56th, 2024)	I&B Ministry (since 1969)	**Anant Nag**	Ceremony 22 September 2026, Ekta Nagar — first time outside the capital
72nd National Film Awards	I&B Ministry	Film **"Article 370"**	Actors Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan · actress Yami Gautam
PM Rashtriya Bal Puraskar 2025	Women and Child Development Ministry	**20 children** (18 states/UTs)	26 December 2025 (Veer Bal Diwas) · Vaibhav Suryavanshi too
National Teachers' Awards 2026	Education Ministry	48 school + 21 higher education teachers	UP: Renu Tripathi, Iftikhar Khan, Shalini Kushwaha
COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal	ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) + COSPAR	**Annapurni Subramaniam**	First Indian woman to get it
Literature			
Jnanpith (60th, 2025)	Bharatiya Jnanpith (since 1965)	**R. Vairamuthu** (Tamil)	Third Tamil writer · 59th: Vinod Kumar Shukla (Hindi)
Saraswati Samman (35th, 2025)	K.K. Birla Foundation (since 1991)	**Ramkumar Mukhopadhyay**	"Har Parvati Katha" (Bangla) · ₹15 lakh
Vyas Samman (34th, 2024)	K.K. Birla Foundation	**Suryabala**	"Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary" (Hindi)
Sahitya Akademi 2025	Sahitya Akademi (since 1954)	Hindi: **Mamta Kalia** · English: **Navtej Sarna**	24 languages · announced 16 March 2026
Sarala Award (47th)	Odia literature	**Ashutosh Parida**	"Biswasa De Pruthibi"
Nobel Literature 2026	Swedish Academy	**Anne Carson** (Canada)	2025: László Krasznahorkai (Hungary)
Booker 2025	UK	**David Szalay** — "Flesh"	Booker 2026 announced 9 November
International Booker 2026	UK	**Yang Shuang-zi** — "Taiwan Travelogue"	First from Mandarin · 2025: Banu Mushtaq (Kannada)
Pulitzer (Fiction) 2026	Columbia University, USA	**Daniel Kraus** — "Angel Down"	Announced 4 May 2026
Women's Prize for Fiction 2026	UK	**Virginia Evans** — "The Correspondent"	Debut novel
Cinema and Music			
Oscars (98th)	US Film Academy	**"One Battle After Another"**	Director Paul Thomas Anderson · actress Jessie Buckley ("Hamnet")
BAFTA (79th)	UK	**"One Battle After Another"**	Actor Robert Aramayo · actress Jessie Buckley
Golden Globes 2026	USA	Drama **"Hamnet"** · comedy "One Battle After Another"	Horizon Award to Alia Bhatt (Red Sea)
Grammys (68th)	USA	Album of the Year: **Bad Bunny**	First Spanish-language album
Cannes 2026 — Palme d'Or	France	**"Fjord"** (Cristian Mungiu)	Romania
Berlin 2026 — Golden Bear	Germany	**"Yellow Letters"** (İlker Çatak)	Jury president Wim Wenders
Venice (83rd) — Golden Lion	Italy	**"Woman Unknown"**	Anuparna Roy best director at the 82nd

Award	Given by / Field	Winner	Key Point
IFFI (56th) — Golden Peacock	Goa	**"Skin of Youth"**	Silver Peacock: Santosh Davakhar ("Gondhal")
Sports			
Ballon d'Or 2026	France Football	**Harry Kane** · women: **Alexia Putellas**	26 October, London — first time outside Paris · Putellas for the third time · Kopa: Lamine Yamal
Ballon d'Or 2025	France Football	Ousmane Dembélé · Aitana Bonmatí	Bonmatí for the third straight time
FIFA (Fédération Internationale de Football Association) **The Best 2025**	FIFA	Dembélé · Bonmatí	16 December 2025, Doha
Laureus 2026	Laureus (Madrid)	Alcaraz · Sabalenka	Lifetime: Nadia Comăneci
BBC Indian Sportswoman 2025	BBC	**Smriti Mandhana**	Para: Preethi Pal · Lifetime: Anjali Bhagwat
Science, Mathematics and Architecture			
Nobel Medicine 2026	Karolinska Institute	Deisseroth, Hegemann, Nagel	Optogenetics
Nobel Physics 2026	Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences	**Francis Halzen**	Neutrinos, Antarctica's IceCube
Nobel Chemistry 2026	Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences	Henri Kagan, Kenso Soai	Chirality, asymmetric synthesis
Nobel Economics 2026	Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences	Robert E. Hall, Michael Woodford	Microfoundations of stabilisation
Abel 2026	Norway	**Gerd Faltings** (Germany)	"Nobel of mathematics"
Fields Medal 2026	IMU (every 4 years)	Hong Wang, Yu Deng, John Pardon, Jacob Tsimerman	Under 40 · Hong Wang the third woman
Turing 2025	ACM	Charles Bennett, Gilles Brassard	Quantum cryptography
Pritzker 2026	Architecture	**Smiljan Radić** (Chile)	55th laureate
Templeton 2026	Templeton Foundation	Simon Conway Morris	Palaeontologist (Cambridge)
Peace, Society and the World			
Nobel Peace 2026	Norwegian Nobel Committee	**Navi Pillay** (South Africa)	First South African woman · 2025: María Corina Machado
Sakharov 2026	European Parliament	**International Criminal Court (ICC)** and its judges	Announced 22 October · 2025: Poczobut, Amaglobeli
Ramon Magsaysay 2025	Philippines	**"Educate Girls"** (India), Shaahina Ali (Maldives), Flaviano Villanueva (Philippines)	**First Indian organisation** to get it · 2026: Tommy Koh, Bo Kyi, Runa Khan
Right Livelihood 2026	Sweden ("Alternative Nobel")	Jalila Haider, Timnit Gebru, GYLA and others	Timnit Gebru — AI ethics
World Food Prize 2026	USA	**Huub Lelieveld** (Netherlands)	First for food safety · $5 lakh
Global Teacher Prize	Varkey Foundation	**Rouble Nagi**	$10 lakh
Environment			
UNEP (United Nations Environment Programme) **Champions of the Earth**	UNEP	**Supriya Sahu** (IAS, Tamil Nadu)	
Stockholm Water Prize	SIWI	Kaveh Madani (Iran)	Youngest · "water bankruptcy"
Goldman Environmental Prize 2026	USA	Six winners — all women	A first
Whitley Award ("Green Oscar")	UK	Parveen Shaikh, Barkha Subba	Indian skimmer · Himalayan salamander

Award	Given by / Field	Winner	Key Point
IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature) **Kenton Miller**	IUCN	**Sonali Ghosh** (Kaziranga)	First Indian

Map **The World's Major Awards: Awarding Body and Place**



1. **Stockholm** — Nobel (except Peace), Right Livelihood, Stockholm Water Prize
2. **Oslo** — Nobel Peace, Abel (Norwegian Academy of Science)
3. **Manila** — Ramon Magsaysay ("Nobel of Asia")
4. **Strasbourg** — Sakharov (European Parliament)
5. **Des Moines (Iowa)** — World Food Prize
6. **Chicago** — Pritzker (architecture)
7. **London** — Booker, BAFTA
8. **Trieste** — ICTP (International Centre for Theoretical Physics)'s Dirac Medal
9. **Nairobi** — UNEP "Champions of the Earth"
10. **Los Angeles** — Oscars, Grammys
11. **Cannes** — Palme d'Or · Berlin — Golden Bear · Venice — Golden Lion

11.1 Nobel Prizes: 2026 and 2025 (2026 announcements 5-12 October)

Comparison **Nobel 2026 vs 2025**

Medicine

2026 Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann, Georg Nagel — **optogenetics** (controlling brain cells with light)

2025 Brunkow, Ramsdell, Sakaguchi — peripheral immune tolerance

Physics

2026 **Francis Halzen** — neutrinos, Antarctica's **IceCube**

2025 Clarke, Devoret, Martinis — macroscopic quantum tunnelling in a circuit

Chemistry

2026 Henri Kagan, Kenso Soai — **chirality**, asymmetric synthesis

2025 Kitagawa, Robson, Yaghi — MOFs

Literature

2026 **Anne Carson** (Canadian poet) — "bold and innovative"

2025 László Krasznahorkai (Hungary) — "Satantango"

Peace

2026 **Navi Pillay** — South African jurist, former UN High Commissioner for Human Rights (2008-14); 85 years; announced 9 October

2025 María Corina Machado (Venezuela)

Economics

2026 **Robert E. Hall** (Stanford), **Michael Woodford** (Columbia) — microfoundations of stabilisation

2025 Mokyr, Aghion, Howitt — innovation-driven growth

Ceremony 10 December (Nobel's death anniversary): Peace in Oslo, the rest in Stockholm · prize 1.2 crore Swedish kronor · Peace Nobel to WFP (World Food Programme) in 2020

36th Ig Nobel (Zurich, 3 September)

"First make people laugh, then make them think"

1. Indians **Sanchari Banerjee and Subramaniam Ramaswamy** in Chemistry (inStem Bengaluru; cockroach milk protein crystals)
2. Technology: 3D printing with mosquito proboscis "necroprinting" · Medicine: Tokuji Unno (posthumous, "how to blow your nose", 1977)
3. Soil: "Soil Your Undies" · Physics: urinal splashback · Biomechanics: animal kissing

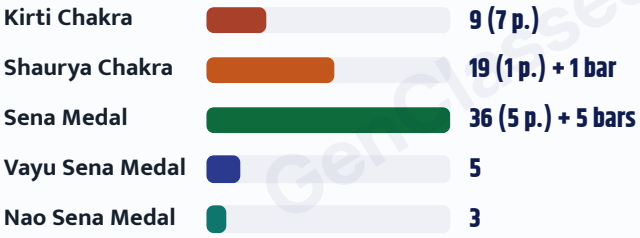
11.2 National Honours: Civilian, Gallantry and Science

Chart **Padma Awards 2026 (total 131)**



19 women · 6 foreigners/NRIs · 16 posthumous · investitures 25 May (66) and 23 June

Chart **Gallantry Awards — Independence Day 2026 (total 78; 13 posthumous)**



Ashoka Chakra: Shubhanshu Shukla — first Indian to go to the ISS (International Space Station); second in space after Rakesh Sharma

Padma Vibhushan 2026

1. **Dharmendra** (p.) · Justice **K.T. Thomas** · **N. Rajam** (violin)
2. P. Narayanan · **V.S. Achuthanandan** (p.)

Padma Bhushan 2026

1. Alka Yagnik · Bhagat Singh Koshyari · K.R. Palaniswamy · **Mammootty** · Nori Dattatreyudu · **Piyush Pandey** (p.)
2. S.K.M. Maeilanandhan · Shatavadhani R. Ganesh · **Shibu Soren** (p.) · **Uday Kotak** · V.K. Malhotra (p.) · Vellappally Natesan · **Vijay Amritraj**
3. Padma Shri in the news: Rohit Sharma · Harmanpreet Kaur · Savita Punia · R. Madhavan

Bharat Ratna and Gandhi Peace Prize

No new announcement in 2025-26

1. **Bharat Ratna**: last announced 2024 — Karpoori Thakur, L.K. Advani, P.V. Narasimha Rao, Chaudhary Charan Singh, M.S. Swaminathan · started in 1954
2. **Gandhi Peace Prize**: last announced year 2021 — Gita Press, Gorakhpur · started by the Government of India in 1995 (Gandhi's 125th birth anniversary) · ₹1 crore

! **Trap** The Indira Gandhi Peace Prize (the Trust's) and the Gandhi Peace Prize (the government's) are different.

Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025

Announced 26 October 2025

1. **Vigyan Ratna**: Prof. **Jayant Vishnu Narlikar** (posthumous; astrophysics)
2. **Vigyan Shri**: 8 scientists · **Vigyan Yuva-Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar**: 14 young scientists
3. **Vigyan Team**: CSIR's **Aroma Mission** (agricultural science) · nominations for 2026 closed in May

Four categories — Ratna, Shri, Yuva, Team; the Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar award is now merged into "Vigyan Yuva".

Static

1. Bharat Ratna and Padma — both started in **1954** · then the Padma Vibhushan alone had three classes; the names Vibhushan, Bhushan, Shri came with the notification of **8 January 1955**

11.3 Sports Honours

Board **National Sports Awards 2025 (announced 18 August 2026) — 17 Arjuna, Sport-wise**

Athletics · Badminton
- Tejaswin Shankar, Muhammed Ajmal, Priyanka Goswami
- Treesa Jolly, Gayatri Gopichand

Chess · Hockey · Kabaddi
- Vidit Gujrathi, Divya Deshmukh
- Lalremsiami, Rajkumar Pal (UP)
- Surjeet, Pooja

Shooting
- Akhil Sheoran
- Dhanush Srikanth (deaf)
- Rudransh Khandelwal (para)

Others
- Narender (boxing)
- Ekta Bhyan (para athletics)
- Arvind Singh (rowing)

Khel Ratna to no one (none in 2008, 2014 either; four in 2024) · committee chair Justice (retd.) Arun Kumar Mishra · Arjuna Lifetime I. Arumainayagam (1962 Asiad gold football team) · Dronacharya Parveer Singh, Chhote Lal Yadav, Neha Chavan; lifetime Dharmendra Singh Yadav, Virendra Kumar · Khel Protsahan Army Paralympic Node (Pune) · MAKA Trophy to the best university

Sports Awards: Years They Began

1. Arjuna **1961** · Dronacharya **1985** (first Bhalchandra Bhaskar Bhagwat, O.P. Bhardwaj, O.M. Nambiar)
2. Khel Ratna **1991-92** (named after Dhyan Chand from 6 August 2021) · Dhyan Chand Lifetime 2002 · Khel Protsahan 2009
3. Tenzing Norgay Adventure 2024: Baljeet Kaur, Skalzang Rigzin, Rimo Saha; lifetime Shiv Prasad Chamoli

Football Honours

1. **Ballon d'Or 2025** (Paris, 22 September 2025): **Ousmane Dembélé** · women **Aitana Bonmatí** (third in a row — the first to do so)
2. Kopa Trophy Lamine Yamal (first to win twice) · Yashin Donnarumma · women's Yashin Hannah Hampton (first time)
3. **FIFA The Best 2025** (Doha, 16 December): Dembélé, Bonmatí · coaches Luis Enrique, Sarina Wiegman · Puskás Santiago Montiel

Other National-International Sports Honours

1. **BBC Indian Sportswoman 2025** (16 February 2026): **Smriti Mandhana** · Para: Preethi Pal · Lifetime: Anjali Bhagwat
2. **Laureus** (Madrid): Alcaraz, Sabalenka, team PSG, breakthrough Lando Norris, young Lamine Yamal, lifetime Nadia Comăneci
3. **Wisden** (163rd): leading Starc and Deepti Sharma, T20 Abhishek Sharma · **Princess of Asturias** Messi (first individual footballer)
4. Hockey India: lifetime Zafar Iqbal; players Hardik Singh, Navneet Kaur · first Indian Athletics Awards: Neeraj Chopra, Parul Chaudhary · Sheetal Devi — World Archery's best para archer 2025

11.4 Cinema, Music and TV

Timeline **Dadasaheb Phalke: Recent Winners**

- **1969** — Devika Rani (first)
- **2022** — Mithun Chakraborty
- **2023** — Mohanlal
- **2024 (56th)** — **Anant Nag**

Ceremony **22 September 2026, Ekta Nagar (Gujarat)** — first time outside the capital (the 17th in 1970 was in Madras)

72nd National Film Awards (films of 2024)

Announced 18 July 2026

1. Feature **"Article 370"** (Aditya Jambhale) · director Rajkumar Periasamy ("Amaran")
2. Actors **Mammootty** ("Bramayugam") and **Kartik Aaryan** ("Chandu Champion") · actress **Yami Gautam**
3. Popular "Kalki 2898 AD" · social values "Captain Miller" · debut director Randeep Hooda · children's film "35: Chinna Katha Kaadu" · Santali "Angen" (Ravi Raj Murmu)
4. 3 awards each: "Amaran", "Article 370", "Mithya" (Kannada)

98th Oscars

1. Film **"One Battle After Another"** (6 awards) · director Paul Thomas Anderson
2. Actor Michael B. Jordan ("Sinners") · actress Jessie Buckley ("Hamnet") · international "Sentimental Value" (Norway)
3. Cinematography Autumn Durald Arkapaw (first woman) · new category "Best Casting", 24 in all
4. India's entry "Homebound"; for the 99th the Marathi "Gondhal"

Festivals

1. **Cannes 2026** (79th): Palme d'Or **"Fjord"** (Cristian Mungiu, Romania) · jury president Park Chan-wook
2. **Berlin 2026** (76th): Golden Bear **"Yellow Letters"** (İlker Çatak) · jury president Wim Wenders
3. **Venice** 83rd Golden Lion "Woman Unknown" (May el-Toukhy) · at the 82nd **Anuparna Roy** best director ("Songs of Forgotten Trees")
4. 56th **IFFI** Golden Peacock "Skin of Youth", Silver Peacock Santosh Davakhar ("Gondhal") · "Boong" (Manipuri, Lakshmipriya Devi) at the 79th BAFTA · "CHYIMI" (Assamese animation) NYSAF best director

Globes, Grammys, Emmys

1. **Golden Globes 2026** (11 January): drama "Hamnet" · musical/comedy "One Battle After Another"
2. **Grammys 2026** (68th, 1 February): Album of the Year **Bad Bunny** — first Spanish-language album · record "Luther" (Kendrick Lamar-SZA) · song "Wildflower" (Billie Eilish) · new artist Olivia Dean
3. **78th Emmys**: drama "The Pitt" · comedy "Widow's Bay" · Noah Wyle, Rhea Seehorn, Matthew Rhys, Jean Smart, Allison Janney
4. Individual: Alia Bhatt Golden Globe Horizon (Red Sea) · Ilaiyaraaja Padmapani · Shantanu Moitra Lata Mangeshkar Award (MP) · Amol Palekar META Lifetime

11.5 Literature

Board **Literary Honours — Indian Languages**

Jnanpith

- **60th (2025): R. Vairamuthu** — third Tamil after Akilan, Jayakanthan
- 59th: **Vinod Kumar Shukla** (Hindi)

K.K. Birla Foundation

- **35th Saraswati**: Ramkumar Mukhopadhyay — "Har Parvati Katha" (Bangla) · ₹15 lakh
- **34th Vyas** (2024): Suryabala — "Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary" · ₹4 lakh

Sahitya Akademi 2025

- Hindi: **Mamta Kalia** — "Jeete Jee Allahabad" (memoir)
- English: **Navtej Sarna** — "Crimson Spring"
- Urdu Prithvipal Singh Betab · Maithili Mahendra Malangia · Rajasthani Jitendra Kumar Soni
- 24 works · announced 16 March, ceremony 31 March

Sarala (Odia)

- **47th**: Dr. Ashutosh Parida — "Biswasa De Pruthibi" · ₹7 lakh
- Announced 20 August, ceremony 25 October Bhubaneswar

Sahitya Akademi 2025's 24 works: 8 poetry, 6 short stories, 4 novels, 2 essays, 2 memoirs, 1 criticism, 1 autobiography · JCB Prize for Literature closed after 2024 (Upamanyu Chatterjee)

Booker Prizes

1. **International Booker 2026**: Yang Shuang-zi (Taiwan) — "Taiwan Travelogue"; translated by Lin King; **first from Mandarin**
2. International Booker 2025: **Banu Mushtaq** — "Heart Lamp" (Kannada; translated by Deepa Bhasthi)
3. **Booker 2025**: David Szalay — "Flesh" (first British-Hungarian) · **Booker 2026** announced 9 November — shortlist: M. John Harrison, Marlon James, Luke Kennard, Rebecca Perry, Elizabeth Strout, Douglas Stuart
4. Changes: "Buchmann International Booker" from 2027 · prize from £50,000 to £100,000 · International Booker biennial in 2005, annual from 2016 · split equally between author and translator

! **Trap** International Booker: 2025 Kannada, 2026 Mandarin · the plain Booker only for works originally in English.

Other Literary Honours

1. **Pulitzer** fiction "Angel Down" · illustrated reporting Bloomberg's "trAPPed" (Anand R.K., Suparna Sharma)
2. Geetanjali Shree — PEN Translation 2025 · William Dalrymple — Mark Lynton History Prize ("The Golden Road")
3. 7 honours to the Publications Division (1941) at FIP: second "India 2026", "Wings to Our Hopes Vol 2", "Yojana", "Kurukshetra"; third "Dharti Ki Sehat", "Rangoli Roop Sur Lay Ki", "Ajkal" (Urdu)

11.6 Honours from Abroad

Timeline **Foreign Honours Received by PM Modi**

28th	29th	31st	32nd	Others
Ethiopia "Great Honour Nishan"	Oman "Order of Oman First Class"	Sweden "Royal Order of the Polar Star"	Norway "Grand Cross ... Order of Merit"	Indonesia "Bintang Adipurna" · Seychelles · FAO "Agricola" · Uzbekistan "Oliy Darajali Do'stlik"

First foreign leader to get Ethiopia's honour · Seychelles: "Guardian of the Blue Horizon" · Uzbekistan (30 August): trade $5 billion by 2030, uranium framework

To Other Indians

1. **Payal Kapadia** — France's "Order of Arts and Letters" · **N. Chandrasekaran** — honorary KBE
2. Rituparna Sengupta — House of Commons "Women's Empowerment Award" · **Gurcharan Das** — "Lifetime Libertarian Award" (Kathmandu; first Indian writer)
3. Pakistan's **Nishan-e-Imtiaz** posthumously to two Parsi doctors of Mumbai (Dr. Jal Ratanji Patel and a radiologist colleague) — they kept Jinnah's 1946 TB report secret (confirmed by Ahsan Iqbal)

To Foreigners

1. **Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development 2025**: **Graça Machel** (Mozambique) — announced 21 January 2026 (Indira Gandhi Memorial Trust, since 1986)
2. South Korea's "Grand Order of Mugunghwa" — Trump

11.7 Science, Education and Social Service

Dirac Medal (ICTP, since 1985)

Announced 8 August (Dirac's birth anniv

1. **Deepak Dhar** (ICTS-TIFR) with Bernard Derrida, Marc Mézard, Haim Sompolinsky — from statistical mechanics to AI
2. Dhar in 2022 the first Indian to get the Boltzmann Medal (Abelian sandpile) · Ashoke Sen Dirac 2014

COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal

3 August, Florence

1. **Annapurni Subramaniam** (Director IIA (Indian Institute of Astrophysics)) — first Indian woman, fourth Indian overall
2. Earlier: U.R. Rao 1996, G.S. Lakhina 2014, Anil Bhardwaj 2024 · led AstroSat's UVIT · biennial (ISRO + COSPAR)

Big Prizes in Mathematics and Physics

1. **Fields Medal 2026**: Hong Wang (third woman), Yu Deng, John Pardon, Jacob Tsimerman (under 40; every 4 years)
2. **Abel 2026**: Gerd Faltings (Germany) · **Turing 2025**: Charles Bennett and Gilles Brassard (quantum cryptography)
3. SASTRA Ramanujan: Dr. Sarah Peluse (age 32 or below) · Wolf Physics: Immanuel Bloch and Jun Ye (ultracold atoms) · Crafoord: Veerabhadran Ramanathan

Infosys Prize 2025

1. Nikhil Agarwal (economics) · Sushant Sachdeva (engineering) · Andrew Ollett (humanities)
2. Anjana Badrinarayanan (life sciences) · Sabyasachi Mukherjee (mathematics) · Karthish Manthiram (physical sciences)
3. AIAA Goddard Astronautics Award to the Chandrayaan-3 team (21 May)

Teacher Honours

1. National Teachers' Awards: 48 school (26 men, 22 women) + 21 higher education · from UP **Renu Tripathi, Iftikhar Khan, Shalini Kushwaha**
2. Uttarakhand Gabar Singh · Bihar Khushboo Kumari, Pushpa Prasad · Rajasthan Divyendu Sen, Vartika Gulati · MP Archana Shukla, Shailendra Pratap Singh
3. **Global Teacher Prize** ($10 lakh) Rouble Nagi · Cambridge Dedicated Teacher Soma Mandal · T4 Education World's Best Schools: India the most, 7 schools

Magsaysay, Sansad Ratna and Others

1. **Ramon Magsaysay 2026**: Tommy Koh (Singapore), Bo Kyi (Myanmar), Runa Khan (Bangladesh) · trust 1957, first award 1958 · first Indian Vinoba Bhave
2. **Sansad Ratna** (16th; since 2010; Prime Point Foundation, Chennai; Kalam's idea): 10 Lok Sabha + 2 Rajya Sabha MPs + 4 committees · Kalam Jan Seva Award Kishor Makwana (NCSC chair)
3. Lokmanya Tilak Award **Ajit Doval** · Kalinga Ratna Dipak Misra · Bihar Shiksha Ratna Acharya Rakesh Jha · Soumya Swaminathan FRS (father also FRS)

Other Honours

1. **Rajbhasha Kirti** (sixth conference, Vashi): large ministries Defence · small Department of Financial Services · regulator IRDAI · large banks Central Bank, small Indian Overseas Bank · magazine PNB "Pratibha" ('A'), Union Bank "Srijan" ('B')
2. Kalpana Soren — BRICS CCI WE "Women Empowerment Trailblazer" · Stuti Pradhan (Sikkim) Viksit Bharat Youth Parliament winner · Plas-Stick (microplastic filter from shrimp waste) — Geneva Foundation's 14th Young Environment Award
3. D.S. Mahajan Award to Arunachal (36th ISGF assembly, Kannur) · Paradip Port first in Swachh Bharat Pakhwada · Dr. C. Srinivasa Rao 9th M.S. Swaminathan Award · Z.T. Lalrithangi (Mizoram, "strawberry revolution") among FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization) "100 Women Heroes"

11.8 Green, UN and World Awards

Board **Green and UN Honours: Winner · Key Point**

Environment

- **UNEP Champions of the Earth**: Supriya Sahu (IAS, Tamil Nadu)
- **Stockholm Water**: Kaveh Madani (Iran) — youngest and first UN official; "water bankruptcy"
- **Goldman**: all six women for the first time
- **Whitley** ("Green Oscar"): Parveen Shaikh (Indian skimmer), Dr. Barkha Subba (Himalayan salamander)

Indian "Firsts" in Conservation

- **IUCN Kenton Miller**: Sonali Ghosh (Kaziranga) — first Indian
- **Ramsar Wise Use**: Dr. Jayashree Venkatesan — first Indian
- **UNDP** (United Nations Development Programme) **Equator**: Bibi Fatima Women's SHG (Dharwad)
- Swaminathan Environment: P. Pechiammal (ghost gear), Govindammal (organic farming) · WWF: Anita Chaudhary (Shergarh; ~500 wild animals rescued) · Gaj Gaurav: seven mahouts of Jaldapara ("30 Giant Steps")

UN Peace and Population

- **Dag Hammarskjöld Medal**: L. Havildar Harbhajan Singh (DRC) and Naib Subedar Sujeet Kumar Pradhan (South Sudan) — posthumous
- **UN Gender Advocate**: Major Abhilasha Barak (UNIFIL) · **UN Secretary-General's Award 2025**: Major Swathi Shantha Kumar
- **UN Population Award**: Varsha Deshpande

More Big Awards of the World

- **World Food Prize 2026**: Huub Lelieveld (Netherlands) — first for food safety; $5 lakh
- **Templeton 2026**: Simon Conway Morris (Cambridge; palaeontology) · **Pritzker 2026**: Smiljan Radić (Chile; 55th)
- **Right Livelihood 2026** ("Alternative Nobel"): Jalila Haider (Pakistan), Timnit Gebru (AI), GYLA (Georgia) and one other organisation
- **Sakharov 2025**: journalists Andrzej Poczobut (Belarus) and Mzia Amaglobeli (Georgia)

ZERO Award: India's first national performance-based environment award (₹5 crore) · UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) Literacy Prizes (since 1967): King Sejong — Escuelas LEO (Colombia), Language Friendly School (Netherlands), Project PAL (Nigeria); Confucius — Accelerated Education (Lebanon), Chiapas Puede (Mexico), Language for Life (Thailand)

11.9 Appointments

Politics-Parliament

1. **Nitin Nabin** (Bihar) BJP president (20 January; unopposed; youngest)
2. **Menaka Guruswamy** in the Rajya Sabha — first openly LGBTQ+ MP (lawyer in Navtej Johar 2018)
3. Harivansh Deputy Chairman for the third time (first nominated member) · after Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation (25 July) additional charge of Education to Pralhad Joshi

Institutions and Regulators

1. V. Narayanan ISRO (from 14 January 2025) · NITI Aayog CEO Anurag Jain, Vice-Chairman Ashok Lahiri
2. Neelkanth Mishra Executive Director at the World Bank (also UIDAI (Unique Identification Authority of India) chairman) · Harjit Singh Grewal NCM chair · Shashi Shekhar Vempati CBFC (Central Board of Film Certification) · Prasoon Joshi Prasar Bharati
3. A.K. Balasubramanian AERB (Atomic Energy Regulatory Board) · Veer Vikram Yadav DGCA (Directorate General of Civil Aviation) · Dr. Kanad Das 13th Director of BSI (first mycologist) · Anant Swarup FICCI (Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry) Secretary General

Ram Janmabhoomi Trust and Others

1. Trust's first CEO **Jitendra Mishra** (retd. Air Marshal) · first woman trustee **Nirmala Yadav**
2. Dinesh Sharma LG of Andaman-Nicobar · Prashant Pise ambassador to Oman · Ashutosh Gowariker director of the 57th IFFI · Sudarsan Pattnaik Census-2027 brand ambassador
3. Bihar: Vinay Kumar CIC (Chief Information Commissioner), Harjot Kaur Bamhrah BPSC, Preeta Verma acting DGP · Sjoerd Marijne women's hockey coach · Vijender Singh on the Asian Boxing Council

Indians in the World

1. **Vivek Aggarwal** FATF (Financial Action Task Force) Vice-President · **Bimal N. Patel** ITLOS (International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea) judge 2026-35 (in place of Neeru Chadha)
2. **Jay Shah** ICC chairman; among WEF (World Economic Forum) "Young Global Leaders" · D.Y. Chandrachud arbitrator for Russia (Oschadbank BIT dispute, Crimea, ~$1.1 billion)
3. Nalini Joshi NSW "Scientist of the Year"

Board New Appointments in the World — Who, Where, in Whose Place

Michael Kremer	World Bank Chief Economist (in place of Indermit Gill; Nobel 2019)
Luc Lindberg	WFP Executive Director (in place of Cindy McCain)
John Ternus	Apple CEO (Tim Cook executive chairman)
Min Aung Hlaing	Myanmar President (10 April)
Fatima Zahra Al Mansouri	Morocco's first woman PM
Roman Gofman	14th chief of Mossad (in place of David Barnea)
Susan Coyle	First woman chief of the Australian Army
Soraya Aghaei Hajiagha	IOC (International Olympic Committee) member — Iran's first woman and youngest

Static

1. NCM non-statutory in 1978 (first chair M.R. Masani), statutory from 1993 · CBFC: Cinematograph Act 1952, Mumbai, 9 regional offices · Prasar Bharati Act 1990, in force 1997
2. AERB 1983 Mumbai · BSI 1890 · FICCI 1927 (G.D. Birla, Purushottamdas Thakurdas) · FATF 1989 (G-7) · ITLOS 1982 convention, Hamburg

11.10 Deaths · Records · "First Women"

Board **Deaths — Field-wise**

Cinema-Music

- Asrani (20 October 2025) · Pankaj Dheer (Karna of "Mahabharat") · Dharmendra (24 November 2025) · Piyush Pandey (23 October 2025, advertising)
- **Asha Bhosle** (12 April 2026; 92; Phalke 2000) · **Teejan Bai** (5 July; Pandavani; Padma Vibhushan 2019) · Kumari Kamala (Bharatanatyam; 91)

Sports

- Manuel Frederick (1972 Munich hockey bronze; Kerala's first Olympic medallist)
- Shyam Lal Meena (1988 Seoul, first Olympic archery team)

Science-Environment

- **James Watson** (DNA double helix; Nobel 1962) · François Englert (Nobel 2013, Higgs mechanism)
- **Madhav Gadgil** (7 January 2026; Western Ghats panel) · **Saalumarada Thimmakka** (114; 385 banyans along NH-94)

Politics-Army

- **Ajit Pawar** (28 January 2026; Learjet-45 crash, Baramati; longest-serving Deputy CM; 3 days of mourning)
- Swaraj Kaushal (former Governor of Mizoram) · Chandrikapersad Santokhi (former President of Suriname) · General V.N. Sharma (15th Army Chief)

Records and in the News

1. **Elon Musk** first with $1 trillion (June 2026, after SpaceX listed on Nasdaq)
2. **Nathan Thomas** youngest male professor at 18 years 346 days (broke Colin Maclaurin's 1717 record) · **Lakshmanan Meyyappan** youngest CA at 16 years 170 days (ACCA, UK)
3. 22.3 m underwater human pillar of 14 divers at Swaraj Dweep (Guinness) · first life-size bronze statue of Vivekananda in the US (Seattle)
4. Sayani Gupta Harvard South Asian Association "Person of the Year" · **Miss Universe 2025** Fátima Bosch (Mexico) · **Miss World 2026** (73rd, Vietnam) Joheiry Mola (Dominican Republic)

! **Trap** Meyyappan's CA qualification is from the UK's ACCA, not India's ICAI · the human pillar was of divers, not a statue.

Board First Women in the Armed Forces (and a Mountaineer)

Major Navya Shekhawat	First woman from the Army to become ADC to the President (second across the three services; first was the Navy's Yashasvi Solanki, 2025)
Captain Shivani Sehrawat	First woman ADC to the Army Chief
Shakti Sharma	First woman Air Vice Marshal in a non-medical branch of the IAF (1 September)
Bhawana Kanth	IAF's first woman fighter combat leader
Sanjukta Parashar	First woman IG of CRPF (Central Reserve Police Force)'s CoBRA unit
Vinita Soren	First tribal woman on Everest (26 May 2012)

11.11 Books: Awarded and Launched (2025-26)

Book	Author	Honour / Launched by	Key Point
Award-Winning Books			
"Flesh"	David Szalay	Booker 2025	First British-Hungarian winner
"Taiwan Travelogue"	Yang Shuang-zi (translation: Lin King)	International Booker 2026	First winner translated from Mandarin
"Heart Lamp"	Banu Mushtaq (translation: Deepa Bhasthi)	International Booker 2025	Stories in Kannada
"Angel Down"	Daniel Kraus	Pulitzer (Fiction) 2026	Set in the First World War
"The Correspondent"	Virginia Evans	Women's Prize for Fiction 2026	Debut novel
"Jeete Jee Allahabad"	Mamta Kalia	Sahitya Akademi 2025 (Hindi)	Memoir
"Crimson Spring"	Navtej Sarna	Sahitya Akademi 2025 (English)	Novel on Jallianwala Bagh 1919
"Har Parvati Katha"	Ramkumar Mukhopadhyay	Saraswati Samman 2025 (35th)	Bangla novel
"Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary"	Suryabala	Vyas Samman (34th)	Hindi novel
"Biswasa De Pruthibi"	Ashutosh Parida	Sarala Award (47th)	Odia
"The Golden Road"	William Dalrymple	Mark Lynton History Prize	Ancient India's influence on the world
"India 2026", "Yojana", "Dharti Ki Sehat", "Rangoli Roop Sur Lay Ki"	Publications Division	FIP honours	7 honours in all to the Publications Division (1941)
Books Launched by the Government / Ministers			
"Triumph of the Indian Republic: My Life, My Struggles"	Ram Nath Kovind (14th President)	**PM Modi** · 12 August 2026, Vigyan Bhawan	Autobiography: from Paraunkh (Kanpur Dehat) to Rashtrapati Bhavan
"RSS @100: A Century of Service, Unity & Sacrifice"	Prabhat Prakashan	**Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan** · 17 July 2026	Defence Minister Rajnath Singh present
"The Voice of Justice: Justice Gavai Speaks"	Speeches of former CJI (Chief Justice of India) B.R. Gavai	**Vice-President** · 14 July 2026	Vice-President's House
"VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy"	—	**Vice-President** · 24 June 2026	On VIP culture
"Dancing with Joy"	Ananda Shankar Jayant	**Vice-President** · 14 October 2026	A dancer's memoir
"IIT: The Story of India's Most Prestigious Educational Ecosystem"	Prabhat Kumar	**Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla** · 20 June 2026, IIT Delhi	The story of the IIT system

Book	Author	Honour / Launched by	Key Point
"Timeless India"	Editor Tarun Vijay (IGNCA)	**Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**, Dr. Jitendra Singh · 28 October 2026, Dharohar Bhawan	Preserving India's cultural identity — Vadnagar, Lothal, Dholavira
"Life Skills to Reach the Top"	Ashok Kumar (former DGP, Uttarakhand)	**Mansukh Mandaviya** · 16 October 2026, IIT Delhi	The gap between studies and life skills
"Five Prescriptions from the Ashtavakra Mahagita"	Daaji (Heartfulness)	**Mansukh Mandaviya** · June 2026	On the Ashtavakra Gita
"Mahatma: A Great Communicator"	Dhiraj Kakadiya	**Mansukh Mandaviya**	Gandhi's art of communication
"Apnapan"	Shivraj Singh Chouhan	New Delhi · May 2026	Experiences with PM Modi (Prabhat Prakashan)
"The Saga of Kudopali"	—	**Dharmendra Pradhan** · 10 January 2026, World Book Fair	In 9 Indian languages and Spanish
"India's First Olympic Gold"	K. Arumugam	**P.T. Usha**	1928 Amsterdam hockey gold
"A Road Well Travelled"	R.K. Raghavan	—	Autobiography of a former CBI (Central Bureau of Investigation) Director

Points to Note

1. Physics Nobel 2026: Halzen (neutrinos, IceCube) · Peace: Navi Pillay (first South African woman)
2. No new Bharat Ratna after 2024 · Gandhi Peace Prize last announced year 2021 (Gita Press)
3. Khel Ratna 2025 to no one — third time after 2008, 2014
4. Phalke 2024 Anant Nag · ceremony at Ekta Nagar — first time outside the capital
5. Jnanpith 60th Vairamuthu — third Tamil (after Akilan, Jayakanthan)
6. International Booker: 2025 Kannada (Banu Mushtaq), 2026 Mandarin
7. Vigyan Ratna 2025: Jayant Narlikar (posthumous) · Vigyan Team: CSIR Aroma Mission
8. COSPAR Sarabhai Medal: first Indian U.R. Rao (1996), first Indian woman Annapurni Subramaniam
9. Indira Gandhi Peace Prize 2025 (Graça Machel) is the Trust's · the Gandhi Peace Prize is the government's
10. First Indian Magsaysay winner Vinoba Bhave
11. India's new judge at ITLOS Bimal N. Patel
12. First Army woman ADC to the President Navya Shekhawat; first from the Navy Yashasvi Solanki

12 Indices and Rankings 2025-26: Where India Stands

At a Glance

1. India at its highest: **third in Stanford AI Vibrancy**
2. At its lowest: **176/177 in the EPI** (Environmental Performance Index)
3. Improved: tourism 39 → 31 · hunger 102 → 100 · CPI (Consumer Price Index) 96 → 91 · SDG (Sustainable Development Goal) 99 → 94
4. Fell: peace 115 → 127 · press 151 → 157 · CCPI (Climate Change Performance Index) 10 → 23
5. Among states: investment friendliness Gujarat · fiscal health Odisha · school quality Punjab

One Rule: Three Questions for Every Index

A **Whose?** WEF (World Economic Forum), UNDP (United Nations Development Programme), RSF (Reporters Without Borders), IEP (Institute for Economics and Peace), Yale — the body

B **Out of how many?** 176 of 177 and 157 of 180 are different things

C **Is a high rank good or bad?** In GTI (Global Terrorism Index) and climate risk a high rank = more danger

Being 13th in the GTI is not good — more terror-affected.

12.1 Leaderboard: Where India Stands in Each Index

Leaderboard India's Rank — Best at the Top, Furthest Behind at the Bottom

India	Index (body)	Place in list	Earlier	Top / key point
3	**Stanford AI Vibrancy** Stanford HAI	3 / 36	—	USA, China, then India
3	**Global Air Power (country-wise)** WDMMA (World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft)	Country-wise rankings	—	After the US, Russia · ahead of China
6	**Asia Manufacturing** Dezan Shira	6 / 11	—	Top China, Malaysia, Vietnam
16	**Responsible Nations Index** —	16 / 154	—	Top Singapore
23	**Climate Performance (CCPI)** Germanwatch	23 / 67	▼ 10	First three places empty, Denmark fourth
31	**Travel-Tourism (TTDI)** WEF	31 / 110	▲ 39	Top Japan
38	**Global Innovation (GII)** WIPO (World Intellectual Property Organization)	38 / 139	= 38	Top Switzerland · first in Central-South Asia
44	**World Competitiveness** IMD (India Meteorological Department)	44 / 69	▼ 41	
91	**Corruption Perceptions (CPI 2025)** Transparency International	91 / 180	▲ 96	Score 39 · first Denmark
94	**SDG Index** SDSN (Sustainable Development Solutions Network)	94 / 169	▲ 99	Top Finland
100	**Global Hunger (GHI)** Welthungerhilfe · Concern	100 / 122	▲ 102	Score 24.1 "serious" · with Ethiopia
116	**World Happiness** UN SDSN · Gallup	116 / 147	▲ 118	Finland first for the 9th year

India	Index (body)	Place in list	Earlier	Top / key point
127	**Global Peace (GPI)** IEP	127 / 163	▼ 115	Top Iceland · last Russia
130	**Human Development (HDI)** UNDP	130 / 193	—	
131	**Gender Gap (GGGI)** WEF	131 / 145	= 131	Top Iceland · India 64.5%
157	**Press Freedom** RSF	157 / 180	▼ 151	Top Norway
176	**Environmental Performance (EPI)** Yale University	176 / 177	= 176	Top Estonia · last Laos

Green ▲ = improved · red ▼ = fell · gold = = same rank · blue = new or no previous rank · the further left the dot on the strip, the further ahead India is · in passport indices many countries share a rank, so they are in the card below

High rank = more danger

Reverse indices

1. **Global Terrorism Index (GTI)**: India 13th · most affected Pakistan · region the Sahel · deadliest ISIS, JNIM, TTP · in 2025 deaths fell 28%, incidents 22% · safest Albania
2. **Climate Risk 1995-2024 (Germanwatch)**: India 9th — among the countries hit hardest by extreme weather

! **Trap** 13th in the GTI and 9th in climate risk — both bad news.

Other Rankings

1. **QS Future Skills 2027**: India 13th (5th in Future of Work; the only South Asian country in the top 15)
2. **Henley Passport** (October 2026): 84th (July 81; 85 in October 2025) · with Algeria-Mauritania · 55 countries visa-free · first Singapore (193), then Japan, South Korea, UAE (188)
3. **CPI 2025**: first Denmark (89, 8th year) · last South Sudan, Somalia (9) · average 42
4. **GHI** (Global Hunger Index): 122 countries · Pakistan 106 · wasting ~19%, stunting 29.3% · 10 countries including Bhutan, Cuba joint 100th
5. Global Passport Index score 45.1 (top Sweden, Switzerland, Finland) · Women Peace and Security 2025/26 (Georgetown): India 131, 0.607; Denmark first, Afghanistan last

! **Trap** The Henley rank changes every quarter.

12.2 Gender Gap Report (WEF, 20th edition)

Chart India's Rank in the Four Sub-Indices (out of 145) — lower = better

Political empowerment	67 (best; score 24.5%)
Educational attainment	112
Health-survival	136
Economic participation	143 (worst; 41.2%)

India overall 131 · score 64.5% (60.2% in 2006) · world 69.2% · ~120 years to full parity

Chart Region-wise Score (%)

Europe	75.7
North America	75.2
Latin America	74.5
East Asia	70.3
Central Asia	70
Sub-Saharan	68.8
South Asia	64.5
MENA	62.5 (furthest behind)

Top: **Iceland 93.0%** (17th year; the only one past 90%), Finland, Norway, Namibia, UK · bottom Algeria, DR Congo, Pakistan (143), Iran, Chad (145)

Trap

India's economic sub-index is **143** — the same number is Pakistan's overall rank.

12.3 Comparison with Neighbours: Three Indices

Comparison India vs Neighbours — Rank (green = better than India, red = below India)

Country	Happiness (147)	Press Freedom (180)	SDG (169)
India	116	157	94
China	65	Third from bottom	49
Nepal	99	87	90
Pakistan	104	153	—
Bangladesh	127	152	—
Sri Lanka	134	134	92
Bhutan	—	150	73
Maldives	—	108	63

Happiness (20 March; Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre): Finland, Iceland, Denmark, Costa Rica, Sweden · **Press (RSF)**: top Norway; last Eritrea (180), North Korea, China · **SDG (UN-SDSN)**: score 68.3; 33.3% of targets on track, 42.7% limited progress, 24% worsening; top Finland; USA 45; last South Sudan

Trap

In press freedom India is **below all its neighbours** — even Pakistan (153); only China is lower.

12.4 Environmental Performance Index (EPI)

Timeline **India in the EPI: Ten Years**

2016	2018	2020	2022	2024	2026
141	177	168	180 (last)	176	176 / 177

Chart **Issue-wise Rank (2026)**

Climate	130 (best)
Waste-sanitation	141
Ecosystem vitality	171
Environmental health	174
Biodiversity	174
Air	174

EPI's Identity and Result

Yale + Columbia (CIESIN)

1. Biennial · 25th year · 177 countries, 47 indicators, 12 issues · three goals: environmental health, ecosystem vitality, climate
2. India **176 (22.46)** · last **Laos** (21.78) · first **Estonia** (74.79), then Luxembourg, UK, Finland, Netherlands · 7th of 8 in South Asia
3. Over the decade: climate +13.98 · air −0.15 (despite ₹16,423 crore on NCAP (National Clean Air Programme) since 2019) · Environment Ministry's objection: ignores level of development and CBDR

12.5 Big Reports of the World

Chart **SIPRI 2026: Nuclear Warheads (estimated)**

Russia	5420
USA	5042
China	620
France	370 (from 290)
UK	225
India	190 (from 180)
Pakistan	170
Israel	90
North Korea	60

India has more warheads than Pakistan

Hunger and Drugs

1. **SOFI 2026** (FAO, IFAD (International Fund for Agricultural Development), UNICEF (United Nations Children's Fund), WFP (World Food Programme), WHO (World Health Organization)): ~64.5 crore hungry in 2025 (7.8%; 8.1% in 2024, 8.6% in 2022) · theme: high cost of a healthy diet · moderate-severe food insecurity 25.8% (~2.1 billion)
2. **Hunger Hotspots** (FAO-WFP): Sudan, South Sudan, Somalia, Nigeria, Yemen, Palestine · FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization)'s "Forest for Food 2026"
3. **UNODC World Drug Report** (26 June): 6.2% of those aged 15-64 in 2024 (~33.1 crore; 5.2% a decade ago) · cocaine production 4,000 tonnes+ · new psychoactive substances 755

WEF and Cities

1. **Global Risks 2026**: theme "A New Age of Competition" · top risk "geoeconomic confrontation" · Chief Economists Outlook (September): India top in growth resilience
2. **EIU Liveability**: Copenhagen (98), Vienna (97.1), Melbourne · **Time Out** happiest cities: **Jaipur 6th** (top Bath) · **Lonely Planet 2027**: Gujarat in the top 25 destinations, Darjeeling toy train in the top 25 experiences
3. Numbeo: Abu Dhabi safest for the 10th year · City Inclusion 2025 (for women): Bengaluru, Chennai, Pune, Hyderabad, Mumbai · Gallup safety Singapore (98%) · UN Multilateralism Index: top Barbados, last USA

12.6 State Rankings

Board **Which State Leads in Which Index — and Where UP Stands**

Investment Friendliness (NITI, first)

- Top: **Gujarat** (~56.6) · hilly-North-East **Uttarakhand** (47.5) · city-state/UT **Goa** (53.1)
- Last: Bihar (41.2), Ladakh (27.0), Lakshadweep (24.5)
- 36 states/UTs · 8 pillars · 84 indicators · none reached 60 · five with 50+: Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Goa, Odisha (52.4)
- UP: **13th** (~45.0)

Electric Mobility IEMI (NITI)

- Overall: **Delhi (84)**, Maharashtra (78), Karnataka, Chandigarh, Goa
- Weights: transport electrification 50%, charging 30%, research 20%
- Bihar 13th (40), Gujarat 17th · hilly-North-East Manipur, Tripura
- UP: **10th** (51)

School Quality SEQI (NITI)

- **Punjab** (27th in 2020), then Kerala
- 19,125 government schools upgraded · ~12 lakh children through Mission Samarth · NEET (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test) passes via PACE from 80 (2021) to 882 (2026)
- First state to make AI a core subject in classes 1-12 · class-3 language 82%, maths 78%

LEADS · Cyber Crime

- **LEADS** (Logistics Ease Across Different States) **2025** (DPIIT): Tamil Nadu, UP, Mizoram, Delhi — category-wise exemplars; UP in the landlocked category
- **NCRB** (National Crime Records Bureau) **2024**: Telangana highest (27,230), Karnataka 21,003, **UP third** (11,073)

Board Fiscal Health Index (NITI, second) — four categories, based on CAG reports

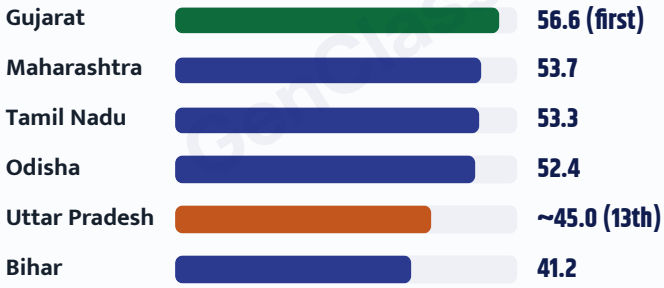
Achievers	Front Runners	Performers	Aspirational
Odisha (73.1) · Goa (54.7) · Jharkhand (50.5)	Gujarat · Maharashtra · Chhattisgarh · Telangana	Bihar (30.5) · Tamil Nadu (29.8) · MP and Rajasthan (27.6) · Haryana (24.5)	Kerala · West Bengal · Andhra (12.4) · **Punjab (last)**
North-East-Himalayan: Arunachal (59.5) · Uttarakhand (52.5)	**UP (41.9)** · Karnataka	North-East: Tripura · Meghalaya · Assam · Mizoram · Sikkim	North-East: Nagaland · Himachal · Manipur (17.6)

India's total public debt 82% of GDP · states' debt-GSDP from 16.7% (2013-14) to ~23.7% (2024-25) · states' combined fiscal deficit ~2.8% in 2025

Trap

Punjab first in school quality, but Punjab **last** in fiscal health — one state, two opposite ranks.

Chart NITI Aayog's First Investment Friendliness Index (IFI) 2026 — 17 July, Ashok Kumar Lahiri (Vice-Chairman)



1. **36** states/UTs (28 + 8) · **84** indicators · **8** pillars · no one's score reached 60
2. Pillar weights: **infrastructure 25%** (highest), business environment 20%, resources 15%, regulatory ease 12%, government policy 10%, financial health 7%, institutional environment 6%, environmental resilience 5%
3. Category winners: among hilly-North-East **Uttarakhand** (then Assam, Himachal) · among UTs/city-states **Goa** (then Delhi, Chandigarh)
4. Categories: 5 Top Performers, 15 Front-runners (UP in this), 8 Emerging, 8 Aspiring (Mizoram, Arunachal, Manipur etc.)

Trap: this is a ranking of states, not countries · the "first" edition in 2026

12.7 NITI Aayog and Other National Reports

Four NITI Aayog Reports

1. **"School Education System in India"** (May 2026; UDISE (Unified District Information System for Education)+ 2024-25): in **Jharkhand** primary-level dropout **from 6.41% (2014-15) to 0%** · upper primary 7.42% → 1.7% · secondary 23.2% → 3.5% · national primary dropout ~0.3%
2. **"Reimagining Care"** (6 August): 60+ population from 14.9 crore (2022) to 34.7 crore (2050) · care market from $29.62 billion (2023) to $72.31 billion (2030) · based on Time Use Survey 2024
3. **"Global Manufacturing Hub"** (13 August): 12 priority sectors; four key — chemicals-petrochemicals, textiles-apparel, telecom equipment, solar PV
4. **"Reimagining Skilling"** (23 August): 8.7 crore NEET youth · based on NSS 78th round

Aspirational Blocks Delta (January-March 2026)

1. First **Keran** (Kupwara), second Marwah (Kishtwar)
2. Zone-1 Tulail (Bandipora) and Karsha (Kargil) · Zone-2 **Bansgaon (Gorakhpur)**, ₹1.5 crore
3. Programme since 7 January 2023 · 500 blocks · ~40 indicators, 5 themes

Trap UP's Bansgaon (Gorakhpur) — Zone-2 winner.

Other Reports

1. MeitY Digital Threat Report 2025-26 (second; BFSI)
2. First National Household Income Survey **NHIS** (MoSPI-NSO, April 2026-March 2027)
3. CSE "State of India's Environment" (since 1982) · NITI "Ease of Doing R&D" (R&D ~0.64% of GDP)

12.8 University Rankings

QS 2027 (18 June)

- First **MIT** (15th year) · then Imperial, Stanford, Oxford, Harvard
- India's top **IIT Delhi 118** (from 123) · IIT Bombay 134, IIT Madras 170, IIT Kharagpur 205, IISc and IIT Kanpur 221 · top private Shoolini 454
- 52 institutions from India · USA 184, UK 93, China 85

VS

THE 2027 (30 September)

- First **Oxford** (11th time) · MIT second; Princeton and Stanford (3); Cambridge (5); Harvard 6
- India's top **IISc 254**
- **143** institutions from India — second after the USA (168) · Asia's top Tsinghua (11)

THE Asia 2026 and AISHE

1. **THE Asia 2026**: Tsinghua, Peking, NUS · India the top country with **128** institutions (Japan 115, Türkiye 109) · IISc joint 43
2. **AISHE** (All India Survey on Higher Education) **2023-24**: enrolment from 3.42 crore (2014-15) to 4.5 crore (+31.5%) · GER (Gross Enrolment Ratio) from 23.7% to ~30% · women +42.2% · STEM 1.02 crore

Trap First in QS is MIT, in THE Oxford · India's top in QS is IIT Delhi, in THE IISc.

Points to Note

1. High rank in GTI = more terror-affected · India 13th
2. EPI 2026: India 176/177 · last Laos · first Estonia
3. Gender gap: India's best sub-index political empowerment (67), worst economic (143)
4. In press freedom India (157) is below even Pakistan (153)
5. CPI 2025: India 91 (from 96), score 39 · first Denmark
6. SIPRI (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute): India 190, Pakistan 170, China 620
7. Fiscal health: Odisha first (73.1), Punjab last
8. Delhi first in IEMI (India Electric Mobility Index) · Gujarat in investment friendliness
9. QS: MIT · THE: Oxford · in THE India second by number of institutions
10. Time Out happy cities: Jaipur 6th (the only Indian city in the top 10)

13 Days and Themes: October 2026 to November 2025

At a Glance

1. New UN Day: **27 November** — ending child marriage and forced marriage (India a co-sponsor)
2. 12th Yoga Day **"Yoga for Healthy Ageing"**, Red Road Kolkata
3. Environment Day host **Azerbaijan** · Tourism Day host **El Salvador**
4. Third National Space Day (23 August), main event **Ahmedabad**
5. World Radio Day theme **"Radio and Artificial Intelligence"** · Mental Health Day "Lived Experiences Heard"

One Rule: Link Each Day to Its "Reason"

- **A** **Birth anniversary** — day from a person (5 September Radhakrishnan, 29 June Mahalanobis)
- **B** **Event/founding** — what happened that day (5 April S.S. Loyalty, 21 October Hot Springs)
- **C** **Body's birthday** — founding of a UN agency (16 October FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization), 7 April WHO (World Health Organization))
- **D** **Theme** — changes every year; remember the body's name with it

The date is remembered on its own through the "reason" — the theme has to be learnt separately.

Key Know by Colour: What Kind of Day It Is

Birth anniversary · Event/founding · Health · Nature · Rights/UN · Knowledge-sport-business

Themes in green letters · where no official theme is declared/available, only the "reason" is given

October 2026

31 October — **National Unity Day** — Sardar Patel's birth anniversary · since 2014 · 150th birth anniversary in 2025 (₹1,219 crore projects at Kevadia)

30 October — **World Savings Day** — 1924, Milan (International Savings Bank Congress)

24 October — **United Nations Day** — UN Charter 1945 · 80 years in 2025

21 October — **Police Commemoration Day** — Hot Springs, Ladakh (1959) — 10 CRPF (Central Reserve Police Force) jawans

16 October — **World Food Day** — FAO founded 16 October 1945
Theme: "Innovate Today. Nourish Tomorrow."

11 October — **International Day of the Girl Child** — Since 2012

9 October — **World Post Day** — UPU founded 1874, Bern

1 October — **International Day of Older Persons** — First 1991 · India's policy on older persons 1999

12 October — **NHRC Foundation Day** — 1993 (Protection of Human Rights Act)

10 October — **World Mental Health Day** — Since 1992 (WFMH)
Theme: "Lived Experiences Heard: Real Voices, Real Change"

5 October — **World Teachers' Day** — UNESCO-ILO Recommendation 1966 · (National Teachers' Day 5 September)

September 2026

28 September — **World Rabies Day** — Death anniversary of Louis Pasteur (1895; born 1822, Dole) — rabies vaccine, germ theory, pasteurisation

25 September — **Antyodaya Diwas · World Lung Day** — Deendayal Upadhyaya's birth anniversary (since 2014)

23 September — **11th Ayurveda Day** — Main event in Nagpur · 3 new AIIAs in the budget
Theme: "Ayurveda for a Healthier Tomorrow"

16 September — **World Ozone Day** — Montreal Protocol 1987
Theme: "Global Action for a Cooler Planet"

14 September — **Hindi Diwas** — Hindi in Devanagari the official language in 1949 (Art. 343(1)) · since 1953

8 September — **International Literacy Day** — UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) 1966, since 1967
Theme: "Literacy for People, Planet and Prosperity"

5 September — **Teachers' Day** — S. Radhakrishnan's birth anniversary (1888)

27 September — **World Tourism Day** — UNWTO (UN Tourism, earlier World Tourism Organization) statutes 1970 · Day since 1980 · host El Salvador
Theme: "Digital Agenda and AI to Redesign Tourism"

24 September — **World Maritime Day** — Last Thursday of September · IMO (International Maritime Organization) 1958, London
Theme: "From Policy to Practice: Empowering Maritime Excellence"

21 September — **International Day of Peace** — UNGA (United Nations General Assembly) 1981
Theme: "Invest in Peace — For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day"

15 September — **Engineers' Day** — M. Visvesvaraya's birth anniversary (1861, Muddenahalli)

10 September — **World Suicide Prevention Day** — IASP + WHO
Theme: "Changing the Narrative on Suicide"

7 September — **International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies** — UNGA 2019
Theme: "Clean Air for Climate Action"

4 September — **New UN Day declared: 27 November — ending child and forced marriage** — Passed unanimously in the UNGA · initiative of Sierra Leone · India a co-sponsor · to be observed first on 27 November 2026

August 2026

30 August — **Small Industry Day** — 2000 package; first in 2001

29 August — **National Sports Day** — Dhyan Chand's 121st birth anniversary · Mandaviya, Dhyan Chand Stadium Delhi
Theme: "Ek Ghanta Khel Ke Maidan Mein" (one hour on the playground; Fit India)

26 August — **Women's Equality Day** — US 19th Amendment 1920 · Bella Abzug

23 August — **Third National Space Day** — Chandrayaan-3 landing 2023 · main event Ahmedabad (Gajendra Singh Shekhawat) · 2024 "Touching Lives while Touching the Moon", 2025 "Aryabhata to Gaganyaan"
Theme: "Towards Viksit Bharat: Innovating, Collaborating and Aspiring to Global Space Leadership"

21 August — **World Senior Citizens Day** — Reagan's proclamation 1988, first 1991

20 August — **Sadbhavana Diwas · Renewable Energy Day** — Rajiv Gandhi's birth anniversary (1944; award since 1992, ₹10 lakh) · Renewable Energy Day since 2004

19 August — **World Humanitarian Day** — Baghdad Canal Hotel attack 2003 (22 dead; Sérgio Vieira de Mello) · UNGA 63/139 · since 2009

14 August — **Partition Horrors Remembrance Day** — Since 2021 · sixth

12 August — **International Youth Day · World Elephant Day · Librarians' Day** — Youth Day since 2000 · Elephant Day 2012 · S.R. Ranganathan's birth anniversary (1892)
Theme: (Youth Day) "Different Contexts, Common Aspirations"

10 August — **World Lion Day** — First 2013, Livingstone (Zambia); ALERT

9 August — **International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples** — UNGA 49/214 (1994) · a Sunday in 2026, so the UN event on 10 August
Theme: "Honouring Indigenous Midwives: Safeguarding Life and Well-being"

7 August — **12th National Handloom Day** — Swadeshi movement from Calcutta Town Hall in 1905 · since 2015 (announced in Chennai)

July 2026

29 July — **International Tiger Day** — 58 tiger reserves
Theme: "Securing the Future of Tigers with Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities at the Heart"

28 July — **World Hepatitis Day · Nature Conservation Day** — Baruch Blumberg's birthday (discovered the hepatitis-B virus)
Theme: "Hepatitis: Let's Break It Down"

26 July — **Kargil Vijay Diwas · Mangrove Day** — Operation Vijay 1999 · Mangrove Day UNESCO since 2016 (top in area West Bengal, Gujarat, Andaman)

22 July — **National Flag Day** — Constituent Assembly adopted the tricolour in 1947

20 July — **International Moon Day · World Chess Day** — Apollo-11 (1969) · FIDE (International Chess Federation) founded 1924

15 July — **World Youth Skills Day** — Since 2015 · Skill India 15 July 2015
Theme: "Skills for a Shared Future"

11 July — **World Population Day** — UNDP (United Nations Development Programme) 1989, first 1990 · 5 billion 1987, 7 billion 31 October 2011, 8 billion 15 November 2022
Theme: "Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people"

4 July — **International Day of Cooperatives** — First Saturday of July
Theme: "Cooperatives for a Peaceful World"

3 July — **International Plastic Bag Free Day**

1 July — **National Doctors' Day** — Birth and death anniversary of Dr. B.C. Roy · (BNS, BNSS, BSA in force from 1 July 2024)
Theme: "Behind the Mask: Who Heals the Healers?"

June 2026

29 June — **Statistics Day** — P.C. Mahalanobis's birth anniversary (1893) · since 2007

27 June — **MSME** (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) **Day** — Since 2017
Theme: "Empowering MSMEs through Innovation and Sustainable Industrial Development"

26 June — **International Day against Drug Abuse** — UNGA 1987 · "Nasha Mukt Bharat Week" 17-26 June in India

23 June — **Olympic Day · UN Public Service Day** — Olympic Day since 1948 (IOC 1894, Paris)
Theme: "Sports: Building Bridges, Breaking Barriers"

21 June — **12th International Day of Yoga** — UNGA resolution 11 December 2014 · main event Red Road, Kolkata (PM) · Yoga Mahotsav New Delhi
Theme: "Yoga for Healthy Ageing"

20 June — **World Refugee Day** — Since 2001

17 June — **Desertification and Drought Day** — Since 1995 (UNCCD)
Theme: "Rangelands. Recognize. Respect. Restore."

15 June — **Global Wind Day**
Theme: "Our Wind, Our Community"

14 June — **World Blood Donor Day** — Since 2004 · Karl Landsteiner's birth anniversary
Theme: "One Drop of Humanity. Give Blood. Save Lives."

13 June — **International Albinism Awareness Day** — Since 2015 · lack of melanin, not contagious

12 June — **World Day Against Child Labour** — ILO (International Labour Organization) since 2002
Theme: "Red Card to Child Labour"

8 June — **World Oceans Day**
Theme: "REIMAGINE"

7 June — **World Food Safety Day** — Since 2019
Theme: "From burden to solution: safe food everywhere"

5 June — **World Environment Day** — Host Azerbaijan (Baku)
Theme: "Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future."

4 June — **International Day of Innocent Children Victims of Aggression** — 1982

3 June — **World Bicycle Day** — UNGA 72/272 (2018)

1 June — **Global Day of Parents · World Milk Day** — Parents since 2012 · Milk Day FAO since 2001

May 2026

31 May — **World No Tobacco Day** — WHO since 1987
Theme: "Unmasking the appeal: Countering nicotine and tobacco addiction"

30 May — **Hindi Journalism Day** — "Udant Martand" 1826, Kolkata — Pt. Jugal Kishore Shukla · first Hindi weekly

29 May — **Everest Day · UN Peacekeepers' Day** — 1953 Tenzing-Hillary
Theme: (Peacekeepers) "Invest in Peace"

28 May — **Menstrual Hygiene Day · World Hunger Day** — Hunger Day since 2011
Theme: (Hunger Day) "The End of Hunger is in Our Hands"

25 May — **World Thyroid Day · World Football Day** — Football Day since 2024

23 May — **World Turtle Day**

22 May	**International Day for Biological Diversity** — CBD (Convention on Biological Diversity) 1992 · since 2000 **Theme:** "Acting Locally for Global Impact"
21 May	**Anti-Terrorism Day** — Assassination of Rajiv Gandhi, Sriperumbudur 1991
18 May	**International Museum Day · AIDS Vaccine Awareness Day**
17 May	**World Telecommunication Day** — ITU 1865
15 May	**International Day of Families** — Since 1994
12 May	**International Nurses Day** — Florence Nightingale (1820) **Theme:** "Our Nurses. Our Future. Empowered Nurses Save Lives."
11 May	**National Technology Day** — Pokhran-II (1998) **Theme:** "Responsible Innovation for Inclusive Growth"
10 May	**Mother's Day** — Second Sunday of May
8 May	**Red Cross-Red Crescent Day · Ovarian Cancer · Thalassaemia** — Henry Dunant (1828, Geneva; first Peace Nobel 1901) · ICRC 1863 · first 1948, this name since 1984 **Theme:** (Ovarian Cancer) "No Woman Left Behind"
7 May	**World Athletics Day** — Since 1996 · IAAF 1912 Stockholm; World Athletics since 2019; HQ Monaco
5 May	**World Asthma Day · International Day of the Midwife** — Asthma: first Tuesday of May (GINA 1993, Day since 1998) **Theme:** (Midwife) "Honouring Indigenous Midwives..."
4 May	**International Firefighters' Day** — Red-blue ribbon
3 May	**World Press Freedom Day** — UNESCO 1991, UNGA 1993, since 1994 · UDHR (Universal Declaration of Human Rights) Art. 19 · Windhoek Declaration · global conference Lusaka (Zambia) **Theme:** "Shaping a Future at Peace: Promoting Press Freedom for Human Rights, Development and Security"
1 May	**Labour Day**

April 2026

30 April	**Ayushman Bharat Diwas** — First HWC 14 April 2018, Jangla (Bijapur) · PM-JAY 23 September 2018, Ranchi
29 April	**International Dance Day** — International Theatre Institute (ITI)-UNESCO, 1982
28 April	**World Day for Safety and Health at Work** — ILO 2003
26 April	**World Intellectual Property Day** — WIPO (World Intellectual Property Organization) Convention 1967 Stockholm, in force 1970; Geneva; India 1975 **Theme:** "IP and Sports: Ready, Set, Innovate!"
25 April	**World Malaria Day** — 60th World Health Assembly 2007, since 2008 · Plasmodium, female Anopheles **Theme:** "Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must."
24 April	**Panchayati Raj Day** — 73rd Amendment in force from 1993 · since 2010 **Theme:** "Sashakt Panchayat, Sarvangeen Vikas" (empowered panchayats, all-round development)
24-30 April	**World Immunization Week** **Theme:** "For every generation, vaccines work"
23 April	**World Book and Copyright Day** — UNESCO 1995
22 April	**Earth Day** — First 1970, USA · 56th year **Theme:** "Our Power, Our Planet"
21 April	**Civil Services Day** — Patel called it the "steel frame" in 1947 (Metcalfe House) · since 2006

19 April	**World Liver Day**
18 April	**World Heritage Day** — ICOMOS 1982, UNESCO 1983
17 April	**World Haemophilia Day** — WFH since 1989 · Frank Schnabel · "royal disease"
15 April	**World Art Day** — IAA 2012, UNESCO 2019 · Leonardo da Vinci's birthday
14 April	**Ambedkar Jayanti** — 1891, Mhow · Bharat Ratna 1990
13 April	**Jallianwala Bagh** — 1919, Dyer
11 April	**National Safe Motherhood Day · Parkinson's Day** — Kasturba's birth anniversary · since 2003 (White Ribbon Alliance; first country to declare it) · Parkinson's since 1997
10 April	**World Homoeopathy Day** — Hahnemann (1755, Meissen, Germany) · homoeopathy 1796
7 April	**World Health Day** — WHO Constitution 1948, since 1950 **Theme:** "Together for Health. Stand with Science."
6 April	**International Day of Sport for Development and Peace** — UNGA 2013, first 2014
5 April	**National Maritime Day (63rd)** — S.S. Loyalty from Mumbai to London in 1919 · since 1964 **Theme:** "Maritime India: Empowering Progress"
2 April	**World Autism Awareness Day** — UNGA 62/139 (2007), first 2008 · a neurodevelopmental condition
1 April	**RBI** (Reserve Bank of India) **Day** — Act 1934, founded 1935 · Hilton Young Commission 1926 · first Kolkata, Mumbai from 1937 · nationalised 1949

March 2026

28 March	**Earth Hour** — Last Saturday of March, 8:30-9:30 pm · WWF · first 2007 Sydney
27 March	**World Theatre Day** — International Theatre Institute (ITI), since 1962
24 March	**World TB Day** — Robert Koch 1882 · 1.07 crore ill, 12.3 lakh deaths in 2024 · 8.3 crore lives saved since 2000 **Theme:** "Yes! We Can End TB: Led by countries, powered by people"
23 March	**Martyrs' Day · World Meteorological Day** — Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, Sukhdev (Lahore 1931) · WMO 1950, Geneva **Theme:** (Meteorology) "Observing Today, Protecting Tomorrow"
22 March	**World Water Day · Bihar Diwas** — Water Day since 1993 · Bihar 1912 (114th) **Theme:** (Water) "Water and Gender" · (Bihar) "Unnat Bihar, Ujjwal Bihar"
21 March	**World Glacier Day · International Day of Forests** — Glacier Day since 2025
19 March	**Gudi Padwa and Ugadi (2026)**
16 March	**National Vaccination Day** — First OPV dose in 1995 (Pulse Polio) · polio-free certification 27 March 2014 **Theme:** "Vaccines for All is Humanly Possible"
15 March	**World Consumer Rights Day · Day to Combat Islamophobia** — Islamophobia Day UNGA 76/254 (2022) — moved by Pakistan for the OIC **Theme:** (Consumer) "Safe Products, Confident Consumers"
11 March	**No Smoking Day** — Second Wednesday of March
8 March	**International Women's Day** — UN theme + IWD campaign theme are different **Theme:** UN: "Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls." · campaign: "Give To Gain"
5 March	**Disarmament and Non-Proliferation Awareness Day** — UNGA 77/51 (2022) · first in 2023
4 March	**National Safety Day** — National Safety Council 1966 (Labour Ministry) · since 1972

3 March — **World Wildlife Day · World Hearing Day** — CITES signed 1973 · UNGA 2013
Theme: "Medicinal and Aromatic Plants: Conserving Health, Heritage and Livelihoods"

1 March — **Zero Discrimination Day · Civil Defence Day · World Compliment Day**

February 2026

28 February — **National Science Day** — Raman effect 1928 (Nobel 1930) · since 1987
Theme: "Women in Science: Catalyzing Viksit Bharat"

21 February — **International Mother Language Day** — Dhaka language movement 1952 · UNESCO, since 2000
Theme: "Youth voices on multilingual education"

20 February — **World Day of Social Justice**

13 February — **National Women's Day · World Radio Day · APEDA** (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) **founded** — Sarojini Naidu's birth anniversary (1879) · APEDA 1986 (Act 1985)
Theme: (Radio) "Radio and Artificial Intelligence" — "AI is a tool, not a voice"

10 February — **World Pulses Day** — Since 2019 (FAO)
Theme: "Pulses of the world: from modesty to excellence"

4 February — **World Cancer Day** — UICC
Theme: "United by Unique" (2025-27)

2 February — **World Wetlands Day** — Ramsar Convention 1971
Theme: "Wetlands and Traditional Knowledge: Celebrating Cultural Heritage"

1 February — **Coast Guard Day** — 1977

January 2026

30 January — **Martyrs' Day** — Gandhi's death anniversary

26 January — **77th Republic Day** — Chief guests EU leadership · Constitution in force 1950

25 January — **National Voters' Day** — ECI (Election Commission of India) founded 1950 · since 2011
Theme: "Mera Bharat, Mera Vote" (my India, my vote)

24 January — **National Girl Child Day · International Day of Education** — Girl Child Day since 2008 (WCD) · Education Day since 2019

23 January — **Parakram Diwas** — Netaji's birth anniversary (1897, Cuttack) · since 2021 · 2026 main event Sri Vijaya Puram

16 January — **National Startup Day · Lokpal Day** — Startup Day since 2022 (Startup India 2016) · Lokpal Day since 2025 (Lokpal 2014, Act 2013)

12 January — **National Youth Day** — Vivekananda's birth anniversary (1863) · since 1985 · Youth Festival since 1995
Theme: "Youth Empowerment for Nation Building"

10 January — **World Hindi Day** — First World Hindi Conference 1975, Nagpur · since 2006

9 January — **Pravasi Bharatiya Divas** — Gandhi returned from South Africa in 1915 · since 2003 · convention biennial since 2015 · 18th January 2025, Bhubaneswar

4 January — **World Braille Day** — Louis Braille (1809) · UN declaration 2018, observed from 2019

December 2025

25 December — **Good Governance Day** — Atal Bihari Vajpayee's birth anniversary

23 December — **Kisan Diwas** — Chaudhary Charan Singh's birth anniversary

22 December — **National Mathematics Day** — Ramanujan's birth anniversary (first Indian Fellow of Trinity College)

18 December — **Minorities Rights Day**

14 December — **National Energy Conservation Day** — Energy Conservation Act 2001 · BEE

11 December — **UNICEF** (United Nations Children's Fund) **Day · International Mountain Day** — UNICEF 1946

10 December — **Human Rights Day** — UDHR 1948
Theme 2025: "Human Rights, Our Everyday Essentials"

7 December — **Armed Forces Flag Day** — Since 1949

5 December — **World Soil Day · International Volunteer Day** — FAO, since 2014
Theme 2025: (Soil) "Healthy Soils for Healthy Cities"

4 December — **Navy Day** — Operation Trident of 1971 (Karachi)

3 December — **International Day of Persons with Disabilities** — UNGA 1992 · CRPD 2006 · ~16% of the world (1.3 billion)
Theme 2025: "Fostering disability-inclusive societies for advancing social progress"

2 December — **Day for the Abolition of Slavery · Computer Literacy Day** — 1949 Convention

1 December — **World AIDS Day** — Since 1988
Theme 2025: "Overcoming disruption, transforming the AIDS response"

November 2025

26 November — **Constitution Day · National Milk Day** — Constitution adopted 1949 · Verghese Kurien's birth anniversary

21 November — **World Television Day**

18-24 November — **Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR) Awareness Week** — WHO

17 November — **International Students' Day** — Prague 1939

16 November — **National Press Day** — Press Council of India 1966

15 November — **Janjatiya Gaurav Divas · Jharkhand Foundation** — Birsa Munda's birth anniversary · since 2021 · Jharkhand 2000

14 November — **World Diabetes Day · Children's Day** — Frederick Banting (insulin 1921) · Nehru's birth anniversary

11 November — **National Education Day** — Maulana Azad's birth anniversary

9 November — **Uttarakhand Foundation** — 2000 · silver jubilee in 2025

7 November — **National Cancer Awareness Day** — Marie Curie's birth anniversary · since 2014

6 November — **Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War** — Since 2001

5 November — **World Tsunami Awareness Day** — UNGA 2015 · Japan's "Inamura-no-hi" story (1854)

Indian Days Made from Birthdays — Summary

1. **Mahalanobis**: ISI 1931, model of the Second Five-Year Plan, D^2 distance, NSS 1950, Padma Vibhushan 1968
2. **Ranganathan**: five laws of library science, colon classification, Padma Shri 1957
3. **Radhakrishnan**: first Vice-President, second President · **Dhyan Chand**: Olympic gold 1928, 1932, 1936; Khel Ratna named after him in 2021

Background of Wildlife Conservation

1. **Asiatic lion** (16th census, May 2025): 891 (674 in 2020, 523 in 2015) · ~35,000 sq km · 384 in protected forest, 507 outside · Barda the second home · Project Lion 15 August 2020 (announced from the Red Fort)
2. **Project Elephant**: 1992 · centrally sponsored · MIKE for monitoring poaching
3. **Child marriage**: ~1.2 crore every year · "Bal Vivah Mukt Bharat" from 27 November 2024 (Bhuvan Ribhu, Just Rights for Children)

Timeline **Tourism Administration in India**

1958	1963	1966 · 1967	1982	1986	2002
Department of Tourism (1 March)	Lakshmikant Jha Committee	ITDC · Ministry of Tourism and Civil Aviation	First tourism policy · "industry" status in June	Kerala — first state to give industry status · Mohammad Yunus Committee	Separate Ministry of Tourism

Tourism not in the Concurrent List · UP: tourism department 1956, directorate 1972, UPSTDC 1974

Static

1. MSME Act 2006 · MSME Ministry 2007 · SIDBI 1990
2. IMO HQ London · UN Tourism (formerly UNWTO) statutes 1975, HQ Madrid, secretariat 1976
3. World Statistics Day (20 October) every 5 years — 2010, 2015, 2020, 2025; next 2030

Points to Note

1. World Hindi Day 10 January · National Hindi Diwas 14 September
2. National Teachers' Day 5 September · World Teachers' Day 5 October
3. National Safety Council (1966, 4 March) and National Security Council (1998) are different
4. Project Lion (2020) and the 2018 lion project are different
5. IWD 2026: UN theme "Rights. Justice. Action..." vs campaign "Give To Gain"
6. National Voters' Day 25 January — ECI founded 1950
7. Hindi Journalism Day: "Udant Martand" (1826, Kolkata)
8. Police Commemoration Day: Hot Springs (Ladakh), 1959
9. World Statistics Day every 5 years — not in 2026
10. New UN Day 27 November — initiative of Sierra Leone, India a co-sponsor

14 Uttar Pradesh Special: District Tour

At a Glance

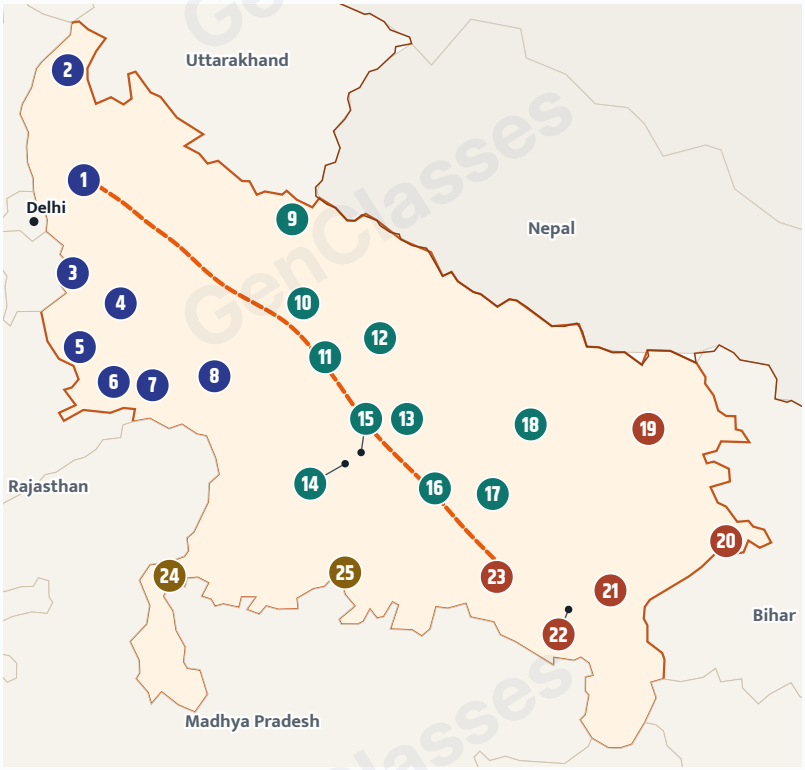
1. Budget 2026-27 **₹9,12,696 crore** — the largest ever
2. Ganga Expressway (**594 km, 12 districts**) inaugurated from Hardoi
3. Sarnath: India's **45th**, UP's **fourth** World Heritage Site
4. Three new Ramsar sites in 2026: **Sheikha, Surha Tal, Sauj**
5. Parichha dam (Jhansi) — World Heritage Irrigation Structure

One Rule: District ↔ Story

- **A** **West** — lakes, heritage, airport, corridor
- **B** **Awadh-Central** — capital, industry, defence, solar
- **C** **Purvanchal** — Kashi's "firsts", Magh Mela, Ramsar
- **D** **Bundelkhand** — dam, solar, geo-heritage

Questions often ask in reverse: "In which district is this project?" — so learn it by seeing the place on the map.

Map **District Tour: What Happened Where (numbers = cards below)**



1. **Meerut** — Start of the Ganga Expressway
2. **Saharanpur** — Delhi-Dehradun corridor
3. **Gautam Buddh Nagar** — Jewar airport
4. **Aligarh** — Sheikha Lake Ramsar
5. **Mathura** — Cow culture museum
6. **Agra** — Three older World Heritage sites
7. **Firozabad** — Clean air: second in Category II
8. **Mainpuri** — Sauj Lake Ramsar
9. **Pilibhit** — Leopard safari, APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) centre
10. **Shahjahanpur** — Airstrip on the expressway
11. **Hardoi** — Expressway inauguration
12. **Sitapur** — 250 MW solar
13. **Lucknow** — Creative City of Gastronomy
14. **Kanpur** — India-France aeronautics centre
15. **Unnao** — Aluminium can plant
16. **Raebareli** — Bachhrawan industrial area
17. **Amethi** — IRRPL (Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited), Korwa
18. **Ayodhya** — Deepotsav Guinness
19. **Gorakhpur** — First forestry university
20. **Ballia** — Surha Tal Ramsar
21. **Varanasi** — Sarnath, ropeway, hydrogen vessel
22. **Mirzapur** — Chhannulal Mishra
23. **Prayagraj** — Magh Mela, end of the expressway
24. **Jhansi** — Parichha dam, 600 MW solar
25. **Banda** — Kalinjar geo-heritage

14.1 Western Uttar Pradesh

1 Meerut

Also the Hastinapur area

1. **Starting point** of the Ganga Expressway
2. **Major Dhyan Chand Sports University**
3. Parallel events of Parakram Diwas 2026
4. **Hastinapur** (barasingha sanctuary expansion): Meerut, Muzaffarnagar, Hapur, Bijnor, Amroha · draft notification of a **408.7 sq km** eco-sensitive zone (Union Environment Ministry)

2 Saharanpur region

213 km

1. **Delhi-Dehradun Economic Corridor**: 6-lane, ₹12,000 crore+, 3 states · in UP Ghaziabad, Baghpat, Shamli, Saharanpur
2. **School Chalo Abhiyan Phase-2** (1-31 July; 100% enrolment; ₹163.60 lakh) from here
3. Lucknow-Saharanpur Vande Bharat

4 Aligarh

Ramsar 22 April

1. **Sheikha Lake** — India's **99th** Ramsar
2. Proposed district **"Kalyan Singh Nagar"**: Atrauli and Gangiri (Aligarh) + Dibai (Bulandshahr) tehsils

! **Trap** "Kalyan Singh Nagar" only a proposal for now — UP still has **75** districts

8 Mainpuri

Ramsar 15 October

1. **Sauj Lake** — India's **103rd**, UP's **14th** Ramsar

3 Gautam Buddh Nagar

1. **Noida International Airport (Jewar)** — first phase inaugurated on **28 March 2026** (PM) · cost ₹11,282 crore · capacity 1.2 crore passengers/year · Delhi-NCR's second international airport
2. 9 October 2026: UP Cabinet approved a proposal to name it **"Narendra Modi International Airport, Noida-Jewar"**

5 Mathura

1. India's first **National Cow Culture Museum**

6 Agra

1. Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, Fatehpur Sikri — UP's **three** World Heritage Sites before Sarnath

7 Firozabad

1. Joint second in Swachh Vayu Survekshan **Category II** (with Guntur)

14.2 Awadh and Central Uttar Pradesh

13 · Lucknow — Capital: One City, Many Stories

UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization)	Creative City (**Gastronomy**) · October 2025, Samarkand (43rd session) · India's **9th** creative city · second in gastronomy after Hyderabad
Air	**First in Category I** of Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026 (NCAP)
BRICS	Meeting of heads of National Statistical Offices (3-4 August; 350+) · 18th BRICS Academic Forum (24 August)
Army	Country's first **Department of Military Medicine** at the Command Hospital (Central Command) (Rajnath Singh, about 29 July)
Science	**Prakriti Gyan Dham** (CSIR-NBRI, Banthra; 8 August; Dr. Jitendra Singh) · **Param Shavak DL** to IET Lucknow (C-DAC Pune; GPU version of "supercomputer in a box")
New Bacterium	*Microbacterium pollutisoli* · HCH-contaminated dumpsite at Ummari village (30 cm depth) · DU + CSIR-IMTECH (Council of Scientific and Industrial Research) · thrives from 12°C to 46°C
Events	UP Diwas 2026 (24 January; inaugurated by Amit Shah; **"One District One Cuisine"** launched) · Kakori nearby

Parts of Prakriti Gyan Dham: Pavan Path (heritage path) · Indian Heritage Garden (tamarind tree of Bawan Imli, mother Dussehri mango tree) · Vibhav Enclave (rare-endangered plants) · Bhairav Enclave · bambusetum of 43 species

Trap: the new bacterium does not break down HCH, it tolerates it and lives · Param Shavak DL is not India's first AI supercomputer

14 Kanpur

1. **India-France National Centre of Excellence in Aeronautics** (the other four: Ludhiana, Hyderabad, Chennai, Bhubaneswar)
2. **Paraunkh** in Kanpur Dehat — Ram Nath Kovind's village

15 Unnao

₹2,078.44 crore

1. **Crown Packaging India**'s aluminium beverage can plant
2. Under the FDI (Foreign Direct Investment)-Fortune 500 policy · foundation stone **11 September**

16 Raebareli (Bachhrawan)

104 sq km

1. The state's **largest industrial area** (about 25,700 acres) · Lucknow Development Authority · 25 years, 4 phases
2. Investment target **₹26,000 crore** · 2.5 lakh+ direct jobs
3. 150-hectare logistics hub on NH-30 (₹1,300 crore)
4. Industries: automobiles, railway equipment, defence, food processing, cement, ceramics, building materials, warehousing

17 Amethi (Korwa)

Defence

1. **IRRPL** plant (more in 14.9)
2. Fully indigenous automatic and burst-firing test of AK-203 **"Sher"** on **23 August** · Army evaluation in September

10 Shahjahanpur

1. **3.5 km emergency airstrip** on the Ganga Expressway
2. The Kakori revolutionaries boarded the train here

11 Hardoi

29 April

1. **Inauguration** of the Ganga Expressway (PM Modi)
2. Among the top 5 districts of the CM Yuva Udyami Abhiyan

9 Pilibhit

1. APEDA's **₹15 crore** farmer training centre proposed (basmati, organic)
2. First **leopard safari park** in Pilibhit-Shahjahanpur (1,716 hectares; ₹49.44 crore)

12 Sitapur

1. **250 MW** solar project · Defence Ministry approval · with battery energy storage (BESS)

18 Ayodhya

Guinness

1. Deepotsav 2025: **26.17 lakh** lamps on the Saryu bank
2. **Ashfaqulla** hanged in Faizabad jail (1927)

14.3 Purvanchal

21 · Varanasi — Kashi: The City of "Firsts"

Sarnath	World Heritage on **25 July 2026** · 48th session **Busan** (20-29 July) · criteria (iii) and (vi) · on the Tentative List since 1998 · the lion capital of the National Emblem comes from here
Hydrogen Vessel	**11 December 2025** · country's first indigenous hydrogen fuel-cell passenger ship · Namo Ghat to Lalita Ghat
Ropeway	India's first **urban public-transport ropeway** · Cantt station to Godowlia · 3.85 km · about 96,000 passengers/day
Electric Boat	Battery-boat pilot service on the Ganga
Guinness	**2,51,446 saplings** in one hour at Sujabad-Domri (Ganga bank) · broke China's 1,53,981 · Miyawaki urban forest "Namo Van"
Rail-Air	Four Vande Bharats (8 November 2025, from here): Banaras-Khajuraho, Lucknow-Saharanpur, Firozpur-Delhi, Ernakulam-Bengaluru · first hub-and-spoke aviation service Varanasi-Delhi (Air India)
And	72nd National Volleyball Championship · launch of Poshan Maah 2026 · about 32 GI (Geographical Indication) products of the Kashi region

Static

1. Components of Sarnath: Chaukhandi Stupa, Dhamek Stupa, Dharmarajika Stupa, Mulagandha Kuti Vihar, Ashoka Pillar
2. India sixth in the world, second in Asia-Pacific by number of World Heritage Sites
3. UP's four World Heritage Sites: Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, Fatehpur Sikri, Sarnath

23 Prayagraj

1. **Magh Mela**: 3 January (Paush Purnima) to 15 February (Mahashivratri); Mauni Amavasya 18 January
2. **End point** of the Ganga Expressway
3. Birthplace of Dhyan Chand (29 August 1905; family later in Jhansi)
4. Whitley Award to **Parveen Shaikh** (Ganga basin) — Indian skimmer (90% of the global population in India) · Whitley Gold: Farwiza Farhan (Indonesia)
5. Harshit Lokheran: junior vault gold at the 19th Asian Artistic Gymnastics (China)
6. Roshan Singh hanged in Naini jail · Azad's sacrifice at Alfred Park

19 Gorakhpur

1. First **forestry university** (forestry-horticulture; 125 acres; about ₹491 crore)
2. Bansgaon block: North Zone first in Aspirational Blocks Delta (₹1.5 crore)
3. **Divya Singh** — first Indian woman to hoist the tri-colour at Everest Base Camp (5,364 m) by bicycle
4. Bismil hanged in Gorakhpur jail · Gorakhpur-Saharanpur corridor (₹34,000 crore, in the budget)

20 Ballia

Ramsar 5 June

1. Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (**Surha Tal**) — India's **100th** Ramsar

22 Mirzapur

1. Death of Pt. **Chhannulal Mishra** (October 2025; 89 years; born 1936 Azamgarh; Padma Vibhushan) — khayal, thumri, dadra, chaiti, kajri

Yuva Udyami Abhiyan: Top 5 Districts

1. Jaunpur · Azamgarh · Hardoi · Ambedkar Nagar · Jhansi

Timeline — UP's Three New Ramsar Sites (2026)

22 April — Sheikha Lake · Aligarh
India 99 · UP 12

5 June — Surha Tal (JPN Bird Sanctuary) · Ballia
India 100 · UP 13

15 October — Sauj Lake · Mainpuri
India 103 · UP 14

India's 100th Ramsar is in UP — Surha Tal

14.4 Bundelkhand

24 Jhansi

WHIS 13 August

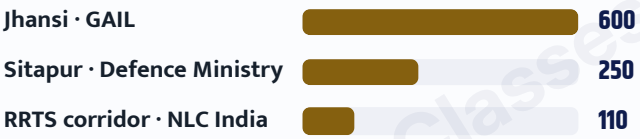
Betwa river · headworks of the Betwa canal system

1. **Parichha dam**: built 1881-86 · 1,174 m long · 16.8 m above the riverbed · 318 steel gates
2. ICID (International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage) declared it a World Heritage Irrigation Structure (WHIS) on **13 August** · medal 14 October, **Marseille** (ICID's 26th congress, 77th executive council)
3. First WHIS (World Heritage Irrigation Structure) of the region: Sukwan-Dukwan dam (2022)
4. **600 MW solar park** (15 April; agreement between GAIL and TUSCO) · 5th in Swachh Vayu Survekshan Category II

25 Banda and the Whole Region

1. **Kalinjar Fort** — GSI (Geological Survey of India)'s National Geo-heritage Site
2. Special subsidy for Bundelkhand-Purvanchal in the data centre policy

Bar **Three Solar Projects (MW)**



Remember each of the three with its partner

Chart **The 12 Districts of the Ganga Expressway — West to East, 594 km**



6-lane greenfield (expandable to 8-lane) · ₹36,230 crore

14.5 The State Economy: Budget and Growth

Board

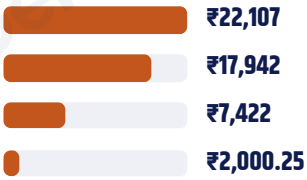
Main Budget vs Supplementary (2026-27)

Main budget · 11 February

- Size **₹9,12,696 crore**
- Largest share **education** (12.4%)
- Agriculture 9% · medical 6%
- Finance Minister Suresh Khanna · capital outlay about ₹1.78 lakh crore
- Fiscal deficit limit 3% of GSDP (till 2030-31)
- 14 new medical colleges · UP AI Mission · 8 data centre parks (900 MW)
- Destitute women's pension ₹3,500 crore · scooty for meritorious girls (Cabinet July)
- Target: 1 trillion dollars by about 2029-30

Supplementary · 4 August

- Size **₹59,019.54 crore** (about 6.5%)
- Largest share **heavy-medium industries**
- Education not even mentioned



(₹ crore)

Bar

GSDP: More Than Dodoubled in Eight Years



UPI (June 2026): UP second — 122.2 crore transactions, 5.38% (first Maharashtra) · also among the top states in e-Shram registration

Bar

GI Tags: Comparison of States (IP India, 2 May 2026)



822 in all in the country · UP 81 as per PIB (December 2025) — different counting method · GI Registry under DPIIT (Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade), in Chennai

Table

UP Number 1: Schemes and Rankings

Jan Dhan accounts	**10.67 crore** (7 October 2026)
Ayushman cards	**5.46 crore**
Beneficiaries	PMAY, Ujjwala, Stand-Up India — most in all three
Ease of doing business	First in reducing compliance burden · "Top Performer" in startup ranking
Solar share	2.3% (2016-17) to **27%** (2025-26)
APAAR ID	Schools 2.93 crore+ · higher education 73.20 lakh+
Cooperation	First state to start celebrating the International Year of Cooperatives 2025

14.6 New Policies and Schemes

Startup Policy 2026

6 July

1. Target: **1 trillion dollar** contribution to GDP by 2030 · nodal: UP Startup Mission
2. Dedicated fund **₹1,000 crore** · AKTU startup fund ₹400 crore · at least one incubator in every district

Startup Incentives: Old → New

Prototype, seed doubled

Sustenance allowance	₹17,500/month, 1 year → **₹20,000/month, 2 years**
Prototype grant	₹5 lakh → **₹10 lakh**
Seed funding	₹7.5 lakh → **₹15 lakh**

Data Centre Policy 2026

Replaces the 2021 policy

1. **₹2 lakh crore+** direct investment · about **2 GW** additional capacity
2. Focus on AI-GPU, green technology · jobs 7,500 long-term + 50,000 short-term

Mukhyamantri Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan

24 January 2025

1. **10 lakh** micro enterprises in 10 years · age 21-40 · minimum 8th pass
2. Interest-free, collateral-free loan up to **₹5 lakh**

Sardar Patel Employment and Industrial Zone Programme

1. Initial budget **₹575 crore** · an industrial cluster of at least **50 acres** in every district

Clean Air Management Programme

Tripartite

1. World Bank + Government of India + UP · 10 years (2 years grace) · loan **299.66 million dollars**
2. About 200 monitoring stations · private investment target about 150 million dollars

Other Schemes

1. Plantation drive 12 July (**35 crore** saplings)
2. Safe Mobility Programme: about 1,000 e-rickshaws to SHG (Self-Help Group) women
3. **"4E model"** of Road Safety Month (January): education, enforcement, engineering, emergency care
4. RRTS (Regional Rapid Transit System) corridor solar 110 MW — contract to NLC India

14.7 Governance and Elections

Electoral Roll SIR

From 27 October 2025

1. Final roll **10 April 2026** · about **13.4 crore** voters
2. About 2 crore names removed (dead, shifted, duplicate)

Census 2027, First Phase

1. Self-enumeration **7-21 May 2026** (portal)
2. House listing and housing census 22 May-20 June (door to door)

Panchayat

1. Pradhans' term ended on **26 May 2026**, no elections · pradhans themselves administrators for six months (till about end of November)
2. OBC commission for the triple test · elections possible after the 2027 Assembly polls

Institutions and Judiciary

1. 38 state + 52 private universities
2. Justice **Mahesh Chandra Tripathi** (Allahabad HC) the **50th** Chief Justice of the Bombay HC on 9 September 2026
3. Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra recommended for the Punjab-Haryana HC
4. Dr. Dinesh Sharma (former Deputy CM) Lieutenant Governor of Andaman-Nicobar

14.8 Agriculture: Where UP Leads

Bar **UP's Share of the Country (%, 2024-25)**



First in all except mushroom · India 4.27 lakh tonnes of mushroom

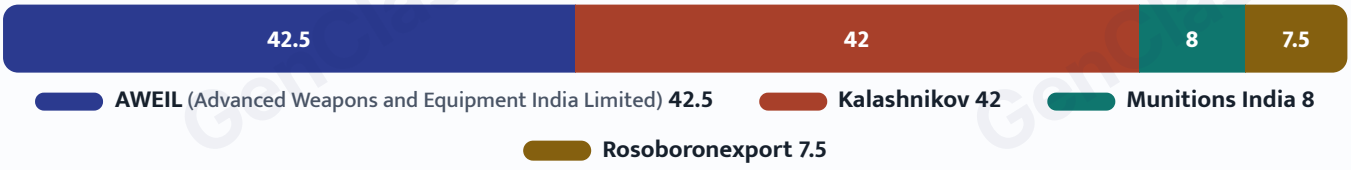
Where Else It Leads

1. First: **potato, mango, guava, amla, mentha oil**
2. 42.27% of ethanol supply · 54.5% of sugarcane-based ethanol
3. In rice second is Telangana, then West Bengal
4. **Fourth in pulses** (after MP, Rajasthan, Maharashtra)
5. Agricultural growth 2024-25: **17.7%** · fourth in Export Preparedness Index 2024 (7th in 2022) · first among landlocked states
6. Mushroom: state subsidy 40-50% · as per FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization), in the world China, Japan, Poland (China always first)

! **Trap** UP is not first in pulses but fourth · second in rice is Telangana, not Punjab

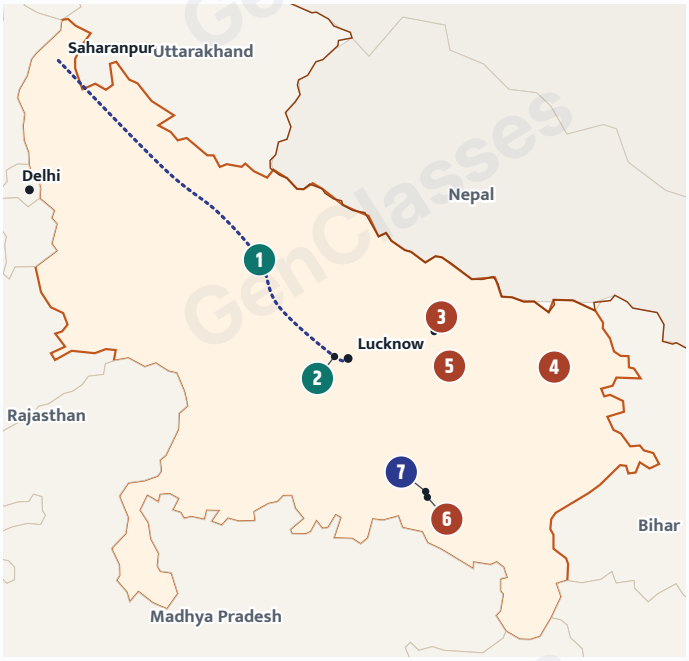
14.9 Defence Production and Kakori

Diagram **Indo-Russian Rifles (IRRPL), Korwa — Shareholding (%)**



Founded **3 March 2019** · contract for 6,01,427 rifles · Indian majority (AWEIL + Munitions India = 50.5%) · trap: the largest single share is AWEIL's (42.5%), not Kalashnikov's (42%)

Map **Kakori Train Action: Where They Boarded, Where They Were Hanged (1925-1931)**



9 August 1925	**1·2** 8-Down Saharanpur-Lucknow passenger · 10 revolutionaries boarded at Shahjahanpur · Lahiri pulled the chain at Kakori · about ₹8,000 treasury · German Mauser C-96 · accidental death of one passenger · about 40 arrested later
6 April 1927	Special court verdict
16 September 1927	Privy Council in London rejected the appeal
17 December 1927	**3** Rajendra Nath Lahiri — Gonda jail (first of all)
19 December 1927	**4** Bismil — Gorakhpur · **5** Ashfaqulla — Faizabad · **6** Roshan Singh — Naini
1928	Azad turned the HRA (Hindustan Republican Association) into the HSRA (Hindustan Socialist Republican Association)
27 February 1931	**7** Azad's sacrifice, Alfred Park (Prayagraj)

Ten names: Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Rajendra Nath Lahiri, Chandrashekhar Azad, Sachindra Bakshi, Keshav Chakravarty, Manmathnath Gupta, Mukundi Lal, Murari Lal Khanna, Banwari Lal · all four hanging-jails in UP

14.10 Pride of the State: People and Honours

Board **Padma Shri 2026: UP's 10 (Field-wise)**

Medicine (3)

- Kewal Krishan Thakral
- Rajendra Prasad
- Shyam Sundar

Art (2)

- Anil Rastogi
- Chiranji Lal Yadav

One Each

- Ashok Singh (science)
- Buddha Rashmi Mani (archaeology)
- Mangla Kapoor (literature-education)
- Praveen Kumar (sports, para high jump)
- Raghupat Singh (agriculture, posthumous)

The country's sports Padma Shri 2026: Baldev Singh (hockey), Bhagwandas Rai Raikwar (Bundeli martial art), Harmanpreet Kaur, K. Pazhanivel (silambam), Praveen Kumar, Rohit Sharma, Savita Punia, Vladimer Mestvirishvili (posthumous, wrestling, Georgia)

UP Gaurav Samman 2026

1. **Shubhanshu Shukla** (space)
2. Alakh Pandey and Rashmi Arya (education)
3. Hariom Pawar (literature)
4. Sudhanshu Singh (agriculture)

Education-Literature-Handloom

1. National Teachers' Award: Renu Tripathi, Iftikhar Khan, Shalini Kushwaha
2. Sant Kabir Handloom Award: Shah Muhammad Ansari (Zarbaft Shwetambari Awadh Jamdani)
3. Asim Mandal (BHU), leader of the winning team at the National Handloom Hackathon (IIHT Sutra)
4. Hindi books honoured at FIP: "India 2026", "Dharti Ki Sehat", "Rangoli Roop Sur Lay Ki", "Yojana"

Sports

1. **Arjuna** to Rajkumar Pal (hockey)
2. Asmita Dey: 48 kg judo gold at Glasgow (originally from Tripura, sub-inspector in UP Police)
3. State sports awards: **Lakshman** (men) and **Rani Laxmibai** (women), from ₹3.11 lakh to ₹10 lakh

Ram Nath Kovind

1. 14th President · village Paraunkh (Kanpur Dehat)
2. Autobiography launched **12 August 2026**

Points to Note

1. "Kalyan Singh Nagar" only a proposal — still 75 districts
2. Three solar projects: 600 Jhansi (GAIL) · 250 Sitapur (Defence Ministry) · 110 RRTS (NLC India)
3. Largest share in the supplementary budget heavy-medium industries; education not mentioned
4. IRRPL: largest single share AWEIL (42.5%), Kalashnikov 42%
5. UP fourth in pulses · second in rice Telangana
6. India's 100th Ramsar Surha Tal (Ballia); UP's 14th Sauj (Mainpuri)
7. Kakori: Lahiri hanged first (Gonda, 17 December) — the other three on 19 December
8. GI: UP 79 (IP India) vs 81 (PIB) — different counting method
9. First district with 100% insurance coverage Alwar (Rajasthan) — not one in UP
10. The new bacterium tolerates HCH, does not break it down

15 Quick Revision

At a Glance

1. Read only this chapter on the day before the exam
2. Every line of "firsts" is a possible question
3. Upcoming dates: useful for interviews and Mains too
4. 40 questions at the end: cover the answers, solve, then check

One Rule: Three Questions for Every "First"

A **Who/where?** — state, district, village, person

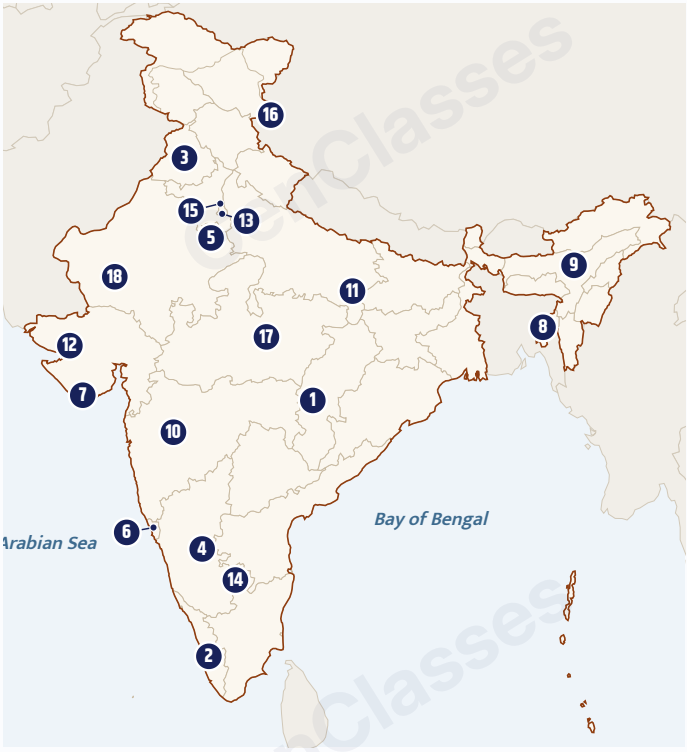
B **In what?** — the exact word of the achievement (water-positive, caste-free...)

C **First within what scope?** — country, state, woman, Arab, Asia

The examiner traps with the third question: turns "first in the state" into "first in the country".

"Firsts" — Compilation

Map States, Governance, Transport, Energy — "Firsts" on the Map



1. Balod (Chhattisgarh) — first **child-marriage-free district**
2. Kerala — **free of extreme poverty** (self-declared) · senior citizens department
3. Punjab — revised BharatNet 100% · "Pehchaan" portal · **AI a core subject** in classes 1-12
4. Karnataka — **paid menstrual leave** in government + private
5. Rajasthan — electoral roll 100% digital · first **Namo Biodiversity Park** (Alwar)
6. Goa — police: 100% action on the 1930 helpline · first direct cargo mission to Antarctica from **Mopa**
7. Mitiyaj (Gir Somnath) — first **night gram panchayat**
8. Tripura — State Innovation Mission
9. Assam — **matcha tea** production
10. Saundala (Maharashtra) — the state's first **caste-free village**
11. Varanasi — hydrogen passenger ship · urban transport ropeway
12. Kandla — **electric green tug** · green methanol plant
13. IGI Delhi — **water-positive** airport
14. Kempegowda (Bengaluru) — ACI (Airports Council International) Level-3 accessibility
15. Sonipat — first **e-truck battery swapping** station (5 minutes; Gadkari)
16. Mig La (Ladakh) — highest motorable road (**19,400 feet**)
17. Nauradehi (MP) — **third home** of cheetahs
18. Pachpadra (Balotra) — first **greenfield integrated refinery-petrochemical** complex

In technology: **Dhruv64** (C-DAC) — indigenous 64-bit RISC-V processor

Table "Firsts" — People

Khaled El-Enany	First **Arab** UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) Director-General
Sonali Ghosh · Jayashree Venkatesan	First Indians to get the Kenton Miller and Ramsar Wise Use awards
Annapurni Subramaniam	COSPAR (Committee on Space Research) Sarabhai Medal — first Indian woman
Jyothi Surekha Vennam	World Cup Final medal — first Indian woman archer
Sheetal Devi	Armless archer — world para gold
Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty	First woman president of the Press Club of India
Dr. Manali Kshirsagar	First full-time woman Vice-Chancellor of Nagpur University
Kunchala Kaivalya Reddy (17)	Selected for four-year astronaut training in Florida
Menaka Guruswamy	First openly LGBTQ+ MP
Ritika Shree	First transgender cricket umpire

15.1 Leftover Exam-Useful Facts

Beauty Pageants

Miss Universe India 2026

1. **Kaziya Liz Mejo** (19; born in UAE; from Mavelikkara, Alappuzha) · 23 August, Zee Studios Jaipur · crowned by Manika Vishwakarma (2025) · 52 contestants
2. 75th Miss Universe: Puerto Rico (November) · runners-up Vaishnavi Ganesh (for Miss International), Anushree Satavlekar, Tejaswini Srivastava, Anubha Vashishtha Chaudhary
3. 61st Femina Miss India (Bhubaneswar): **Sadhvi Satish Sail** (Goa) · runner-up Rajnandini Pawar
4. 73rd Miss World (5 September, Vietnam): **Joheiry Mola** (Dominican Republic) · Nikita Porwal out of the top 20
5. Geetanjali Omprakash — first Indian to win "Mrs International World Classic" (Kuala Lumpur)

72nd Nehru Trophy Boat Race

22 August

Punnamada Lake, Alappuzha

1. Winner **"Aroma Chundan"** — on debut (4:23.328)
2. Runner-up Nadubhagam Chundan (0.12 seconds behind)
3. 71 boats including 22 chundan vallams
4. Since 1952 — Nehru's silver trophy

Skill and Knowledge Contests

1. **WorldSkills 2026** (48th, Shanghai): India 6 silver + 20 Medallions for Excellence, **10th** (best ever) · China first
2. Linguistics Olympiad: "India Saffron" and "India Green" teams · India since 2009, 37 medals (IIIT Hyderabad) · IOL 2027 Bangkok
3. Bharat Buildcon 2026: "One Nation, One Expo"

Other Facts

1. **Maharshi Sushruta**: Royal College of Surgeons of Edinburgh unveiled a 90 kg bronze statue on 13 June 2026
2. **Scouting**: Baden-Powell 1907, Brownsea Island · in India 1909, Bengaluru · Bharat Scouts and Guides 7 November 1950

Table — Word of the Year 2025

Collins	**vibe coding**
Oxford	**rage bait**
Cambridge	**parasocial**
Merriam-Webster	**slop**

All four words from internet culture — Oxford's "rage bait" is asked the most

Board — Science Olympiads 2026: India's Score

Physics (56th)	Chemistry (58th)	Biology (37th)
Bucaramanga, Colombia	Tashkent	Vilnius, Lithuania
5/5 gold · joint first among 87 countries	**4/4 gold** · joint first	1 gold Bhavya Gunwal (Haryana) · 3 silver

IPhO team: Kanishk Jain, Riddhesh Bendale, Rishit Garg, Shreshth Suraiya, Swarit Joshi · **IChO team:** Debdutta Priyadarshi, Harshit Singla, Kabir Chillar, Sandeep Kuchi · **IBO silver:** Saumil Maity, Nishit Kalani, Anmol Kumar

Upcoming Events: November 2026 to 2027

Calendar Upcoming Dates (and Recently Passed)

October 2026
Just passed

19-30
CBD (Convention on Biological Diversity) COP-17, Yerevan

20
India-New Zealand FTA (Free Trade Agreement) in force

November 2026
This month

7
Close of the Vande Mataram 150 years celebration

9
Booker 2026 announced

9-20
COP-31, Antalya

13
DPDP (Digital Personal Data Protection) consent manager framework in force

24 Nov.-12 Dec.
World Chess Championship, Geneva

25-26
Calcutta HC hearing on Great Nicobar

27
First UN Day: ending child and forced marriage

30
Aravalli definition committee report

December 2026
Year end

2-4
RBI (Reserve Bank of India) monetary policy review

14-15
G20 summit, Miami

23
Tripura's final electoral roll

31
Guterres's term ends

—
Target for signing the India-EU FTA · target for Gaganyaan G1 (end of 2026)

2027
Ahead

Start
39th National Games, Meghalaya

9 February
CJI (Chief Justice of India) Surya Kant retires

8-12 February
Aero India, Bengaluru

9-28 February
Census Phase 2 · 14-28 February Women's Champions Trophy (India)

May (approx.)
8th Pay Commission report · 13 May remaining DPDP obligations

! Points to Note

1. Saundala — first caste-free village of the state (Maharashtra), not of the country
2. Kerala's freedom from extreme poverty is self-declared
3. IGI Delhi water-positive; Kempegowda ACI Level-3 accessibility — don't swap them
4. Nauradehi the third home of cheetahs (after Kuno, Gandhi Sagar)
5. Word of the Year: Oxford "rage bait", Collins "vibe coding"
6. India 10th at WorldSkills 2026 (best ever) — first China
7. COP-31 Antalya (Türkiye) · CBD COP-17 Yerevan (Armenia)
8. 5/5 gold in IPhO, 4/4 gold in IChO — joint first in both

16 Budget and Economic Survey 2026: India and Uttar Pradesh

At a Glance

1. Economic Survey 2025-26 (**29 January 2026**): GDP growth **7.4%** in FY26 · FY27 projection **6.8-7.2%**
2. Union Budget 2026-27 (**1 February 2026, Sunday**): total expenditure **₹53.47 lakh crore** · fiscal deficit **4.3%**
3. UP's **first separate Economic Review** (**9 February 2026**): GSDP (Gross State Domestic Product) **₹30.25 lakh crore** (2024-25)
4. UP Budget 2026-27 (**11 February 2026**): **₹9,12,696.35 crore** · fiscal deficit **2.98%** of GSDP

One Rule: Four Documents, Four Dates

- **A** **29 January** — Union Economic Survey 2025-26
- **B** **1 February** — Union Budget 2026-27
- **C** **9 February** — UP Economic Review 2025-26
- **D** **11 February** — UP Budget 2026-27

The Survey reviews the past year (FY26); the Budget plans the coming year (2026-27).

16.1 Economic Survey 2025-26: Growth and Structure of the Economy

Outline of the Survey and Growth Projections

29 January 2026

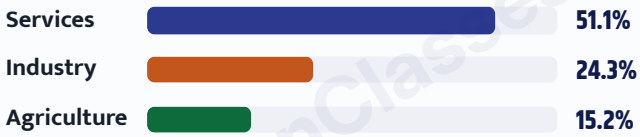
1. The table of contents has **16 chapters** (Chapter 16 in Part I and II); the preface says "seventeen chapters"
2. Real GDP growth in FY26 **7.4%** · FY27 projection **6.8%-7.2%**
3. Private consumption **61.5%** of GDP (FY26) — **highest since FY12**

Financial Inclusion and Social Security

1. Jan Dhan: **55.02 crore** accounts (March 2025), of which **36.63 crore** rural/semi-urban
2. More than **31 crore** unorganised workers registered on the e-Shram portal (January 2026)

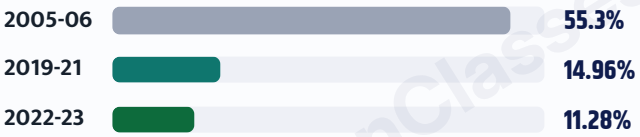
! **Trap** 55.02 crore Jan Dhan accounts is the March 2025 figure; at 12 years (August 2026) it reached 59.09 crore.

Chart Sector-wise Share in GDP (FY26, First Advance Estimates)



Services **56.4%** of GVA (FY26 FAE (First Advance Estimates)) · services **53.6%** of GDP in H1 FY26 · agriculture was 16.3% in FY25, **15.2%** in FY26 · industry **24.3%**, not 29-31%

Chart Decline in Multidimensional Poverty (MPI)



Fell to about **one-fifth** between 2005-06 and 2022-23

Table **Employment (PLFS) and Industrial Output (IIP) — December 2025**

Indicator	Value	Note
Unemployment rate	**4.8%**	Up from 4.7% in November 2025
Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR)	**56.1%**	Female LFPR (Labour Force Participation Rate) **35.3%**
Worker Population Ratio (WPR)	**53.4%**	—
IIP (Index of Industrial Production) **growth**	**7.8%**	Manufacturing 8.1%, mining 6.8%, electricity 6.3%

Source: Economic Survey 2025-26; MoSPI PLFS (Periodic Labour Force Survey) press note (December 2025) and IIP quick estimates (28 January 2026)

16.2 Economic Survey: Foreign Trade, Investment and Infrastructure

Board **External Sector at a Glance**

1. Remittances FY25: about **$135.4 billion** — India the world's **largest recipient**
2. Total exports (goods + services) FY25: **$825.3 billion** (record)
3. India's share in world services exports: about **2%** (2005) → **4.3%** (2024)
4. Share in world merchandise exports: **1%** (2005) → **1.8%** (2024)
5. **80.2%** of FDI (Foreign Direct Investment) in the services sector (FY23-FY25 average)
6. India **fourth** in the world in greenfield investment announcements in 2024; **1,080** projects
7. Foreign exchange reserves: **$701.4 billion** (16 January 2026; RBI (Reserve Bank of India))

Chart **FY25: Top Export Destinations ($ billion)**

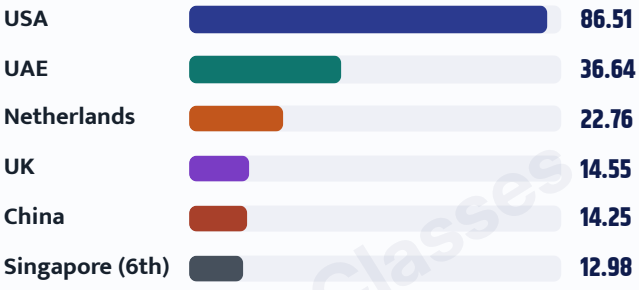


Chart **FY25: Top Import Sources ($ billion)**

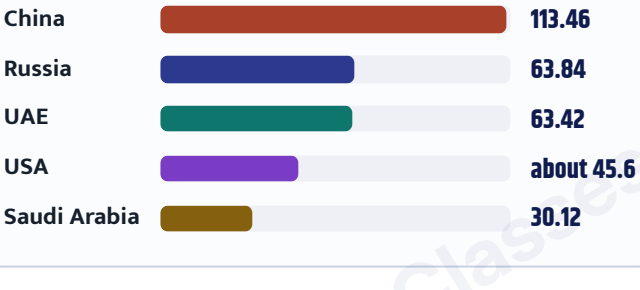


Table **FY25: Top Export and Import Items**

Rank	Top export item	Top import item
1	Engineering — **$116.67 billion**	Petroleum and crude oil — **$185.78 billion**
2	Petroleum — $63.34 billion	Electronics — $98.73 billion
3	Chemicals and drugs (combined) — $59.17 billion	Gold — $58.01 billion
4	Electronics — $38.58 billion	Machinery — $53.55 billion
5	Gems and jewellery — $29.82 billion	Transport equipment — $33.16 billion

Fertilisers are not in the top 5 imports; **coal ($31.09 billion)** is sixth.

Agriculture, Energy and Water

1. Foodgrain output 2024-25: **357.73 million tonnes** (record; +25.43 MMT over the previous year)
2. Installed power capacity: **509.74 GW** (November 2025)
3. Share of renewables in total capacity: **49.83%** (30 November 2025)
4. India **fourth** in the world in total renewable capacity (IRENA; after China, the US and Brazil); the Survey's "third" refers to **solar power**
5. Jal Jeevan Mission: tap water to **more than 81%** of rural households by October 2025

Trap Fourth in renewable capacity, third in solar — two different facts.

Aviation and Highways

1. Domestic aviation market **third** in the world
2. Airports **74** (2014) → **164** (2025)
3. National highways **91,287 km** (2013-14) → **1,46,572 km** (December 2025)

Chart **Expansion of National Highways (km)**



16.3 Union Budget 2026-27: Fiscal Figures and Allocations

Background of the Budget

1 February 2026 · Sunday

1. First Union Budget presented on a **Sunday**; the Finance Minister's **9th in a row**
2. Record for most budgets: **Morarji Desai (10)**
3. First budget prepared in **Kartavya Bhawan**; theme **"Yuva Shakti-driven"**
4. The 1999-2000 budget came on 27 February 1999 (**Saturday**), not Sunday

Trap The first Sunday budget is 2026; the 1999 one was on a Saturday.

Three Kartavyas of the Budget

1. **Momentum and stability** to economic growth
2. **Fulfilling aspirations** and building capacity
3. **Sabka Sath, Sabka Vikas**

Total and Capital Expenditure

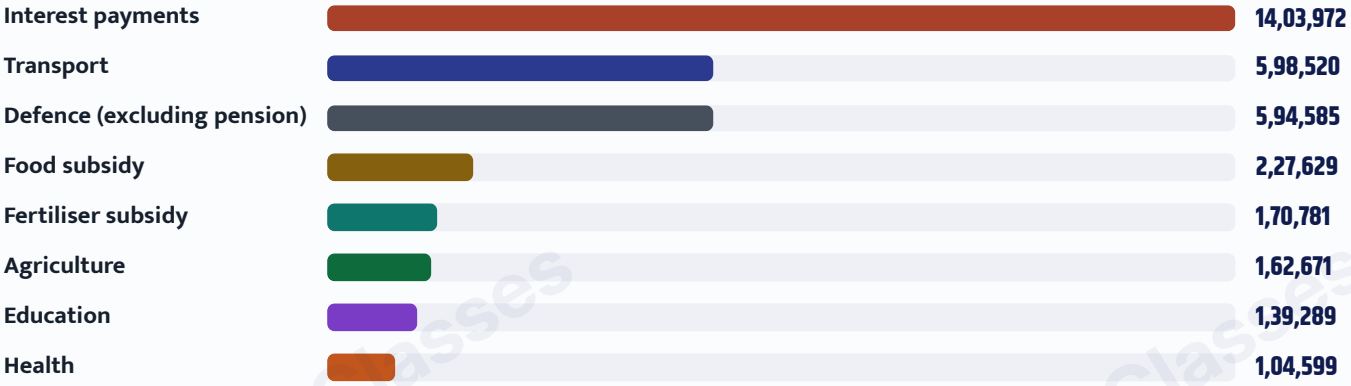
1. Total expenditure ≈ **₹53.47 lakh crore** — **7.7%** more than RE 2025-26 (₹49.65 lakh crore)
2. Capital expenditure ≈ **₹12.22 lakh crore**

Table **Deficit Indicators (% of GDP)**

Indicator	2024-25 (Actual)	2025-26 (RE)	2026-27 (BE)
Fiscal deficit	4.8%	4.4%	**4.3%**
Revenue deficit	1.7%	—	1.5%
Effective revenue deficit (ERD)	0.9%	0.6%	0.3%
Primary deficit (PD)	1.4%	0.8%	0.7%

The 4.4% fiscal deficit is for 2025-26 (RE); the target for 2026-27 (BE) is 4.3%.

Chart **Allocation to Major Heads (₹ crore)**



Total defence allocation including pensions is **₹7,84,678 crore**.

Table **Major Schemes and Bodies: Allocation**

Scheme / head	Allocation
PMGKAY (Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana)	₹2,27,429 crore
VB-G RAM G	₹95,692 crore (₹30,000 crore for MGNREGA; interim allocation)
Jal Jeevan Mission (Centre)	₹67,670 crore
PM-KISAN	₹63,500 crore
NHAI (National Highways Authority of India)	₹1,87,293 crore
Road construction	₹1,21,999 crore
Railways — total capex	₹2,93,030 crore
Railways — Gross Budgetary Support (GBS)	₹2,78,030 crore

The ₹2,78,030 crore for railways is "Gross Budgetary Support (GBS)", not "gross budgetary outlay".

16.4 Union Budget 2026-27: Major Announcements

Taxation

1. **No change in income tax slabs and rates**
2. **New Income Tax Act from 1 April 2026**

7 High-Speed Rail Corridors

1. Mumbai-Pune · Pune-Hyderabad · Hyderabad-Bengaluru
2. Hyderabad-Chennai · Chennai-Bengaluru
3. Delhi-Varanasi · Varanasi-Siliguri

Two touch UP: Delhi-Varanasi and Varanasi-Siliguri.

Table **Industry, Manufacturing and Innovation**

Initiative	Key fact
Biopharma Shakti Mission	₹10,000 crore (5 years)
India Semiconductor Mission 2.0	ISM (India Semiconductor Mission) 2.0
SME Growth Fund	₹10,000 crore ("Champion MSMEs")
CCUS (Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage) **programme**	₹20,000 crore (5 years)
City Economic Regions (CER)	₹5,000 crore per CER (5 years)
Chemical parks	3
Legacy industrial clusters	200

Waterways

1. **20 new National Waterways** (in 5 years), starting with **NW-5 (Odisha)**
2. Ship-repair ecosystem at **Varanasi and Patna**

! **Trap** Waterways, not highways.

Health, Education and Institutions

1. **5 regional medical hubs** (medical tourism)
2. **3 new Ayurveda institutes** (AIIA); **NIMHANS-2** (National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro-Sciences) (North India); upgrade of institutes at Ranchi and Tezpur
3. NCHMCT (National Council for Hotel Management and Catering Technology) upgraded into a **National Institute of Hospitality** (headquarters: **Noida, UP**)
4. **One new National Institute of Design (NID)** in the eastern region — no number in the speech; with the existing 5 NIDs it will be the **sixth**
5. **5 university townships**

Culture and Tourism

1. **15 archaeological sites**; seven named in the speech: **Lothal, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Adichanallur, Sarnath, Hastinapur, Leh Palace**
2. **National Destination Digital Knowledge Grid**
3. Tourist guide skilling pilot (**10,000 guides**); **5 tourist sites** in Purvodaya states; **Buddhist circuit**

Agriculture, Rural Livelihood and Others

1. **Bharat-VISTAAR**: multilingual AI tool — linking AgriStack and ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) packages with AI
2. **SHE-Marts**: built on the success of Lakhpati Didi; community retail outlets of cluster federations of self-help groups
3. **Coconut Promotion Scheme**
4. **Gram Swaraj initiative**; integrated development of **500 reservoirs/Amrit Sarovars**; **sports goods initiative**; **Durgapur East Coast Corridor node**

List **5 Sub-components of the Integrated Textile Programme**

1. National Fibre Scheme
2. Textile Expansion and Employment Scheme
3. National Handloom and Handicraft Programme
4. Tex-Eco
5. Samarth 2.0

Timeline **Global Big Cat Summit (under IBCA)**

Budget 2026-27	First-ever hosting in India announced (Budget Speech para 70)
1 June 2026	Proposed date in New Delhi
21/22 May 2026	Summit postponed
8 August 2026	MEA: new date not yet fixed

16.5 Uttar Pradesh Economic Review 2025-26

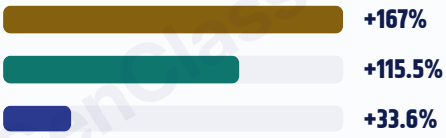
Uttar Pradesh presented its separate Economic Review **for the first time** on **9 February 2026**. Note: UP is not the "first state" to do so; many states already publish their own economic surveys.

Table **UP Economy: 2016-17 vs 2024-25**

Indicator	2016-17	2024-25	Note
GSDP	₹13.30 lakh crore	**₹30.25 lakh crore**	More than doubled; 2025-26 estimate about ₹36 lakh crore
Share in national GDP	8.6%	**9.1%**	—
Per capita income (NSDP)	₹54,564	**₹1,09,844**	2025-26 estimate ₹1,20,000
Per capita GSDP	₹61,142	₹1,26,304	—
State budget	₹3.47 lakh crore	₹8.33 lakh crore (2025-26)	—

Per capita income as a share of the national average: **50.2%** (2014-15) → **53.5%** (2024-25).

Chart **Agriculture and Animal Husbandry: Growth in 8 Years**



UP **first** in milk production — about **15.66%** of the country (388.15 lakh MT) · irrigated area **2.16** → **2.76 crore hectares** · cropping intensity **162.7%** → **193.7%** · **first state** to give agricultural input subsidy through DBT (Direct Benefit Transfer)

Chart **PM Awas (Gramin): UP Third, Not First**



Number of completed houses — Lok Sabha unstarred question 447 (21 July 2026), Annexure-II

List UP at the National Level: First Place

1. **PMJDY** (Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana): 10,66,99,894 accounts (7 October 2026); Bihar second (7,06,94,953); 10.22 crore in the Review
2. **Ujjwala**: 1,89,78,084 connections (1 July 2026)
3. **PM Awas (Urban)**: 17,31,873 completed (28 September 2026); Andhra 11,46,350; Maharashtra 11,02,917
4. **Ayushman cards**: 5.46 crore (January 2026), highest in the country (5.38 crore in September 2025)
5. **Rural toilets**: 2.74 crore individual toilets, highest in the country
6. **Government procurement on GeM** (Government e-Marketplace): about 30% in FY25, ₹16,828.75 crore
7. First in **milk production**
8. First in reducing **compliance burden** (Invest UP, 16 January 2026)
9. First in use of the **e-Prosecution** system

Other Rankings and Achievements

1. Export Preparedness Index (**EPI**) **2024** (NITI Aayog, January 2026): UP **fourth**; **first** among landlocked large states; was **7th** in EPI (Environmental Performance Index) 2022
2. Startup ecosystem ranking (5th edition): **Top Performer, Category A**
3. **38 state universities** and **52 private universities**
4. **3 sports colleges** running (Lucknow, Gorakhpur, Saifai); 3 more under construction in 2026-27; Major Dhyan Chand Sports University in **Meerut**
5. **9 July 2025**: **37,21,40,925** saplings planted in a single day
6. **Ayodhya Deepotsav 2025**: **26,17,215** lamps; two **Guinness World Records** certificates (October 2025)

! **Trap** Here EPI = Export Preparedness Index (NITI Aayog), not the environmental EPI.

16.6 Uttar Pradesh Budget 2026-27

Size of the Budget

11 February 2026 | Suresh Kumar Khanna

1. Presented: **11 February 2026**, Finance Minister **Suresh Kumar Khanna**
2. Total budget **₹9,12,696.35 crore** — **12.9%** more than last year's BE (₹8,08,736.06 crore)
3. New schemes: **₹43,565.33 crore**

Chart Sector-wise Share (% of Total Budget)

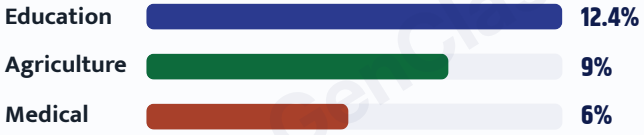


Table Receipts and Expenditure (₹ crore)

Head	Amount
Total receipts	8,48,233.18
— Revenue receipts	7,28,928.12
— Capital receipts	1,19,305.06
Revenue expenditure	6,64,470.55
Total capital expenditure	2,48,225.80
Capital outlay	1,77,744.12 (19.5%)
Fiscal deficit	**1,18,480.59 (2.98% of GSDP)**

The FRBM (Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management) limit is 3%, with an extra 0.5% allowed for power-sector reforms.

Health and Medical Education

1. Medical, health and family welfare **₹37,956 crore** (15% more than 2025-26)
2. National Rural Health Mission **₹8,641 crore**; AYUSH **₹2,867 crore**; Ayushman Bharat (national) **₹2,000 crore**
3. Medical education **₹14,997 crore**; 14 new medical colleges **₹1,023 crore**
4. Ayushman-Mukhyamantri Jan Arogya **₹500 crore**; cancer institute (Lucknow) **₹315 crore**; incurable diseases **₹130 crore**

Digital, AI and Infrastructure

1. **8 data centre parks**; **₹30,000 crore** investment; **900 MW** target
2. **UP AI Mission ₹225 crore**; **AI-Pragya** programme (with Microsoft, Google, Intel, IBM and others)
3. City Economic Region **₹100 crore**; Cyber Security Operations Centre **₹95.16 crore**
4. Jal Jeevan Mission **₹22,452 crore**; PM Gram Sadak Yojana **₹822 crore**

Table Industry, MSME and Employment

Scheme / head	Provision
Infrastructure and industrial development	₹27,103 crore (+13%)
Handloom and textiles	₹5,041 crore (more than five-fold); 30,000 jobs
CM Industrial Area Expansion Scheme	₹5,000 crore
MSME (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) **schemes**	₹3,822 crore (+19%)
Atal Infrastructure Mission	₹2,000 crore
Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan	₹1,000 crore
Sardar Patel Employment and Industrial Zone (new)	₹575 crore
Yuva Swarozgar Yojana	₹225 crore
One District One Cuisine	₹75 crore

Social Welfare and Education

1. Destitute women pension **₹3,500 crore**; Swami Vivekananda Yuva Sashaktikaran **₹2,374 crore**
2. Mass marriage grant **₹51,000** → **₹1.01 lakh**; budget **₹750 crore**
3. Rani Laxmibai Scooty Yojana **₹400 crore**; Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana **₹400 crore**
4. New universities: Swami Shukdevanand (**Shahjahanpur**) ₹21 crore; Kashi Naresh (**Bhadohi**) ₹21 crore

Environment and Cooperation

1. Target of **35 crore** saplings in monsoon 2026
2. India's **first state** to launch the **International Year of Cooperatives 2025**

Points to Note

1. Survey **29 January**, Union Budget **1 February (Sunday)**, UP Review **9 February**, UP Budget **11 February**
2. FY26 growth **7.4%**; FY27 projection **6.8-7.2%** — do not mix them
3. Services **51.1%** of GDP but **56.4%** of GVA; industry **24.3%**, agriculture **15.2%**
4. India **fourth** in renewable capacity (IRENA); "third" is for solar
5. Largest export destination **USA**; largest import source **China**; sixth import is **coal**, fertiliser not in top 5
6. Fiscal deficit: **4.4%** = 2025-26 (RE), **4.3%** = 2026-27 (BE)
7. Record of 10 budgets: **Morarji Desai**; the 1999 budget came on a **Saturday**
8. Railways ₹2,78,030 crore = **Gross Budgetary Support (GBS)**; total capex ₹2,93,030 crore
9. New NID (National Institute of Design) in the eastern region — the **sixth**; NCHMCT headquarters **Noida**; 20 new waterways begin with **NW-5 (Odisha)**
10. UP is **not the first state** with a separate economic review; UP **third** in PM Awas (Gramin) (MP first)
11. Largest share in UP budget: **education 12.4%**; fiscal deficit **2.98%** (FRBM limit 3%)

17 Supplement Update: Uttar Pradesh, Indices, Schemes, Defence, Awards and Appointments

At a Glance

1. **First woman Director General** of GSI (Geological Survey of India) — **Varsha Ashok Aglawe** (54th DG; GSI founded 1851)
2. Index of Economic Freedom: India **128th in 2025, 132nd in 2026** · Singapore on top
3. UPSC (Union Public Service Commission) Chairman **Dr. Ajay Kumar** · Chairman of the 23rd Law Commission **Justice Dinesh Maheshwari**
4. Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve (Spiti) joins the UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) network — India's **13th**
5. Ramsar Wetland City: **Indore and Udaipur** — India's first two cities

One Rule: Check Both the Spelling and the Year

- **A** **Name** — Aglawe, Karikot, UP-AGREES (look-alike wrong forms appear in options)
- **B** **Year** — the same index has different ranks in 2025 and 2026
- **C** **Edition** — first or second (Bharatiya Kala Mahotsav is the second)
- **D** **Category** — jury vs popular choice (Republic Day tableaux)

This is where examiners trap you: right person, wrong spelling; right index, wrong year.

17.1 Lock These In Before the Exam

Trap Right Fact, Right Spelling

1. **Index of Economic Freedom** (The Heritage Foundation): India **128th** in 2025, **132nd** in 2026 ("mostly unfree" category); **Singapore** on top — check the year in the question
2. **First woman DG of GSI**: **Varsha Ashok Aglawe** (not "Kawade") — 54th DG, from August 2026; predecessor Asit Saha · GSI founded in **1851**
3. **Award-winning village of Bahraich**: **Karikot** (not "Karkot") — near Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary; Indian Subcontinent Responsible Tourism Award 2025 for inclusive rural tourism
4. **World Bank's UP agriculture project**: **UP-AGREES** (not "UP-AGRIS") — UP Agriculture Growth and Rural Enterprise Ecosystem Strengthening; **28 districts** of Purvanchal and Bundelkhand
5. **77th Republic Day 2026, tableaux**: jury — Maharashtra (Ganeshotsav), Jammu and Kashmir, Kerala · popular choice — Gujarat ("Swadeshi ka Mantra: Vande Mataram"), **Uttar Pradesh** (culture of Bundelkhand), Rajasthan
6. **Bharatiya Kala Mahotsav, Secunderabad**: this was the **second** edition (first in September 2024) — inaugurated by President Droupadi Murmu, November 2025, Rashtrapati Nilayam
7. **UP in Swachh Survekshan and National Water Awards**: Prayagraj — Best Ganga Town; Lucknow — third among new clean cities (after Ahmedabad, Bhopal); Gorakhpur — Best Safaimitra Surakshit Shehar; 6th Water Award — best district of the North Zone **Mirzapur**, **Agra** joint third among urban local bodies

17.2 Uttar Pradesh Special: Schemes, Agreements, Firsts

Schemes, Agreements and Administration

1. **Kukrail Night Safari** (Lucknow): India's **first night safari** and zoo in the Kukrail reserve forest, on the Singapore model — billed as the world's fifth night safari
2. **UP-AGREES**: World Bank + UP government, about **₹3,900 crore** (World Bank loan about ₹2,737 crore); farm productivity and rural enterprise in 28 districts
3. **Project GANGA** (Government Assisted Network for Growth and Advancement): UP government + **Hinduja Group** — fast broadband to 20 lakh rural households
4. **Yaksh app**: AI-based app of UP Police — criminal database and real-time monitoring of beat policing
5. **UP Outsource Seva Nigam (UPCOS)**: to protect about 3.5 lakh outsourced workers from middlemen and wage cuts; ₹20 crore interest-free loan approved by the cabinet
6. **UP State Minorities Commission**: former minister **Mohsin Raza** appointed chairman

AI, Education and Judiciary: UP "Firsts"

1. India's **first AI-enabled state university pilot**: **Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut** (Skill Development Ministry + Google Cloud)
2. India's first **private AI-augmented multidisciplinary campus**: Chandigarh University, **Unnao**
3. UP's first district to use AI in judicial proceedings: **Sambhal district court** (AI transcription of witness statements)
4. **UP Regional AI Impact Conference 2026**: 12-13 January 2026, The Centrum hotel, Lucknow

! **Trap** AI university pilot is in Meerut, private AI campus in Unnao — two different facts.

List **New Centres, Museums, Industrial Parks and Events**

1. **Lucknow** — UP's first **Zero Fresh Waste Dump City**; 100% daily solid waste processing at the Shivri plant
2. UP's first **state-level Braille library** — Dr. Shakuntala Misra National Rehabilitation University, Lucknow
3. India's first **glass museum** — the glass city of **Firozabad**
4. UP's first **footwear park** — **Ramaipur**, Kanpur, 131 acres; master design by IIT Bombay
5. **Floating bathing ghat on the Saryu** — Ayodhya
6. Purvanchal's first **yarn processing plant** — Lalganj area of Mirzapur (for carpet exporters)
7. **Green Hydrogen Centres of Excellence** — IIT Kanpur and IIT BHU (UP Green Hydrogen Policy 2024)
8. **Jal Setu Centre of Excellence** — Greater Noida campus of Western Sydney University (Australia)
9. **Kavach 4.0** — remaining **712 route km** of Moradabad rail division, ₹170 crore
10. **4th UP International Trade Show** — 25-29 September 2026, India Expo Centre and Mart, Greater Noida
11. **Kashi Tamil Sangamam 4.0** — from 2 December 2025, Varanasi (Ministry of Education)
12. **5th Gomti Book Festival** — 12-20 September 2026, Lucknow University (National Book Trust)
13. Heritage: Swami Shri Haridas auditorium (Gita Research Institute, Mathura-Vrindavan) · **Maharishi Bhrigu Corridor, Ballia** (₹100 crore) · Maithilisharan Gupt state museum, **Chirgaon (Jhansi)** (₹24 crore)

17.3 Indices and Rankings

Table **India's Rank, Top Countries and Publisher**

Index	India	Top	Publisher
Energy Transition Index 2026	**70th** (up two places)	Sweden, Finland, Denmark	World Economic Forum (WEF)
V-Dem Democracy Report 2026	Electoral democracy **106th**, liberal democracy **105th**	Denmark, Norway, Sweden	V-Dem Institute, Sweden
Global Soft Power Index 2026	**32nd** (30th in 2025)	USA, China	Brand Finance (193 countries)
Index of Economic Freedom	128th in 2025, **132nd** in 2026	Singapore	The Heritage Foundation
Network Readiness Index 2025	**45th** (up four places)	USA	Portulans Institute, Washington
IMD (India Meteorological Department) **World Talent Ranking**	**63rd**	—	International Institute for Management Development
Global AI Brain Race 2026	**Sixth** (score 32)	USA (82), China, Singapore	—
SIPRI (military spending / arms imports)	**Fifth** in spending, **second** in imports	Spending: USA, China, Russia, Germany, India	SIPRI, Stockholm
Global Cities Index 2026	Delhi top in India — **268th**	New York, London, Paris (1,000 cities)	Oxford Economics
Work From Anywhere Index 2026	**Mumbai 50th** (only Indian city)	Bangkok	International Workplace Group
Skytrax World Airline Awards 2026	Air India **57th**, top in South Asia	Singapore Airlines, Qatar Airways	Skytrax

17.4 Central and State Schemes and Portals

Big Schemes and Missions

1. **PM Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana** (ELI): Labour Ministry, **₹99,446 crore** · **3.5 crore** new jobs in two years · up to ₹15,000 in two instalments on the first formal job
2. **RDI** (Research, Development and Innovation) **Scheme** (Research, Development and Innovation): **₹1 lakh crore** fund under the Anusandhan National Research Foundation — private R&D, deep-tech, sunrise sectors
3. **National Critical Mineral Mission**: Ministry of Mines, 7 years, **₹34,300 crore** (government ₹16,300 + PSUs ₹18,000)
4. **MERITE scheme**: reforms in 275 technical institutions, ₹4,200 crore
5. **Tapti Basin Mega Recharge**: Madhya Pradesh-Maharashtra, about ₹19,244 crore (inter-state groundwater recharge)

Portals and Digital Initiatives

1. **DHRUVA** (Digital Hub for Reference and Unique Virtual Address): Department of Posts — a unique digital address for every premises
2. **NAKSHA** (National geospatial Knowledge-based land Survey of urban HabitAtions): Department of Land Resources; pilot from **Raisen (MP)**
3. **Sahyog portal**: I4C (Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre) of the Home Ministry — notices to remove unlawful content under the IT Act 2000
4. **Pratibha Setu**: UPSC — links candidates who reached the interview but were not selected with employers
5. **SHRESTH** (State Health Regulatory Excellence Index): Health Ministry + CDSCO (Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation) — measures states' drug-regulatory systems

Targeted Initiatives

1. **BHARATI**: APEDA (Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority) — farm exports through 100 agri-food startups
2. **WE-RISE**: NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform + DP World — women's products to global markets
3. **NAVYA**: WCD + Skill Ministry — non-traditional vocational training for girls aged 16-18
4. **Apna Ghar**: Petroleum Ministry — rest facilities for truck drivers at highway fuel stations
5. **Vishwas scheme**: EPFO (Employees' Provident Fund Organisation) — rationalising penal damages to cut litigation

ULLAS: Fully Literate

1. First among Union Territories: **Ladakh**
2. States in order: **Mizoram** (first), Goa, Tripura, Himachal Pradesh, Sikkim

> ! **Trap** Ladakh first among UTs; Mizoram first among states.

17.5 Defence, Science and Space

Weapons, Warships and Bases

1. **Dhvani**: DRDO (Defence Research and Development Organisation)'s indigenous **hypersonic glide vehicle** (above Mach 5)
2. First foreign buyer of **Astra Mk-1** (BVR air-to-air missile): **Indonesia**
3. **INS Tamal (F71)**: Yantar Shipyard, Kaliningrad (Russia) — India's **last** major warship built abroad
4. **INS Anjadip**: third ASW (Anti-Submarine Warfare) shallow water craft by GRSE (Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers) Kolkata — 27 February 2026, Chennai
5. **Nyoma airbase** (eastern Ladakh): about 13,700 ft near the LAC (Line of Actual Control), built by BRO (Border Roads Organisation); inaugurated by Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh landing a C-130J

! **Trap** Dhvani = hypersonic glide vehicle; Astra's buyer is Indonesia.

Partnerships, Industry and Expeditions

1. India-Sweden pact for **Shukrayaan-1**: ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) + Swedish National Space Agency — **Venusian Neutrals Analyzer** payload
2. India's first **overseas defence manufacturing plant**: **Berrechid (Morocco)**, Tata Advanced Systems — WhAP 8x8 armoured vehicles
3. **Safran Aircraft Engine Services, Hyderabad**: global repair facility for LEAP engines (inaugurated by PM Modi)
4. **Samudra Pradakshina**: first all-women tri-service round-the-world sailing expedition — vessel **IASV** (Indian Army Sailing Vessel) **Triveni**

Table **Major Military Exercises 2026**

Exercise	Partners	When / where
16th Vajra Prahar	India-USA (special forces)	24 February-16 March 2026, Bakloh (Himachal Pradesh)
7th Dharma Guardian	India-Japan	24 February-9 March 2026, Chaubatia (Uttarakhand)
11th Lamitiye	India-Seychelles	March 2026, Seychelles — first time with an Indian tri-service contingent
17th Dosti	India, Sri Lanka, Maldives (coast guards)	January 2026, Male
6th VINBAX	India-Vietnam	Hanoi
Pragati 2026	Multilateral	Umroi (Meghalaya)
Ocean Sky	Spain's air force exercise	India the first non-NATO country to take part

17.6 Awards, Environment, Conferences and Appointments

Table **77th Republic Day Parade 2026: Awards**

Category	Jury	Popular choice
State tableau	Maharashtra, Jammu and Kashmir, Kerala	Gujarat, **Uttar Pradesh**, Rajasthan
Ministry tableau	Ministry of Culture	Department of School Education and Literacy
Marching contingent (three services)	Indian Navy	Assam Regiment
Marching contingent (CAPF)	Delhi Police	CRPF (Central Reserve Police Force)

Awards

1. **6th National Water Awards**: best states Maharashtra, Gujarat, Haryana · North Zone district **Mirzapur** · urban bodies: Navi Mumbai, Bhavnagar, joint third Agra and Nabadiganta
2. **Swachh Survekshan 2024-25**: Indore, Surat, Navi Mumbai in the "Super Swachh League" · new top cities: Ahmedabad, Bhopal, Lucknow · Prayagraj Best Ganga Town · Gorakhpur Best Safaimitra Surakshit Shehar
3. **Grammy 2026**: first Grammy for the Dalai Lama — "Meditations: The Reflections of His Holiness the Dalai Lama" (Best Audio Book, Narration and Storytelling Recording)
4. First **Global M.S. Swaminathan Award for Food and Peace**: Prof. Ademola Adenle (Nigeria)
5. **Tyler Prize 2026** ("Nobel of the environment"): Dr. Toby Kiers — underground fungal networks
6. **President's Nishan**: Sikkim Police (28 May 2026, Gangtok) — **15th** state to receive it · **Wings India 2026** (Hyderabad): Uttarakhand best state

Environment and Conferences

1. **Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve** (Spiti, Himachal) in UNESCO's MAB (Man and the Biosphere) network — India's **13th**
2. **Ramsar Wetland City**: Indore and Udaipur — India's first two
3. New name of **Ratapani Tiger Reserve** (MP): **Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar Tiger Reserve** (discoverer of Bhimbetka)
4. **9th Indian Ocean Conference**: 10-12 April 2026, Port Louis (Mauritius)
5. **11th India International Science Festival**: 6-9 December 2025, Panchkula; theme "Vigyan se Samriddhi: for Aatmanirbhar Bharat"
6. **60th DGP/IGP Conference**: November 2025, Raipur · **10th India Mobile Congress**: October 2026, Yashobhoomi (New Delhi)

Table Key Appointments

Post	Name	Note
IOC (International Olympic Committee) **President**	**Kirsty Coventry** (Zimbabwe)	First woman and first African
UN Tourism Secretary-General	**Shaikha Nasser Al Nowais** (UAE)	First woman; 2026-2029
Commonwealth Secretary-General	**Shirley Ayorkor Botchwey** (Ghana)	Seventh; first African woman
GSI Director General	**Varsha Ashok Aglawe**	54th; first woman
RPF (Railway Protection Force) **Director General**	**Sonali Mishra**	First woman
UPSC Chairman	**Dr. Ajay Kumar**	Former Defence Secretary
23rd Law Commission, Chairman	**Justice Dinesh Maheshwari**	Former Supreme Court judge
PM's Economic Advisory Council, Chairman	**Prof. S. Mahendra Dev**	—
RAW (Research and Analysis Wing) **chief**	**Parag Jain**	Succeeded Ravi Sinha
NIA (National Investigation Agency) / **CISF** (Central Industrial Security Force) / **BSF** (Border Security Force) / **ITBP** (Indo-Tibetan Border Police) **Director General**	Rakesh Aggarwal / Praveer Ranjan / **Praveen Kumar** / Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor	Praveen Kumar moved from ITBP to BSF (January 2026)
India's Executive Director at the IMF (International Monetary Fund)	**Dr. Urjit Patel**	Former RBI (Reserve Bank of India) Governor
BCCI (Board of Control for Cricket in India) **President**	**Mithun Manhas**	Elected unopposed at the 94th AGM (Annual General Meeting)

Points to Note

1. GSI DG **Aglawe**, Bahraich village **Karikot**, project **UP-AGREES** — watch the spelling
2. Economic freedom: **128 (2025)** vs **132 (2026)** · soft power: **30 (2025)** vs **32 (2026)**
3. UP **second** in popular-choice tableaux (Gujarat first); Maharashtra first in the jury list
4. Bharatiya Kala Mahotsav, Secunderabad — the **second** edition
5. ULLAS: **Ladakh** first among UTs, **Mizoram** first among states
6. INS Tamal — the **last** major warship built abroad; overseas defence plant — **Morocco**
7. Cold Desert — India's **13th** UNESCO biosphere; Ramsar Wetland Cities — **Indore, Udaipur**
8. Sikkim Police — **15th** state to receive the President's Nishan

18 | Practice — 370 Questions (with Answers)

Chapter 01 · International Relations

1. The "Bhopal Declaration" of BRICS 2026 is linked to the ministerial meeting of which sector?

(A) Tourism (B) Culture
(C) Agriculture (D) Health

B **Correct answer: (B) Culture** — It came from the 11th Culture Ministers' meeting (8 August); the tourism meeting produced the "Jaipur Declaration".

2. Among the countries elected to the UNSC for 2027-28, which became a non-permanent member for the first time?

(A) Portugal (B) Austria
(C) Kyrgyzstan (D) Zimbabwe

C **Correct answer: (C) Kyrgyzstan** — Kyrgyzstan was elected for the first time; the others have been members before.

3. Consider the following statements about the "Correct the Map" resolution:

1. It was moved by Togo on behalf of the African Group.
2. It is binding on member states.
3. Only the US voted against it.

Choose the correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 1 and 3 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 3 only** — The resolution is not binding; it only encourages adopting "Equal Earth".

4. When did the first Indian Prime Minister address Israel's parliament, the "Knesset"?

(A) July 2017 (B) February 2026
(C) May 2026 (D) June 2025

B **Correct answer: (B) February 2026** — During the Israel visit of 25-26 February 2026; he also received the "Speaker of the Knesset Medal".

5. Arrange the countries leaving OPEC in correct chronological order:

1. Angola
2. Qatar
3. UAE
4. Ecuador

(A) 2-4-1-3 (B) 4-2-1-3
(C) 2-1-4-3 (D) 1-2-4-3

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-4-1-3** — Qatar 2019 → Ecuador 2020 → Angola 2024 → UAE 2026.

6. Match the following (military operation — country):

List-I	List-II
A. Epic Fury	1. Pakistan
B. Roaring Lion	2. Iran
C. True Promise 4	3. Israel
D. Ghazab lil-Haq	4. USA

(A) A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1 (B) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1 (C) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (D) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1** — Epic Fury the US, Roaring Lion Israel, True Promise 4 Iran, Ghazab lil-Haq Pakistan.

7. About the 2026 "Islamabad MoU":

1. Trump and Pezeshkian signed it electronically.
2. It allowed 60 days for a final agreement.
3. Qatar was its mediator.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 only
(B) 1 and 2 only
(C) 2 and 3 only
(D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; the third is wrong because the Islamabad MoU (17-18 June 2026) was mediated by Pakistan, not Qatar.

8. Where was the Iranian warship IRIS Dena sunk?

(A) Strait of Hormuz
(B) Gulf of Aden
(C) Near Galle, Sri Lanka
(D) Andaman Sea

C **Correct answer: (C) Near Galle, Sri Lanka** — On 4 March 2026, torpedoed by a US submarine; the ship was returning from MILAN.

9. Which countries are part of the "Makkah Joint Defence Pact" (7 August 2026)?

(A) Saudi Arabia, UAE, Pakistan
(B) Saudi Arabia, Türkiye, Pakistan
(C) Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Türkiye
(D) Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Pakistan

B **Correct answer: (B) Saudi Arabia, Türkiye, Pakistan** — Saudi, Türkiye, Pakistan — "an attack on one is an attack on all".

10. About the 18th BRICS summit:

1. India held the chair for the fourth time.
2. Bangladesh was the special guest.
3. Brazil will be the chair in 2027.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only
(B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only
(D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; the third is wrong because after India, China will chair BRICS in 2027.

11. At the 26th SCO summit (Bishkek), which Indian initiative found a place in the SCO Charter?

(A) Hindi as an official language
(B) English as an official language
(C) A common digital currency
(D) A joint peacekeeping force

B **Correct answer: (B) English as an official language** — Earlier the SCO's official languages were only Russian and Chinese.

12. About Khalilur Rahman, President of the 81st UNGA session:

1. He is Bangladesh's foreign minister.
2. He defeated Cyprus's candidate.
3. He is the first Bangladeshi to become UNGA President.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only
(B) 1 only
(C) 2 and 3 only
(D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — Humayun Rasheed Choudhury (41st session, 1986) was the first Bangladeshi President.

13. Where was the 52nd G-7 summit (June 2026) held?

(A) Kananaskis
(B) Evian-les-Bains
(C) Hiroshima
(D) Apulia

B **Correct answer: (B) Evian-les-Bains** — At Evian-les-Bains, France, 15-17 June; 2025 was Kananaskis (Canada).

14. What is India's status in the "Board of Peace" set up for Gaza?

(A) Founding member
(B) Permanent member
(C) Observer
(D) Co-chair

C **Correct answer: (C) Observer** — India joined the first meeting (19 February) as an observer.

15. Where was NATO's 2026 summit held?

(A) The Hague
(B) Washington
(C) Ankara
(D) Vilnius

C **Correct answer: (C) Ankara** — NATO's 2026 summit was held in Ankara, Türkiye's capital, on 7-8 July; the 2025 summit was in The Hague, Netherlands.

16. Match the following (leader — country):

List-I	List-II
A. Sanae Takaichi	1. Morocco
B. Balen Shah	2. Netherlands
C. Fatima Zahra El Mansouri	3. Japan
D. Rob Jetten	4. Nepal

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (C) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — Takaichi Japan, Balen Shah Nepal, Mansouri Morocco, Jetten the Netherlands.

17. Which is the first country to ban social media use by children under 16?

(A) France (B) Spain
(C) Australia (D) Indonesia

C **Correct answer: (C) Australia** — Australia, from 10 December 2025; Spain is the first European country.

18. Arrange PM Modi's 2026 visits in the correct order:

1. Israel
2. Seychelles
3. Malaysia
4. New Zealand

(A) 3-1-2-4 (B) 1-3-2-4
(C) 3-1-4-2 (D) 3-2-1-4

A **Correct answer: (A) 3-1-2-4** — Malaysia (7-8 February) → Israel (25-26 February) → Seychelles (27-29 June) → New Zealand (10-11 July).

19. "Pax Silica" is related to:

(A) A solar panel trade alliance (B) A US initiative on the AI-semiconductor supply chain
(C) An Indian Ocean maritime security agreement (D) An international treaty on silica mining

B **Correct answer: (B) A US initiative on the AI-semiconductor supply chain** — Launched in December 2025; India joined on 20 February 2026.

20. The Strait of Hormuz lies between which two countries?

(A) Iran and UAE (B) Iran and Oman
(C) Saudi Arabia and Iran (D) Oman and Yemen

B **Correct answer: (B) Iran and Oman** — Oman's Musandam Peninsula lies on the southern shore of Hormuz.

Chapter 02 · Parliament, Judiciary and Elections

21. What was the proposed maximum strength of the Lok Sabha in the 131st Constitutional Amendment Bill?

(A) 550 (B) 815
(C) 850 (D) 888

C **Correct answer: (C) 850** — The bill proposed a maximum Lok Sabha strength of 850 — 815 members from the states and 35 from the Union Territories.

22. Which majority is required to remove the Lok Sabha Speaker?

(A) Simple majority (B) Effective majority
(C) Special majority (D) Special majority + ratification by half the states

B **Correct answer: (B) Effective majority** — Art. 94: effective majority, 14 days' notice.

23. Consider the following statements about renaming to "Keralam":

1. It was done under Article 3.
2. It needed a special majority under Article 368.
3. The state legislature's views are not binding on Parliament.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 1 and 3 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 3 only** — Because of Art. 4 this is not an amendment; it was done by a simple majority.

24. In the Lok Sabha vote on the 131st Amendment Bill, how many votes were "in favour" and "required" respectively?

(A) 298 and 352 (B) 230 and 352
(C) 298 and 272 (D) 352 and 362

A **Correct answer: (A) 298 and 352** — Two-thirds of the 528 members present is 352, but only 298 voted in favour — so the bill was defeated.

25. Who are the mascots of Census 2027?

(A) Pragati and Vikas (B) Unnati and Pragati
(C) Jan and Gan (D) Bharat and Bharati

A **Correct answer: (A) Pragati and Vikas** — Mascots "Pragati" (female) and "Vikas" (male), 5 March 2026.

26. Where is the country's first fully paperless district court?

(A) Gangtok (B) Kalpetta (Wayanad)
(C) Patna (D) Lucknow

B **Correct answer: (B) Kalpetta (Wayanad)** — 6 January 2026; Sikkim is the first paperless state judiciary.

27. Match the following (state — new Chief Minister in 2026):

List-I	List-II
A. W. Bengal	1. Vijay
B. Tamil Nadu	2. Samrat Choudhary
C. Kerala	3. Suvendu Adhikari
D. Bihar	4. V.D. Satheesan

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4 (D) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — Bengal Suvendu, Tamil Nadu Vijay, Kerala Satheesan, Bihar Samrat Choudhary.

28. Arrange the number of Supreme Court judges (including CJI) in chronological order:

1. 31
2. 18
3. 26
4. 34

(A) 2-3-1-4 (B) 2-1-3-4
(C) 3-2-1-4 (D) 1-2-3-4

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-3-1-4** — 18 in 1977 → 26 in 1986 → 31 in 2008 → 34 in 2019.

29. In the Harish Rana case (2026), what did the Supreme Court permit?

(A) Active euthanasia (B) Direct passive euthanasia
(C) Ending the living will (D) A stay on the death penalty

B **Correct answer: (B) Direct passive euthanasia** — First direct passive euthanasia; earlier Aruna Shanbaug (2011).

30. Under which Article was menstrual health recognised as a right?

(A) Article 14 (B) Article 21
(C) Article 21A (D) Article 47

B **Correct answer: (B) Article 21** — Under the right to life (Art. 21); sanitary pads in every school.

31. What is the name of the PMO's new building?

(A) Kartavya Path (B) Seva Teerth
(C) Lok Bhavan (D) Jan Seva Sadan

B **Correct answer: (B) Seva Teerth** — Inaugurated 13 February 2026; Raj Bhavan is now "Lok Bhavan".

32. Which laws were repealed by the SHANTI Act 2025?

1. Atomic Energy Act 1962
2. Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act 2010
3. Environment Protection Act 1986

Choose the correct answer:

(A) 1 only (B) 1 and 2 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 2 only** — Both nuclear laws repealed; not the environment law.

33. What is the punishment for a paper leak under the Public Examinations Amendment 2026?

(A) 3-5 years, ₹10 lakh (B) 5-10 years, up to ₹50 lakh
(C) 7 years to life (D) 10 years, ₹1 crore

B **Correct answer: (B) 5-10 years, up to ₹50 lakh** — After the amendment a paper leak attracts 5-10 years in jail and a fine of up to ₹50 lakh; earlier it was 3-5 years and ₹10 lakh.

34. Who is in line to become the first woman Chief Justice?

(A) Hima Kohli (B) B.V. Nagarathna
(C) Bela Trivedi (D) Indira Banerjee

B **Correct answer: (B) B.V. Nagarathna** — For about 36 days, till 30 October 2027.

35. UP's panchayat that received the "Nanaji Deshmukh" award in the National Panchayat Awards 2025:

(A) Muddi (B) Girharu (Agra)
(C) Telkap (D) Shansha

B **Correct answer: (B) Girharu (Agra)** — Girharu (Agra) and Telkap (Rohtas, Bihar).

36. Who chairs the JPC on the FCRA Amendment Bill 2026?

(A) P.P. Chaudhary (B) Dr. Sanjay Jaiswal
(C) D. Purandeswari (D) Jagdambika Pal

B **Correct answer: (B) Dr. Sanjay Jaiswal** — A 31-member JPC; P.P. Chaudhary chairs the "One Nation One Election" JPC.

37. How many districts does Ladakh have after April 2026?

(A) 2 (B) 5
(C) 7 (D) 9

C **Correct answer: (C) 7** — Ladakh earlier had only two districts, Leh and Kargil; with 5 new districts in April 2026 the total became 7.

38. Correct statements about NITI Aayog:

1. It is a constitutional body.
2. It was set up on 1 January 2015 by an executive resolution.
3. Since April 2026 its Vice-Chairperson is Ashok Kumar Lahiri.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 2 and 3 only** — The first statement is wrong because NITI Aayog was set up by an executive resolution — it is neither a constitutional nor a statutory body; the second and third are correct.

39. Who declares geo-heritage sites (such as the Yana caves)?

(A) ASI (B) GSI
(C) UNESCO (D) Ministry of Environment

B **Correct answer: (B) GSI** — National geo-heritage sites are declared by the Geological Survey of India (GSI); the ASI conserves archaeological monuments.

40. What is correct about Aadhaar in the SIR of electoral rolls?

(A) It is proof of citizenship (B) It is the 12th valid document, not proof of citizenship
(C) It is the only mandatory document (D) It was excluded from the list

B **Correct answer: (B) It is the 12th valid document, not proof of citizenship** — Aadhaar is a document of identity, not of citizenship.

Chapter 03 · Economy

41. Which new criterion did the 16th Finance Commission add for sharing among states?

(A) Tax effort (B) State's contribution to GDP
(C) Forest cover (D) Demographic performance

B **Correct answer: (B) State's contribution to GDP** — Weight 10%; tax effort was removed.

42. What is the MSF rate after 7 October 2026?

(A) 5.25% (B) 5.50%
(C) 5.75% (D) 6.00%

C **Correct answer: (C) 5.75%** — Repo is 5.50% and MSF is 0.25% above it at 5.75% — this is also the bank rate and the upper limit of the interest rate corridor.

43. What is the base year of the new CPI series?

(A) 2011-12 (B) 2022-23
(C) 2024 (D) 2025

C **Correct answer: (C) 2024** — The base year of the new CPI series is 2024, while GDP, WPI and IIP have been given the new base year 2022-23.

44. Where is India's first barrier-free (MLFF) toll?

(A) Kondareddypalli (B) Choryasi (NH-48)
(C) Panipat (D) Umling La

B **Correct answer: (B) Choryasi (NH-48)** — The country's first multi-lane free flow (barrier-free) toll started in May 2026 at the Choryasi plaza on NH-48 in Gujarat.

45. Correct statements about the PFBR Kalpakkam:

1. It uses MOX fuel.
2. Its coolant is heavy water.
3. Its first criticality was in April 2026.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 1 and 3 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 3 only** — The first and third statements are correct; the second is wrong because the coolant in the PFBR (Kalpakkam) is liquid sodium, not heavy water.

46. Match the growth estimates for 2026-27:

List-I	List-II
A. RBI	1. 7.0%
B. ADB	2. 6.8-7.2%
C. Economic Survey	3. 7.1%
D. IMF (calendar 2026)	4. 7.4%

(A) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4 (B) A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4 (C) A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4 (D) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4** — RBI 7.1, ADB 7.0, Survey 6.8-7.2, IMF 7.4 in calendar 2026.

47. Which is correct about the Union Budget 2026-27?

(A) It was Sitharaman's 10th budget in a row
(B) It was presented on a Sunday for the first time
(C) Income tax rates were cut
(D) The fiscal deficit target was set at 4.4%

B **Correct answer: (B) It was presented on a Sunday for the first time** — 9th in a row; deficit target 4.3%; income tax rates unchanged.

48. Under RBI rules, a loan will not be given against:

(A) Silver jewellery
(B) Silver coins (up to 500 g)
(C) Silver bars and ETFs
(D) Gold jewellery

C **Correct answer: (C) Silver bars and ETFs** — Jewellery up to 10 kg and coins up to 500 g are allowed.

49. Which is the 9th country to adopt UPI?

(A) Maldives
(B) Cambodia
(C) Israel
(D) Nepal

B **Correct answer: (B) Cambodia** — The 9th country to adopt UPI is Cambodia; the UPI corridor with "Favara" in the Maldives is separate news.

50. India's rank in the world in foreign exchange reserves:

(A) Second
(B) Third
(C) Fourth
(D) Fifth

C **Correct answer: (C) Fourth** — India is fourth in the world in forex reserves — after China, Japan and Switzerland.

51. When were India-EU free trade agreement talks concluded?

(A) 27 January 2026
(B) 15 July 2026
(C) 1 June 2026
(D) October 2025

A **Correct answer: (A) 27 January 2026** — India-EU FTA talks concluded on 27 January 2026; signing is targeted for December 2026 and entry into force in 2027.

52. Match the following (sector — first state):

List-I	List-II
A. Pulses output	1. Gujarat
B. Marine fish	2. Tamil Nadu
C. Cotton	3. Andhra Pradesh
D. Eggs	4. Madhya Pradesh

(A) A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3 (B) A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4 (C) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (D) A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

A **Correct answer: (A) A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3** — Pulses MP, marine fish Tamil Nadu, cotton Gujarat, eggs Andhra.

53. What was India's rice output in 2025-26?

(A) 120.66 mn tonnes
(B) 150.18 mn tonnes
(C) 154.02 mn tonnes
(D) 376.56 mn tonnes

C **Correct answer: (C) 154.02 mn tonnes** — Rice output in 2025-26 was 154.02 million tonnes, higher than 150.18 million tonnes in 2024-25.

54. On which section did the first hydrogen train "Namo Green Rail" run?

(A) Malda-Kamakhya
(B) Jind-Sonipat
(C) Sabarmati-Dholera
(D) Kalka-Shimla

B **Correct answer: (B) Jind-Sonipat** — The first hydrogen train "Namo Green Rail" ran on 17 July 2026 on Haryana's Jind-Sonipat section (about 89 km).

55. Which is now the world's highest motorable road?

(A) Umling La (B) Mig La
(C) Khardung La (D) Fotu La

B **Correct answer: (B) Mig La** — 19,400 ft; Umling La (19,024 ft) left behind.

56. Descending order of energy sources by installed capacity:

1. Wind
2. Solar
3. Nuclear
4. Hydro (large)

(A) 2-1-4-3 (B) 2-4-1-3
(C) 1-2-4-3 (D) 2-1-3-4

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-1-4-3** — Solar 164.59 > wind 58.14 > hydro 57.24 > nuclear 8.78.

57. India's rank in the world in ship recycling?

(A) First (B) Second
(C) Third (D) Fourth

A **Correct answer: (A) First** — India is first in the world in ship recycling — global share about 35.4%.

58. Correct statements about GST 2.0:

1. It is in force from 22 September 2025.
2. It has two main rates of 5% and 18%.
3. Harmful goods attract 28%.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; remember that GST 2.0 has a special rate of 40% on harmful and luxury goods.

59. Who chairs the 8th Pay Commission?

(A) Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai (B) Poonam Gupta
(C) Nidhi Chhibber (D) B.V. Nagarathna

A **Correct answer: (A) Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai** — The 8th Pay Commission is chaired by Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai; the resolution was issued on 3 November 2025 and the report is due around May 2027.

60. Where did the first PM MITRA park start?

(A) Pachpadra (B) Warangal
(C) Dholera (D) Sanand

B **Correct answer: (B) Warangal** — The first PM MITRA (textile park) started at Warangal, Telangana, on 10 May 2026; parks are to be built in 7 states in all.

Chapter 04 · Government Schemes

61. What is the Centre:State ratio for North-Eastern states under VB-G RAM G?

(A) 60:40 (B) 75:25
(C) 90:10 (D) 100:0

C **Correct answer: (C) 90:10** — For North-Eastern states the Centre:State ratio is 90:10, for general states 60:40, and in Union Territories the Centre bears the full cost.

62. The "Samudra Manthan" scheme is linked to which ministry?

(A) Earth Sciences (B) Petroleum and Natural Gas
(C) Fisheries (D) Jal Shakti

B **Correct answer: (B) Petroleum and Natural Gas** — Offshore oil-gas exploration, 600 MMTOE+ reserves.

63. What is the service standard of the Jal Jeevan Mission?

(A) 40 litres/person/day (B) 55 litres/person/day
(C) 70 litres/person/day (D) 135 litres/person/day

B **Correct answer: (B) 55 litres/person/day** — 55 litres per person per day.

64. Who chairs the Examination Reform Task Force (26 July 2026)?

(A) K. Radhakrishnan (B) Nandan Nilekani
(C) S. Somanath (D) V. Kamakoti

B **Correct answer: (B) Nandan Nilekani** — Members include S. Somanath and V. Kamakoti too.

65. CHIRAG is a platform of which institution?

(A) Indian Railways (B) NHAI
(C) UIDAI (D) EPFO

A **Correct answer: (A) Indian Railways** — CHIRAG is Indian Railways' AI-based human resources (HR) platform, launched in Hyderabad on 29 May.

66. Statements about VB-G RAM G:

1. It came into force on 1 July 2026.
2. It provides 125 days of work per household.
3. Its launch ceremony was held in Varanasi.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; remember that VB-G RAM G was formally launched in Tirupati on 2 July.

67. Which schemes were approved on 31 July 2026?

(A) BHAVYA, SARTHAK-PDS, Semicon 2.0 (B) PM-KISAN extension, Samudra Manthan, PM Surya Sarovar
(C) Cotton mission, BHAVYA, PM-SETU (D) JJM 2.0, Atal Pension, e-Shram

B **Correct answer: (B) PM-KISAN extension, Samudra Manthan, PM Surya Sarovar** — Three approvals on a single day.

68. What is the target of PM Surya Sarovar?

(A) 5,000 MW rooftop solar (B) 5,000 MW floating solar + 10,000 MWh battery
(C) 10,000 MW wind (D) 500 solar villages

B **Correct answer: (B) 5,000 MW floating solar + 10,000 MWh battery** — Support of ₹1 crore/MW.

69. Correct chronological order of the EPFO wage ceiling:

1. ₹25,000
2. ₹6,500
3. ₹15,000

(A) 2-3-1 (B) 3-2-1
(C) 2-1-3 (D) 1-2-3

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-3-1** — The EPFO wage ceiling was ₹6,500 earlier, became ₹15,000 in 2014 and was raised to ₹25,000 in 2026 — so the correct order is 2-3-1.

70. Correct about the e-Shram portal:

(A) Men are 60% on it (B) Women are 54.28% on it
(C) It started in 2019 (D) It has only gig workers

B **Correct answer: (B) Women are 54.28% on it** — 31.89 crore+ registrations, since 26 August 2021.

71. Under which provision did NCERT get deemed university status?

(A) Section 3 of the UGC Act (B) Section 12B of the UGC Act
(C) Article 30 (D) Section 10 of NEP 2020

A **Correct answer: (A) Section 3 of the UGC Act** — "Deemed to be University (Distinct Category)", 30 March 2026.

72. Match the following (scheme/campaign — feature):

List-I	List-II
A. Roshni	1. J&K-Ladakh skills
B. Himayat	2. Women along highways
C. Daanveer	3. Skills in insurgency-affected districts
D. Project Saksham	4. Donating equipment to panchayats

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4 (D) A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — Roshni insurgency areas, Himayat J&K-Ladakh, Daanveer equipment donation, Saksham women.

73. Where was the 29th Conference of the e-Governance Awards 2026 held?

(A) Bhopal (B) Jaipur
(C) Guwahati (D) Lucknow

B **Correct answer: (B) Jaipur** — The 29th National Conference of the e-Governance Awards 2026 was held in Jaipur on 1-2 July; a "Jaipur Declaration" on e-governance was issued there.

74. How many districts does PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana focus on?

(A) 50 (B) 100
(C) 112 (D) 500

B **Correct answer: (B) 100** — PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana focuses on 100 districts with low farm productivity, to raise output and farmers' income there.

75. Who developed the "SATHEE" platform?

(A) IIT Kanpur (B) IIT Madras
(C) NCERT (D) IGNOU

A **Correct answer: (A) IIT Kanpur** — The "SATHEE" platform was developed by IIT Kanpur with the Ministry of Education; it offers free preparation for exams such as JEE, NEET and UPSC.

76. Number of accounts after 12 years of Jan Dhan Yojana, approximately:

(A) 41.29 crore (B) 59.09 crore
(C) 32.92 crore (D) 72.43 crore

B **Correct answer: (B) 59.09 crore** — After 12 years of Jan Dhan Yojana there are about 59.09 crore accounts, 55.7% of them held by women.

77. PM-SETU is related to:

(A) Upgrading 1,000 government ITIs (B) Bridge building
(C) Border roads (D) Start-up loans

A **Correct answer: (A) Upgrading 1,000 government ITIs** — ₹60,000 crore, 4 October 2025.

78. Entry age for the Atal Pension Yojana:

(A) 18-40 (B) 18-60
(C) 21-50 (D) 25-45

A **Correct answer: (A) 18-40** — One can join the Atal Pension Yojana between 18 and 40 years of age; after 60 a monthly pension of ₹1,000 to ₹5,000 is paid.

79. Target size of the economy by 2047 under the DPI@2047 vision:

(A) $10 trillion (B) $30 trillion
(C) $18 trillion (D) $50 trillion

B **Correct answer: (B) $30 trillion** — The DPI@2047 vision targets a $30 trillion economy and per capita income of about $18,000 by 2047.

80. What is the outlay of Semicon India 2.0?

(A) ₹76,000 crore (B) ₹1,27,500 crore
(C) ₹84,084 crore (D) ₹3,15,614 crore

B **Correct answer: (B) ₹1,27,500 crore** — 1.0 (December 2021) was ₹76,000 crore.

Chapter 05 · Defence and Security

81. "Veer Guardian 2026" was an exercise between the air forces of which two countries?

(A) India-France (B) India-Japan
(C) India-Australia (D) India-Malaysia

B **Correct answer: (B) India-Japan** — In Jodhpur; the Japanese air force in India for the first time.

82. INS Aridhaman belongs to which category?

(A) Stealth frigate (B) Third indigenous SSBN
(C) Diving support vessel (D) Missile tracking ship

B **Correct answer: (B) Third indigenous SSBN** — INS Aridhaman is India's third indigenous nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN) — after Arihant and Arighaat.

83. Which is India's first glide weapon system?

(A) Rudram-II (B) TARA
(C) Khagantak-243 (D) Astra Mk-2

B **Correct answer: (B) TARA** — TARA is India's first glide weapon system (7 May 2026); Rudram-II is a different, anti-radiation missile.

84. Who holds the largest share in IRRPL?

(A) Kalashnikov (B) AWEIL
(C) Rosoboronexport (D) Munitions India

B **Correct answer: (B) AWEIL** — The largest share in IRRPL is India's AWEIL (42.5%) and Russia's Kalashnikov holds 42% — the gap is tiny, which is the trap.

85. When was the "PRAHAAR" policy released?

(A) 26 November 2025 (B) 23 February 2026
(C) 28 September 2026 (D) 15 August 2026

B **Correct answer: (B) 23 February 2026** — "PRAHAAR" — India's first national counter-terrorism policy — was released on 23 February 2026; its first national conference was held on 28 September.

86. About the top military appointments:

1. The CDS and Navy Chief took office on the same day.
2. Army Chief Dhiraj Seth is the 31st chief.
3. The Air Chief also changed in 2026.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; the Air Chief did not change — Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh remains in office.

87. What is the calibre of the AK-203 rifle?

(A) 5.56×45 mm (B) 7.62×39 mm
(C) 7.62×51 mm (D) 9×19 mm

B **Correct answer: (B) 7.62×39 mm** — The calibre of the AK-203 "Sher" is 7.62×39 mm; weight about 3.6 kg and rate of fire about 700 rounds per minute.

88. Match the following (exercise — partner):

List-I	List-II
A. Dustlik-VII	1. Kyrgyzstan
B. Nomadic Elephant-18	2. Cambodia
C. Khanjar-13	3. Uzbekistan
D. CINBAX-2	4. Mongolia

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — Dustlik Uzbekistan, Nomadic Mongolia, Khanjar Kyrgyzstan, CINBAX Cambodia.

89. Missiles with a range of 3,000 to 5,500 km fall in which class?

(A) SRBM (B) MRBM
(C) IRBM (D) ICBM

C **Correct answer: (C) IRBM** — That is why the 4,000 km Agni-4 is also called an IRBM.

90. Correct about the "Shachi"-class patrol vessels:

(A) 7 ships in all, all GRSE (B) 11 ships in all — 7 Goa Shipyard, 4 GRSE
(C) 4 ships in all, Cochin Shipyard (D) 11 ships in all, all MDL

B **Correct answer: (B) 11 ships in all — 7 Goa Shipyard, 4 GRSE** — ₹9,781 crore; 3,000 tonnes, 23 knots.

91. The first Indian naval ship to visit the Canary Islands:

(A) INS Tarangini (B) INS Sudarshini
(C) INS Taragiri (D) INS Vikrant

B **Correct answer: (B) INS Sudarshini** — The training ship INS Sudarshini became the first Indian naval ship to visit the Canary Islands during the "Lokayan-26" voyage.

92. The three most Naxal-affected districts belong to which state?

(A) Jharkhand (B) Odisha
(C) Chhattisgarh (D) Maharashtra

C **Correct answer: (C) Chhattisgarh** — All three most Naxal-affected districts — Bijapur, Sukma and Narayanpur — are in the Bastar region of Chhattisgarh.

93. The first export customer of BrahMos:

(A) Vietnam (B) Indonesia
(C) The Philippines (D) Armenia

C **Correct answer: (C) The Philippines** — BrahMos's first export deal was with the Philippines in 2022; Vietnam has now also become a customer.

94. Which is the first indigenous multi-calibre rocket launcher?

(A) Pinaka (B) Suryastra
(C) Akashteer (D) Pralay

B **Correct answer: (B) Suryastra** — "Suryastra" is the first indigenous multi-calibre rocket launcher with a range of about 300 km; it was shown at the Republic Day 2026 parade.

95. Match the following (ship — identity):

List-I	List-II
A. INS Taragiri	1. First indigenous MPV
B. INS Dhruv	2. Fourth frigate of P-17A
C. INS Nipun	3. Second of the Nistar class
D. Samarthak	4. First missile tracking ship

(A) A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1 (B) A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1 (C) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1 (D) A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

A **Correct answer: (A) A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1** — Taragiri frigate, Dhruv tracking, Nipun diving, Samarthak MPV.

96. Where is the new NSG hub coming up?

(A) Varanasi (B) Ayodhya
(C) Prayagraj (D) Mathura

B **Correct answer: (B) Ayodhya** — The new NSG hub is coming up at Ayodhya; a national IED data system was also started at NSG headquarters, Manesar.

97. "Operation RAGEPILL" is related to:

(A) Digital arrest (B) Captagon seizure
(C) Illegal migrants (D) Child trafficking

B **Correct answer: (B) Captagon seizure** — First big seizure, about ₹182 crore.

98. When did the DAC approve 114 Rafales (MRFA)?

(A) 12 February 2026 (B) 6 August 2026
(C) 31 May 2026 (D) 27 February 2026

A **Correct answer: (A) 12 February 2026** — The DAC approved 114 Rafales (MRFA) on 12 February 2026; 18 aircraft will come directly from France and the rest will be built in India.

99. Correct statements about the CDS post:

1. The post was created on 24 December 2019.
2. The CDS is Secretary of the Department of Military Affairs.
3. The CDS is the commander above all three service chiefs.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The CDS is "first among equals", not a commander.

100. Up to which pass did the NCC's "Aparajita" trek go?

(A) Khardung La (B) Parang La
(C) Nathu La (D) Shipki La

B **Correct answer: (B) Parang La** — The NCC's "Aparajita" trek went up to Parang La pass (about 5,578 m) — the first such trek for girl cadets only.

Chapter 06 · Science and Technology

101. The world's first OptoSAR satellite belongs to which Indian company?

(A) Pixxel (B) GalaxEye
(C) Skyroot (D) Agnikul

B **Correct answer: (B) GalaxEye** — The world's first OptoSAR (optical + radar) satellite "Drishti" was built by Bengaluru's GalaxEye; it was launched on Falcon-9 on 3 May 2026.

102. The top supercomputer in the TOP500 (June 2026):

(A) El Capitan (B) LineShine
(C) Frontier (D) JUPITER

B **Correct answer: (B) LineShine** — China, 2.198 exaflops; first time since 2017.

103. Who made the "Dhruv64" processor?

(A) ISRO (B) C-DAC
(C) IIT Madras (D) DRDO

B **Correct answer: (B) C-DAC** — "Dhruv64" was made by C-DAC — it is India's first indigenous 1 GHz, 64-bit, dual-core RISC-V processor.

104. Which institute produced the T2T genome of pigeon pea?

(A) ICRISAT (B) ICAR-NIPB
(C) IARI (D) NBPGR

B **Correct answer: (B) ICAR-NIPB** — The T2T (telomere-to-telomere) genome of pigeon pea was produced by ICAR-NIPB, New Delhi — size 752.65 Mb and 36,557 genes.

105. The Canadian astronaut in the Artemis-II crew:

(A) Victor Glover (B) Jeremy Hansen
(C) Reid Wiseman (D) Chris Hadfield

B **Correct answer: (B) Jeremy Hansen** — Of the four Artemis-II astronauts, Jeremy Hansen is from Canada; the other three are from the US (NASA).

106. About Skyroot's rockets:

1. Vikram-S was sub-orbital.
2. Vikram-1 is the first private Indian rocket to reach orbit.
3. Vikram-1's mission was named "Prarambh".

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; the third is wrong because Vikram-1's mission was named "Aagaman", not "Prarambh" ("Prarambh" was Vikram-S's mission).

107. Where will the Nancy Grace Roman Telescope be stationed?

(A) Sun-Earth L1 (B) Sun-Earth L2
(C) Earth-Moon L4 (D) Low Earth orbit

B **Correct answer: (B) Sun-Earth L2** — L2 is on the side away from the Sun; James Webb is also there.

108. Correct chronological order of ISRO events:

1. EOS-05 (GSLV-F17)
2. CMS-03 (LVM3-M5)
3. PSLV-C62 failure
4. Gaganyaan crew module air-drop

(A) 2-3-4-1 (B) 3-2-4-1
(C) 2-4-3-1 (D) 2-3-1-4

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-3-4-1** — November 2025 → January 2026 → April 2026 → September 2026.

109. On which fuel combination does the "Everest" engine run?

(A) Liquid hydrogen + liquid oxygen (B) Liquid oxygen + methane
(C) Kerosene + liquid oxygen (D) Solid fuel

B **Correct answer: (B) Liquid oxygen + methane** — 800 kN, full-flow staged combustion.

110. Which signatory of the Artemis Accords is India?

(A) 21st (B) 27th
(C) 35th (D) 71st

B **Correct answer: (B) 27th** — India signed the Artemis Accords on 21 June 2023 and became the 27th signatory; Türkiye is the 71st country.

111. When was the "New Delhi AI Impact Declaration" released?

(A) 19 February 2026 (B) 21 February 2026
(C) 16 February 2026 (D) 20 March 2026

B **Correct answer: (B) 21 February 2026** — The India AI Impact Summit (New Delhi) was inaugurated on 19 February and the "New Delhi AI Impact Declaration" was released on 21 February 2026.

112. Match the following (innovation — institution):

List-I	List-II
A. SraVaani	1. IIT Madras
B. ANCHOR	2. IIT Guwahati
C. BODH	3. IISc
D. E-Eye	4. IIT Kanpur + NHA

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (D) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — SraVaani IISc, ANCHOR IIT Madras, BODH IIT Kanpur + NHA, E-Eye IIT Guwahati.

113. Who made the first indigenous vaccine for African swine fever?

(A) ICAR-IVRI (B) ICAR-NIHSAD Bhopal
(C) Bharat Biotech (D) NDDB

B **Correct answer: (B) ICAR-NIHSAD Bhopal** — The first indigenous vaccine for African swine fever was made by ICAR-NIHSAD Bhopal — a live attenuated vaccine against genotype-II.

114. How many Indian supercomputers are in the TOP500 list?

(A) 3 (B) 7
(C) 15 (D) 31

B **Correct answer: (B) 7** — India has 7 supercomputers in the TOP500 (June 2026) list; by number India is 15th.

115. The world's first IVF calf belongs to which breed?

(A) Gir (B) Lakhimi
(C) Sahiwal (D) Tharparkar

B **Correct answer: (B) Lakhimi** — Lakhimi is an indigenous cattle breed of Assam; the world's first IVF calf of this breed was born at Khanapara (Assam) on 22 August.

116. Qdenga is a vaccine for which disease?

(A) Malaria (B) Dengue
(C) Chikungunya (D) Japanese encephalitis

B **Correct answer: (B) Dengue** — Qdenga is a dengue vaccine; CDSCO approved it for people aged 4 to 60 years — the first dengue vaccine in India.

117. Pakistan's first lunar rover:

(A) Iqbal-1 (B) Jinnah-1
(C) PakSat-MM1 (D) Al-Barq

B **Correct answer: (B) Jinnah-1** — Pakistan's first lunar rover "Jinnah-1" (about 35 kg) will be sent with China's lunar mission around 2029.

118. The first NIT with an observatory on campus:

(A) NIT Trichy (B) NIT Srinagar
(C) NIT Rourkela (D) NIT Calicut

B **Correct answer: (B) NIT Srinagar** — NIT Srinagar became the first NIT with an astronomical observatory on campus; it was built under the guidance of the Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA).

119. Correct about "Plant OpenCRISPR-1":

(A) IARI's experiment on wheat (B) CRRI Cuttack's AI-designed plant genome editing
(C) ICRISAT's cotton technology (D) NIPB's pigeon pea genome

B **Correct answer: (B) CRRI Cuttack's AI-designed plant genome editing** — Model crop rice.

120. With which vehicle was CMS-03 (GSAT-7R) launched?

(A) PSLV-C62 (B) LVM3-M5
(C) GSLV-F17 (D) SSLV-D3

B **Correct answer: (B) LVM3-M5** — CMS-03 (GSAT-7R) is the Navy's communication satellite, launched on LVM3-M5; it weighs about 4,400 kg — the heaviest communication satellite launched from India.

Chapter 07 · Environment

121. Arunachal Pradesh's first Ramsar site:

(A) Surha Tal (B) Glow Lake (Lohit)
(C) Loktak (D) Deepor Beel

B **Correct answer: (B) Glow Lake (Lohit)** — Glow Lake (Lohit district) is Arunachal Pradesh's first Ramsar site; it lies inside the Kamlang Tiger Reserve.

122. Emission intensity reduction target in the third NDC (from 2005, by 2035):

(A) 33-35% (B) 45%
(C) 47% (D) 60%

C **Correct answer: (C) 47%** — The third NDC targets cutting emission intensity by 47% from 2005 levels by 2035 and raising non-fossil power capacity to 60%.

123. In India, the Indus river dolphin is found only in which river?

(A) Sutlej (B) Beas
(C) Ravi (D) Chenab

B **Correct answer: (B) Beas** — In India, the Indus river dolphin is found only in the Beas river of Punjab; the first national survey counted only 3 of them.

124. Bihar's share in the Son water agreement:

(A) 2.0 MAF (B) 5.75 MAF
(C) 7.75 MAF (D) 3.5 MAF

B **Correct answer: (B) 5.75 MAF** — Under the Son river water agreement, Bihar got 5.75 MAF and Jharkhand 2.0 MAF of water.

125. World's most polluted city in IQAir 2025:

(A) New Delhi (B) Loni
(C) Byrnihat (D) Hotan

B **Correct answer: (B) Loni** — In IQAir 2025, the world's most polluted city was Loni (Ghaziabad) in UP, while Delhi was the most polluted capital.

126. Match the following (conference — venue):

List-I	List-II
A. UNCCD COP-17	1. Antalya
B. CBD COP-17	2. Victoria Falls
C. UNFCCC COP-31	3. Ulaanbaatar
D. Ramsar COP-15	4. Yerevan

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — UNCCD Ulaanbaatar, CBD Yerevan, COP-31 Antalya, Ramsar Victoria Falls.

127. When did the High Seas Treaty (BBNJ) come into force?

(A) 10 November 2025 (B) 17 January 2026
(C) 8 June 2026 (D) 1 January 2027

B **Correct answer: (B) 17 January 2026** — The High Seas Treaty (BBNJ) came into force on 17 January 2026 — the first binding treaty under UNCLOS on marine biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction.

128. Correct chronological order of ozone agreements:

1. Kigali Amendment
2. Vienna Convention
3. Montreal Protocol

(A) 2-3-1 (B) 3-2-1
(C) 2-1-3 (D) 1-2-3

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-3-1** — First the Vienna Convention (1985), then the Montreal Protocol (1987) and finally the Kigali Amendment (2016) — so the correct order is 2-3-1.

129. India's 100th Ramsar site:

(A) Sauj (B) Surha Tal (Ballia)
(C) Sheikha (D) Gogabil

B **Correct answer: (B) Surha Tal (Ballia)** — Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary, Ballia, UP) became India's 100th Ramsar site on 5 June 2026.

130. Which is the third home of cheetahs?

(A) Kuno (B) Gandhi Sagar
(C) Nauradehi (D) Mukundra

C **Correct answer: (C) Nauradehi** — The first home of cheetahs is Kuno, the second Gandhi Sagar and the third Nauradehi (MP), where cheetahs were released on 8 October.

131. Which is the top state for Ramsar sites?

(A) Uttar Pradesh (B) Tamil Nadu
(C) West Bengal (D) Gujarat

B **Correct answer: (B) Tamil Nadu** — Tamil Nadu is first with 20 Ramsar sites; Uttar Pradesh is second with 14.

132. Correct statements about COP-30:

1. It was the first COP in the Amazon region.
2. The roadmap away from fossil fuels was included in the final text.
3. The "Global Mutirão" talks of tripling adaptation finance by 2035.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 1 and 3 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 3 only** — The first and third statements are correct; the second is wrong because the roadmap away from fossil fuels could not be included in COP-30's final text.

133. First among cities with 10 lakh+ population in Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026:

(A) Indore (B) Lucknow
(C) Jabalpur (D) Agra

B **Correct answer: (B) Lucknow** — In Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026, Lucknow was first among cities with over 10 lakh population (Category I) with 198 marks.

134. Which state has the largest area in the Western Ghats ESA draft?

(A) Kerala (B) Karnataka
(C) Maharashtra (D) Tamil Nadu

B **Correct answer: (B) Karnataka** — In the Western Ghats Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) draft, Karnataka has the largest area — 20,668 sq km.

135. Number of Asiatic lions as per the 16th census (May 2025):

(A) 674 (B) 891
(C) 523 (D) 718

B **Correct answer: (B) 891** — The 16th census of May 2025 counted 891 Asiatic lions; there were 674 in 2020 and 523 in 2015.

136. Which country gave the next North Indian Ocean cyclone name "Arnab"?

(A) India (B) Bangladesh
(C) Myanmar (D) Thailand

B **Correct answer: (B) Bangladesh** — Previous names: Shakti, Montha, Senyar, Ditwah.

137. The UN declared 2026 as which year?

1. International Year of the Woman Farmer
2. Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists
3. Year of Glacier Preservation

Correct:

(A) 1 only (B) 1 and 2 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 2 only** — Glacier Day (21 March) is separate; not the year.

138. India's tiger count (2022) is about what percentage of the world's?

(A) 50% (B) 60%
(C) 75% (D) 90%

C **Correct answer: (C) 75%** — The 2022 count found 3,682 tigers in India, about 75% of the world's; the country has 58 tiger reserves.

139. The "Montreux Record" relates to:

(A) Threatened species (B) Ramsar sites under threat
(C) Ozone-depleting substances (D) World Heritage Sites

B **Correct answer: (B) Ramsar sites under threat** — A list kept under the Ramsar Convention.

140. What was the NCAP target?

(A) 20-30% cut by 2024 (B) 40% cut by 2026 (base 2017)
(C) 50% cut by 2030 (D) 60% cut by 2026

B **Correct answer: (B) 40% cut by 2026 (base 2017)** — NCAP aimed to cut particulate pollution by 40% by 2026 with 2017 as the base; only 26 cities achieved it.

Chapter 08 · Society, Health and Education

141. Which is the nodal body for NFHS-6?

(A) NSO (B) IIPS Mumbai
(C) ICMR (D) Registrar General

B **Correct answer: (B) IIPS Mumbai** — The nodal body for NFHS-6 is the International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai; the survey covered 6.79 lakh households and 715 districts.

142. Which state/UT has the lowest TFR in SRS 2023?

(A) Kerala (B) Delhi (1.2)
(C) Sikkim (D) Tamil Nadu

B **Correct answer: (B) Delhi (1.2)** — In SRS 2023 the lowest TFR is Delhi's (1.2) and the highest Bihar's (2.8); the national TFR is 1.9.

143. Leading state in deceased-donor organ donation:

(A) Delhi (B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Maharashtra (D) Kerala

B **Correct answer: (B) Tamil Nadu** — 266 deceased donors; Delhi leads in total transplants.

144. Which state is lowest in literacy (PLFS 2023-24)?

(A) Bihar (B) Rajasthan
(C) Andhra Pradesh (D) MP

C **Correct answer: (C) Andhra Pradesh** — In PLFS 2023-24, Andhra Pradesh (72.6%) is lowest in literacy; Bihar is above it at 74.3%.

145. Where was the HPV vaccination campaign launched from?

(A) Varanasi (B) Ajmer
(C) New Delhi (D) Jaipur

B **Correct answer: (B) Ajmer** — The PM launched the HPV vaccination campaign from Ajmer, Rajasthan on 28 February 2026; girls aged 14 are vaccinated under it.

146. Statements about NFHS-6:

1. It has a TFR of 2.0.
2. Stunting fell from 35.5% to 29.3%.
3. The number of indicators rose from 101 to 131.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; the third is wrong because in NFHS-6 the indicators fell from 131 to 101, they did not rise.

147. Total organ transplants in India in 2025 were about:

(A) 18,911 (B) 20,138
(C) 14,477 (D) 4,990

B **Correct answer: (B) 20,138** — India had 20,138 organ transplants in 2025 — the first time the number crossed 20,000.

148. India's first child-marriage-free district:

(A) Ganjam (B) Balod
(C) Dantewada (D) Nuapada

B **Correct answer: (B) Balod** — Chhattisgarh's Balod was declared the country's first child-marriage-free district on 1 October 2025; all its 436 panchayats are covered.

149. Target of the SUMAN Roadmap 2030:

(A) IMR below 20 (B) MMR below 70
(C) TFR 2.1 (D) Zero zero-dose children

B **Correct answer: (B) MMR below 70** — The SUMAN Roadmap 2030 aims to bring the maternal mortality ratio (MMR) below 70; it focuses on 130 districts in 13 states.

150. Match the following (indicator — value):

List-I	List-II
A. Infant mortality rate (SRS)	1. 43.4%
B. Birth rate (SRS)	2. 24
C. Government health spending (% of GDP)	3. 1.43%
D. Out-of-pocket spending (NHA)	4. 18.3

(A) A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1 (B) A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1 (C) A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1 (D) A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3

A **Correct answer: (A) A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1** — IMR 24, birth rate 18.3, spending 1.43%, out-of-pocket 43.4%.

151. India's rank in the world in organ transplants (total):

(A) First (B) Second
(C) Third (D) Fourth

C **Correct answer: (C) Third** — India is third in total organ transplants after the US and China, while it is first in the world in living-donor transplants.

152. Descending order of states in literacy:

1. Kerala
2. Mizoram
3. Nagaland
4. Lakshadweep

(A) 2-4-3-1 (B) 1-2-4-3
(C) 2-3-4-1 (D) 4-2-3-1

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-4-3-1** — Mizoram 98.2, Lakshadweep 97.3, Nagaland 95.7, Kerala 95.3.

153. Which species of virus is behind DRC's Ebola outbreak (2026)?

(A) Zaire (B) Bundibugyo
(C) Sudan (D) Taï Forest

B **Correct answer: (B) Bundibugyo** — Ervebo is licensed for the Zaire species.

154. NOTTO comes under which Act?

(A) Transplantation of Human Organs Act 1994 (B) Drugs and Cosmetics Act 1940
(C) National Health Policy 2017 (D) Clinical Establishments Act 2010

A **Correct answer: (A) Transplantation of Human Organs Act 1994** — NOTTO is in Delhi.

155. Pupil-teacher ratio in schools (UDISE+ 2025-26):

(A) 30:1 (B) 24:1
(C) 35:1 (D) 20:1

B **Correct answer: (B) 24:1** — According to UDISE+ 2025-26, the pupil-teacher ratio in schools is 24:1, better than the NEP norm of 30:1.

156. Where did Poshan Maah 2026 begin?

(A) Varanasi (B) Lucknow
(C) Bhopal (D) Patna

A **Correct answer: (A) Varanasi** — Poshan Maah 2026 (9th) began from Varanasi on 9 September 2026; the theme was "Our Anganwadi, Our Responsibility".

157. What has the DCGI's maximum age been raised to?

(A) 56 (B) 58
(C) 60 (D) 62

B **Correct answer: (B) 58** — The maximum age limit of the Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) was raised from 56 to 58 years.

158. According to NITI Aayog, how many youth aged 15-29 are "NEET"?

(A) 2.68 crore (B) 8.7 crore
(C) 34.7 crore (D) 4.5 crore

B **Correct answer: (B) 8.7 crore** — According to NITI Aayog, about 8.7 crore youth aged 15-29 are "NEET" — that is, not in education, employment or any training.

159. Who discovered the ABO blood groups?

(A) Louis Pasteur (B) Karl Landsteiner
(C) Robert Koch (D) Edward Jenner

B **Correct answer: (B) Karl Landsteiner** — The ABO blood groups were discovered by Karl Landsteiner (Nobel 1930); he discovered the Rh factor with Wiener in 1940.

160. Correct about higher education (AISHE 2023-24):

(A) Enrolment 4.5 crore, GPI 1.08 (B) GER 50%
(C) Women fewer than men (D) STEM enrolment 50 lakh

A **Correct answer: (A) Enrolment 4.5 crore, GPI 1.08** — Women 2.24 crore; GER about 30%.

Chapter 09 · Art, Culture and Heritage

161. India's 44th World Heritage Site:

(A) Sarnath (B) Maratha Military Landscapes
(C) Moidams (Assam) (D) Santiniketan

B **Correct answer: (B) Maratha Military Landscapes** — "Maratha Military Landscapes" (12 forts) became India's 44th World Heritage Site in 2025; in 2026 Sarnath became the 45th.

162. In which districts are the Shekhawati havelis?

(A) Jaipur, Ajmer, Tonk (B) Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Churu
(C) Bikaner, Nagaur, Jodhpur (D) Alwar, Bharatpur, Dausa

B **Correct answer: (B) Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Churu** — The painted havelis of Shekhawati (Rajasthan) are in 14 towns of Jhunjhunu, Sikar and Churu districts — it is called an "open-air art gallery".

163. The fish on the pot found at Keezhadi is the emblem of which dynasty?

(A) Chola (B) Chera
(C) Pandya (D) Pallava

C **Correct answer: (C) Pandya** — The fish on the Keezhadi pot is the emblem of the Pandya dynasty; the Chola emblem was the tiger and the Chera the bow.

164. The UP weaver who won the Sant Kabir Award 2025:

(A) Ram Meher (B) Shah Muhammad Ansari
(C) Runima Chetia Choudhury (D) Nandlal Yadav

B **Correct answer: (B) Shah Muhammad Ansari** — Zarbaft Shwetambari Awadh Jamdani.

165. New name of Havelock Island:

(A) Shaheed Dweep (B) Swaraj Dweep
(C) Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Island (D) Sri Vijaya Puram

B **Correct answer: (B) Swaraj Dweep** — The new name of Havelock Island in the Andamans is Swaraj Dweep, while Neil Island's new name is Shaheed Dweep.

166. Statements about India in the UNESCO lists:

1. There are 45 World Heritage Sites.
2. Deepavali is on the World Heritage Sites list.
3. The Bhagavad Gita is in the Memory of the World.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 1 and 3 only
(C) 2 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 and 3 only** — The first and third statements are correct; the second is wrong because Deepavali is on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list, not among World Heritage Sites.

167. Correct chronological order of events linked to Vande Mataram:

1. Published in "Anandamath"
2. Rabindranath sang it at the Congress
3. Composition
4. The Constituent Assembly gave it status

(A) 3-1-2-4 (B) 1-3-2-4
(C) 3-2-1-4 (D) 3-1-4-2

A **Correct answer: (A) 3-1-2-4** — Vande Mataram was written in 1875, published in "Anandamath" in 1882, sung at the Congress session in 1896 and became the National Song in 1950.

168. Among the four ages of Somnath, who built the stone temple?

(A) Shri Krishna (B) Ravana
(C) Bhimdev Solanki (D) Chandradev

C **Correct answer: (C) Bhimdev Solanki** — Among Somnath's four ages, the stone temple was built by Bhimdev Solanki; the present temple's style is "Kailash Mahameru Prasad".

169. Who inaugurated the rebuilt Somnath temple in 1951?

(A) Jawaharlal Nehru (B) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
(C) Sardar Patel (D) K.M. Munshi

B **Correct answer: (B) Dr. Rajendra Prasad** — The rebuilt Somnath temple was inaugurated (prana-pratishtha) by President Dr. Rajendra Prasad on 11 May 1951.

170. Match the following (site — district):

List-I	List-II
A. Bagh Caves	1. Morena
B. Udayagiri Caves	2. Sehore
C. Chambal valley temples	3. Dhar
D. Ginnorgarh Fort	4. Vidisha

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — Bagh Dhar, Udayagiri Vidisha, Chambal Morena, Ginnorgarh Sehore.

171. What happens with the flag on 26 January?

(A) Hoisting, by the PM (B) Unfurling, by the President
(C) Hoisting, by the President (D) Unfurling, by the PM

B **Correct answer: (B) Unfurling, by the President** — On Kartavya Path a flag tied at the top is unfurled.

172. Correct about the Kumbhalgarh wall:

(A) The longest in the world (B) The second-longest continuous wall after the Great Wall of China
(C) Built by the Mughals (D) Built by Rana Pratap

B **Correct answer: (B) The second-longest continuous wall after the Great Wall of China** — About 36 km; Rana Kumbha.

173. Where was the 20th session of the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage Committee held in India?

(A) Bharat Mandapam (B) Red Fort
(C) Rashtrapati Bhavan (D) Kartavya Path

B **Correct answer: (B) Red Fort** — The 20th session of the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage Committee was held at Delhi's Red Fort on 8-13 December 2025.

174. Guest country of the 53rd World Book Fair:

(A) France (B) Spain
(C) Japan (D) Saudi Arabia

B **Correct answer: (B) Spain** — The 53rd World Book Fair was held in New Delhi on 10-18 January 2026; the guest country was Spain.

175. The Indian who contributed to drafting the Universal Declaration of Human Rights:

(A) Sarojini Naidu (B) Hansa Mehta
(C) Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit (D) Amrit Kaur

B **Correct answer: (B) Hansa Mehta** — Hansa Mehta had "all human beings" put in place of "all men" in the draft of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR, 1948).

176. "Sapt Dhara" relates to:

(A) Seven streams of the Ganga (B) The PM's Viksit Bharat blueprint
(C) Seven new schemes (D) A Navy operation

B **Correct answer: (B) The PM's Viksit Bharat blueprint** — In the address of 15 August 2026.

177. The Darjeeling mandarin orange got its GI tag from which state?

(A) Sikkim (B) West Bengal
(C) Assam (D) Meghalaya

B **Correct answer: (B) West Bengal** — The Darjeeling mandarin orange got its GI tag from West Bengal; Sikkim got GI tags for Lepcha instruments.

178. The Shikshapatri is linked to:

(A) Sahajanand Swami, Vadtal (B) Jyotiba Phule
(C) Dayanand Saraswati (D) Narayana Guru

A **Correct answer: (A) Sahajanand Swami, Vadtal** — The "Shikshapatri" was written in 1826 at Vadtal (Gujarat) by Sahajanand Swami, founder of the Swaminarayan sect; it completed 200 years in 2026.

179. Who was Khudiram Bose's target?

(A) Lord Curzon (B) Magistrate Kingsford
(C) General Dyer (D) Saunders

B **Correct answer: (B) Magistrate Kingsford** — But two English women died.

180. How many languages does the Sahitya Akademi recognise?

(A) 22 (B) 24
(C) 23 (D) 26

B **Correct answer: (B) 24** — The Sahitya Akademi recognises 24 languages — the 22 languages of the Eighth Schedule plus English and Rajasthani.

Chapter 10 · Sports

181. Who won India's first medal at the Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games?

(A) Mirabai Chanu (B) Jhandu Kumar
(C) Preeti Pawar (D) Asmita Dey

B **Correct answer: (B) Jhandu Kumar** — India's first medal at Glasgow 2026 was won by Jhandu Kumar — a bronze in para power-lifting heavyweight.

182. Mascot of the Asian Games 2026 (Aichi-Nagoya):

(A) Miraitowa (B) Honohon
(C) Finnie (D) Mor Veer

B **Correct answer: (B) Honohon** — The mascot of the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games is "Honohon", based on the mythical creature "Shachihoko"; "Finnie" is the mascot of the Glasgow Commonwealth Games.

183. Winner of the Ranji Trophy 2025-26:

(A) Vidarbha (B) Jammu & Kashmir
(C) Karnataka (D) Mumbai

B **Correct answer: (B) Jammu & Kashmir** — Jammu & Kashmir won the Ranji Trophy 2025-26 for the first time; it beat Karnataka in the final.

184. Golden Ball winner of the FIFA World Cup 2026:

(A) Mbappé (B) Rodri
(C) Messi (D) Ferran Torres

B **Correct answer: (B) Rodri** — The Golden Ball of the FIFA World Cup 2026 went to Spain's Rodri; Mbappé won the Golden Boot with 10 goals.

185. Top state by golds at the first Khelo India Tribal Games:

(A) Odisha (B) Karnataka
(C) Jharkhand (D) Chhattisgarh

B **Correct answer: (B) Karnataka** — Karnataka topped the first Khelo India Tribal Games with 23 golds; Odisha was ahead on total medals (57).

186. Where will the Commonwealth Games 2030 be held?

(A) Glasgow (B) Ahmedabad
(C) New Delhi (D) Victoria

B **Correct answer: (B) Ahmedabad** — The Commonwealth Games 2030 (centenary edition) will be held in Ahmedabad; it was confirmed on 26 November 2025.

187. Which sports were dropped at Glasgow 2026?

1. Hockey
2. Wrestling
3. Boxing
4. Shooting

Choose the correct:

(A) 1, 2 and 4 only (B) 1 and 3 only
(C) 2, 3 and 4 only (D) 1, 2, 3 and 4

A **Correct answer: (A) 1, 2 and 4 only** — Boxing stayed — India won 7 golds in it.

188. Match the following (tournament — winner):

List-I	List-II
A. Women's T20 World Cup 2026	1. RCB
B. Vijay Hazare	2. India
C. IPL 2026	3. Australia
D. SAFF Women's Championship	4. Vidarbha

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — Women's T20 Australia, Vijay Hazare Vidarbha, IPL RCB, SAFF India.

189. Becoming the first team to defend the T20 World Cup title, whom did India beat in the final?

(A) Australia (B) New Zealand
(C) South Africa (D) Pakistan

B **Correct answer: (B) New Zealand** — India beat New Zealand by 96 runs in the final at Ahmedabad on 8 March 2026 and became the first team to defend the title.

190. Correct statements about the Grand Slams 2026:

1. Alcaraz completed the career Grand Slam by winning the Australian Open.
2. Zverev won the French and US Opens.
3. Rybakina won Wimbledon.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct; the third is wrong because Linda Nosková, not Rybakina, won the Wimbledon 2026 women's singles.

191. Winner of the women's section of the Hockey World Cup 2026:

(A) Netherlands (B) Argentina
(C) Belgium (D) Germany

B **Correct answer: (B) Argentina** — Argentina won the women's section of the Hockey World Cup 2026; it beat the Netherlands 3-1 in a shootout in the final.

192. How many consecutive Commonwealth golds has Mirabai Chanu won?

(A) Two (B) Three
(C) Four (D) Five

B **Correct answer: (B) Three** — Mirabai Chanu won three consecutive Commonwealth golds in 2018, 2022 and 2026 — the first Indian weightlifter to do so.

193. Who won the FIDE World Cup 2025 (Goa)?

(A) Gukesh (B) Javokhir Sindarov
(C) Wei Yi (D) Praggnanandhaa

B **Correct answer: (B) Javokhir Sindarov** — The FIDE World Cup 2025 (Goa) was won by Uzbekistan's Javokhir Sindarov; he beat China's Wei Yi in the final tie-breaks.

194. First Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour:

(A) Gukesh (B) Praggnanandhaa
(C) Arjun Erigaisi (D) Vidit Gujrathi

B **Correct answer: (B) Praggnanandhaa** — The first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour is R. Praggnanandhaa; he beat Fabiano Caruana 15-13 in the final.

195. Youngest grandmaster in chess history (American of Indian origin):

(A) Gukesh (B) Abhimanyu Mishra
(C) Praggnanandhaa (D) Raunak Sadhwani

B **Correct answer: (B) Abhimanyu Mishra** — 12 years 4 months 25 days; India's youngest GM is Gukesh.

196. Where was the first World Yogasana Championship held?

(A) Rishikesh (B) Ahmedabad
(C) Mysuru (D) New Delhi

B **Correct answer: (B) Ahmedabad** — The first World Yogasana Championship was held on 4-8 June at the EKA Arena, Ahmedabad.

197. Winning the Squash World Cup, whom did India beat in the final?

(A) Egypt (B) Hong Kong
(C) England (D) Malaysia

B **Correct answer: (B) Hong Kong** — India won the Squash World Cup; it beat Hong Kong 3-0 in the final in Chennai.

198. Correct chronological order in Asian Games history:

1. India 107 medals (Hangzhou)
2. First Asian Games (New Delhi)
3. Delhi's second hosting
4. 85 medals at Aichi-Nagoya

(A) 2-3-1-4 (B) 3-2-1-4
(C) 2-1-3-4 (D) 2-3-4-1

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-3-1-4** — First Asian Games in New Delhi in 1951, second hosting in 1982, India's 107 medals at Hangzhou 2023 and then Aichi-Nagoya 2026 — so the order is 2-3-1-4.

199. Which trophy did India win for the first time at the Commonwealth Fencing (Lagos)?

(A) Benson Trophy (B) Wilkinson Sword Trophy
(C) Aston Trophy (D) Martini Cup

B **Correct answer: (B) Wilkinson Sword Trophy** — A trophy given since 1982.

200. Messi's international career numbers:

(A) 180 matches, 106 goals (B) 207 matches, 125 goals
(C) 196 matches, 112 goals (D) 210 matches, 130 goals

B **Correct answer: (B) 207 matches, 125 goals** — Messi scored 125 goals in 207 internationals; he retired on 31 August 2026 and his last match was the World Cup final.

Chapter 11 · Awards and Honours

201. The Physics Nobel 2026 is linked to which discovery/instrument?

(A) Gravitational waves, LIGO (B) Neutrinos, IceCube
(C) Quantum tunnelling (D) Dark matter, JWST

B **Correct answer: (B) Neutrinos, IceCube** — Francis Halzen, Antarctica's IceCube.

202. Third Tamil writer to get the Jnanpith:

(A) Jayakanthan (B) R. Vairamuthu
(C) Akilan (D) Perumal Murugan

B **Correct answer: (B) R. Vairamuthu** — R. Vairamuthu got the 60th Jnanpith; he is the third Tamil writer to receive it, after Akilan and Jayakanthan.

203. Where was the Dadasaheb Phalke ceremony held outside the capital for the first time?

(A) Mumbai (B) Ekta Nagar (Gujarat)
(C) Hyderabad (D) Goa

B **Correct answer: (B) Ekta Nagar (Gujarat)** — 22 September 2026; the 17th in 1970 was in Madras.

204. India's new judge at ITLOS:

(A) Neeru Chadha (B) Bimal N. Patel
(C) Dalveer Bhandari (D) D.Y. Chandrachud

B **Correct answer: (B) Bimal N. Patel** — Bimal N. Patel became a judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for 2026-35; he replaced Neeru Chadha.

205. First Indian to get the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal:

(A) Anil Bhardwaj (B) U.R. Rao (1996)
(C) G.S. Lakhina (D) Annapurni Subramaniam

B **Correct answer: (B) U.R. Rao (1996)** — First Indian woman Annapurni Subramaniam.

206. About the Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025:

1. Vigyan Ratna went posthumously to Jayant Narlikar.
2. The Vigyan Team award went to CSIR's Aroma Mission.
3. The Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar award was given separately in it.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The Bhatnagar award is now in the "Vigyan Yuva-SSB" category.

207. Match the following (award — 2026 winner):

List-I	List-II
A. Abel	1. Simon Conway Morris
B. Pritzker	2. Huub Lelieveld
C. Templeton	3. Gerd Faltings
D. World Food Prize	4. Smiljan Radić

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — Abel Faltings, Pritzker Radić, Templeton Conway Morris, Food Lelieveld.

208. How many awards are there in all in the Padma Awards 2026?

(A) 113 (B) 131
(C) 139 (D) 128

B **Correct answer: (B) 131** — The Padma Awards 2026 total 131 — 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri.

209. The International Booker 2026 winning work is translated from which language?

(A) Kannada (B) Mandarin
(C) Korean (D) Japanese

B **Correct answer: (B) Mandarin** — The International Booker 2026 went to Yang Shuang-zi's "Taiwan Travelogue", the first winning work translated from Mandarin.

210. Best feature film at the 72nd National Film Awards:

(A) Amaran (B) Article 370
(C) Kalki 2898 AD (D) Chandu Champion

B **Correct answer: (B) Article 370** — The best feature film at the 72nd National Film Awards was Aditya Jambhale's "Article 370".

211. Correct statements about the Ballon d'Or 2025:

1. The men's award went to Ousmane Dembélé.
2. Aitana Bonmatí won for the third straight time.
3. The Kopa Trophy went to Lionel Messi.

Correct statements:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The Kopa Trophy went to Lamine Yamal (for the second time).

212. Which film won the Palme d'Or at Cannes 2026?

(A) Minotaur (B) Fjord
(C) Yellow Letters (D) Woman Unknown

B **Correct answer: (B) Fjord** — Cristian Mungiu; Yellow Letters got Berlin's Golden Bear.

213. BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year 2025:

(A) Harmanpreet Kaur (B) Smriti Mandhana
(C) Divya Deshmukh (D) Jyothi Yarraji

B **Correct answer: (B) Smriti Mandhana** — Smriti Mandhana became BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year 2025 (announced 16 February 2026); Preethi Pal in the para category.

214. Sweden's "Royal Order of the Polar Star" is which number among PM Modi's foreign honours?

(A) 28th (B) 29th
(C) 31st (D) 32nd

C **Correct answer: (C) 31st** — Sweden's "Royal Order of the Polar Star" is PM Modi's 31st foreign honour; Norway's honour is the 32nd.

215. First Indian to get the Ramon Magsaysay Award:

(A) Mother Teresa (B) Vinoba Bhave
(C) Satyajit Ray (D) Kiran Bedi

B **Correct answer: (B) Vinoba Bhave** — The Ramon Magsaysay Award began in 1958 and the first Indian winner was Vinoba Bhave; in 2025 "Educate Girls" became the first Indian organisation to receive it.

216. Who got the Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development 2025?

(A) Navi Pillay (B) Graça Machel
(C) Michelle Bachelet (D) Jacinda Ardern

B **Correct answer: (B) Graça Machel** — Announced 21 January 2026; Indira Gandhi Memorial Trust.

217. The special point of the "Album of the Year" at the Grammys 2026:

(A) First time to a woman (B) First Spanish-language album
(C) First Indian collaboration (D) First live album

B **Correct answer: (B) First Spanish-language album** — Bad Bunny — "DeBÍ TiRAR MáS FOToS".

218. Who got the Sakharov Prize 2025?

(A) Two jailed journalists (B) The Ukrainian people
(C) Alexei Navalny (D) The Iranian women's movement

A **Correct answer: (A) Two jailed journalists** — Andrzej Poczobut (Belarus), Mzia Amaglobeli (Georgia).

219. In which year was the Bharat Ratna last announced (as of October 2026)?

(A) 2019 (B) 2024
(C) 2025 (D) 2026

B **Correct answer: (B) 2024** — The Bharat Ratna was last announced in 2024 — to five personalities including Karpoori Thakur; no new announcement was made in 2025-26.

220. Who got the Sahitya Akademi 2025 (Hindi)?

(A) Vinod Kumar Shukla (B) Mamta Kalia
(C) Suryabala (D) Gagan Gill

B **Correct answer: (B) Mamta Kalia** — "Jeete Jee Allahabad"; the 59th Jnanpith went to Vinod Kumar Shukla.

Chapter 12 · Indices and Rankings

221. Last country in EPI 2026:

(A) India (B) Laos
(C) Myanmar (D) Pakistan

B **Correct answer: (B) Laos** — Of 177 countries in EPI 2026, Laos is last; India is 176th and Estonia first.

222. India's best sub-index in the Gender Gap Report:

(A) Educational attainment (B) Political empowerment
(C) Health-survival (D) Economic participation

B **Correct answer: (B) Political empowerment** — India's best sub-index in the Gender Gap Report is political empowerment (rank 67); the worst is economic participation (143).

223. State with the highest score in the Fiscal Health Index:

(A) Gujarat (B) Odisha
(C) Goa (D) Arunachal

B **Correct answer: (B) Odisha** — In NITI Aayog's Fiscal Health Index, Odisha is highest with 73.1 points and is in the "Achievers" category.

224. India's nuclear warheads as per SIPRI 2026:

(A) 170 (B) 180
(C) 190 (D) 225

C **Correct answer: (C) 190** — According to SIPRI 2026, India has about 190 nuclear warheads, up from 180 the previous year.

225. UP block that won Zone-2 in Aspirational Blocks Delta:

(A) Chakia (B) Bansgaon (Gorakhpur)
(C) Maharajganj (D) Mihinpurwa

B **Correct answer: (B) Bansgaon (Gorakhpur)** — In the Aspirational Blocks Delta ranking, Gorakhpur's Bansgaon block came first in Zone-2 and won a ₹1.5 crore award.

226. In which of these indices is a high rank bad?

1. Global Terrorism Index
2. Climate Risk Index
3. Global Innovation Index

Choose the correct:

(A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only
(C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) 1 and 2 only** — The first two statements are correct — a high rank is bad in the terrorism and climate risk indices; but in the innovation index a high rank is good.

227. India's rank in the Corruption Perceptions Index 2025:

(A) 85 (B) 91
(C) 96 (D) 100

B **Correct answer: (B) 91** — In the Corruption Perceptions Index 2025, India is 91st of 180 countries (score 39); it was 96th the previous year.

228. Match the following (index — body):

List-I	List-II
A. Global Peace Index	1. WIPO
B. Press Freedom	2. Yale + Columbia
C. Global Innovation	3. IEP
D. Environmental Performance	4. RSF

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — GPI IEP, press RSF, GII WIPO, EPI Yale-Columbia.

229. India's top institution in the QS World Rankings 2027:

(A) IISc (B) IIT Delhi
(C) IIT Bombay (D) IIT Madras

B **Correct answer: (B) IIT Delhi** — India's top institution in the QS World Rankings 2027 is IIT Delhi — rank 118, up from 123.

230. First in the THE World Rankings 2027:

(A) MIT (B) Oxford
(C) Stanford (D) Cambridge

B **Correct answer: (B) Oxford** — Oxford was first in the THE World Rankings 2027 for the 11th time; first in the QS rankings is MIT.

231. Which of these is below India in the Press Freedom Index?

(A) Pakistan (B) China
(C) Bangladesh (D) Sri Lanka

B **Correct answer: (B) China** — India is 157th in the Press Freedom Index; among the options only China is below India — it is third from the bottom.

232. First country in the Global Gender Gap:

(A) Finland (B) Iceland
(C) Norway (D) New Zealand

B **Correct answer: (B) Iceland** — Iceland is first in the Global Gender Gap Index for the 17th straight year, having closed 93.0% of the gap.

233. First among large states in the Investment Friendliness Index (NITI):

(A) Maharashtra (B) Gujarat
(C) Tamil Nadu (D) Odisha

B **Correct answer: (B) Gujarat** — In NITI Aayog's first Investment Friendliness Index (17 July 2026), Gujarat was first among large states with 56.6 points; then Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu.

234. India's rank in the World Happiness Report:

(A) 104 (B) 116
(C) 118 (D) 126

B **Correct answer: (B) 116** — India is 116th of 147 countries in the World Happiness Report 2026; it was 118th the previous year.

235. India in the Global Hunger Index:

(A) 102nd, "serious" (B) 100th, "serious"
(C) 105th, "alarming" (D) 94th, "moderate"

B **Correct answer: (B) 100th, "serious"** — India is 100th of 122 countries in the Global Hunger Index 2026; with a score of 24.1 it is in the "serious" category.

236. Correct order of India's EPI ranks (2016 to 2022):

1. 180
2. 141
3. 168
4. 177

(A) 2-4-3-1 (B) 2-3-4-1
(C) 4-2-3-1 (D) 2-4-1-3

A **Correct answer: (A) 2-4-3-1** — India's EPI rank was 141 in 2016, 177 in 2018, 168 in 2020 and 180 in 2022 — so the correct order is 2-4-3-1.

237. Top in IEMI (electric mobility):

(A) Maharashtra (B) Delhi
(C) Karnataka (D) Goa

B **Correct answer: (B) Delhi** — Delhi tops the Electric Mobility Index (IEMI) with 84 points.

238. Top country by number of institutions in THE Asia 2026:

(A) Japan (B) India
(C) China (D) Türkiye

B **Correct answer: (B) India** — In THE Asia 2026, India tops by number of institutions with 128; Japan is second with 115.

239. First in the School Education Quality Index (SEQI):

(A) Kerala (B) Punjab
(C) Delhi (D) Himachal

B **Correct answer: (B) Punjab** — Punjab is first in the School Education Quality Index (SEQI), while it was 27th in 2020.

240. Top risk in the WEF Global Risks 2026:

(A) Climate change (B) Geoeconomic confrontation
(C) AI misinformation (D) Pandemic

B **Correct answer: (B) Geoeconomic confrontation** — The top risk in the WEF Global Risks Report 2026 is "geoeconomic confrontation"; the report's theme is "A New Age of Competition".

Chapter 13 · Days and Themes

241. National Maritime Day commemorates which event?

(A) Commissioning of INS Vikrant (B) S.S. Loyalty's Mumbai-London voyage (1919)
(C) First Indian port (D) Founding of the Navy

B **Correct answer: (B) S.S. Loyalty's Mumbai-London voyage (1919)** — 1919; Day since 1964.

242. Hindi Journalism Day is linked to which newspaper?

(A) Bangdoot (B) Udant Martand (1826)
(C) Saraswati (D) Pratap

B **Correct answer: (B) Udant Martand (1826)** — Pt. Jugal Kishore Shukla, Kolkata.

243. Police Commemoration Day is based on which event?

(A) Jallianwala Bagh (B) Hot Springs, Ladakh 1959
(C) Chauri Chaura (D) Pulwama

B **Correct answer: (B) Hot Springs, Ladakh 1959** — Police Commemoration Day (21 October) honours the 10 CRPF jawans martyred at Hot Springs, Ladakh in 1959.

244. How often does World Statistics Day come?

(A) Every year (B) Every 2 years
(C) Every 5 years (D) Every 10 years

C **Correct answer: (C) Every 5 years** — World Statistics Day (20 October) is observed every 5 years — 2010, 2015, 2020, 2025; next in 2030.

245. The resolution for the new UN Day (27 November) was the initiative of which country?

(A) India (B) Sierra Leone
(C) Nigeria (D) Bangladesh

B **Correct answer: (B) Sierra Leone** — The new UN Day for ending child and forced marriage (27 November) was passed in the UNGA on 4 September 2026 on Sierra Leone's initiative; India was a co-sponsor.

246. Theme of World Radio Day 2026:

(A) Radio and Climate Change (B) Radio and Artificial Intelligence
(C) Radio and Peace (D) Radio and Sports

B **Correct answer: (B) Radio and Artificial Intelligence** — Tagline "AI is a tool, not a voice".

247. Match the following (day — 2026 theme):

List-I	List-II
A. World Health Day	1. Our Power, Our Planet
B. World Water Day	2. Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.
C. Earth Day	3. Together for Health. Stand with Science.
D. World Environment Day	4. Water and Gender

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — Health "Stand with Science", water "Water and Gender", earth "Our Power...", environment "Inspired by Nature...".

248. Theme and main venue of the 12th International Day of Yoga:

(A) "Yoga for One Earth", Visakhapatnam
(B) "Yoga for Healthy Ageing", Red Road Kolkata
(C) "Yoga for Self and Society", Srinagar
(D) "Yoga for Humanity", Mysuru

B **Correct answer: (B) "Yoga for Healthy Ageing", Red Road Kolkata** — The PM led it in Kolkata.

249. Which body declared the theme of World Mental Health Day 2026?

(A) WHO
(B) WFMH (World Federation for Mental Health)
(C) UNICEF
(D) UNESCO

B **Correct answer: (B) WFMH (World Federation for Mental Health)** — "Lived Experiences Heard: Real Voices, Real Change".

250. Why is World Food Day observed on 16 October?

(A) Founding of the WFP
(B) Founding of the FAO (1945)
(C) Green Revolution
(D) Founding of IFAD

B **Correct answer: (B) Founding of the FAO (1945)** — 2026 theme "Innovate Today. Nourish Tomorrow."

251. Match the days made from birth anniversaries:

List-I	List-II
A. 29 June	1. M. Visvesvaraya
B. 15 September	2. Ramanujan
C. 12 August	3. P.C. Mahalanobis
D. 22 December	4. S.R. Ranganathan

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (D) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — Mahalanobis, Visvesvaraya, Ranganathan, Ramanujan.

252. The theme of World Wildlife Day 2026 relates to:

(A) Coral reefs
(B) Medicinal and aromatic plants
(C) Big cats
(D) Migratory birds

B **Correct answer: (B) Medicinal and aromatic plants** — "Medicinal and Aromatic Plants...".

253. Focus of the National Science Day 2026 theme:

(A) Space
(B) Women in science
(C) AI
(D) Indigenous technology

B **Correct answer: (B) Women in science** — "Women in Science: Catalyzing Viksit Bharat".

254. Theme of Human Rights Day 2025:

(A) Our Rights, Our Future, Right Now
(B) Human Rights, Our Everyday Essentials
(C) Dignity, Freedom and Justice for All
(D) Equality — Reducing Inequalities

B **Correct answer: (B) Human Rights, Our Everyday Essentials** — 10 December 2025.

255. World Blood Donor Day is observed on whose birth anniversary?

(A) Louis Pasteur
(B) Karl Landsteiner
(C) Robert Koch
(D) Jonas Salk

B **Correct answer: (B) Karl Landsteiner** — World Blood Donor Day (14 June) is observed on the birth anniversary of Karl Landsteiner, who discovered the ABO blood groups.

256. International Mother Language Day commemorates which movement?

(A) Dhaka language movement 1952 (B) Tamil anti-Hindi agitation 1965
(C) Punjabi Suba movement (D) Andhra state movement

A **Correct answer: (A) Dhaka language movement 1952** — UNESCO has observed International Mother Language Day (21 February) since 2000 in memory of the 1952 Dhaka language movement.

257. Where was the main event of the third National Space Day held?

(A) Bengaluru (B) Ahmedabad
(C) Sriharikota (D) New Delhi

B **Correct answer: (B) Ahmedabad** — The main event of the third National Space Day (23 August) was held in Ahmedabad; the chief guest was Gajendra Singh Shekhawat.

258. Host country of World Tourism Day 2026:

(A) Saudi Arabia (B) El Salvador
(C) Malaysia (D) Georgia

B **Correct answer: (B) El Salvador** — The host of World Tourism Day 2026 was El Salvador; the theme was "Digital Agenda and AI to Redesign Tourism".

259. Theme of World AIDS Day 2025:

(A) Let Communities Lead (B) Overcoming disruption, transforming the AIDS response
(C) Equalize (D) Take the Rights Path

B **Correct answer: (B) Overcoming disruption, transforming the AIDS response** — 1 December 2025.

260. National Safe Motherhood Day (11 April) is whose birth anniversary?

(A) Sarojini Naidu (B) Kasturba Gandhi
(C) Savitribai Phule (D) Indira Gandhi

B **Correct answer: (B) Kasturba Gandhi** — National Safe Motherhood Day (11 April) has been observed since 2003 on Kasturba Gandhi's birth anniversary (a White Ribbon Alliance initiative).

Chapter 14 · Uttar Pradesh Special

261. In which district is the 3.5 km emergency airstrip on the Ganga Expressway?

(A) Hardoi (B) Shahjahanpur
(C) Budaun (D) Unnao

B **Correct answer: (B) Shahjahanpur** — Inauguration from Hardoi, airstrip in Shahjahanpur.

262. On which river is the Parichha dam?

(A) Ken (B) Betwa
(C) Dhasan (D) Yamuna

B **Correct answer: (B) Betwa** — Jhansi's Parichha dam is on the Betwa river and is the headworks of the Betwa canal system; it was declared a World Heritage Irrigation Structure.

263. Uttar Pradesh's 14th Ramsar site:

(A) Sheikha Lake (B) Surha Tal
(C) Sauj Lake (D) Haiderpur

C **Correct answer: (C) Sauj Lake** — Mainpuri's Sauj Lake became UP's 14th and India's 103rd Ramsar site on 15 October 2026.

264. Who was hanged first in the Kakori case?

(A) Bismil, Gorakhpur (B) Rajendra Nath Lahiri, Gonda
(C) Ashfaqulla, Faizabad (D) Roshan Singh, Naini

B **Correct answer: (B) Rajendra Nath Lahiri, Gonda** — 17 December 1927; the other three on 19 December.

265. Largest share in UP's supplementary budget (4 August 2026):

(A) Education (B) Rural development
(C) Heavy-medium industries (D) Energy

C **Correct answer: (C) Heavy-medium industries** — The largest share in UP's supplementary budget (4 August 2026) went to heavy-medium industries — ₹22,107 crore; education was not mentioned.

266. Who has the largest single shareholding in IRRPL?

(A) Kalashnikov (B) AWEIL
(C) Rosoboronexport (D) Munitions India

B **Correct answer: (B) AWEIL** — The largest single shareholding in IRRPL (Amethi) is India's AWEIL (42.5%); Russia's Kalashnikov has 42%.

267. In which category did UNESCO make Lucknow a Creative City?

(A) Music (B) Crafts and folk art
(C) Gastronomy (D) Literature

C **Correct answer: (C) Gastronomy** — UNESCO made Lucknow a Creative City in the Gastronomy category at the Samarkand conference in October 2025; the second Indian city after Hyderabad.

268. In which session was Sarnath declared World Heritage?

(A) 47th, Paris (B) 48th, Busan
(C) 46th, New Delhi (D) 45th, Riyadh

B **Correct answer: (B) 48th, Busan** — Sarnath was declared World Heritage on 25 July 2026 at the 48th session in Busan, South Korea — India's 45th site.

269. Where is India's first urban public-transport ropeway?

(A) Prayagraj (B) Varanasi
(C) Dehradun (D) Guwahati

B **Correct answer: (B) Varanasi** — India's first urban public-transport ropeway is in Varanasi — from Cantt station to Godowlia, 3.85 km.

270. Match the following (district — story):

List-I	List-II
A. Mathura	1. Forestry university
B. Gorakhpur	2. 250 MW solar
C. Kanpur	3. National Cow Culture Museum
D. Sitapur	4. India-France aeronautics centre

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (D) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — Cow museum, forestry univ., aeronautics centre, 250 MW solar.

271. Put in chronological order:

1. Privy Council rejected the appeal
2. Kakori Train Action
3. HRA became HSRA
4. Lahiri hanged

(A) 2-1-4-3 (B) 2-4-1-3
(C) 1-2-4-3 (D) 2-1-3-4

B **Correct answer: (B) 2-4-1-3** — 1925 → 16 September 1927 → 17 December 1927 → 1928.

272. Statements:

1. UP is first in pulse production
2. UP is first in sugarcane production

Choose the correct statement(s).

(A) 1 only (B) 2 only
(C) Both 1 and 2 (D) Neither 1 nor 2

B **Correct answer: (B) 2 only** — Only the second statement is correct — UP is first in sugarcane; the first is wrong because UP is fourth in pulses.

273. UP's GI tags as per IP India (2 May 2026):

(A) 74 (B) 79
(C) 81 (D) 58

B **Correct answer: (B) 79** — As per IP India (2 May 2026), UP has 79 GI tags, the most in the country; PIB says 81 — the two count differently.

274. Prototype grant in the UP Startup Policy 2026:

(A) ₹5 lakh (B) ₹7.5 lakh
(C) ₹10 lakh (D) ₹15 lakh

C **Correct answer: (C) ₹10 lakh** — In the UP Startup Policy 2026 the prototype grant rose from ₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh and seed funding from ₹7.5 lakh to ₹15 lakh.

275. Limit of the interest-free loan under the CM Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan:

(A) ₹2 lakh (B) ₹5 lakh
(C) ₹10 lakh (D) ₹25 lakh

B **Correct answer: (B) ₹5 lakh** — Under the CM Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan, the loan up to ₹5 lakh is both interest-free and collateral-free; age limit 21-40 years.

276. From which body is the loan for UP's Clean Air Management Programme?

(A) ADB (B) World Bank
(C) AIIB (D) JICA

B **Correct answer: (B) World Bank** — The World Bank gave a loan of 299.66 million dollars for UP's Clean Air Management Programme; it is a tripartite agreement of the World Bank, the Government of India and UP.

277. In what form was Kalinjar Fort recently in the news?

(A) UNESCO World Heritage
(B) GSI National Geo-heritage Site
(C) Ramsar site
(D) WHIS

B **Correct answer: (B) GSI National Geo-heritage Site** — Kalinjar Fort in Banda district was declared a National Geo-heritage Site by the Geological Survey of India (GSI).

278. Honoured from the space field in UP Gaurav Samman 2026:

(A) Rakesh Sharma
(B) Shubhanshu Shukla
(C) Kalpana Chawla
(D) Sunita Williams

B **Correct answer: (B) Shubhanshu Shukla** — Shubhanshu Shukla was honoured from the space field in UP Gaurav Samman 2026 — the first Indian to go to the ISS.

279. The country's first district with 100% insurance coverage:

(A) Lucknow
(B) Varanasi
(C) Alwar
(D) Indore

C **Correct answer: (C) Alwar** — The country's first district with 100% insurance coverage is Alwar in Rajasthan — not any district of UP.

280. Who became the 50th Chief Justice of the Bombay High Court?

(A) Ashwani Kumar Mishra
(B) Mahesh Chandra Tripathi
(C) Arun Bhansali
(D) Dinesh Sharma

B **Correct answer: (B) Mahesh Chandra Tripathi** — Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi of the Allahabad High Court became the 50th Chief Justice of the Bombay High Court on 9 September 2026.

Chapter 15 · Quick Revision

281. India's 45th World Heritage Site:

(A) Maratha Military Landscapes
(B) Sarnath
(C) Moidams
(D) Santiniketan

B **Correct answer: (B) Sarnath** — Sarnath was added to the World Heritage List at Busan (South Korea) on 25 July 2026 and became India's 45th site; the 44th was the Maratha Military Landscapes.

282. In which district is India's 100th Ramsar site?

(A) Aligarh
(B) Ballia
(C) Mainpuri
(D) Gorakhpur

B **Correct answer: (B) Ballia** — India's 100th Ramsar site, Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary), is in Ballia district; it was added on 5 June 2026.

283. The 131st Constitution Amendment Bill fell with how many "ayes"?

(A) 352
(B) 298
(C) 230
(D) 272

B **Correct answer: (B) 298** — The 131st Constitution Amendment Bill got only 298 votes in favour, while 352 were needed for a two-thirds majority.

284. Repo rate after the 7 October 2026 review:

(A) 5.25%
(B) 5.50%
(C) 5.75%
(D) 6.00%

B **Correct answer: (B) 5.50%** — In the 7 October 2026 monetary policy review the RBI raised the repo rate from 5.25% to 5.50% — the first hike since February 2023.

285. New criterion added to the 16th Finance Commission's devolution:

(A) Population
(B) State's contribution to GDP
(C) Forest cover
(D) Tax effort

B **Correct answer: (B) State's contribution to GDP** — The 16th Finance Commission added a new criterion, "state's contribution to GDP", for devolution to states, with a weight of 10%.

286. How many days of work per household under VB-G RAM G?

(A) 100
(B) 125
(C) 150
(D) 200

B **Correct answer: (B) 125** — VB-G RAM G (replacing MGNREGA) guarantees 125 days of work per rural household; MGNREGA had 100 days.

287. Reference date for snow-bound areas in Census 2027:

(A) 1 March 2027
(B) 1 October 2026
(C) 1 January 2027
(D) 1 April 2026

B **Correct answer: (B) 1 October 2026** — In Census 2027 the reference date for snow-bound areas is 1 October 2026; for the rest of the country 1 March 2027.

288. India's first private orbital rocket:

(A) Agnibaan
(B) Vikram-1
(C) Vikram-S
(D) SSLV

B **Correct answer: (B) Vikram-1** — Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 became India's first private rocket to reach orbit on 18 July 2026; Vikram-S (2022) was sub-orbital.

289. Route of the country's first hydrogen train:

(A) Jind-Sonipat (B) Delhi-Meerut
(C) Kalka-Shimla (D) Malda-Kamakhya

A **Correct answer: (A) Jind-Sonipat** — The country's first hydrogen train "Namo Green Rail" ran on Haryana's Jind-Sonipat section (about 89 km) on 17 July 2026.

290. Whom did India beat in the final of the men's T20 World Cup 2026?

(A) Australia (B) South Africa
(C) New Zealand (D) England

C **Correct answer: (C) New Zealand** — In the final of the men's T20 World Cup 2026 (Ahmedabad, 8 March), India beat New Zealand by 96 runs.

291. Winner of the FIFA World Cup 2026:

(A) Argentina (B) France
(C) Spain (D) Brazil

C **Correct answer: (C) Spain** — Spain won the FIFA World Cup 2026 — beating Argentina 1-0 in extra time in the final on 19 July; Spain's second title (first in 2010).

292. The 60th Jnanpith Award:

(A) Vinod Kumar Shukla (B) R. Vairamuthu
(C) Gulzar (D) Damodar Mauzo

B **Correct answer: (B) R. Vairamuthu** — The 60th Jnanpith (2025) went to Tamil poet-lyricist R. Vairamuthu; the 59th to Vinod Kumar Shukla of Hindi.

293. Nobel Peace Prize 2026:

(A) María Corina Machado (B) Navi Pillay
(C) Nihon Hidankyo (D) Narges Mohammadi

B **Correct answer: (B) Navi Pillay** — The Nobel Peace Prize 2026 went to South Africa's Navi Pillay — former UN High Commissioner for Human Rights; in 2025 it went to María Corina Machado.

294. India in the Environmental Performance Index (EPI) 2026:

(A) 180 (B) 176
(C) 165 (D) 157

B **Correct answer: (B) 176** — India is 176th of 177 countries in the Environmental Performance Index (EPI) 2026; last is Laos and first Estonia.

295. On which date is the new UN Day (ending child and forced marriage)?

(A) 11 October (B) 27 November
(C) 19 November (D) 12 June

B **Correct answer: (B) 27 November** — The new UN Day for ending child and forced marriage will be observed on 27 November; the UNGA passed it on 4 September 2026.

296. Total fertility rate (TFR) in NFHS-6:

(A) 2.2 (B) 2.0
(C) 1.9 (D) 2.1

B **Correct answer: (B) 2.0** — India's total fertility rate (TFR) in NFHS-6 is 2.0, below the replacement level of 2.1; urban 1.6 and rural 2.1.

297. Number of organ transplants in India in 2025:

(A) 18,911 (B) 20,138
(C) 16,000 (D) 22,500

B **Correct answer: (B) 20,138** — India had 20,138 organ transplants in 2025 — past 20,000 for the first time; India is third in the world in total transplants.

298. First state in literacy (PLFS 2023-24):

(A) Kerala (B) Mizoram
(C) Goa (D) Tripura

B **Correct answer: (B) Mizoram** — As per PLFS 2023-24, Mizoram (98.2%) is first in literacy; Kerala is now fourth.

299. Architect of Kumbhalgarh:

(A) Mandan (B) Jaita
(C) Lakha (D) Kalyan

A **Correct answer: (A) Mandan** — The architect of Kumbhalgarh Fort (Rajsamand, Rajasthan) was Mandan, who built it for Rana Kumbha.

300. Who first sang Vande Mataram (1896, Congress session)?

(A) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay (B) Rabindranath Tagore
(C) Sarala Devi (D) Aurobindo Ghosh

B **Correct answer: (B) Rabindranath Tagore** — Vande Mataram was first sung by Rabindranath Tagore at the Calcutta session of the Congress in 1896.

301. India's total golds at the Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games:

(A) 9 (B) 13
(C) 22 (D) 18

B **Correct answer: (B) 13** — India won 13 golds in all at the Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games — 7 of them in boxing.

302. First Indian weightlifter to win three consecutive Commonwealth golds:

(A) Mirabai Chanu (B) Sanjita Chanu
(C) Kunjarani Devi (D) Poonam Yadav

A **Correct answer: (A) Mirabai Chanu** — 2018, 2022, 2026 — in wrestling Vinesh Phogat had already won three in a row.

303. Winner of IPL 2026:

(A) Mumbai Indians (B) Royal Challengers Bengaluru
(C) Chennai Super Kings (D) Gujarat Titans

B **Correct answer: (B) Royal Challengers Bengaluru** — Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) won IPL 2026 — beating Gujarat Titans by 5 wickets in the final for a second straight title.

304. Winner of the Hockey World Cup 2026 (women):

(A) Netherlands (B) Argentina
(C) Australia (D) Germany

B **Correct answer: (B) Argentina** — Argentina won the Hockey World Cup 2026 (women) — beating the Netherlands 3-1 in a shootout in the final.

305. Youngest grandmaster in chess history (Indian origin):

(A) D. Gukesh (B) Abhimanyu Mishra
(C) R. Praggnanandhaa (D) Raunak Sadhwani

B **Correct answer: (B) Abhimanyu Mishra** — American; India's youngest GM is Gukesh.

306. Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024:

(A) Mohanlal (B) Anant Nag
(C) Mithun Chakraborty (D) Waheeda Rehman

B **Correct answer: (B) Anant Nag** — The 2024 (56th) Dadasaheb Phalke Award went to Kannada actor Anant Nag; the ceremony was held at Ekta Nagar (Gujarat).

307. Total number of Padma Awards 2026:

(A) 139 (B) 131
(C) 132 (D) 128

B **Correct answer: (B) 131** — The Padma Awards 2026 total 131 — 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri.

308. The International Booker 2026 winning work is translated from which language?

(A) Kannada (B) Mandarin
(C) Korean (D) Japanese

B **Correct answer: (B) Mandarin** — The International Booker 2026 winner "Taiwan Travelogue" is translated from Mandarin; the 2025 winner "Heart Lamp" was from Kannada.

309. New Chief Economist of the World Bank:

(A) Indermit Gill (B) Michael Kremer
(C) Gita Gopinath (D) Pinelopi Goldberg

B **Correct answer: (B) Michael Kremer** — The World Bank's new Chief Economist is Michael Kremer (Economics Nobel 2019); he replaced Indermit Gill.

310. India in the World Press Freedom Index 2026:

(A) 151 (B) 157
(C) 159 (D) 161

B **Correct answer: (B) 157** — India is 157th of 180 countries in the World Press Freedom Index 2026 (RSF); it was 151st the previous year.

311. India's worst sub-index in the Global Gender Gap Index:

(A) Educational attainment (B) Health and survival
(C) Economic participation (D) Political empowerment

C **Correct answer: (C) Economic participation** — India's worst sub-index in the Global Gender Gap Index is "economic participation and opportunity" — 143rd place.

312. India's top institution in the QS World Rankings 2027:

(A) IISc (B) IIT Delhi
(C) IIT Bombay (D) IIT Madras

B **Correct answer: (B) IIT Delhi** — India's top institution in the QS World Rankings 2027 is IIT Delhi — 118th place (earlier 123).

313. National Statistics Day (29 June) is whose birth anniversary?

(A) C.R. Rao (B) P.C. Mahalanobis
(C) P.V. Sukhatme (D) V.K.R.V. Rao

B **Correct answer: (B) P.C. Mahalanobis** — National Statistics Day (29 June) is observed on the birth anniversary of P.C. Mahalanobis, who founded the Indian Statistical Institute (ISI, 1931).

314. Hindi Journalism Day:

(A) 14 September (B) 30 May
(C) 16 November (D) 3 May

B **Correct answer: (B) 30 May** — Hindi Journalism Day is observed on 30 May — on this day in 1826 the first Hindi newspaper "Udant Martand" came out from Kolkata.

315. Size of the Uttar Pradesh Budget 2026-27:

(A) ₹8,08,736 crore (B) ₹9,12,696 crore
(C) ₹7,36,437 crore (D) ₹10,02,000 crore

B **Correct answer: (B) ₹9,12,696 crore** — The size of the UP Budget 2026-27 is ₹9,12,696 crore — the largest ever; ₹8,08,736 crore was the 2025-26 budget.

316. Through how many districts does the Ganga Expressway pass?

(A) 10 (B) 12
(C) 14 (D) 16

B **Correct answer: (B) 12** — The Ganga Expressway (594 km) passes through 12 districts from Meerut to Prayagraj; it was inaugurated from Hardoi on 29 April 2026.

317. UP's rank in pulse production:

(A) First (B) Second
(C) Third (D) Fourth

D **Correct answer: (D) Fourth** — UP is fourth in pulse production — after Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Maharashtra.

318. Who declared the Parichha dam a World Heritage Irrigation Structure?

(A) UNESCO (B) ICID
(C) ICOLD (D) IWMI

B **Correct answer: (B) ICID** — The International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage (ICID) declared the Parichha dam a World Heritage Irrigation Structure on 13 August 2026.

319. How many golds did India get at IPhO 2026?

(A) 3 (B) 4
(C) 5 (D) 2

C **Correct answer: (C) 5** — At the International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026 all five Indian students won gold (5/5) and India was joint first.

320. Oxford Word of the Year 2025:

(A) vibe coding (B) rage bait
(C) parasocial (D) slop

B **Correct answer: (B) rage bait** — Collins vibe coding, Cambridge parasocial, Merriam-Webster slop.

Chapter 16 · Budget and Economic Survey: India and Uttar Pradesh

321. According to the Economic Survey 2025-26, what was India's real GDP growth in FY26?

(A) 6.8% (B) 7.2%
(C) 7.4% (D) 8.2%

C **Correct answer: (C) 7.4%** — As per the Economic Survey 2025-26, real GDP growth in FY26 was 7.4%. The 6.8-7.2% range is the projection for the next year, FY27, so keep the two apart.

322. The Economic Survey 2025-26 projects FY27 growth at:

(A) 6.3%-6.8% (B) 6.8%-7.2%
(C) 7.0%-7.5% (D) 7.4%-7.8%

B **Correct answer: (B) 6.8%-7.2%** — The Survey projects 6.8% to 7.2% growth for FY27. FY26 actual growth was 7.4%, above this range.

323. Match the sector-wise shares (FY26, First Advance Estimates):

List-I	List-II
A. Services	1. 24.3%
B. Industry	2. 15.2%
C. Agriculture	3. 51.1%
D. Services in GVA	4. 56.4%

(A) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4 (B) A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3 (C) A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4 (D) A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4** — In FY26 first advance estimates, services are 51.1% of GDP, industry 24.3% and agriculture 15.2%. The services share in GVA is higher, at 56.4%.

324. Arrange the MPI figures from highest to lowest:

1. 11.28%
2. 55.3%
3. 14.96%

(A) 2-3-1 (B) 1-3-2
(C) 2-1-3 (D) 3-2-1

C **Correct answer: (C) 2-1-3** — MPI was 55.3% in 2005-06, fell to 14.96% in 2019-21 and to 11.28% in 2022-23. So the highest-to-lowest order is 2-1-3.

325. According to the December 2025 PLFS, which pair is correct?

(A) Unemployment rate — 4.7% (B) Labour force participation rate — 56.1%
(C) Female LFPR — 41.7% (D) WPR — 56.1%

B **Correct answer: (B) Labour force participation rate — 56.1%** — In the December 2025 PLFS, LFPR was 56.1%, WPR 53.4% and the unemployment rate 4.8%. 4.7% was November 2025 unemployment, and female LFPR was 35.3%.

326. Statements about India's remittances in FY25:

1. They were about $135.4 billion.
2. India was the world's largest recipient.

Correct?

(A) Only 1 (B) Only 2
(C) Both 1 and 2 (D) Neither 1 nor 2

C **Correct answer: (C) Both 1 and 2** — India received about $135.4 billion in remittances in FY25. With this it stayed the world's largest recipient, so both statements are correct.

327. Which was India's largest export destination in FY25?

(A) UAE (B) USA
(C) Netherlands (D) China

B **Correct answer: (B) USA** — India's largest export destination in FY25 was the USA ($86.51 billion). The UAE ($36.64 billion) and the Netherlands ($22.76 billion) followed.

328. India's largest import source country in FY25:

(A) Russia (B) UAE
(C) China (D) Saudi Arabia

C **Correct answer: (C) China** — China ($113.46 billion) was India's largest import source in FY25. Russia ($63.84 billion) was second and the UAE ($63.42 billion) third.

329. Which item was sixth among India's major imports in FY25?

(A) Fertilisers (B) Coal
(C) Gold (D) Machinery

B **Correct answer: (B) Coal** — Coal ($31.09 billion) was sixth among imports. Fertilisers are not in the top 5, while gold is third and machinery fourth.

330. As per the Economic Survey, what share of FDI went to the services sector (FY23-FY25 average)?

(A) 56.4% (B) 61.5%
(C) 80.2% (D) 49.8%

C **Correct answer: (C) 80.2%** — Per the Survey, 80.2% of FDI went to services on the FY23-FY25 average. 61.5% is the share of private consumption in GDP, which should not be confused with it.

331. According to IRENA, India's rank in the world in total renewable energy capacity:

(A) Second (B) Third
(C) Fourth (D) Fifth

C **Correct answer: (C) Fourth** — According to IRENA, India is fourth in total renewable capacity after China, the US and Brazil. The Survey's "third" refers only to solar power.

332. Length of national highways from 2013-14 to December 2025:

(A) 65,569 to 1,26,350 km (B) 91,287 to 1,46,572 km
(C) 97,830 to 1,46,572 km (D) 91,287 to 1,32,500 km

B **Correct answer: (B) 91,287 to 1,46,572 km** — National highways were 91,287 km in 2013-14 and reached 1,46,572 km by December 2025. That is an increase of about 60%.

333. Statements about Union Budget 2026-27:

1. It was the first Union Budget presented on a Sunday.
2. It was the first budget prepared in Kartavya Bhawan.
3. The record of 10 budgets belongs to the present Finance Minister.

Correct?

(A) Only 1 and 2 (B) Only 2 and 3
(C) Only 1 and 3 (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) Only 1 and 2** — Budget 2026-27 was the first Sunday budget and also the first prepared in Kartavya Bhawan. The record of 10 budgets belongs to Morarji Desai; this was the present Finance Minister's 9th in a row.

334. Fiscal deficit target for 2026-27 (BE) in the Union Budget:

(A) 4.8% (B) 4.4%
(C) 4.3% (D) 3.0%

C **Correct answer: (C) 4.3%** — The fiscal deficit target for 2026-27 (BE) is 4.3% of GDP. 4.4% is the revised estimate (RE) for 2025-26 and 4.8% the actual for 2024-25.

335. Which head received the largest allocation in Union Budget 2026-27?

(A) Transport (B) Defence
(C) Interest payments (D) Food subsidy

C **Correct answer: (C) Interest payments** — The largest allocation is interest payments (₹14,03,972 crore). Transport (₹5,98,520 crore) and defence excluding pensions (₹5,94,585 crore) follow.

336. Total defence allocation including pensions (Budget 2026-27) is about:

(A) ₹5,94,585 crore (B) ₹6,81,210 crore
(C) ₹7,84,678 crore (D) ₹14,03,972 crore

C **Correct answer: (C) ₹7,84,678 crore** — Total defence allocation including pensions is ₹7,84,678 crore. ₹5,94,585 crore is the defence figure excluding pensions.

337. In Budget 2026-27, the ₹2,78,030 crore for railways is:

(A) Total capex (B) Gross Budgetary Support (GBS)
(C) Gross budgetary outlay (D) Internal resources

B **Correct answer: (B) Gross Budgetary Support (GBS)** — The ₹2,78,030 crore for railways is "Gross Budgetary Support (GBS)", not "gross budgetary outlay". Total railway capex is higher, at ₹2,93,030 crore.

338. Which is NOT among the 7 high-speed rail corridors of Budget 2026-27?

(A) Delhi-Varanasi (B) Varanasi-Siliguri
(C) Delhi-Amritsar (D) Chennai-Bengaluru

C **Correct answer: (C) Delhi-Amritsar** — The 7 corridors are Mumbai-Pune, Pune-Hyderabad, Hyderabad-Bengaluru, Hyderabad-Chennai, Chennai-Bengaluru, Delhi-Varanasi and Varanasi-Siliguri. Delhi-Amritsar is not on the list.

339. Match (Budget announcement — amount/fact):

List-I	List-II
A. Biopharma Shakti Mission	1. ₹5,000 crore per CER
B. CCUS programme	2. 20 (starting NW-5)
C. City Economic Region (CER)	3. ₹10,000 crore
D. New National Waterways	4. ₹20,000 crore

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — The Biopharma Shakti Mission is ₹10,000 crore and the CCUS programme ₹20,000 crore, both over 5 years. CERs get ₹5,000 crore per CER, and the 20 new waterways begin with NW-5 (Odisha).

340. Per Budget 2026-27, where is the headquarters of the National Institute of Hospitality (upgraded NCHMCT)?

(A) New Delhi (B) Noida
(C) Goa (D) Hyderabad

B **Correct answer: (B) Noida** — The budget announced upgrading NCHMCT into a National Institute of Hospitality. NCHMCT is headquartered in Noida, Uttar Pradesh.

341. Which site is NOT among those named in the speech for the 15 archaeological sites?

(A) Lothal (B) Rakhigarhi
(C) Kalibangan (D) Adichanallur

C **Correct answer: (C) Kalibangan** — The seven sites named in the speech are Lothal, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Adichanallur, Sarnath, Hastinapur and Leh Palace. Kalibangan is not among them.

342. The "SHE-Marts" initiative of Budget 2026-27 relates to:

(A) A women safety app (B) Community retail outlets of SHG cluster federations
(C) Loans for women startups (D) A government procurement portal

B **Correct answer: (B) Community retail outlets of SHG cluster federations** — SHE-Marts build on the success of Lakhpati Didi. Cluster federations of self-help groups will run them as community retail outlets.

343. Which is correct about the Global Big Cat Summit (IBCA)?

(A) It was held in New Delhi on 1 June 2026 (B) It was announced in Budget 2026-27 and later postponed
(C) It is to be held in Mongolia (D) It is organised by UNEP

B **Correct answer: (B) It was announced in Budget 2026-27 and later postponed** — Budget 2026-27 (para 70) announced India's first Global Big Cat Summit. It was postponed before the proposed 1 June 2026 date, and no new date had been fixed by 8 August.

344. When was Uttar Pradesh's first separate Economic Review presented?

(A) 29 January 2026 (B) 1 February 2026
(C) 9 February 2026 (D) 11 February 2026

C **Correct answer: (C) 9 February 2026** — Uttar Pradesh presented its first separate Economic Review on 9 February 2026. The state budget came two days later, on 11 February.

345. As per the UP Economic Review, the state's GSDP in 2024-25 was:

(A) ₹13.30 lakh crore (B) ₹25.48 lakh crore
(C) ₹30.25 lakh crore (D) ₹36 lakh crore

C **Correct answer: (C) ₹30.25 lakh crore** — Per the Review, UP's GSDP rose from ₹13.30 lakh crore in 2016-17 to ₹30.25 lakh crore in 2024-25. The 2025-26 estimate is about ₹36 lakh crore.

346. UP's rank in completed houses under PM Awas Yojana (Gramin):

(A) First (B) Second
(C) Third (D) Fourth

C **Correct answer: (C) Third** — In completed PM Awas (Gramin) houses, Madhya Pradesh (43,38,053) is first, Bihar (41,89,147) second and UP (36,42,934) third. In PM Awas (Urban), UP is first.

347. About UP in the Export Preparedness Index (EPI) 2024:

1. UP ranked fourth.
2. UP was first among landlocked large states.
3. UP was second in EPI 2022.

Correct?

(A) Only 1 and 2 (B) Only 2 and 3
(C) Only 1 (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) Only 1 and 2** — In EPI 2024 UP ranked fourth and was first among landlocked large states. In EPI 2022 UP was 7th, not second, so the third statement is wrong.

348. Size and presenter of UP Budget 2026-27:

(A) ₹8,08,736 crore — Yogi Adityanath (B) ₹9,12,696.35 crore — Suresh Kumar Khanna
(C) ₹9,12,696.35 crore — Keshav Prasad Maurya (D) ₹8,48,233 crore — Suresh Kumar Khanna

B **Correct answer: (B) ₹9,12,696.35 crore — Suresh Kumar Khanna** — UP Budget 2026-27 of ₹9,12,696.35 crore was presented by Finance Minister Suresh Kumar Khanna on 11 February 2026. It is 12.9% more than last year's BE.

349. Fiscal deficit in UP Budget 2026-27 as a share of GSDP:

(A) 2.5% (B) 2.98%
(C) 3.0% (D) 3.5%

B **Correct answer: (B) 2.98%** — UP's fiscal deficit is ₹1,18,480.59 crore, or 2.98% of GSDP. The FRBM limit is 3%, with an extra 0.5% allowed for power-sector reforms.

350. Which sector has the largest share in UP Budget 2026-27?

(A) Agriculture (B) Medical
(C) Education (D) Energy

C **Correct answer: (C) Education** — Education has the largest sector-wise share (12.4%) in UP Budget 2026-27. Agriculture (9%) and medical (6%) follow.

Chapter 17 · Supplement Update: UP, Indices, Schemes, Defence, Awards, Appointments

351. Who became the first woman Director General of the Geological Survey of India (GSI)?

(A) Varsha Ashok Kawade (B) Varsha Ashok Aglawe
(C) Sonali Mishra (D) Anita Karwal

B **Correct answer: (B) Varsha Ashok Aglawe** — Varsha Ashok Aglawe became GSI's 54th and first woman Director General in August 2026. "Kawade" is a wrong spelling; GSI was founded in 1851.

352. India's rank in The Heritage Foundation's Index of Economic Freedom 2026:

(A) 128th (B) 126th
(C) 132nd (D) 136th

C **Correct answer: (C) 132nd** — India is 132nd in the Heritage Foundation's 2026 index. 128th was the 2025 rank, so read the year in the question before answering.

353. Correct name and coverage of the World Bank-backed UP agriculture project:

(A) UP-AGRIS — 18 districts (B) UP-AGREES — 28 districts
(C) UP-AGREES — 75 districts (D) UP-KISAN — 28 districts

B **Correct answer: (B) UP-AGREES — 28 districts** — The correct name is UP-AGREES, covering 28 districts of Purvanchal and Bundelkhand. It is a project of about ₹3,900 crore with a World Bank loan of about ₹2,737 crore.

354. Uttar Pradesh's position in the popular-choice tableau category of the 77th Republic Day 2026:

(A) First (B) Second
(C) Third (D) No position

B **Correct answer: (B) Second** — In popular choice, Gujarat was first, Uttar Pradesh (culture of Bundelkhand) second and Rajasthan third. In the jury category, Maharashtra was first.

355. Where is India's first night safari being developed?

(A) Kukrail, Lucknow (B) Dudhwa, Lakhimpur
(C) Katarniaghat, Bahraich (D) Chambal, Etawah

A **Correct answer: (A) Kukrail, Lucknow** — India's first night safari is coming up in Lucknow's Kukrail reserve forest on the Singapore model. It is described as the world's fifth night safari.

356. "Project GANGA" (rural broadband) is an agreement between:

(A) UP government and Reliance Jio (B) UP government and the Hinduja Group
(C) Centre and BSNL (D) UP government and the Tata Group

B **Correct answer: (B) UP government and the Hinduja Group** — Project GANGA is an agreement between the UP government and the Hinduja Group. It aims to take fast broadband to 20 lakh rural households.

357. India's first AI-enabled state university pilot is at:

(A) Lucknow University (B) Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut
(C) BHU, Varanasi (D) Chandigarh University, Unnao

B **Correct answer: (B) Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut** — The Skill Development Ministry and Google Cloud chose Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut for the first AI-enabled state university pilot. Chandigarh University's Unnao campus is the private AI campus.

358. India's first glass museum is being developed in:

(A) Khurja (B) Firozabad
(C) Moradabad (D) Bhadohi

B **Correct answer: (B) Firozabad** — India's first glass museum is being developed in Firozabad, the glass city. Khurja is known for pottery and Moradabad for brassware.

359. Match (Index 2026 — India's rank):

List-I	List-II
A. Energy Transition Index	1. 32nd
B. Global Soft Power Index	2. 105th
C. Global AI Brain Race	3. 70th
D. V-Dem Liberal Democracy	4. Sixth

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (D) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — In 2026 India is 70th in the Energy Transition Index, 32nd in soft power, sixth in the AI Brain Race and 105th in V-Dem liberal democracy. In electoral democracy India is 106th.

360. Statements about the PM Viksit Bharat Rozgar (ELI) Yojana:

1. Its outlay is about ₹99,446 crore.
2. Its target is 3.5 crore new jobs in two years.
3. It is a scheme of the Ministry of Education.

Correct?

(A) Only 1 and 2 (B) Only 2 and 3
(C) Only 1 (D) 1, 2 and 3

A **Correct answer: (A) Only 1 and 2** — The ELI scheme has an outlay of about ₹99,446 crore and targets 3.5 crore jobs in two years. It belongs to the Ministry of Labour and Employment, so statement 3 is wrong.

361. Where was the "NAKSHA" programme pilot launched?

(A) Raisen, Madhya Pradesh (B) Sehore, Madhya Pradesh
(C) Barabanki, Uttar Pradesh (D) Nagpur, Maharashtra

A **Correct answer: (A) Raisen, Madhya Pradesh** — Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched the NAKSHA pilot from Raisen, Madhya Pradesh. It is the Department of Land Resources' land survey of urban habitations.

362. Under ULLAS, the first fully literate Union Territory and the first state are:

(A) Ladakh, Mizoram (B) Lakshadweep, Kerala
(C) Ladakh, Goa (D) Puducherry, Tripura

A **Correct answer: (A) Ladakh, Mizoram** — Under ULLAS, Ladakh became the first fully literate Union Territory. Among states, Mizoram was first, followed by Goa, Tripura, Himachal Pradesh and Sikkim.

363. What is DRDO's "Dhvani"?

(A) A sonar system (B) A hypersonic glide vehicle
(C) An anti-drone system (D) A communication satellite

B **Correct answer: (B) A hypersonic glide vehicle** — Dhvani is DRDO's indigenous hypersonic glide vehicle, faster than Mach 5. It is a big step in India's hypersonic capability.

364. Where is India's first overseas defence manufacturing plant?

(A) Armenia (B) Morocco (Berrechid)
(C) Philippines (D) Vietnam

B **Correct answer: (B) Morocco (Berrechid)** — Tata Advanced Systems set up India's first overseas defence manufacturing plant at Berrechid, Morocco. It will build WhAP 8x8 armoured vehicles.

365. Match (military exercise — partner):

List-I	List-II
A. Vajra Prahar	1. India-Japan
B. Dharma Guardian	2. India-Vietnam
C. Lamitiye	3. India-USA
D. VINBAX	4. India-Seychelles

(A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (B) A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2 (C) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (D) A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2** — Vajra Prahar is India-USA, Dharma Guardian India-Japan, Lamitiye India-Seychelles and VINBAX India-Vietnam. So the correct match is A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2.

366. Which statement about INS Tamal is correct?

(A) It was built at GRSE Kolkata (B) It is India's last major warship built abroad
(C) It is a submarine (D) It was built at Mazagon Dock

B **Correct answer: (B) It is India's last major warship built abroad** — INS Tamal is a stealth frigate built at the Yantar Shipyard in Kaliningrad, Russia. It is India's last major warship built abroad.

367. India's first two Ramsar Wetland Cities are:

(A) Bhopal and Indore (B) Indore and Udaipur
(C) Udaipur and Srinagar (D) Kolkata and Chennai

B **Correct answer: (B) Indore and Udaipur** — Indore and Udaipur are India's first two cities to receive Ramsar Wetland City accreditation. The accreditation recognises urban wetland conservation.

368. Ratapani Tiger Reserve has been renamed in honour of:

(A) Salim Ali (B) Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar
(C) Jim Corbett (D) Kailash Sankhala

B **Correct answer: (B) Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar** — Ratapani has been renamed the Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar Tiger Reserve. Wakankar discovered the Bhimbetka rock paintings.

369. Which is correct about Kirsty Coventry?

(A) First woman Secretary-General of UN Tourism (B) First woman and first African President of the IOC
(C) Seventh Commonwealth Secretary-General (D) First woman President of FIFA

B **Correct answer: (B) First woman and first African President of the IOC** — Zimbabwe's Kirsty Coventry is the first woman and first African President of the IOC. The first woman Secretary-General of UN Tourism is Shaikha Nasser Al Nowais.

370. Match (post — person):

List-I	List-II
A. UPSC Chairman	1. Parag Jain
B. 23rd Law Commission	2. Mithun Manhas
C. RAW chief	3. Dr. Ajay Kumar
D. BCCI President	4. Justice Dinesh Maheshwari

(A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2 (B) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2 (C) A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2 (D) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

A **Correct answer: (A) A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2** — UPSC Chairman is Dr. Ajay Kumar, 23rd Law Commission Chairman Justice Dinesh Maheshwari, RAW chief Parag Jain and BCCI President Mithun Manhas. So the correct match is A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2.